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Essence of Traditional Chinese Medicine

《Essence of Traditional Chinese Medicine》 — Asiapac Editorial · World Scientific

A page-faithful English edition of *Essence of Traditional Chinese Medicine* (Asiapac / World Scientific), compiled by Asiapac Editorial with Dr Zhu Wenjun, Dr Lin Yuan and Dr Cheng Sim Kim, illustrated by Fu Chunjiang. All 361 figures, diagrams, channel charts and herb photographs are cropped from the source scan and placed where the book prints them.

192 pages translated · 361 figures · p001–p192

BOOK PAGE -8 · SCAN P001

Essence of Traditional Chinese Medicine

Essence of Traditional Chinese Medicine

Front cover. The title *Essence of TRADITIONAL CHINESE MEDICINE* is printed in orange capitals between two thin gold rules. Below the title sits a small gold emblem of a landscape seal, followed by the Chinese characters 中医 (Traditional Chinese Medicine). In the centre, a large orange medallion carries the white Chinese character 药 (medicine), encircled by fine line drawings of medicinal plants and herbs — ginseng roots, flowering stems, leaves, berries and tubers. At the foot of the cover are the publisher's logos: Asiapac Books (亚太图书) on the left and World Scientific on the right.

BOOK PAGE -7 · SCAN P002

Essence of Traditional Chinese Medicine

Essence of Traditional Chinese Medicine

Title page. The title is repeated in black capitals beneath the same thin rules and the same small gold landscape seal with the characters 中医, and the orange medallion with 药 is reproduced in grey above the imprint details.

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BOOK PAGE -6 · SCAN P003

Trang -6

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BOOK PAGE -5 · SCAN P004

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BOOK PAGE -4 · SCAN P005

Publisher's Note

Publisher's Note

Traditional Chinese medicine has a long history, and it is known throughout the world for its unique methods of diagnosis and treatment. Some of the fundamental concepts of traditional Chinese medicine are already part of our ingrained habits. During the hot summer months, we drink herbal tea to cool down; when the weather turns cold, we consume tonics; when we feel flushed and dry in the mouth, we consume cooling foods; but when our lips and nails are pale, it is a sign of anaemia, so we consume foods that will replenish the blood....

It is our hope to make the world of traditional Chinese medicine accessible to everyone. The book explains the fundamental theories behind traditional Chinese medicine with the help of easy-to-understand diagrams, covers the methods of diagnosis and treatment, and introduces famous historical physicians who influenced the development of traditional Chinese medicine.

This book is the product of a collaborative effort on the part of the Asiapac editorial team to research and compile materials in consultation with authorities on traditional Chinese medicine. Special thanks go to Mr Zhu Wenjun, Dr Lin Yuan and Dr Cheng Sim Kim for their invaluable contributions.

We also wish to thank Mr Fu Chunjiang for his vibrant illustrations, Ms Y N Han for the translation and Mr Zhu Wenjun for writing the foreword. At the same time, we would like to thank Mr Huang Ruide for his assistance, Ms Wong Wan Ling for her editorial support and Ms Wu Li Bin for providing information on Chinese medical bodies in Singapore. Finally, we wish to thank the production team for their hard work that has made this publication possible.

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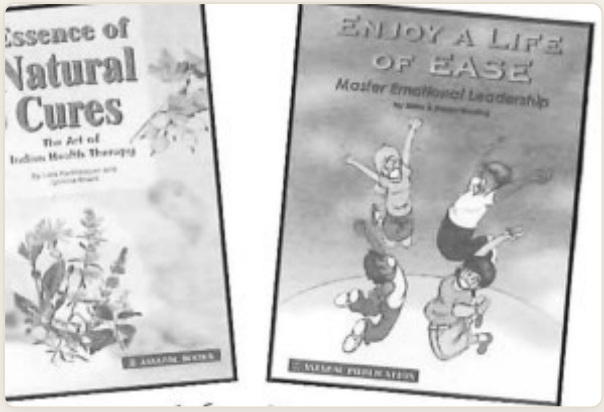
FIG. 1



Two small book-cover thumbnails placed side by side: on the left, the cover of Essence of Natural Cures, showing line drawings of herbs and a leafy plant; on the right, the cover of Enjoy a Life of Ease, showing cartoon figures in motion on a light background.

BOOK PAGE -3 · SCAN P006

Foreword

Foreword

Traditional Chinese medicine is a treasure of the Chinese civilization and an unique aspect of Chinese science and technology, with a history going back thousands of years. The tireless efforts of our forefathers have helped it develop into a unique branch of medicine. Though it originated in China, traditional Chinese medicine is an asset to the human race. To benefit the greatest number of people, it has to go global.

It came to Singapore with the early Chinese immigrants. But that was only a spontaneous situation. With the development of Chinese medicine and government emphasis on the training and development of traditional Chinese medicine in the eighties and nineties, interest and confidence in traditional Chinese medicine increased. While some opted for overseas training, others stayed home to study this branch of medicine. It is with the purpose of acquainting Singaporeans with Chinese medicine that this book has been published. At the same time, it is also in keeping with the current trend of going 'back to nature'.

Essence of Traditional Chinese Medicine provides a comprehensive and in-depth coverage of traditional Chinese medicine. Topics ranging from theories, practical experience and traditional material to modern technology offer a good foundation for understanding traditional Chinese

medicine. Diagrams and illustrations enhance understanding of the text. The practical aspect is made relevant and applicable; stories of famous physicians are put across in a lively manner. All these make this book an easy and informative read.

This book is not only for beginners or those who want a general guide to traditional Chinese medicine. It is also a good companion to families, with simple and effective tips to preserve health, underlining the importance of a healthy lifestyle, prevention of premature ageing and longevity.

Zhu Wenjun

Dean

TCM College (S) Pte Ltd

May 2003

Zhu Wenjun holds a Masters degree from China Pharmaceutical University and taught at Nanjing University of Traditional Chinese Medicine.

BOOK PAGE -2 · SCAN P007

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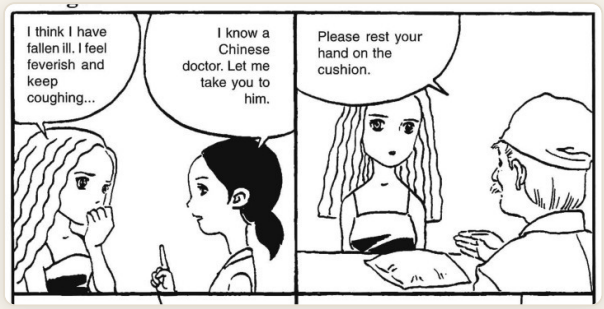
FIG. 2

Line illustration at the foot of the contents page. On the left stands an ancient Chinese physician in a scholar's cap and long flowing robes, holding a scroll, beside bundles of bamboo slips and a cabinet or screen inscribed with Chinese characters. Facing him is a modern physician in a white coat with a stethoscope hung around his neck. Below them, in the foreground, are a shallow bowl with a cutting tool and a desktop computer with monitor, keyboard and mouse. A large black brushstroke circle sweeps behind the modern doctor, linking the old and the new.

Prologue

Prologue

FIG. 3



Top row of the comic strip, three panels. A girl with wavy hair, looking unwell, tells her friend that she thinks she has fallen ill; her friend answers that she knows a Chinese doctor and will take her to him; in the third panel the girl sits at a table facing the elderly physician, who asks her to rest her hand on the cushion.

"I think I have fallen ill. I feel feverish and keep coughing..."

"I know a Chinese doctor. Let me take you to him."

"Please rest your hand on the cushion."

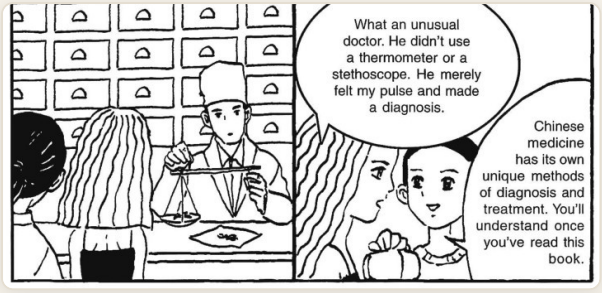
FIG. 4

Middle row, two panels. The physician holds the girl's wrist to feel her pulse and asks whether she coughs often; then he tells her that she has caught a mild cold and writes her a prescription.

"Do you cough often?"

"You've caught a mild cold. I'll write you a prescription. You may pick the medicines outside."

FIG. 5



Bottom row, two panels. Behind the counter of a traditional pharmacy, a pharmacist weighs herbs on a balance in front of a wall of medicine drawers; the two girls talk over the consultation.

"What an unusual doctor. He didn't use a thermometer or a stethoscope. He merely felt my pulse and made a diagnosis."

"Chinese medicine has its own unique methods of diagnosis and treatment. You'll understand once you've read this book."

BOOK PAGE 1 · SCAN P010

The Concept and Theory Behind Chinese Medicine

The Concept and Theory Behind Chinese Medicine

The art of Chinese medicine has a history that goes back a few thousand years. It integrates the concepts of yin and yang, five elements, and the union of man and nature in Chinese philosophy into a unique theory and system that stands as one of a kind in the medical world. Its outstanding therapeutic efficacy has also gained widespread recognition.

BOOK PAGE 2 · SCAN P011

Yin and Yang

Yin and Yang

Everything in creation is categorised into yin (vital essence) and yang (vital energy). For example, in the celestial system, the moon is yin while the sun is yang. In the human system, females are yin while males are yang. The interaction of yin and yang induces changes and causes life on earth to proliferate. Yin and yang complement each other. Together, they trigger off changes in the universe and gives rise to abundant life.

Fire and water are the signs of yin-yang, reflecting its basic characteristics. Water is cold, restrictive and is relatively stagnant. It is yin in nature. Fire is hot, stimulates and feeds, and is relatively active. It belongs to the yang category.

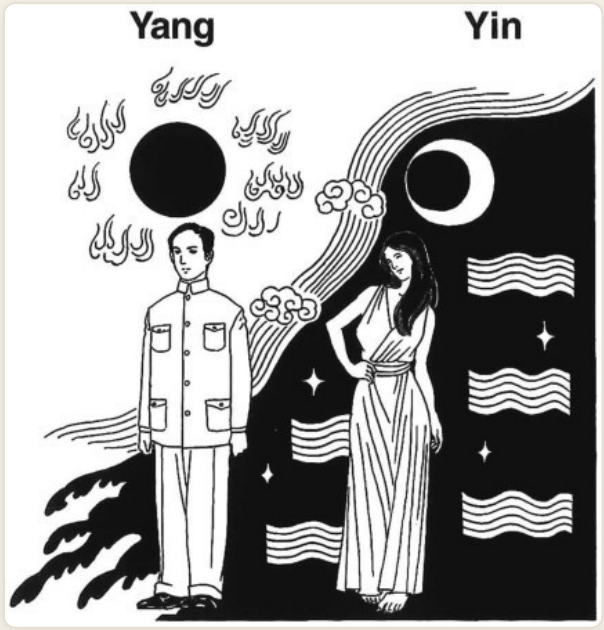
Basic traits of yin-yang:

Yin: Passive, descending, internal, has a form, cold, dark, suppresses, yielding.

Yang: Active, rising, external, formless, warm, bright, stimulates, firm.

Yin and yang cannot stand alone, nor can they exist in an unequal state. For example, the right side means there is a left side. Left and right have to co-exist. It is a complementary and restrictive relationship. They harmonise with and balance each other.

FIG. 6



The Yang and Yin contrast, drawn as two halves of one page. On the left, headed Yang, a man in a buttoned tunic stands against a white ground under a solid black sun wreathed in flames — the hot, bright, active, male principle. On the right, headed Yin, a woman in a long pleated dress stands against a black ground beside a white crescent moon, over stylised water waves and stars — the cold, dark, receptive, female principle. A band of cloud scrolls separates the two halves down the middle.

Application in Chinese medicine

Application in Chinese medicine

- - When a person's yin and yang are in balance, there is good health.
- - When the yin and yang are not in balance, there is ill health.
- - When yin and yang leave the body, death comes.

The makeup of the human body is also categorized into yin and yang:

- - The upper body is yang; the lower body is yin.
- - The exterior is yang; the interior is yin.
- - The back is yang; the chest and abdomen are yin.
- - The heart, liver, spleen, lungs and kidneys are yang; the stomach, gallbladder, intestines and bladder are yin.

BOOK PAGE 4 · SCAN P013

Ailments may be classified as yin and yang as well:

Ailments may be classified as yin and yang as well:

	Yin Syndrome	Yang Syndrome
Causes	Excessive yin influences.	Excessive yang influences.
Symptoms	Pallor, sensitivity to cold, body feels cold to the touch, fatigue, lack of thirst, prefers warm drinks, passes a lot of clear urine, thin stools.	Flushed face, bloodshot eyes, body feels warm to the touch, dry mouth, prefers cold drinks, passes yellow urine, dry and hard stools.

FIG. 7

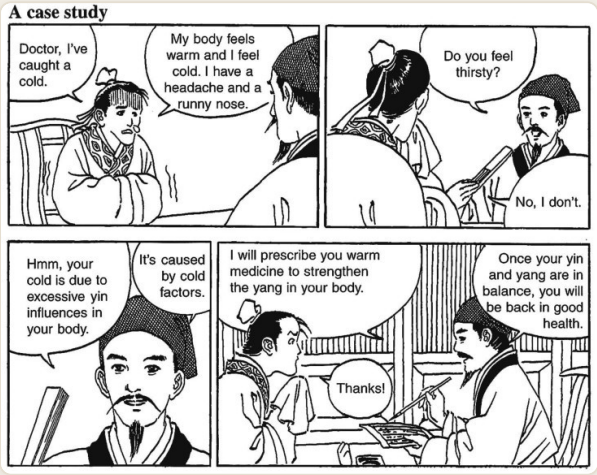
The shaded header band of the table: two grey panels lettered Yin Syndrome on the left and Yang Syndrome on the right, split by a black vertical rule.

FIG. 8

Two line drawings sitting inside the table's Symptoms cells. On the left, a woman with her hair in a high bun and a patterned collar, arms folded into her sleeves, shoulders hunched and shivering — the yin syndrome of cold. On the right, a bald man with a topknot in a sleeveless tunic, gripping a bowl in both hands, scowling and sweating with steam rising around his head — the yang syndrome of heat.

A case study

FIG. 9



A four-panel comic strip under the caption A case study. In the top-left panel a young woman wrapped in a thick robe, her hair in a bun, tells the doctor that she has caught a cold. In the top-middle panel the doctor, seen from behind, answers that her body feels warm and she feels cold, and that she has a headache and a runny nose. In the top-right panel the doctor asks whether she feels thirsty; she answers that she does not. In the bottom-left panel the doctor, in a scholar's cap with a thin moustache, holds a book and explains that her cold is due to excessive yin influences and is caused by cold factors. In the bottom-middle panel he writes at his desk, prescribing warm medicine to strengthen the yang in her body, while she thanks him. In the bottom-right panel he tells her that once her yin and yang are in balance she will be back in good health.

Trang 5

- - Doctor: "Next patient!"
- - Patient: "Doctor, I'm having a cold and a high fever. My head hurts and I'm perspiring."
- - Doctor: "Does your nose run or do you feel thirsty?"
- - Patient: "I don't have a runny nose. But I feel thirsty most of the time."
- - Doctor: "All right, I will write you a prescription."
- - Second patient: "Doctor, I saw another patient down with a cold collecting his prescription."
- - Second patient: "Why is his prescription different from mine?"
- - Doctor: "Although you both have colds, the conditions are different."
- - Doctor: "Your cold is caused by heatiness, so I'm writing you a cooling prescription to bring down the heat."
- - Doctor: "Once the yin in your body is strengthened and the yin-yang reaches a balance, you will recover from your cold."
- - Doctor: "The other patient's cold is caused by excessive yin, hence the different prescription."
- - Patient: "Oh, I see."

FIG. 10

The whole page is one comic strip in four rows, set in a physician's clinic with a bamboo blind and banana leaves in the garden behind. Row one: the doctor, a thin man in a long robe, calls for the next patient, then questions a bald, topknot-wearing man who complains of a cold, a high fever, a headache and sweating; the doctor then promises a prescription. Row two: the first patient, prescription in hand, reports the other man with a cold and asks why their prescriptions differ, and the doctor raises a hand to explain. Row three: the doctor, in a scholar's cap and moustache, points as he explains the cooling prescription and the need to strengthen yin. Row four: he concludes that the other patient's cold comes from excessive yin, and the patient scratches his head, enlightened. The page carries no printed heading or caption.

Five Elements

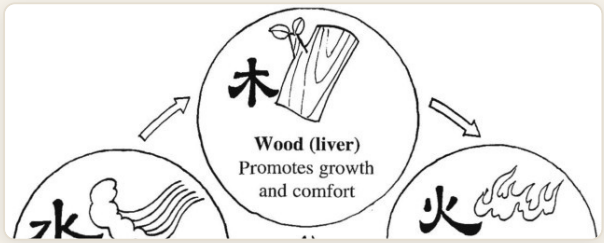
Five Elements

The five elements refer to metal, wood, water, fire and earth. The ancient people believed that the physical universe was made up of the five elements. The five elements support and oppose one another, thus maintaining the balance in the eco-system.

Chinese medicine also uses the five elements to explain the human body:

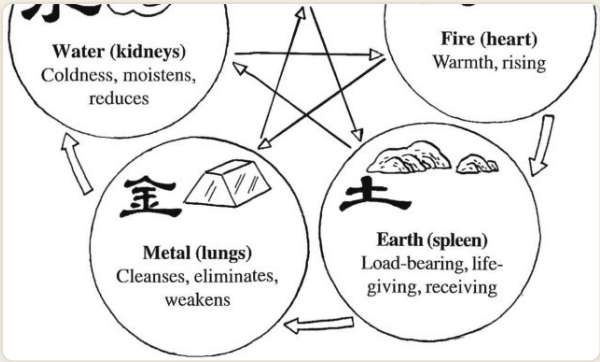
Element	Organ	Qualities
Wood (木)	liver	Promotes growth and comfort
Fire (火)	heart	Warmth, rising
Earth (土)	spleen	Load-bearing, life-giving, receiving
Metal (金)	lungs	Cleanses, eliminates, weakens
Water (水)	kidneys	Coldness, moistens, reduces

FIG. 11



The upper half of the circular diagram of the Five Elements. At the top, the circle for Wood holds the character 木 beside a plank of timber with a sprouting seedling, lettered Wood (liver) — Promotes growth and comfort. Below it, partly cut off, are the circle for Water with stylised flowing water on the left and the circle for Fire with leaping flames on the right. Bold outlined arrows curve between the circles in a clockwise direction.

FIG. 12

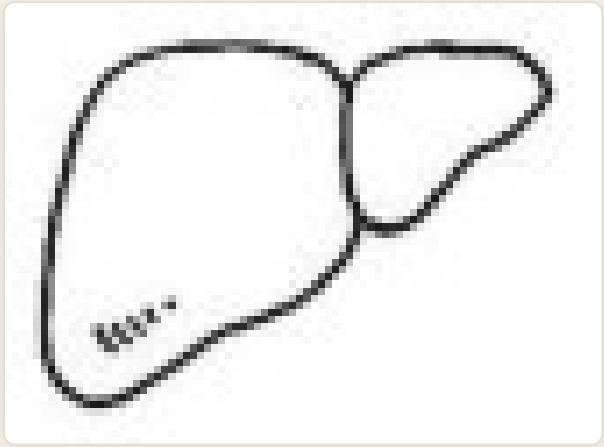


The lower half of the same circular diagram. It carries the circle for Water (水) with a flow of water, the circle for Metal (金) with a metal ingot, the circle for Earth (土) with two rounded mountains, and the circle for Fire (火) with flames. Each is lettered with its organ and qualities: Water (kidneys) — Coldness, moistens, reduces; Metal (lungs) — Cleanses, eliminates, weakens; Earth (spleen) — Load-bearing, life-giving, receiving; Fire (heart) — Warmth, rising. A five-pointed star of thin lines crosses the middle for the inhibiting relationships, while outlined arrows run clockwise around the outside for the constructive ones.

The constructive and inhibitive relationships among the Five Zang, or vital organs.

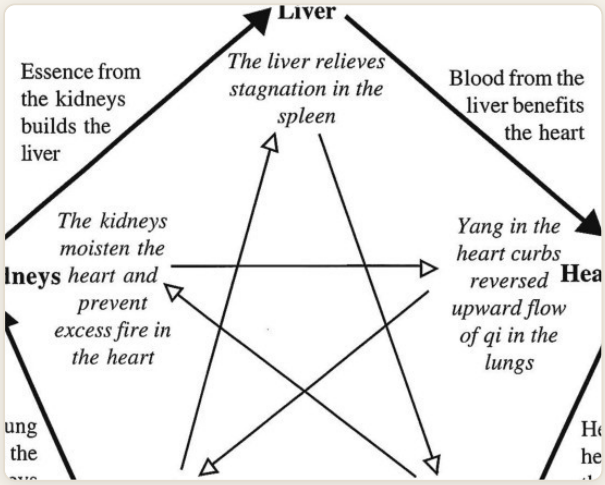
The constructive and inhibitive relationships among the Five Zang, or vital organs.

FIG. 13



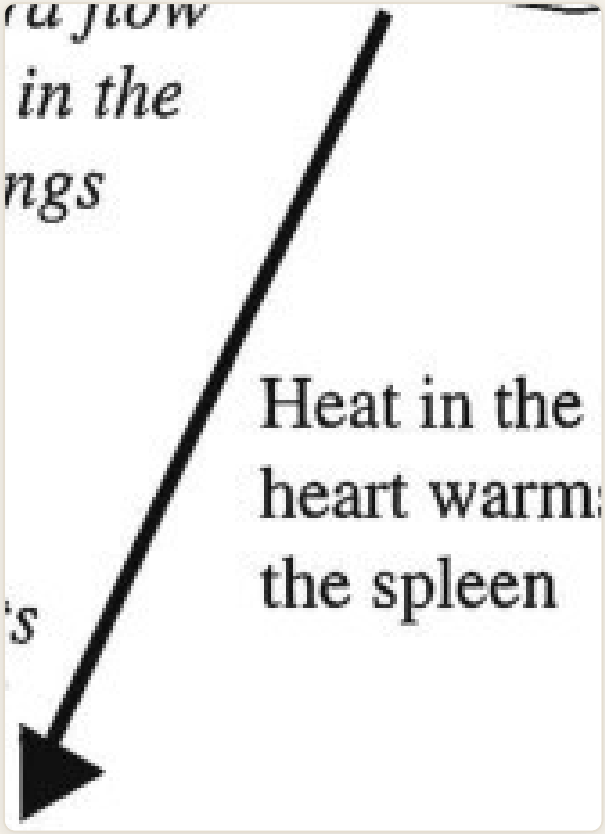
A small outline drawing of the liver, the organ named Liver at the top of the diagram.

FIG. 14



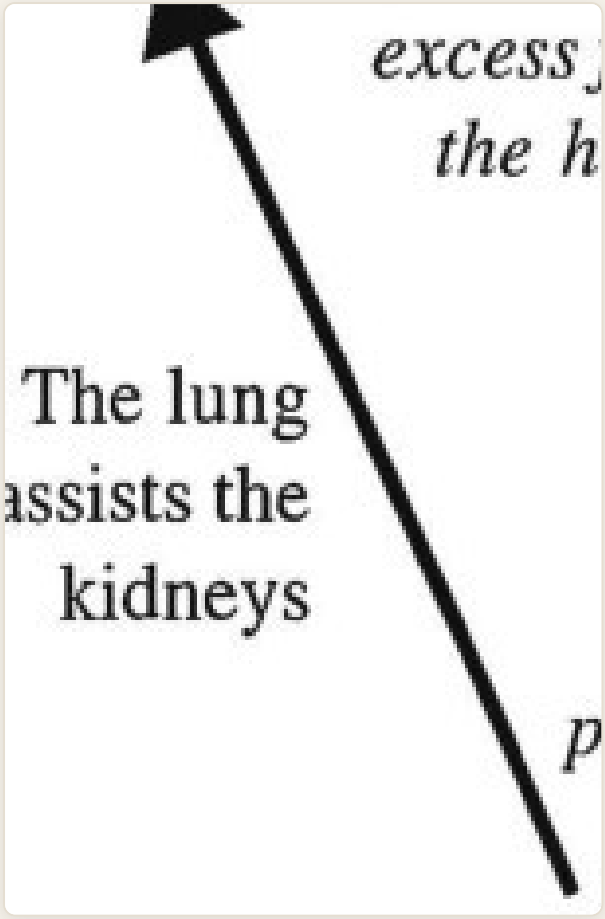
The central part of the diagram: the word Liver at the top, Kidneys on the left and Heart on the right, joined by bold solid arrows and crossed by a five-pointed star of thin lines. Lettering along the arrows reads Essence from the kidneys builds the liver, Blood from the liver benefits the heart, The liver relieves stagnation in the spleen, The kidneys moisten the heart and prevent excess fire in the heart and Yang in the heart curbs reversed upward flow of qi in the lungs.

FIG. 15



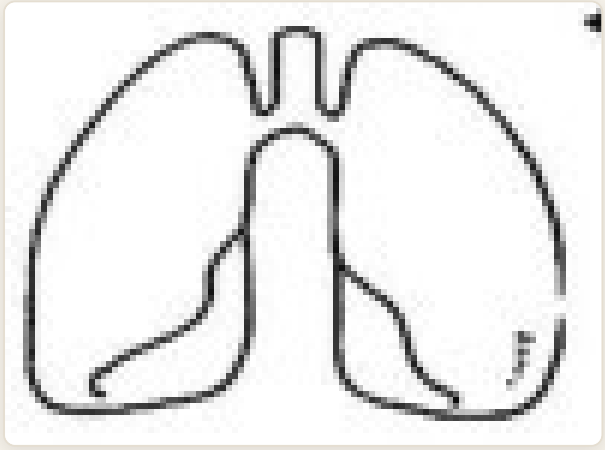
A detail from the lower right of the diagram: a bold solid arrow running down and to the left, lettered Heat in the heart warms the spleen, with the tail of the wording ...upward flow of qi in the lungs visible at the top left.

FIG. 16



A detail from the lower left of the diagram: a bold solid arrow running up and to the right, lettered The lung assists the kidneys, with the beginning of the wording excess... visible at the top right.

FIG. 17



A small outline drawing of the two lungs, the organ named Lungs at the lower left of the diagram.

- - Solid line — the constructive relationships
- - Thin line — the inhibitive relationships

BOOK PAGE 8 · SCAN P017

The Five Zang support and inhibit one another

The Five Zang support and inhibit one another

If one organ is infected or suffers internal injuries, ailments will arise. If no treatment is rendered, it will affect the other organs. This is an inhibiting relationship: Anger will affect and hurt the liver. The liver belongs to the wood element. Wood inhibits earth. Hence a highly-charged liver will unbalance the digestive functions of the spleen. The liver will in turn affect the kidneys (earth and water balance each other), becoming a vicious circle.

If one organ is not functioning properly, boosting the functions of other related organs will help the ailing organ resume normalcy. This is a constructive relationship. An example: Treating an ailment of the lungs may begin with a prescription of tonics for the spleen. The lungs belong to the metal element while the spleen belongs to the earth element; therefore a strong spleen will benefit the lungs as earth generates metal.

BOOK PAGE 9 · SCAN P018

Categorisation of Objects and Phenomena According to the Five Elements

Categorisation of Objects and Phenomena According to the Five Elements

	Wood	Fire	Earth	Metal	Water
Nature					
Seasons	Spring	Summer	Late Summer	Autumn	Winter
Directions	East	South	Center	West	North
Climate	Wind	Summer Humidity	Dampness	Dryness	Coldness
Changes	Germinate	Grow	Transform	Harvest	Store

Color	Green	Red	Yellow	White	Black
Flavors	Sour	Bitter	Sweet	Pungent	Salty
Tones	Jiao	Zheng	Gong	Shang	Yu
Human Body					
Five Senses	Eye	Tongue	Mouth	Nose	Ear
Zang Fu	Liver	Heart	Spleen	Lung	Kidney
	Gall Bladder	Small Intestine	Stomach	Large Intestine	Urinary Bladder
Tissue	Tendon	Vessel	Muscle	Skin, Hair	Bone
Emotions	Anger	Joy	Thinking	Melancholy	Fear
Sound	Shout	Laugh	Sing	Cry	Mourn

The Premise of Chinese Medicine

The Premise of Chinese Medicine

The human body as a unified system

Chinese medicine sees the human body as the sum of various parts that are linked to one another. Every organ, main and collateral channel, qi and blood flow does not function independently. Rather, they are interdependent. Hence, when there is a change to any one part, the other parts will be affected as well. In the diagnosis of ailments, the body is treated as a whole. External observation will assist in the diagnosis of internal ailments. Any treatment that follows should consider the interrelationships before it is recommended.

FIG. 18

A man in a loose white shirt and dark trousers stands with both arms raised, facing a large brush-drawn ring. Inside the ring coil a dragon on the left and a tiger on the right. Star constellations are dotted across the sky around him, and below his feet are rolling hills and flowing water.

The close relationship between man and environment

Natural factors like changes in the climate, time of the day, geographical locations affect human biological activities, bodily changes as well as the diagnosis and treatment of ailments to a certain extent. Nature is therefore regarded as part of the human makeup. They are interlinked.

BOOK PAGE 11 · SCAN P020

Eight Principal Syndromes

Eight Principal Syndromes

In traditional Chinese medicine, illnesses can be grouped into 'Eight Principal Syndromes': Yin-Yang, Exterior-Interior, Cold-Heat and Deficiency-Excess.

Yin-Yang

The primary syndrome among the Eight Principal Syndromes. Exterior, Heat and Excess belong under Yang; Interior, Cold and Deficiency belong to Yin. (Yin-Yang will be explained further in the following pages).

FIG. 19

A woman in a patterned robe bows her head and presses her hands together quietly — the yin, inward state — beside a burly man who clutches a bowl, scowls angrily and steams from the head — the yang, outward state.

Exterior-Interior

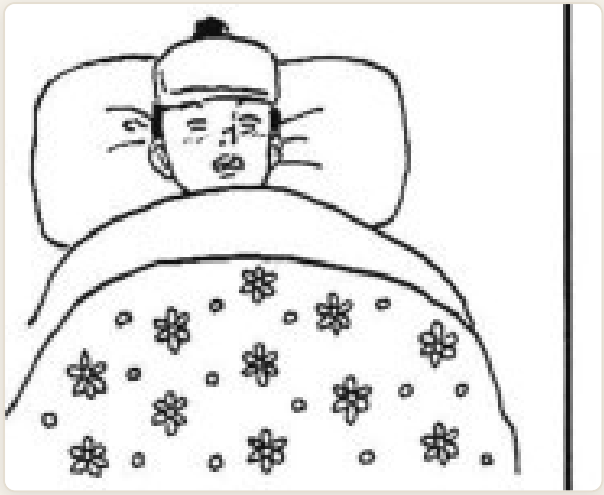
Some illnesses move from the surface into the interior. An illness at the exterior stage is trifling and is easily treated.

Once an illness invades the interior, it means the illness has become serious.

FIG. 20

A woman in a robe looks down with her arms folded across her chest, an illustration of an illness still at the exterior stage.

FIG. 21



A man lies in bed under a thick quilt patterned with snowflakes, his head propped on a pillow with a pained expression, an illustration of an illness that has invaded the interior.

Cold-Heat

The symptoms of cold are cold limbs, clear urine and pallor. The syndromes of heat include a flushed face, warm body, high irritability and constipation.

FIG. 22

A two-panel drawing. In the upper panel a woman hugs herself and shivers, while beside her a man fans himself and flames rise around him — cold and heat. In the lower panel a woman swoons with a spinning halo above her head, and a stout man presses both hands to his chest, doubled over — deficiency and excess.

Deficiency-Excess

Deficiency is marked by deficiency in qi and blood, a weak constitution, loss of weight, giddy spells etc. Excess is marked by symptoms such as rapid breathing, irritability and constipation.

BOOK PAGE 12 · SCAN P021

The Viscera (the Internal Organs — Five Zang and Six Fu)

The Viscera (the Internal Organs — Five Zang and Six Fu)

The viscera are the internal organs in a human body. They are classified into five *zang* organs and six *fu* organs:

The five *zang* organs are: heart, liver, spleen, lungs and kidneys.

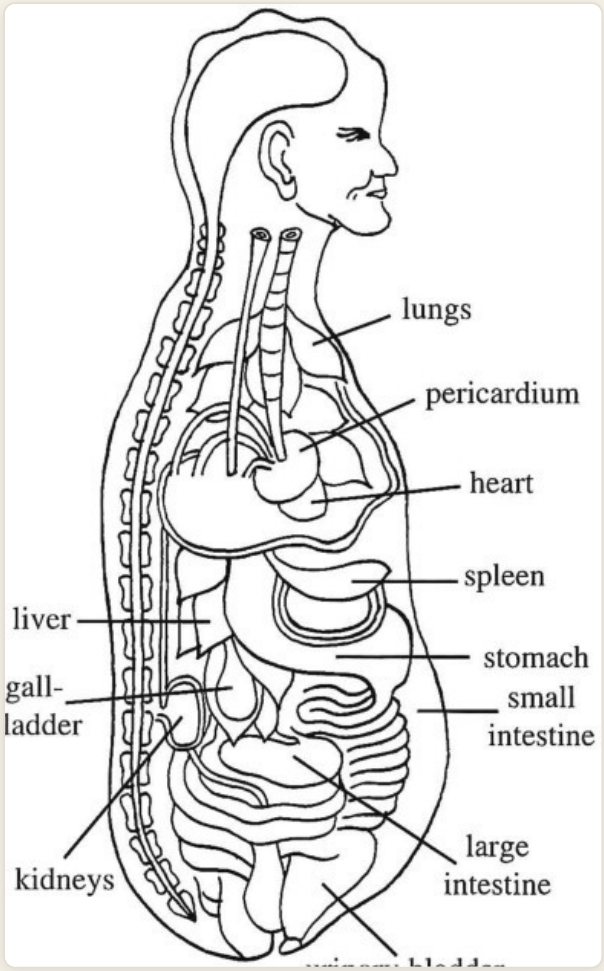
The six *fu* organs are: stomach, small intestine, large intestine, gallbladder, urinary bladder and Triple Energiser.

The five *zang* organs generate life and are the reservoirs of vital energy and the essence of life.

The six *fu* organs take in excesses and transform water and nutrients without storing them.

The five *zang* and six *fu* organs (the viscera) are one system with corresponding yin and yang balances.

FIG. 23



An ancient anatomical diagram showing the various organs of the body, drawn inside the outline of a human figure. Label lines point to the lungs, pericardium, heart, spleen, stomach, small intestine, large intestine, liver, gallbladder, kidneys and urinary bladder, and a chain of vertebrae runs up the spine. It has some differences from modern diagrams.

Five Zang (Yin) — Six Fu (Yang)

Five Zang (Yin)	Six Fu (Yang)
Heart	Small intestine
Liver	Gallbladder

Spleen	Stomach
Lungs	Large intestine
Kidneys	Urinary bladder
*Pericardium with its blood vessels	Triple Energiser

*Pericardium with its blood vessels: also known as *shan zhong*, it refers to the membrane (pericardium) surrounding the heart. It serves to protect the heart.

BOOK PAGE 13 · SCAN P022

Trang 13

Heart

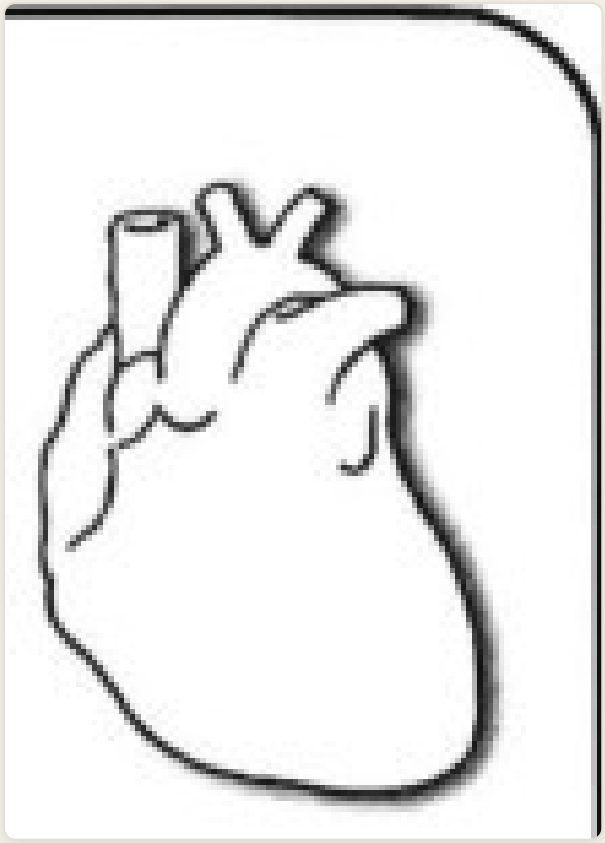
Controls activity and function of viscera.

Circulates blood and qi in the body, transporting nutrients to other parts of the body.

Perspiration is known as the fluid of the heart.

When the heart functions well and there is ample blood and fluids, one has rosy cheeks; when there is deficiency of blood and fluids, the face turns pale.

FIG. 24



Line drawing of a human heart, with the aorta and the large vessels rising from the top.

Liver

Stores and regulates blood volume.

Regulates the flow of qi, which affects the emotions.

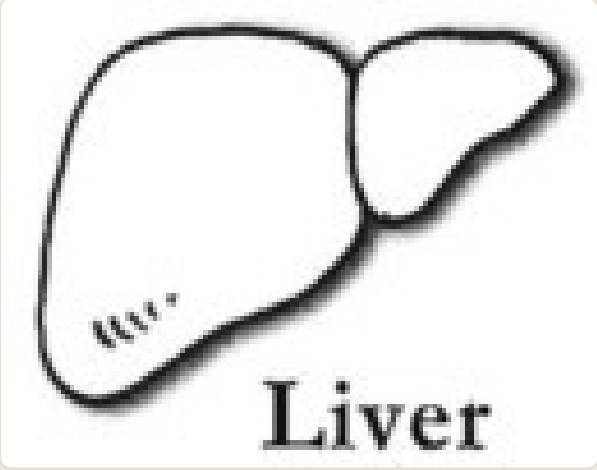
The soul and the spirit have the blood as their foundation.

As the liver stores blood, it also stores the soul.

Deficiency of yin and blood in the liver or excess of yang in the liver will cause irritability in a person.

Sufficient blood in the liver will show in strong and pink nails; insufficient blood in the liver will show in thin, soft and pale nails.

FIG. 25



Line drawing of a liver, showing the larger right lobe and the smaller left lobe.

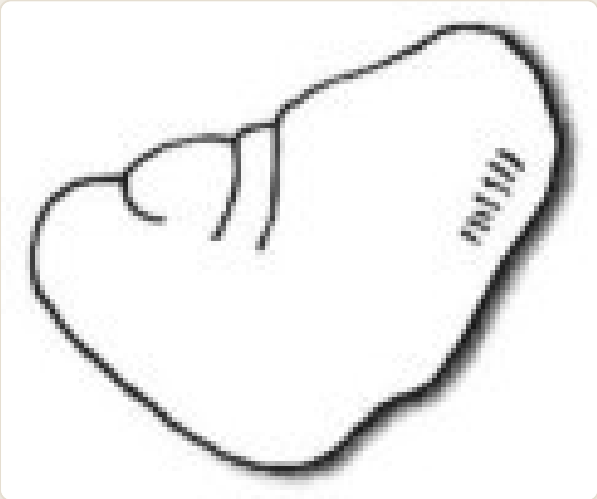
Spleen

Controls digestion and transport: Helps digest and absorb nutrients to be distributed through the body. Also transports bodily fluids and maintains fluid balance.

Regulates the flow of blood in the blood vessels: Helps nourish the limbs and muscles. A healthy spleen will mean strong limbs and muscles. Controls the flow of blood in the arteries and veins. Prevents bleeding.

Ample qi and blood will show in red and lustrous lips; deficiency of blood in the spleen will result in pale lips.

FIG. 26



Line drawing of a spleen, a broad bean-shaped organ with a notch on its inner border.

Lungs

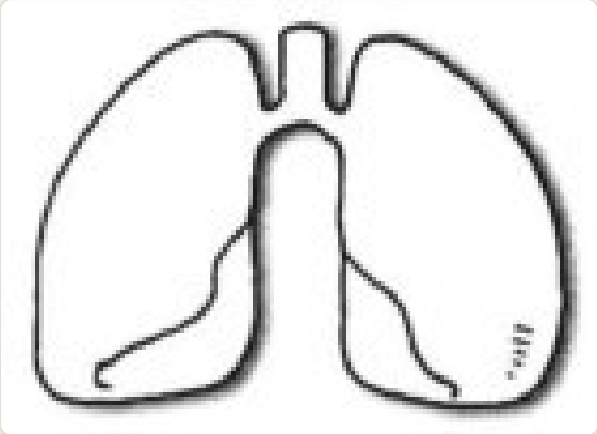
In charge of qi. Take in fresh air and expel carbon dioxide and other gases to maintain metabolism.

Regulate the movement of fluids and qi in the body; a fall directs qi downwards to the kidneys and urinary bladder to maintain the normal flow and expulsion of bodily fluids.

All blood in the body flows through the lungs to exchange fresh and stale air before travelling to other parts of the body.

Healthy skin reflects good lung function and is more resistant to pathogens.

FIG. 27



Line drawing of a pair of lungs flanking the trachea, which divides into the two bronchi.

Kidneys

Store the essence of the five *zang* and six *fu* organs. It is the basis of life that keeps life activity going.

Regulate water metabolism and control the distribution and expulsion of water and maintain water metabolism within the body.

Thick and glossy hair reflect young and healthy kidneys, while hair loss reflects weak and old kidneys.

Qi (Vital Energy), Blood and Bodily Fluids

Qi (Vital Energy), Blood and Bodily Fluids

Qi, blood and bodily fluids are the primary components that make up and sustain the human body. They are the basis on which the normal function of all the organs in the human body depend.

Qi

The vital energy is the basic element of life in a human body. Our vital energy is constantly circulating, rising, falling, getting expelled and being absorbed. We call these movements the 'qi mechanism'. The 'qi mechanism' refers to the increase, decrease and movement of qi, ie the physiological action of qi. A balanced qi mechanism maintains normal physiological activities. When the qi is out of balance, as when blockage in the qi flow results in a steep increase in the levels of qi and pent-up qi, it will lead to illnesses.

FIG. 28

Line drawing of a bearded sage in flowing robes standing with his hands folded into his sleeves, clouds of qi curling up on either side of him.

Blood and Bodily Fluids

The circulation of blood in the vessels serves to provide nutrients and moisture to the organs. This maintains normal physiological activities. A glowing complexion, glossy hair and firm muscles indicate a healthy blood circulation. The reverse will be manifested in symptoms such as giddy spells, a sallow complexion, dry hair, dry skin, forgetfulness and unconsciousness.

FIG. 29

Line drawing of a figure in a robe sitting huddled beneath a single enormous leaf that arches over him like a canopy.

The bodily fluids comprise fluids from the various organs and normal bodily secretions. These fluids keep the internal organs moist and may also transform into blood. Hence, an excessive expenditure of bodily fluids will lead to weak qi and blood circulation. Certain conditions like vomiting, diarrhoea and profuse perspiration will also lead to the depletion of bodily fluids. At the same time, shortness of qi, a pallid complexion and heartburn may manifest.

FIG. 30

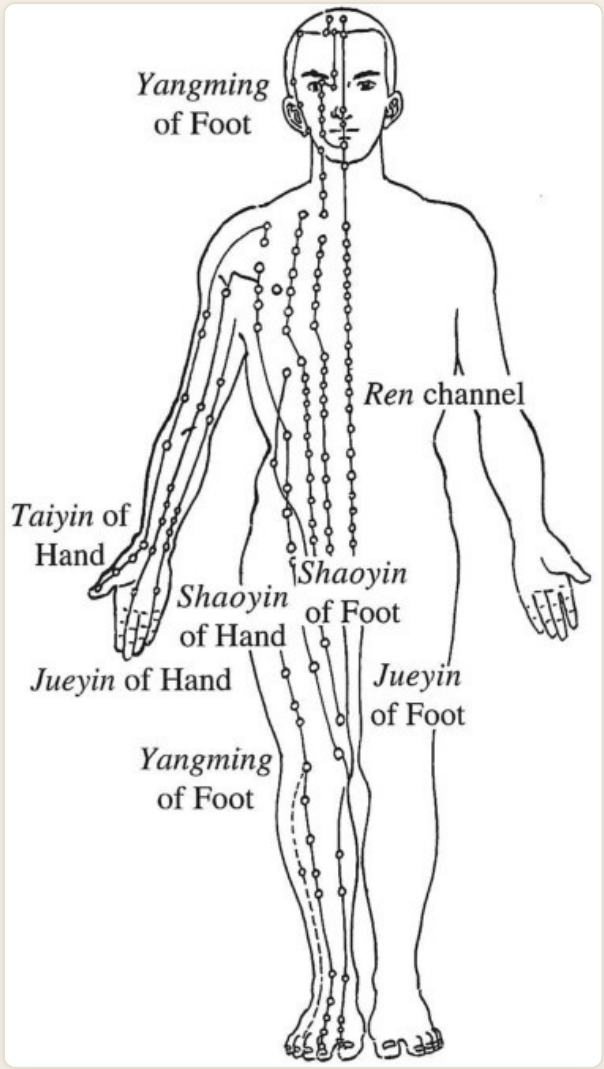
Line drawing of a figure in a robe lying on the ground propped up on one elbow, head resting on his hand.

Main and Collateral Channels, Acupuncture Points

Main and Collateral Channels, Acupuncture Points

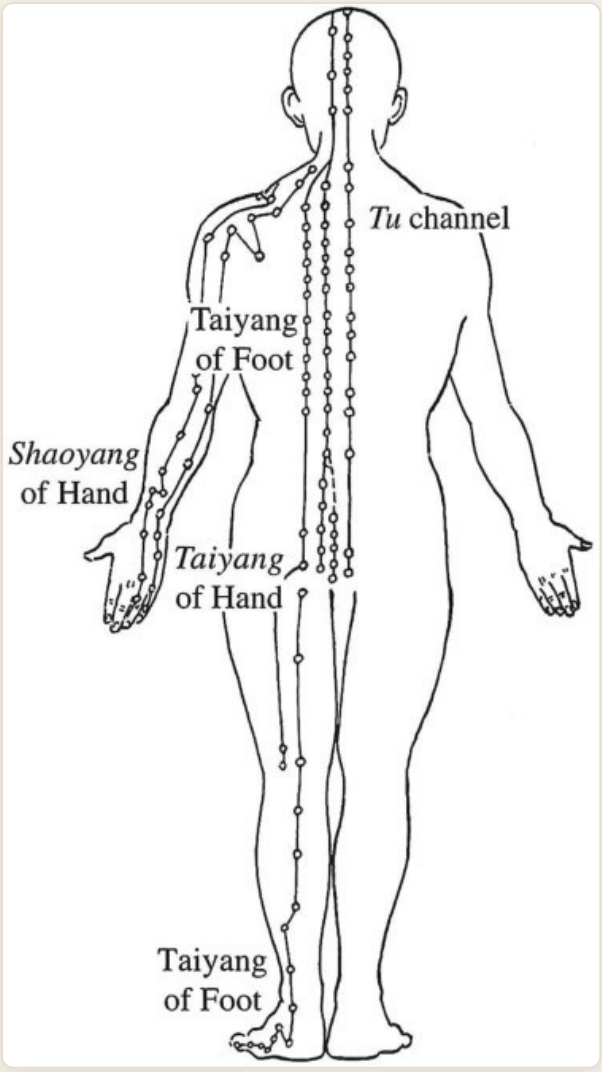
The main and collateral channels transport qi and blood, connects the organs, limbs and joints and are the interface between the exterior and the interior. The main and collateral channels have their designated order and related organs. They are able to reflect any ailment associated with the relevant organs.

FIG. 31



Front view of a male figure with the arms held slightly away from the body, showing the meridian pathways and the rows of acupuncture points running down the face, chest, abdomen and limbs. The pathways are labelled with their channel names: Yangming of Foot, Taiyin of Hand, Jueyin of Hand, Shaoyin of Hand, Shaoyin of Foot, Jueyin of Foot, Yangming of Foot, Ren channel and Tu channel.

FIG. 32



Back view of the same male figure, showing the meridian pathways and points running down the nape, spine, shoulders, arms and legs. The pathways are labelled Tu channel, Taiyang of Foot, Shaoyang of Hand, Taiyang of Hand and Taiyang of Foot.

BOOK PAGE 16 · SCAN P025

A Summary of the Channels and Collaterals

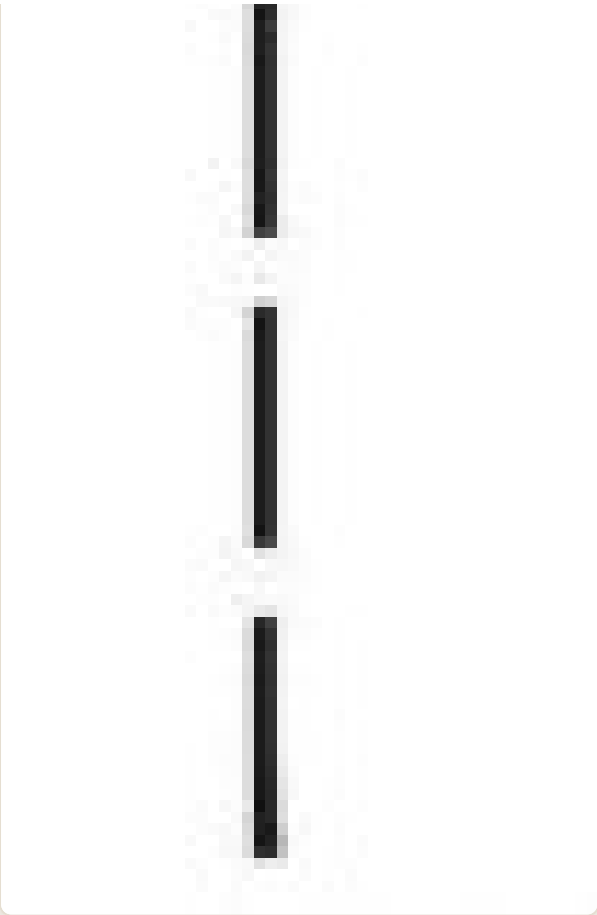
A Summary of the Channels and Collaterals

- - **The Channels and Collaterals**
- - **Channels (meridians)**
- - **Twelve Meridians**
- - **Three yin meridians of the hand**

- - Lung meridian of Hand *Taiyin*
- - Pericardium meridian of Hand *Jueyin*
- - Heart meridian of Hand *Shaoyin*
- - **Three yang meridians of the hand**
- - Large intestine meridian of Hand *Yangming*
- - Triple Energiser meridian of Hand *Shaoyang*
- - Small Intestine meridian of Hand *Taiyang*
- - **Three yin meridians of the foot**
- - Spleen meridian of Foot *Taiyin*
- - Kidney meridian of Foot *Shaoyin*
- - Liver meridian of Foot *Jueyin*
- - **Three yang meridians of the foot**
- - Stomach meridian of Foot *Yangming*
- - Gallbladder meridian of Foot *Shaoyang*
- - Bladder meridian of Foot *Taiyang*
- - **Branches of the Twelve Meridians** — the largest branches from the Twelve Meridians
- - **Eight Extra Meridians** — Governing Vessel, Conception Vessel, Thoroughfare Vessel, Belt Vessel, Yin Heel Vessel, Yang Heel Vessel, Yin Link Vessel and Yang Link Vessel
- - **Collaterals**
- - **Fifteen Main Collaterals** — *Lique, Tongli, Neiguan, Zhizheng, Pianli, Waiguan, Feiyang, Guangming, Fenglong, Gongsun, Dazhong, Ligou, Changqiang, Jiuwei and Dabao*
- - **Superficial Collaterals** — subdivided small branches of the meridian or capillaries
- - **Tertiary Collaterals** — collaterals lying just beneath the skin surface

FIG. 33

Twelve
Meridians



Vertical bracket label taken from the left-hand side of the chart, reading "Twelve Meridians" with a dashed line running down beside it.

Twelve Meridians: Also known as twelve regular meridians, each meridian corresponds to a *zang* or *fu* organ.

Eight Extra Meridians: No direct link to the *zang* and *fu* organs. They are supplementary to the twelve regular meridians.

Fifteen Main Collaterals: The larger of the collaterals in the body.

Branches of the Twelve Meridians: Supplementary passage to the twelve regular meridians for the flow of qi in the meridians.

BOOK PAGE 17 · SCAN P026

Main and collateral channels and acupoints

Main and collateral channels and acupoints

The main and collateral channels transport qi and blood, connect the organs, limbs and joints and are the interface between the exterior and the interior throughout the body. The main and

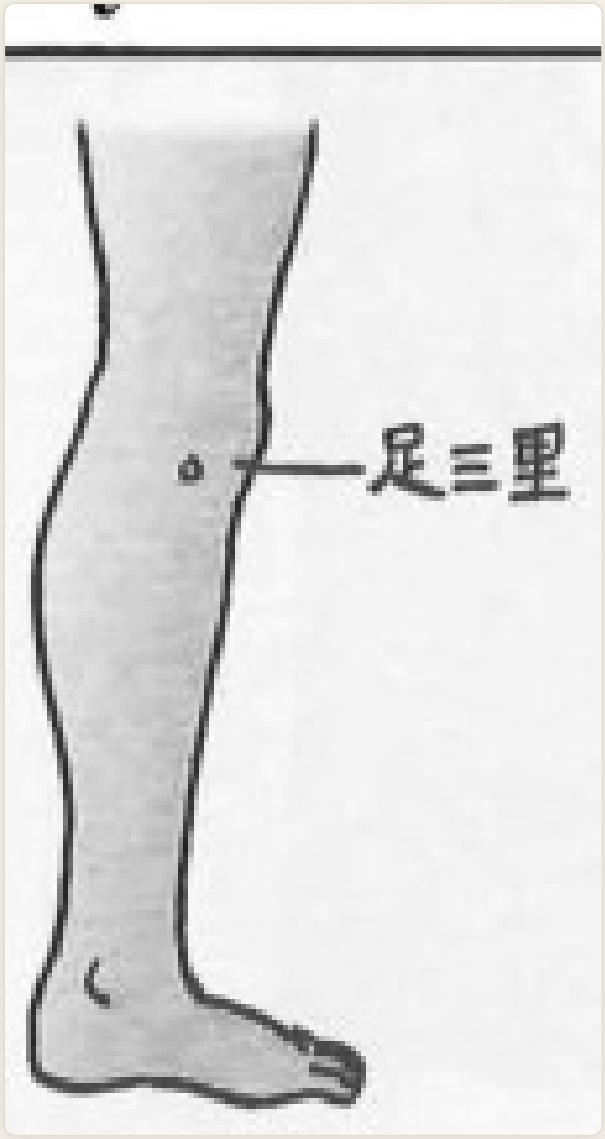
collateral channels have their designated order and related organs. They are able to reflect any ailment associated with the relevant organs.

An acupoint is a node where bundles of nervous tissue intersect. There are 720 acupoints in the human body, of which 108 are vital acupoints. Certain ailments may be treated via the stimulation of acupoints.

Commonly used acupoints

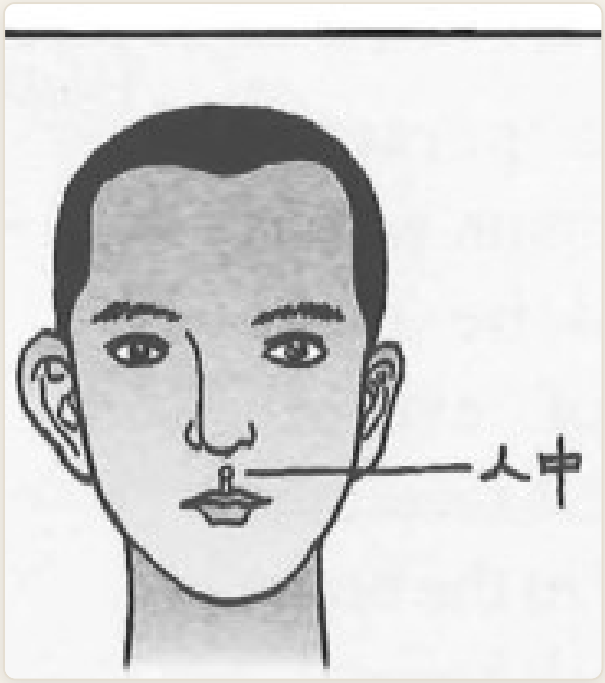
Acupoint	Treats
Zusanli Acupoint	Indigestion, abdominal pains, diarrhoea, gastric ailments and high blood pressure.
Renzhong Acupoint	Coma/unconsciousness. Also swollen faces and backaches as well.
Hegu Acupoint	Facial ailments. It also relieves headaches, toothaches, sore throats, colds, fevers etc.
Tongquan point	Headache, shock, partial paralysis, heat strokes, ringing in the ear, kidney infections, female ailments and diseases of the reproductive system.
Mingmen point	Impotency, low sperm count, weak limbs, deficiency of yang in the kidneys, backaches, ear diseases etc.
Baihui point	Headaches, dizziness, insomnia, neuroses, stroke and loss of speech, low blood pressure etc.

FIG. 34



Line drawing of a bare lower leg and foot seen from the side. A small dot marks the point on the outer shin below the knee, with a short line leading to the vertical Chinese label 足三里 (Zusanli).

FIG. 35



Line drawing of a man's face in front view. A dot marks the groove between nose and upper lip, joined by a line to the Chinese label 人中 (Renzhong).

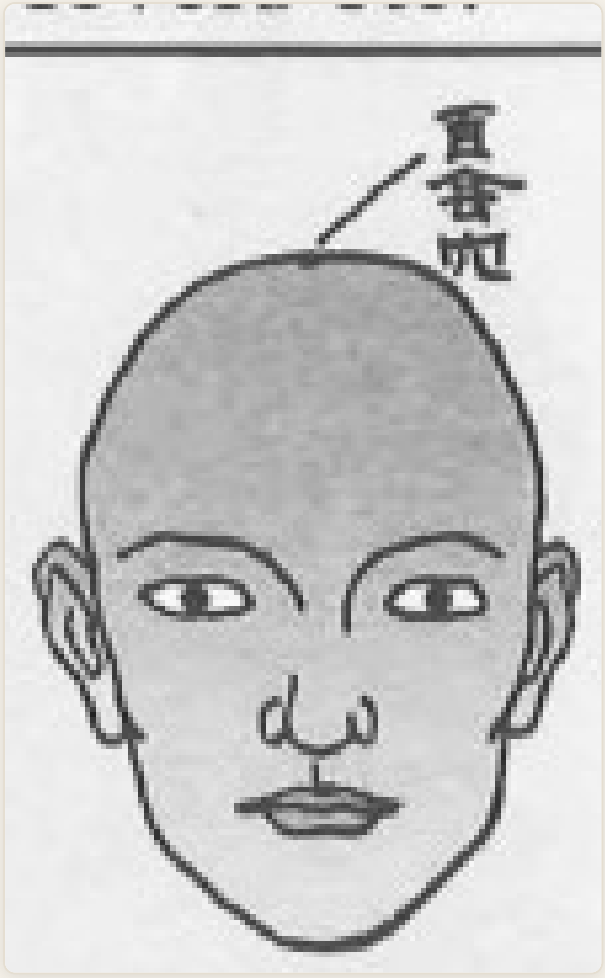
FIG. 36

Line drawing of the back of a right hand with the fingers spread. A dot marks the webbing between thumb and index finger, labelled 合谷 (Hegu).

FIG. 37

Line drawing of the sole of a foot, a dot in its upper third beside the vertical Chinese label 涌泉穴 (Tongquan/Yongquan point).

FIG. 38

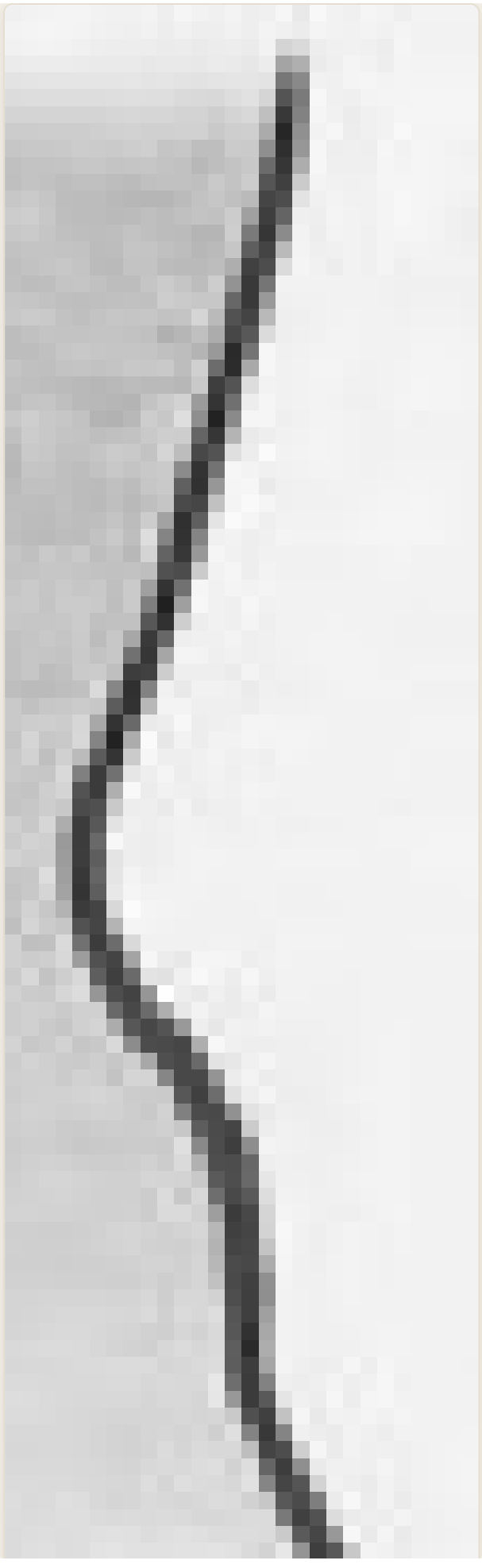


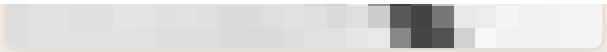
Line drawing of a bald man's head in front view, with the label 百會穴 placed above the crown and a short line pointing down to the top of the head (Baihui point).

FIG. 39

Fragment of the waist-and-abdomen line drawing for the Mingmen point: the long curving left-hand outline of the torso from chest to hip.

FIG. 40





The matching fragment of the same drawing: the curving right-hand outline of the torso, with the hollow of the waist.

BOOK PAGE 18 · SCAN P027

Endogenous and Exogenous Factors

Endogenous and Exogenous Factors

Endogenous Factors

Endogenous factors refer to excessive emotional changes. Traditional Chinese medicine recognises seven types of emotions, which will be addressed in a later chapter.

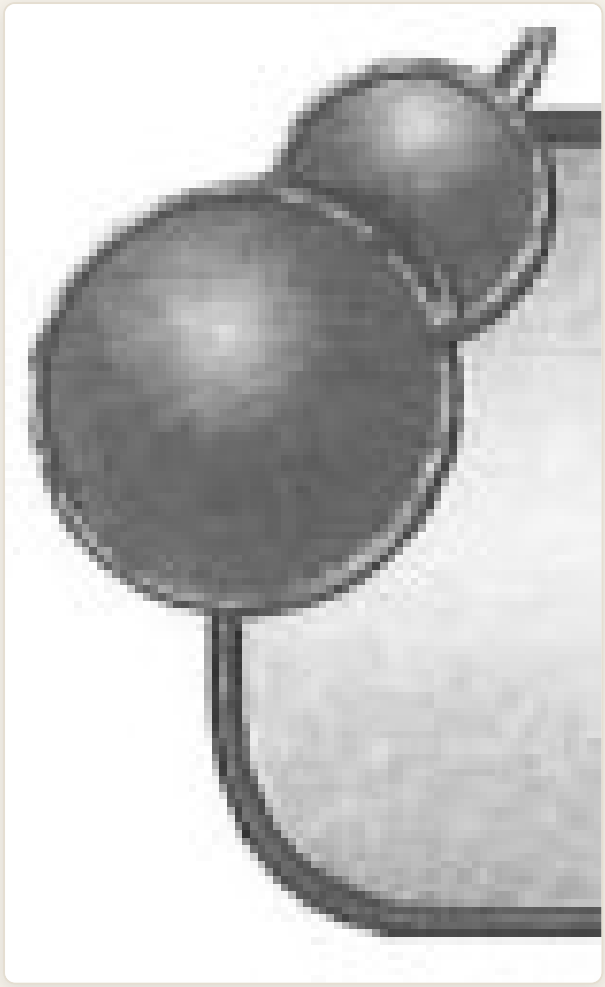
Health is affected by a person's emotional state. Hence, a person who is mentally distressed will be more susceptible to the assault of 'evil qi'. That's why traditional Chinese medicine holds that, "With positive qi in the body, evil qi will be unable to wreak havoc".

Exogenous Factors

Exogenous factors refer to environmental influences such as weather and climatic changes. There are six recognised atmospheric influences: wind, cold, summer heat, dampness, dryness and fire. These six atmospheric influences are unique to each season.

Sudden weather changes will cause the six atmospheric influences to go out of sync, as when the weather unexpectedly turns cold during spring or warm during winter. As the human body fails to cope with the sudden weather change, various ailments will arise.

FIG. 41



The decorative gourd that caps the left end of the chapter's grey title banner: two round lobes joined at the waist with a short stem at the top, the smaller lobe behind and above the larger one.

FIG. 42

Line drawing of a man in a long robe with his hair in a topknot, head bowed and shoulders hunched. Two puffs of curling vapour float around him — one in front of his face and one at his back — both lettered evil qi.

FIG. 43

Line drawing of a man in a wide-sleeved robe and topknot caught in a slanting downpour, dry leaves falling around him. He is turned to one side and sneezing hard, mouth open and drops flying from his nose, with the word Achoo! beside his face.

Trang 19

Wind occurs mostly in springtime although all the four seasons have their windy spells. Wind is the main culprit behind many ailments. As wind is mobile, evil qi like cold, dryness, dampness and heat will penetrate the human body to cause problems like colds and rheumatism.

Cold occurs during winter when air temperature decreases. Cold is evil yin which can harm yang. When the body is affected by cold, symptoms like fever, lack of perspiration and headache will manifest.

Summer heat during the hot summer season may cause dizzy spells, cold sweat and cold hands and feet. They are symptoms of heatstroke.

Dampness is caused by increased humidity in the air. In rainy seasons, the ground becomes damp. People fall ill easily.

Dryness occurs in autumn when humidity is low. Dryness causes dry throat and mouth, among other ailments.

Fire is caused by heat. Wind, cold, summer heat and dryness may all lead to fire. Symptoms include high fevers, a ruddy complexion, emotional distress, thirst, etc.

Neither Endogenous Nor Exogenous

Neither Endogenous Nor Exogenous

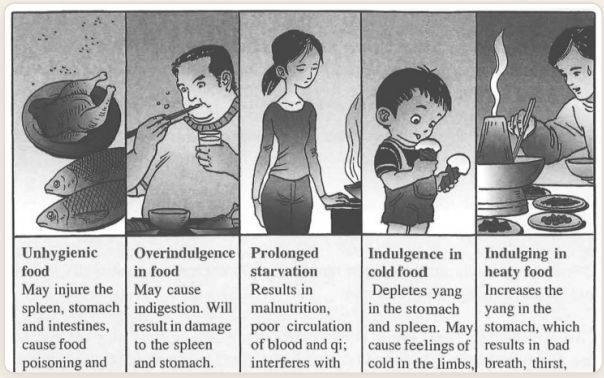
As the saying goes, "We are what we eat". Our diet is also one of the prime causes of many ailments.

	Unhygienic food	Overindulgence in food	Prolonged starvation	Indulgence in cold food	Indulging in heaty food
	May injure the spleen, stomach and intestines, cause food poisoning and allow parasites into the body.	May cause indigestion. Will result in damage to the spleen and stomach.	Results in malnutrition, poor circulation of blood and qi; interferes with development at puberty.	Depletes yang in the stomach and spleen. May cause feelings of cold in the limbs, diarrhoea and abdominal pains.	Increases the yang in the stomach, which results in bad breath, thirst, constipation etc.

Our bodily activity and rest are closely related to the state of our health.

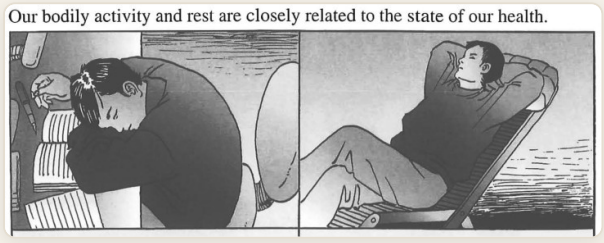
Over-exhaustion	Over-idleness
Over-exertion of our physical and mental states will cause ailments such as mental fatigue, forgetfulness, weight loss, insomnia, and heart palpitations.	An idle and a sedentary lifestyle will lead to certain ailments like lethargy, poor appetite, low stamina, and weight gain.

FIG. 44



A five-panel strip illustrating ways of eating. In the first panel a cooked chicken and two fish lie on plates with flies swarming above them. In the second panel a pot-bellied man sits eating, chopsticks in one hand and a bowl of rice in the other. In the third panel a thin young woman stands at a stove with steam rising from a pot, one hand resting on the counter. In the fourth panel a small boy in a striped shirt bites into an ice-cream bar. In the fifth panel a man sits with chopsticks raised over a steaming hotpot, plates of food spread around him.

FIG. 45



A two-panel strip. On the left a man has fallen asleep face-down across a desk, a pencil still in his hand and an open exercise book, a glass of water and a mobile phone beside him. On the right a man lies back on a folding deck-chair with his hands clasped behind his head and his eyes closed, legs crossed, against a sketched horizon.

BOOK PAGE 21 · SCAN P030

The Disease Has Entered the Vitals

The Disease Has Entered the Vitals

The proverb, "the disease has entered the vitals" (*bing ru gao huang*) refers to a hopeless medical condition.

Just what do the 'vitals' refer to? The following story will give you an idea.

During the Spring and Autumn Period, King Jing of the State of Jin fell very ill.

Summon the renowned doctor Huan.

Before Huan arrived, King Jing had a dream...

Hee... hee...

This place is so nice! I'm not leaving.

FIG. 46

A full-page comic. The large top-left panel carries the title The Disease Has Entered the Vitals above two children in flowered robes with their hair in double buns, floating in mid-air over a sleeper whose face rises into the bottom edge of the panel. In the top-right panel a green dragon speaks in two balloons, first explaining the proverb and then promising that the story will show what the 'vitals' are. In the middle panel a servant kneels on the floor beside a low stand offering medicine to the king, who lies on a bed covered with a swirling patterned quilt; a balloon above orders that the renowned doctor Huan be summoned. In the bottom-left panel is a close-up of King Jing's sleeping face, with a caption box explaining that before Huan arrived the king had a dream. In the bottom-right panel the two children of the dream laugh and say how pleasant this place is and that they are not leaving.

Trang 22

Huan is a good physician. I'm afraid he'll hurt us.

We'll hide above the 'huang' (between the heart and the diaphragm) and the 'gao' (the fat around the heart). Let's see what he can do to us!

Let's go!

Is that Huan? Is there a cure for my illness?

Pardon my bluntness, Your Majesty. The disease has entered the vitals*.

Acupuncture will not work in this case. Neither will medicine. The disease is beyond cure.

You deserve your good reputation as a physician! Your diagnosis is exactly as I have dreamt.

'Gao' refers to the fat around the heart; 'huang' refers to the area between the heart and the diaphragm. Hence, *gao huang* refers to the area below the heart and above the diaphragm.

* *bing ru gao huang*

FIG. 47

A full-page comic continuing the story. The top row shows the two children of the dream: in the first panel one warns that Huan is a good physician and may hurt them; in the second the other points a finger upward and says they will hide above the 'huang' — between the heart and the diaphragm — and the 'gao', the fat around the heart, and see what he can do to them; in the third panel they leap away crying "Let's go!", with the king's anxious, sweating face below them. In the large middle panel Huan, in scholar's robes, kneels by the king's bed with his hand to his chin; the king asks whether there is a cure for his illness, and Huan answers that the disease has entered the vitals, so that neither acupuncture nor medicine will work and the disease is beyond cure. In the bottom-left panel the king, propped on his pillow, praises Huan's reputation and says the diagnosis matches his dream, while Huan bows low before him. In the bottom-right panel the dragon points with a stick at a cut-away drawing of the human trunk showing the heart, lungs, stomach, liver and intestines, and explains that 'gao' is the fat around the heart and 'huang' the space between the heart and the diaphragm, so gao huang means the region below the heart and above the diaphragm.

How To Prevent Diseases

How To Prevent Diseases

Illness is caused by evil qi. Falling ill is like a battle between good and evil. Hence, to prevent illnesses, we need to build up the positive energy in our bodies to prevent the invasion of negative energy.

Cultivating positive energy

Insufficient positive energy is one of the major causes of diseases. Cultivating positive energy will strengthen the constitution and increase resistance level, maintain good health and prolong life. How do we cultivate positive energy? Here are a few ways:

1. **Adapt to the ways of nature:** The human body and nature share a close relationship, hence the need for the body to be in harmony with nature. "Yang is strong in spring and summer; yin is built in autumn and winter". This knowledge should make it difficult for diseases to invade us.

2. **Acknowledge the importance of mental well-being:** Keep a happy and cheerful disposition. Our physical body is affected by our mental health. Staying happy will keep us healthy.

3. **Pay attention to diet and lifestyle:** A balanced diet and regular lifestyle with appropriate rest and activity will leave one with abundant energy and a healthy body.

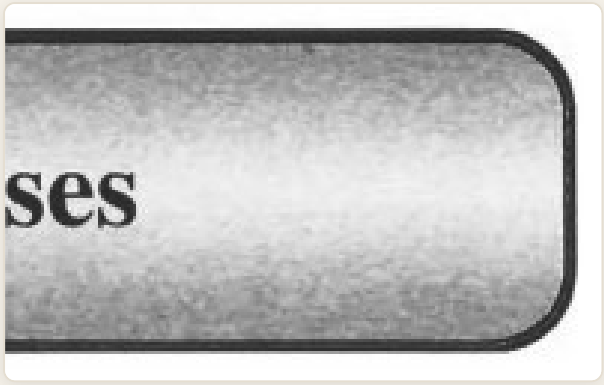
4. **Strengthen the physique:** Exercises like *qigong*, *taijiquan* and *wushu* are ways to boost blood circulation, strengthen muscles and bone and improve strength.

5. **Preventive aids:** Innoculation and moderate ingestion of vitamins and herbal tonics will also help build immunity and boost resistance to pathogens.

FIG. 48

The head of the chapter's grey title banner: the two-lobed gourd ornament at the left edge, with the first part of the framed panel bearing the words How To Prevent Diseases.

FIG. 49



The remainder of the same grey banner panel, carrying the closing letters "...ses" of Diseases and the rounded right-hand corner of the frame.

FIG. 50

A vertical strip of five circular vignettes running down the left side of the list: a boy standing at the water's edge looking out at the sun or moon low over the sea; a man in a shirt raising one hand with a pleased expression; a woman seated at a table working at a jigsaw puzzle; a person standing in a martial-arts stance with one arm extended, the other hand at the waist; and a person holding a glass and swallowing a pill.

BOOK PAGE 24 · SCAN P033

Combating evil qi

Combating evil qi

When evil qi enters the body, one falls ill. Avoidance of evil qi will reduce the occurrence of ailments.

Below are ways to prevent or bring ailments under control:

1. **The use of drugs to destroy agents of diseases:** Application of medicated creams, cleansing and disinfection of infected areas, ingestion of drugs to destroy the cause of diseases.

2. **Personal hygiene:** Pathogens often lurk in our surroundings. Food hygiene, clean water and surroundings will prevent viruses and bacteria from multiplying.

3. **Avoiding sources of infection:** Avoid direct contact with someone who is infectious to prevent the disease from spreading.

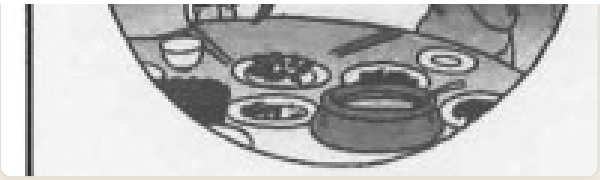
4. **Prevention of accidents and injuries:** The immunity level will drop when hurt or injured, hence the chances of catching a disease will increase.

5. **Proper preparation and handling of food:** We are what we eat. Eating is a daily activity. Food gives our body the energy to carry out our daily activities. But if the food is not prepared or handled properly, it may cause illness instead.

FIG. 51

A circular vignette for the first item: a man in an open jacket holds a glass of water in one hand and touches his throat with the other, while beside him stand a medicine bottle, a blister pack of capsules and a single pill.

FIG. 52



A vertical strip of four circular vignettes running down the left side of the list: a woman washing a cup at a sink; a man in a padded jacket standing outside a window and waving goodbye to someone lying ill in bed indoors; a motorcyclist wearing a helmet on his scooter; and two people seated at a table eating, one of them reaching across with his chopsticks to serve food.

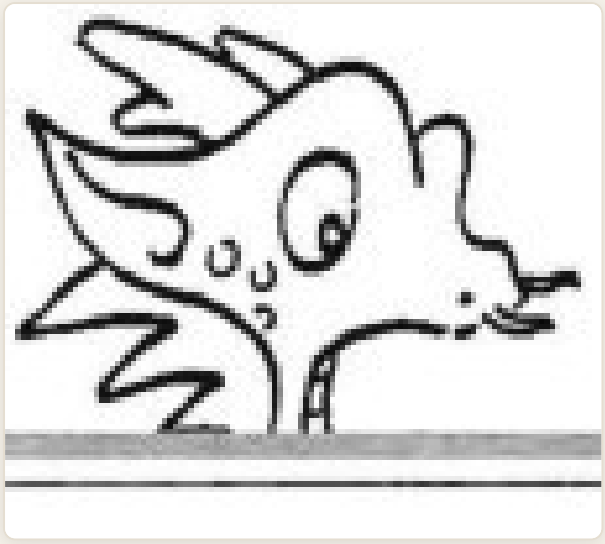
BOOK PAGE 25 · SCAN P034

Traditional Chinese Medical Science (The Skill of Qi and Huang)

Traditional Chinese Medical Science (The Skill of Qi and Huang)

Traditional Chinese medical science is also known as The Skill of Qi and Huang. Qi and Huang refer to two persons — Huang Di (Yellow Emperor) and Qi Bo. Huang Di is the ancestor of the Chinese people. Legend has it that he founded Chinese traditional medicine. Qi Bo, learned in medical science, was a subject of Huang Di. As they were the earliest proponents of Chinese medical theories which laid the foundation for Chinese medicine, people began to use 'Qi Huang' to refer to Chinese medical science.

FIG. 53



The book's small dragon mascot peeks over the top-left corner of the page frame: only its head, crest and one clawed foreleg rise above the border, with beads of sweat beside its cheek.

FIG. 54

A wide line drawing of two men seated facing each other across a low stone table. The man on the left wears a close-fitting hood and holds a folded medicine pouch; the man on the right has long hair and wears a scholar's crown, with a tasselled headdress hanging on a stand behind him, and holds up a sprig of herbs. On the table stand a flask, two cups and a bundle of herbs; a woven basket of leafy plants sits at the right, and rocks with shrubs fill the lower-left foreground.

The Treasure of Chinese Medical Science — *The Yellow Emperor's Medicine Classic*

The Treasure of Chinese Medical Science — *The Yellow Emperor's Medicine Classic*

Any discourse on Chinese medical science will inevitably mention *The Yellow Emperor's Medicine Classic*.

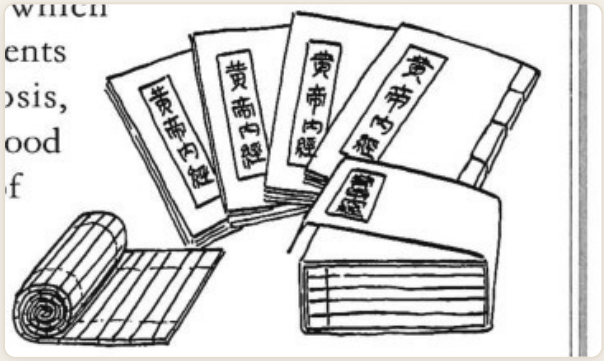
Compiled during the Warring States Period, this work is a collection of the medical anecdotes and theories of many ancient physicians. The famous *Yellow Emperor's Medicine Classic* was the earliest compilation which explained human physiology, ailments and their treatments, diagnosis, prevention and the maintenance of good health through an understanding of yin-yang and the five elements. It laid the foundations of Chinese traditional medicine on which later theories were based.

There are two parts to *The Yellow Emperor's Medicine Classic* — *Plain Questions* and *Canon of Acupuncture*. In all, there are 18 scrolls and 162 chapters.

Plain Questions examines human puberty, the relationship between man and nature, principles and methods of maintaining good health, the four methods of diagnosis and the prevention and cure of ailments.

Canon of Acupuncture introduces the main and collateral channels and acupuncture points in the human body, the link between the mind and physical ailments, explores the exterior of the human body and its internal organs, various body and health types, acupuncture etc.

FIG. 55

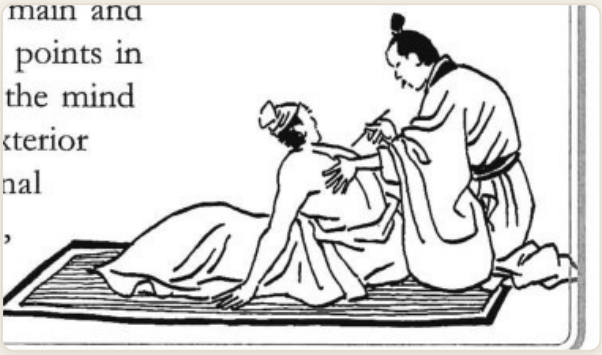


A fanned-out stack of traditional thread-bound books, their covers facing the reader and each bearing the title 黃帝內經; beside them lies a rolled-up bamboo-slip scroll and a further volume lying flat with its page edges showing.

FIG. 56

A bearded man in flowing robes sits cross-legged on the ground beneath an old, gnarled tree, both arms raised above his head with the palms open, in a posture of health-cultivation exercise; low grass and roots surround him.

FIG. 57



Two men on a woven mat: a patient reclines on his side while the physician, kneeling behind him, applies a fine needle to his back.

BOOK PAGE 27 · SCAN P036

Methods of Diagnosis in Traditional Chinese Medicine

Methods of Diagnosis in Traditional Chinese Medicine

Traditional Chinese medicine has its own unique diagnostic methods. Chinese medical practice has no use for stethoscopes, X-ray machines or other diagnostic equipment. Instead,

observation, auscultation and olfaction, interrogation and pulse taking are employed to diagnose diseases.

FIG. 58

A physician in a scholar's cap and long robes sits on a chair at a small table, taking the pulse of a patient who kneels on a low stool opposite him; a small instrument box rests on the table between them. Behind them hangs a tall vertical banner inscribed with the four characters 妙手回春.

BOOK PAGE 28 · SCAN P037

The Four Diagnoses

The Four Diagnoses

Observation

Inspection of the patient's general well-being, colour of complexion etc.

FIG. 59

The physician, an elderly man in a soft cap and spectacles, sits with his chin propped on his hand, studying the patient thoughtfully.

FIG. 60

The patient, a young man in a collared shirt, is drawn in profile facing the physician, mouth closed, waiting quietly.

Auscultation and Olfaction

The patient's voice, breathing patterns and breath are analysed.

FIG. 61

The same young patient in profile, now with his mouth open as he speaks or breathes out.

FIG. 62

The physician in profile, head tilted and turned towards the patient to listen.

Interrogation

Checking with the patient his illness, the symptoms and sensations experienced etc.

FIG. 63

The physician leans forward with his head bowed, questioning the patient.

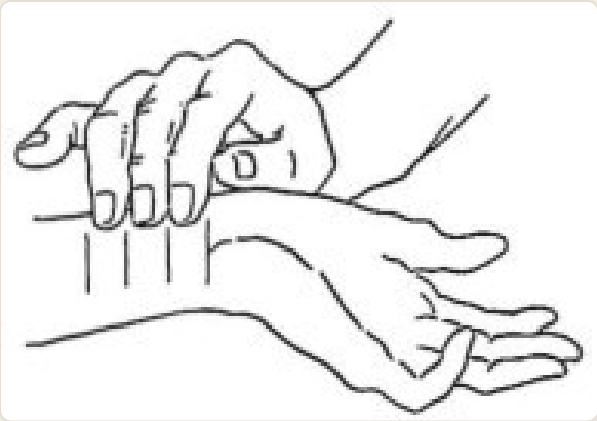
FIG. 64

The young patient in profile again, facing the physician and answering him.

Taking the Pulse

The changes in the patient's pulse is used to determine his qi and blood circulation.

FIG. 65



A close-up of the physician's fingers pressing on the patient's wrist to feel the pulse, the palm turned upwards.

BOOK PAGE 29 · SCAN P038

Diagnosis Through Observation

Diagnosis Through Observation

A person's complexion and his vital organs share a close relationship. Any changes in the blood and qi circulation in the vitals will be reflected in a person's physical appearance, including observing the person's energy level and the colour of his face and tongue.

Observing the patient's energy level

Observation of the patient's vitality, expression in his eyes, facial expression etc. A person's energy may be classified into the following types:

Vigour and vitality present:

Energetic, lively eyes, a bright countenance, etc. They indicate a mild case of illness where the vital energy has not been diminished. It signals a quick recovery.

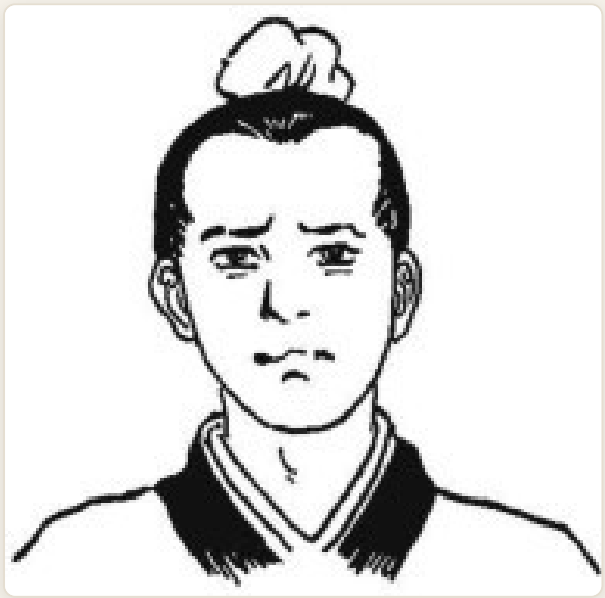
Vigour and vitality absent:

Listless, lethargic, dull eyes, absentmindedness, slowed responses etc. The patient is deficient in vital energy and seriously ill.

FIG. 66

A young man with his hair gathered in a topknot, shown from the chest up: his eyes are bright, his brow is relaxed and a faint smile lifts the corners of his mouth.

FIG. 67



The same young man looking dejected: his brow is drawn, his eyes are dull and downcast and his mouth turns down at the corners.

Observing the patient's complexion

When a person falls ill, his complexion will take on an unusual colour. This is known as the pathogeny of complexion. In all, there are five colours.

Blue	Caused by wind and cold, marked by a sensation of pain.
Yellow	Caused by dampness, marked by deficiency of vital energy and lowering of body resistance.
Red	Caused by heat.
White	Caused by deficiency in vital energy and poor blood circulation.
Black	Caused by cold, pain, fluid retention and blood clots.

Observing the tongue

Observing the tongue

The tongue may be divided into parts representing each of the five vital organs. Hence, any changes in the appearance of the tongue will reflect a change in the state of the corresponding organ.

The colour and appearance of the coating of the tongue surface indicate changes in the patient's condition:

Colour of the coating:

White → Yellow → Grey → Black

Appearance of the coating:

Moist → Dry → Dry and black → Dry and prickly

Thin → Thick

Present → Absent

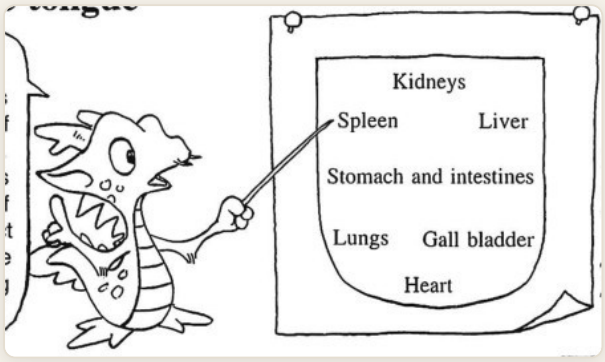
The progression from left to right indicates deterioration in the patient's condition, and vice versa.

The colour, degree of plumpness and softness of the tongue are also important. Here are some conditions and what they might mean.

A whitish tongue	Indicates deficiency in vital energy and blood.
A deep red tongue	Indicates presence of heat.

A plump tongue	Usually related to presence of phlegm, dampness, heat and toxins.
A thin and shrunken tongue	Usually suggests deficiency in vital energy and blood, or interior heat.
A stiff tongue	Usually seen in exogenic diseases, may indicate the possibility of stroke.
A soft and curled tongue	Usually suggests deficiency in vital energy and blood.

FIG. 68



The book's dragon mascot points with a long stick at a chart pinned up like a scroll: an outline of the tongue labelled with the organs mapped onto its parts — Kidneys, Spleen, Liver, Stomach and intestines, Lungs, Gall bladder and Heart.

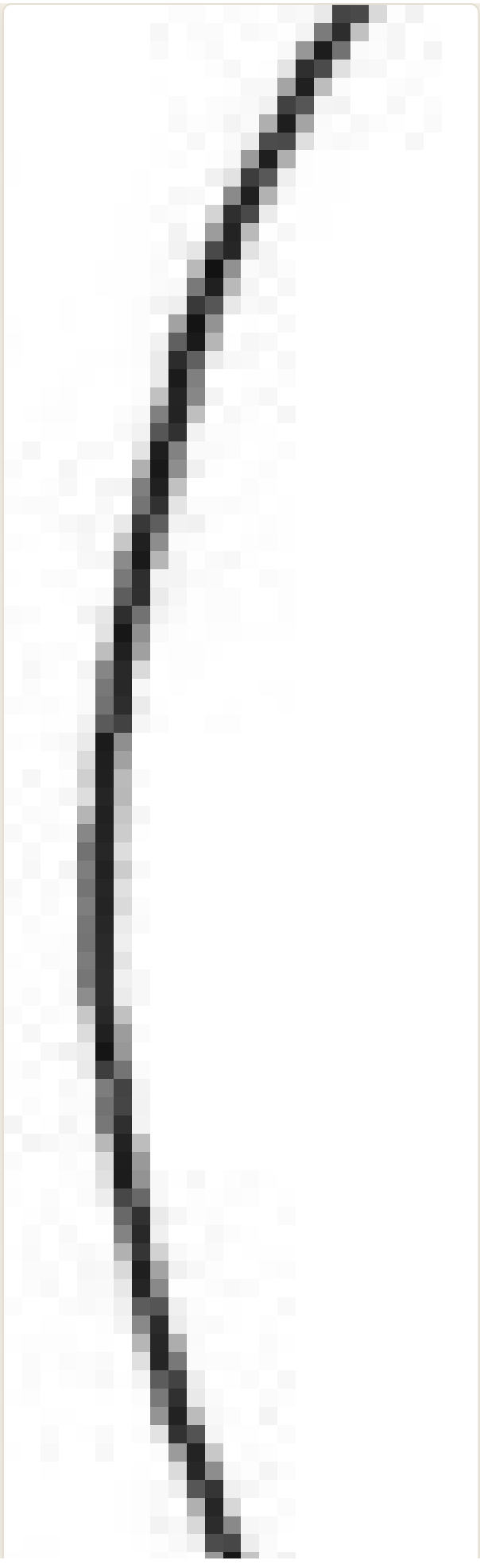
FIG. 69

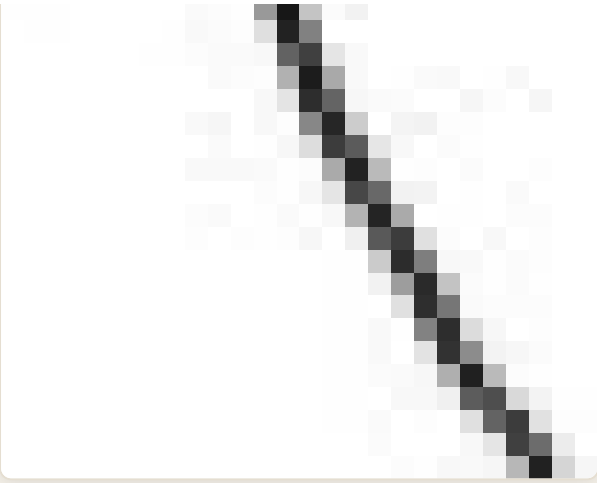
An open mouth with the tongue protruding, enclosed in a circle, beside the dragon mascot, which holds up a small hand mirror.

FIG. 70

A short fragment of a curved line, part of the decorative framing of the page's illustrations.

FIG. 71





A short vertical fragment of a curved line, part of the decorative framing of the page's illustrations.

BOOK PAGE 31 · SCAN P040

Observing the Five Sense Organs and hair

Observing the Five Sense Organs and hair

The condition of one's ears, eyes, lips, nose, hair and skin also reflect the body's state of health. Some examples are listed below:

Swollen eyes	Usually caused by water retention.
Dry eyes	Usually caused by deficiency of blood in the liver.
Swollen and red eyes	Usually caused by wind-heat.
Blocked nose; clear mucus	Usually caused by wind-cold.
Blocked nose; thick yellow mucus	Usually caused by wind-heat.
Dry and thin outer ear	Asthenia (abnormal loss of strength) of kidney.
Dark, red lips	Caused by cold factors, usually seen in weak lungs.
Pale lips	Usually caused by deficiency of blood.
Dark red and dry lips	Usually caused by febrile factors, characterised by a high fever.

Dry, cracked lips	Insufficient bodily fluids.
Dry skin	Insufficient bodily fluids; exhaustion of internal vital essences and blood.
Dry and prickly skin	Usually caused by atrophy of the lungs.
Black, thick and lustrous hair	Healthy kidneys, sufficient blood and vital energy.
Brown, sparse and dry hair	Deficiency of vital essence and blood, usually seen after a major illness.
Dry and brittle hair	Heat in the blood and deficiency of yin.
Curly and oily hair	Usually caused by heat in the blood.
Greying of hair among youths	Caused by worry and anxiety; accumulation of pathogenic heat in blood.
Thinning of hair among youths	Asthenia of kidneys or pathogenic heat in blood.
Slow growth of hair; thin and brown hair	Usually caused by hereditary factors and a weak constitution.

FIG. 72

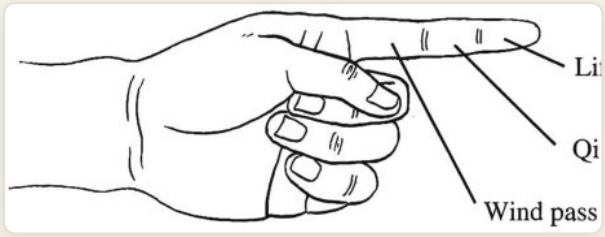
An older girl with her hair in a bun bends forward, combing and smoothing the long black hair of a younger girl seated in front of her.

Observing A Child's Index Finger

Observing A Child's Index Finger

This type of diagnosis is suitable for children under the age of three. The channels and collaterals on the inside of the child's index finger are examined. The diagnosis is based on the observation of the meridian phenomena and colour.

FIG. 73



A diagram of a child's hand with the fingers curled and the index finger extended: three short zones are marked off along the finger by fine cross-lines, and three leader lines run from them to the labels Life pass, Qi pass and Wind pass.

During the finger diagnosis, the child should be carried in a well-lit place where the physician will use his left hand to keep the tip of the child's index finger in place. He will rub the child's index finger from its tip towards the palm with his right hand a few times until the branches of channels show for inspection.

FIG. 74

The physician, a bearded man in a high-collared tunic, sits with a small child on his lap and gently holds up the child's hand to examine the index finger.

Collaterals show in the wind point zone	The disease is within the collaterals; the condition is not serious.
Collaterals show in the qi point zone.	The disease has attacked the channels; condition is quite serious.
Collaterals are evident in all three zones.	The disease has attacked the viscera; condition is serious.
Collaterals show beyond the fingertip.	The situation is very grave.
Collaterals show clearly.	The disease is an exogenous one affecting the exterior of the body.
Collaterals are not obvious.	The disease is an endogenous one affecting the internal organs.
Collaterals are reddish.	Usually caused by cold factors.
Collaterals are purplish.	Usually caused by febrile factors.

Collaterals are greenish.	Caused by wind, cold, or pain.
Collaterals are pale and thin.	Usually caused by cold factors.
Collaterals are dull and thick.	Excess syndrome.

Auscultatory and Olfactory Diagnosis

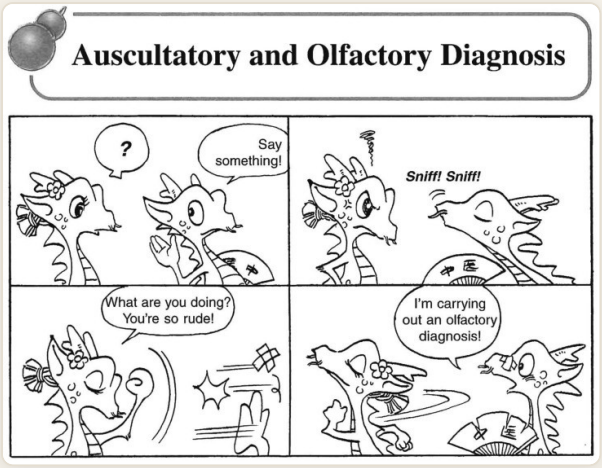
Auscultatory and Olfactory Diagnosis

Diagnosis through auscultation and olfaction involves listening to the patient's tone of voice, breathing patterns and taking a sniff of the patient's breath. The following tables show some of the conditions that may occur and what they mean.

Listening to the patient's voice

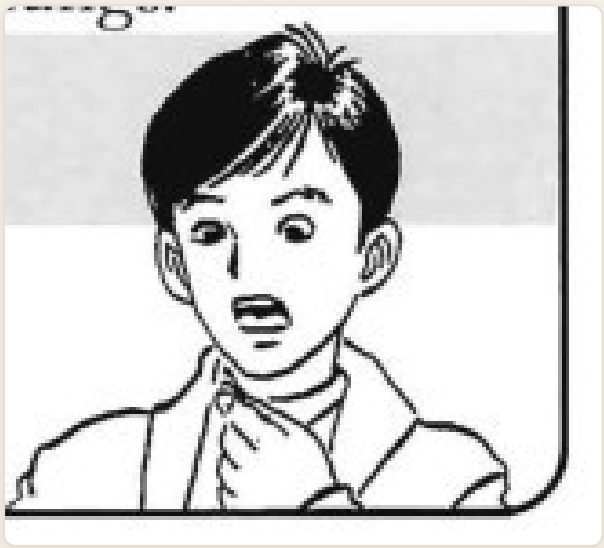
- - **Strong, loud voice** — Presence of yang, heat.
- - **Feeble, broken voice** — Presence of yin, cold. Shows as deficient vital energy and lowered resistance.
- - **Hoarseness or loss of voice due to recent illness** — Caused by febrile factors, usually the result of external colds and heat.
- - **Hoarseness or loss of voice due to prolonged illness** — Lack of energy and reduced resistance; weakness of the lungs and kidneys.
- - **Deep coughs, clear phlegm** — Wind-cold has attacked the lungs.
- - **Sudden coughing, thick and yellow phlegm** — Excess heat in the lungs.
- - **Phlegmy cough** — Presence of phlegm.

FIG. 75



A four-panel cartoon strip featuring the book's two dragon characters. In the first panel one dragon says "Say something!" while the other stares back with a question mark above its head. In the second panel the second dragon leans in and sniffs, "Sniff! Sniff!", while the first recoils. In the third panel the sniffed-at dragon protests, "What are you doing? You're so rude!" In the fourth panel the sniffing dragon replies, "I'm carrying out an olfactory diagnosis!"

FIG. 76



A small line drawing tucked into the bottom right corner of the table: a young man in a jacket, mouth slightly open and one hand raised to his collar.

Trang 34

Listening to the patient's breathing

- - **Strong and heavy breathing** — Caused by febrile factors, excess pathogenic internal heat.
- - **Weak, short breaths** — Caused by deficiency in the function of the lungs.
- - **Breathing difficulties, wheezing sounds** — Asthma.
- - **Uneven breathing or heavy sighing breaths** — Serious condition, with damage to the vital essence or poisoning.
- - **Loud breathing accompanied by snoring sounds** — Stroke patients and comatose patients suffering from liver ailments and diabetes.
- - **Rapid breathing, exhalation brings relief** — Usually seen in cases of lung infection or phlegm-retention.
- - **Low breathing sounds, inhalation brings relief** — Decline in the function of the kidneys.

Inspection through smell

- - **Bad breath** — Poor digestion, heat in the stomach or poor oral hygiene.
- - **Sourish breath** — Undigested food in one's system.
- - **Decaying breath** — Stomach ulcer and sores.
- - **Body odour** — Caused by pathogenic dampness-heat.
- - **Nose emits odour, runny nose** — Heat in the lungs or pathogenic dampness-heat accumulated in the spleen and the stomach.

FIG. 77

A very thin cropped sliver from the illustration at the foot of the page, showing part of a hand and a sleeve of one of the cartoon characters.

FIG. 78

The illustration at the foot of the page: a man with his mouth wide open, wavy lines rising from it to show foul breath, and beside him the dragon mascot leaning in to sniff. A speech bubble beside the dragon reads "Doctor, I think I have bad breath. Please check for me."

BOOK PAGE 35 · SCAN P044

Diagnosis Through Interrogation

Diagnosis Through Interrogation

This involves asking the patient about his illness, the symptoms and how he feels. Through the patient's answers, a diagnosis is made. It is therefore a very important part of a diagnosis.

> *"First, you ask about chills and fever.*

> *Next, you move to perspiration.*

> *Third, you ask about general pains and headaches.*

> *Fourth, you ask about urination and defecation.*

> *Fifth, you ask about the appetite.*

> *Next, you ask about sensations in the chest and abdomen.*

The seventh question concerns hearing and sight.

The eighth question touches on one's sleep pattern.

The ninth question checks past medical history and the tenth inquires of the causes of the new disease.

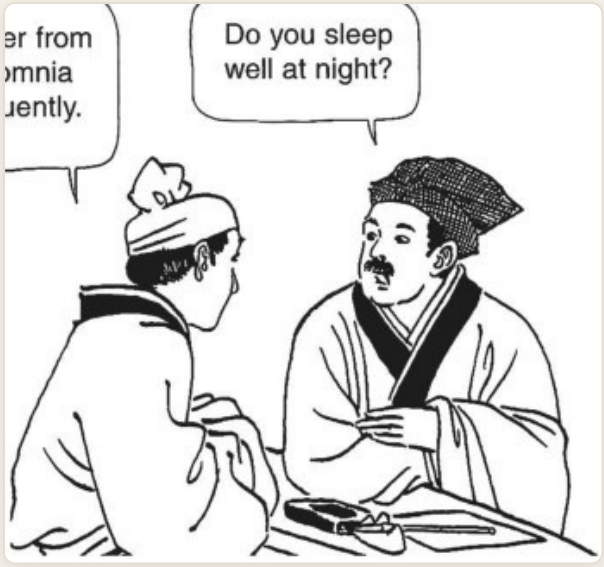
In female adult patients, check on their menstrual cycle.

In young patients, it will be measles."

FIG. 79

The dragon mascot stands at the left of the page with a speech bubble: "Diagnosis through interrogation is very comprehensive. It's even been made into a ditty that lists 10 commonly asked questions."

FIG. 80



A cartoon at the foot of the page: an older physician seated behind a table asks "Do you sleep well at night?", while a younger man seated opposite, leaning forward with his hands clasped, answers "I suffer from insomnia frequently."

BOOK PAGE 36 · SCAN P045

Trang 36

Tables showing some possible conditions and what they mean:

Chills and fever

- - **Feeling feverish in the morning** — Deficiency of gallbladder energy.
- - **Feeling feverish in the afternoon** — Deficiency of yin, dampness-heat.
- - **Feverish without feeling cold** — Excess yang nature, usually seen in acute diseases.
- - **Feeling chilly without having a fever** — Deficiency of yang nature, usually seen in chronic diseases.
- - **The limbs feel cold** — Deficiency of yang.
- - **Heat in the abdomen and chest** — Accumulated internal heat.
- - **The whole body is feverish and is afraid of cold** — Usually caused by febrile factors.

Perspiration

- - **Perspiration before bedtime which stops on waking (night sweat)** — Usually indicates deficiency of yin.

- - **Perspiring easily during the day (spontaneous sweating)** — Usually indicates deficiency of yang.
- - **Afraid of cold, perspiration, cold limbs (cold sweat)** — Usually indicates deficiency of yang.
- - **Perspiration followed by shivering** — Body battling an infectious disease.
- - **Perspiration only on the forehead (Children often perspire on the forehead when they sleep. If no other symptoms are present, this is not a sign of illness.)** — Usually indicates heat in the abdomen and pathogenic dampness-heat.
- - **Only half of the body perspires** — Deficiency of gallbladder energy and blood. A sign of partial paralysis.
- - **Perspiration on the chest** — Deficiency of yin of the heart.
- - **Perspiration of the hands and feet** — Deficiency of yin and excess of yang.
- - **Perspiration of the palms** — Usually caused by anxiety and nervousness.

FIG. 81

A woman with her hair gathered in a bun, arms crossed over her chest, head bowed and shoulders hunched, tucked into the right side of the "Chills and fever" table. Wavy lines beside her suggest she is shivering with cold.

Trang 37

Appetite

- - **Preference for cold drinks when thirsty** — Endogenous heat.
- - **Preference for warm drinks when thirsty** — Endogenous cold.
- - **Low consumption of water despite being thirsty** — Pathogenic dampness-heat in the spleen and stomach.
- - **Dulled sense of taste** — Asthenia of the spleen and stomach.
- - **Bitter taste in mouth** — Heat in the liver and gallbladder.
- - **Sour taste in mouth** — Retention of undigested food in the stomach and intestines.
- - **Sweet taste in mouth** — Pathogenic dampness-heat in the spleen and stomach.
- - **Partiality in limited variety of food** — Usually caused by presence of parasites.
- - **Gets hungry easily** — Heat in the stomach or incomplete digestion.
- - **Bloating after a meal** — Asthenia of spleen and blockage of gallbladder.
- - **Poor appetite, bloated stomach, sour breath** — Retention of undigested food in the stomach and intestines, poor digestion.
- - **Frequent micturition, constant intake of fluid, thirst** — Thirst relief (diabetes).

Ears and eyes

- - **Sound in the ear** — Deficiency of the liver and kidney.
- - **Pain in the ear** — Infection of the inner ear.
- - **Deafness in the ear** — Deficiency of the kidney, infectious febrile disease.
- - **Echoes in the ear** — Deficiency of the kidney or pathogenic wind.
- - **Blurred vision, night blindness** — Deficiency of the liver.
- - **Swollen and red eyes** — Heat in the liver.

FIG. 82

A man seated at a table eating: he lifts food to his mouth with chopsticks while holding a small cup in his other hand, with a bowl and a plate of food set out in front of him.

BOOK PAGE 38 · SCAN P047

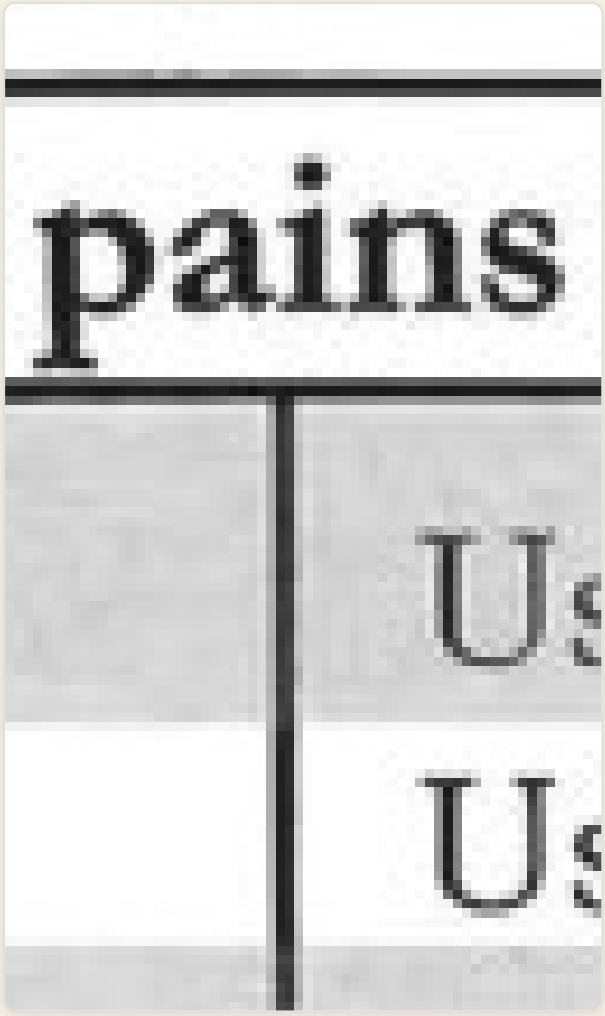
Trang 38

General pains and headaches

- - **Nagging headache** — Usually caused by exogenous heat.
- - **Sporadic headache** — Usually caused by internal injury.
- - **Headache in the morning** — Usually a deficiency of vital energy.
- - **Headache in the afternoon** — Usually a deficiency of blood.
- - **Headache in the day** — Deficiency of yang.
- - **Headache in the evening** — Deficiency of yin.
- - **Feverish and aching body** — Endogenous heat.
- - **Backache** — Deficiency of the kidney.
- - **Sharp pain in the back** — Stagnation of vital energy and stasis of blood.
- - **Stuffy chest, shortness of breath, lethargy** — Deficiency of vital energy.
- - **Stuffy chest, long sighs** — Stagnation of vital energy.
- - **Pain on both sides of the rib cage** — Stagnation of vital energy in the liver.

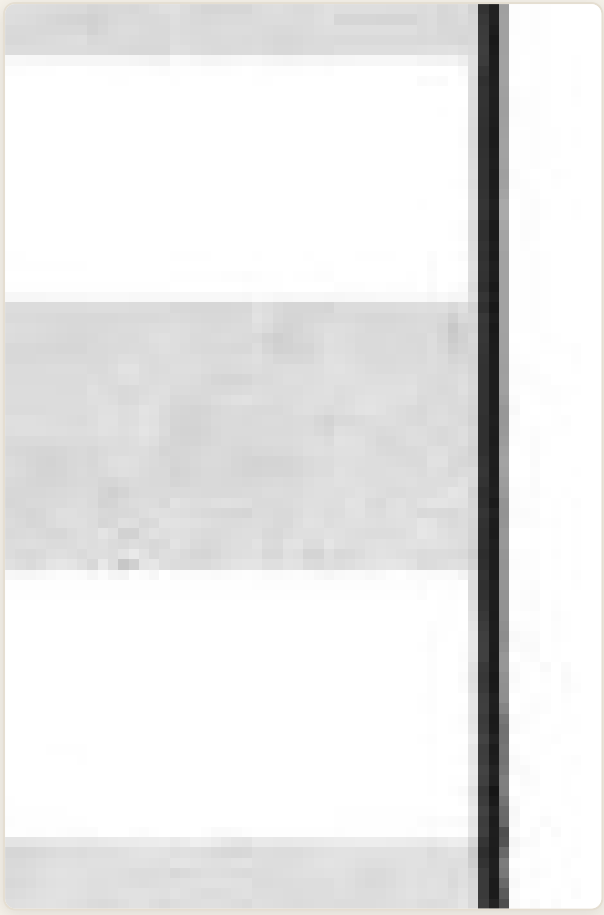
- - **Abdominal pain; aversion to touch, inclination towards cold drinks, sharp abdominal pain after meals** — Excess heat.
- - **Abdominal pain; comfort from massage, loose stools** — Deficiency of yang in the spleen and stomach.
- - **Joints ache during rainy days** — Caused by dampness-cold.
- - **Swelling and pain** — Depression, stagnation of digestion in the stomach, blocked respiratory system.
- - **Sharp pain** — Stasis of blood, stagnation of vital energy.
- - **Angina (chest pains)** — Blood stasis, parasites, gallstones.
- - **Nagging, dull pain** — Poor blood and vital energy circulation; endogenous yin and cold.
- - **Aches** — Dampness in the joints; poor blood and vital energy circulation.
- - **Aversion to cold; excruciating pain** — Usually caused by cold factors.
- - **Aversion to heat; redness and swelling** — Usually caused by heat factors.
- - **Sudden pain** — Syndrome of excess due to exogenous factors.
- - **Prolonged pain** — Deficiency of yin.

FIG. 83



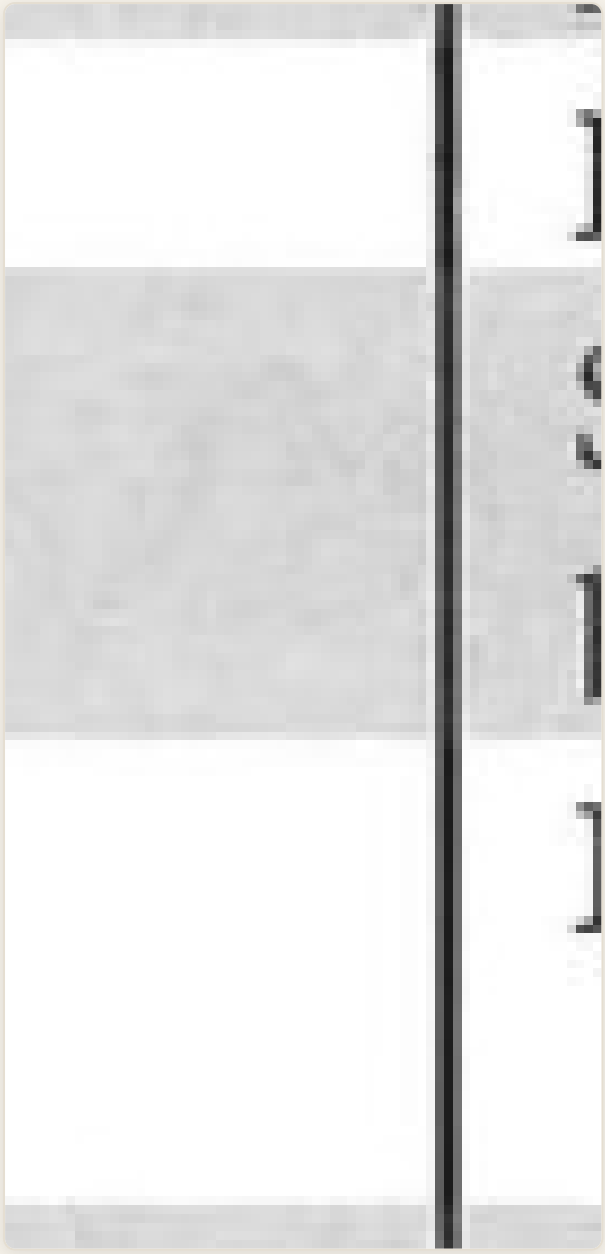
A small cropped fragment of the table heading, showing the printed word "pains" from the heading "General pains and headaches".

FIG. 84



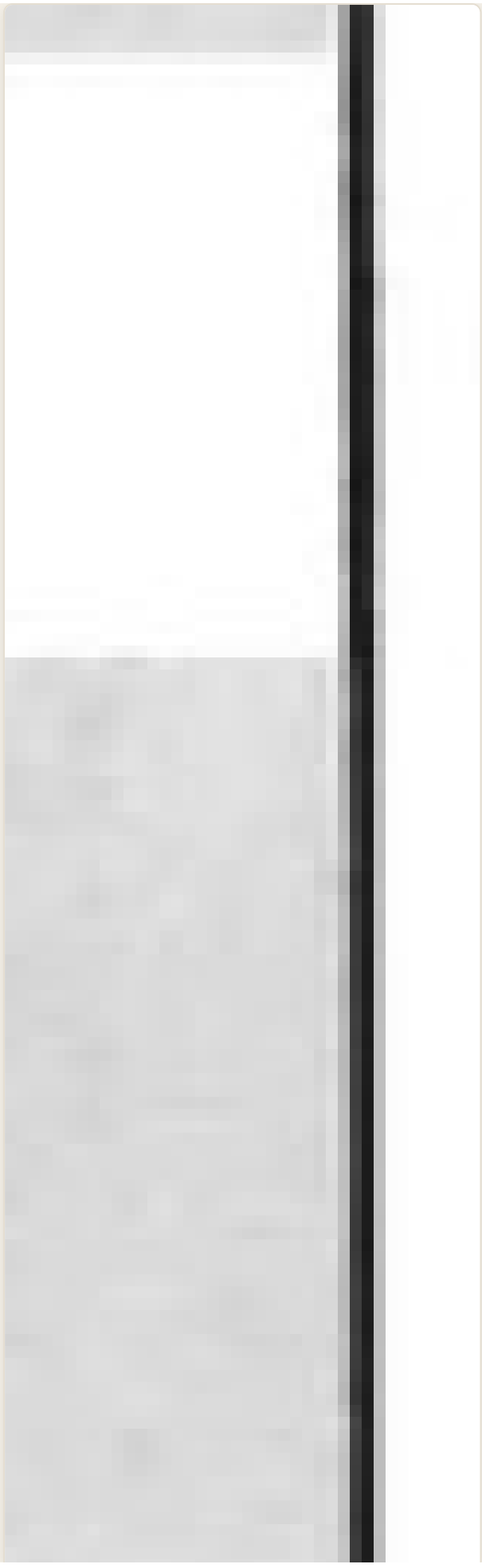
A narrow vertical fragment of the table, showing shaded and blank rows between the ruled lines.

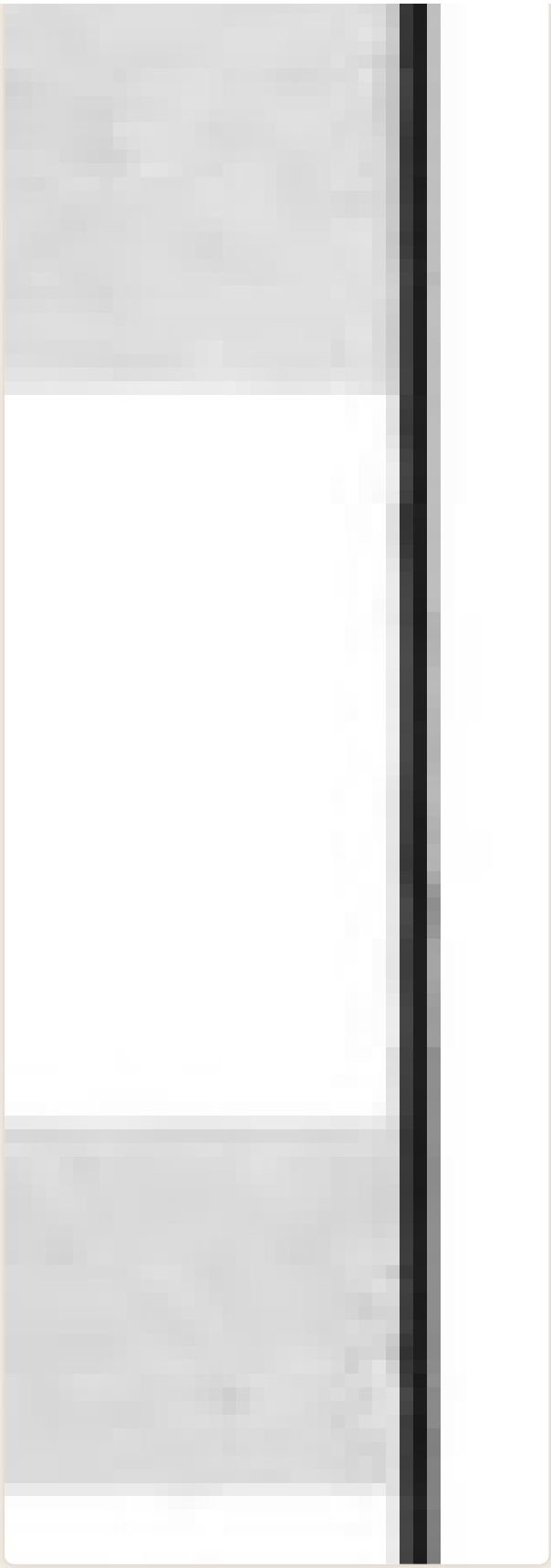
FIG. 85



A small fragment of the table showing a vertical ruled line and the edge of a shaded row.

FIG. 86





A narrow vertical strip from the right-hand edge of the table, with the vertical rule and shaded rows.

FIG. 87

A short horizontal strip of a shaded table row.

FIG. 88

A woman in traditional dress with her hair tied up and a bow-like kerchief on her head, head bowed and one hand raised to her chin while the other rests at her waist, tucked into the bottom right corner of the table.

BOOK PAGE 39 · SCAN P048

Trang 39

Urination and defecation

- - **Constipation** — Heat, sluggish vital energy or blood exhaustion.

- - **Hard stools** — Deficiency of middle-energiser energy or poor liver function.
- - **Whitish stools** — Jaundice or deficiency of cold in large intestines.
- - **Black stools** — Internal bleeding.
- - **Red stools** — Blood in the stools or dysentery.
- - **Clear urine** — Caused by cold factors.
- - **Dark yellow urine** — Caused by heat factors.
- - **Pain during urination** — Caused by stranguria (spasm of the urethra and bladder).
- - **Turbid (cloudy) urine** — Febrile diseases caused by dampness and heat.
- - **Incontinence** — Deficiency of vital energy and strokes.
- - **Difficulty in passing urine** — Caused by dampness-heat harm or damage to the body fluids.

Menstruation (Gynaecology)

- - **Early period, high volume, blood is bright red** — Heat in the blood.
- - **Period delayed, low volume, pale colour, pain in the lower abdomen** — Interior cold.
- - **Irregular periods** — Stagnation of the liver energy or asthenia of the spleen and kidneys, or blockage due to blood clot.
- - **Absence of menstruation** — Deficiency of vital energy and low blood volume; stagnation of the vital energy and blood stasis.
- - **Uterine bleeding** — Heat in the blood, Deficiency of the vital energy.

FIG. 89

A figure seen in profile, seated with knees drawn up and hands resting on them, wearing a plain jacket and trousers, eyes closed and head slightly bowed, set into the left side of the "Urination and defecation" table.

FIG. 90

A small cropped fragment of the printed table heading, showing the word "(Gynaecology)".

FIG. 91

A young woman with long dark hair looking downwards with a subdued expression, one hand raised to her chest, set into the right side of the "Menstruation" table.

BOOK PAGE 40 · SCAN P049

Trang 40

Sleep patterns

- - **Insomnia** — Over-anxiety, deficiency of the heart and spleen.
- - **Inability to sleep combined with thirst and feeling of vexation** — Usually indicates deficiency of the yin of the heart.
- - **Inability to sleep combined with feeling of panic** — Usually indicates deficiency of the gallbladder energy.
- - **Inability to sleep combined with dizziness and panic** — Usually indicates deficiency of blood in the heart and spleen.
- - **Inability to sleep combined with dizziness and heavy head** — Usually indicates an excess of yang of the liver.
- - **Inability to sleep combined with fullness of the stomach** — Usually caused by lack of coordination of the spleen, resulting in nausea and vomiting.
- - **Wakes up easily** — Usually indicates lack of vital energy of the heart and the gallbladder, excess heat in the heart.
- - **Wakes up early** — Usually indicates deficiency of vital energy.
- - **Unable to fall asleep** — Anxiety, insufficient vital energy.

- - **Sleep disturbed by many dreams** — Deficiency of yin of the liver and kidneys, imbalance of yin and yang.
- - **Constant sleepiness, lethargy** — Usually indicates asthenia of the spleen or accumulation of dampness.

FIG. 92

A person lying on their back asleep, head resting on a pillow, eyes closed and one arm folded across the body, drawn inside the lower right of the table.

BOOK PAGE 41 · SCAN P050

Diagnosis Through Pulse Taking and Palpation

Diagnosis Through Pulse Taking and Palpation

The changes in one's pulse are used to determine the level of qi and blood in one's body.

The human wrist can be divided into three sections: inch, bar and cubit. Each section corresponds to different internal organs.

In general, traditional Chinese medicine uses the entrance to the pulse, ie. the inch section. As it is where the Hand *Taiyin* lung channel passes through, bearing in mind that the lungs are the part of the viscera that store qi, blood and nutrients, and are crucial to the limbs and bones, this section will reveal the state of the viscera, channels and collaterals, qi and blood etc.

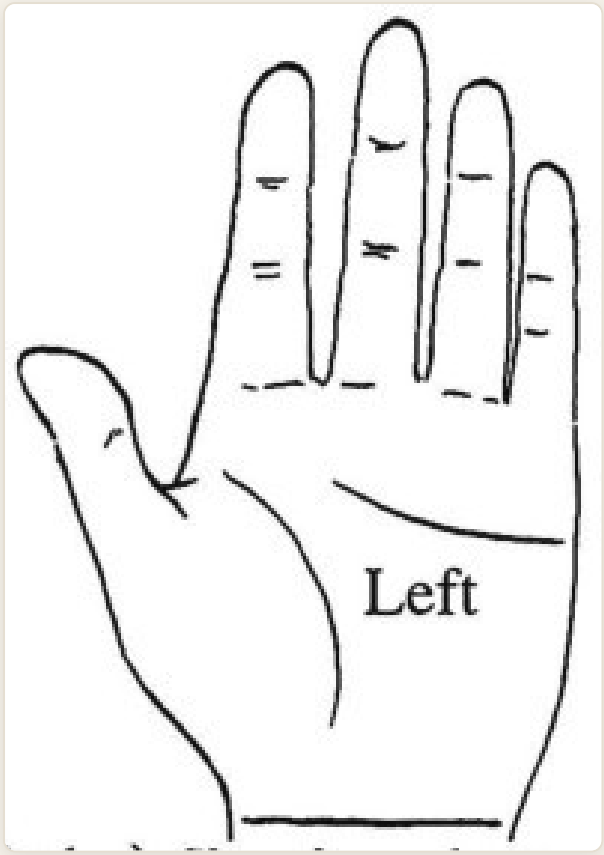
When a person is in good health, the pulse is slow and steady, rhythmic and strong. A rapid or a very slow pulse will indicate presence of disease.

If a patient is very ill, but the pulse is calm and strong, it indicates a chance of recovery. But if the pulse is fine and faint, almost imperceptible, it is a portent of grave consequences.

There are many types of pulse, such as floating pulse, deep pulse, full pulse, fine pulse, feeble pulse, replete pulse and others. The differences are very subtle. Hence diagnosis through pulse

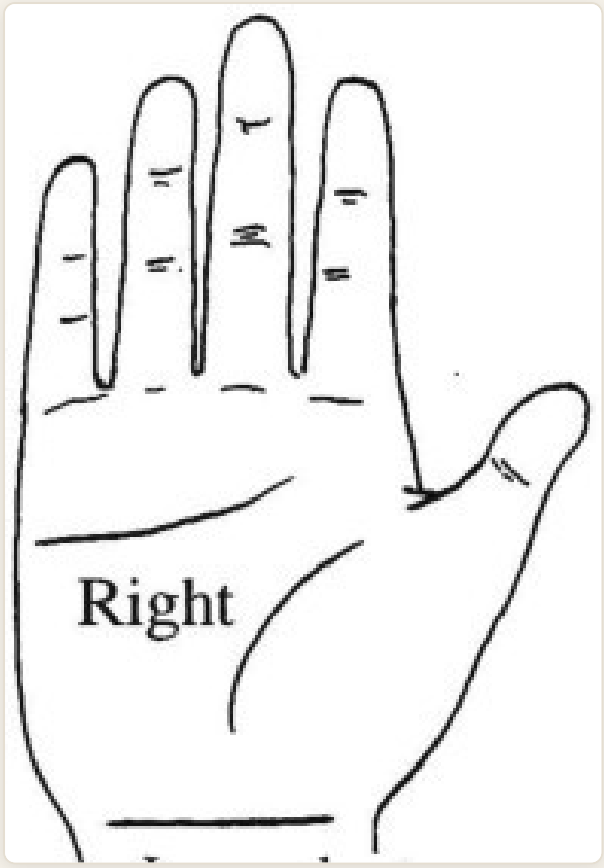
taking is not easy to master.

FIG. 93



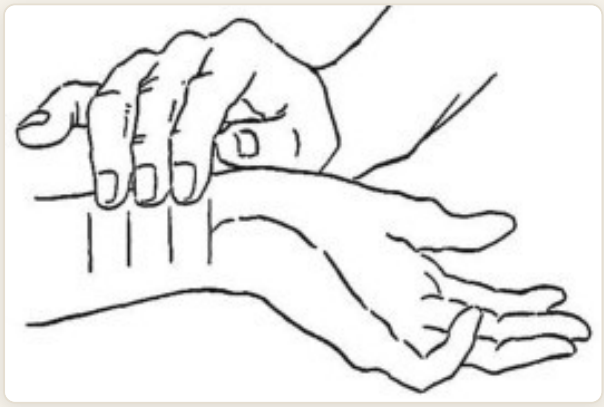
A line drawing of an open left palm, marked "Left", with the wrist divided into three sections and the internal organs each section reflects written beside them.

FIG. 94



A line drawing of an open right palm, marked "Right", showing the three pulse sections of that wrist and their corresponding organs.

FIG. 95



A line drawing of one hand resting three fingers along the wrist of a second hand in order to feel the pulse.

An overview of various types of pulse

An overview of various types of pulse

Pulse	Description
Floating pulse	Can be felt by a light touch. It grows faint on hard pressure and can be likened to a floating log. Usually seen in early stages of diseases caused by exogenous factors.
Deep pulse	Can only be felt by applying pressure. Usually seen in many various chronic diseases. Indicates that the disease has attacked the internal organs.
Rapid pulse	Fast beating. Usually indicates the presence of heat.
Retarded pulse	Pulse beat is slow. Indicates diseases of a cold nature.
Feeble pulse	The pulse feels feeble and faint. Indicates deficiency of positive qi.
Replete pulse	The pulse is vigorous and forceful. Indicates excess syndrome.
Full pulse	A pulse beating like waves with forceful rising and gradual decline. Indicates presence of excessive pathogenic heat.
Fine pulse	A thin, thready pulse. Faint yet always perceptible. Indicates deficiency of yin and blood.
Taut pulse	A long and forceful pulse that feels like a string on a musical instrument. Usually seen in liver trouble, severe pains and retention of phlegm.
Tense pulse	A fast and strong pulse that feels like a tightly stretched cord. Indicates presence of cold or pain.
Knotted pulse	A pulse pausing at irregular intervals. Usually seen in cases of stagnation of qi or blood, phlegm due to cold.
Intermittent pulse	A slow and weak pulse pausing at regular intervals. Indicates severely weakened viscera, deficiency of the qi and blood, severe trauma or terror.
Running pulse	A rapid pulse with irregular intermittence. Usually seen in cases of excessive heat, stagnation of qi and blood, retention of phlegm or indigestion.

Slippery pulse	A smooth pulse running like beads rolling on a plate. Usually seen in cases of phlegm retention.
Hesitant pulse	An uneven pulse. Usually caused by loss or stagnation of qi and blood.

Trang 43

"You needn't tell me about your illness. Just give me your hand and I can diagnose it."

"I just need to take your pulse and I'll know what you're suffering from."

"... ..."

"Where's your pulse? I can't feel it!"

It is an exaggeration to say that feeling the pulse will be able to tell one what the patient is suffering from. Diagnosis cannot be based on pulse taking alone. The four methods of diagnosis are not self-contained. During a consultation, all four methods of diagnosis have to be exercised before a comprehensive and accurate diagnosis can be made.

Wang Shuhe and the *Pulse Classic*

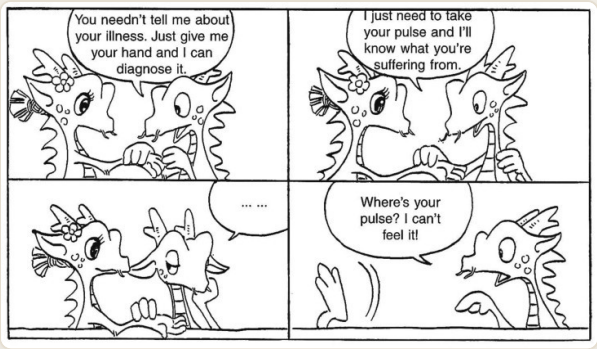
Wang Shuhe (180–270 AD) was a famous physician from the Western Jin state. He studied sphygmology*. He compiled the various documents on sphygmology from generations before him and his own experience in this area of medicine into a book known as the *Pulse Classic*.*

The *Pulse Classic* categorised pulse conditions into 24 types. They still form the basis for methods of diagnosis in traditional Chinese medicine to date. The book established the study of the entrance of the pulse and clearly defined the inch, bar and cubit sections.

The *Pulse Classic* was China's earliest work on sphygmology and was highly regarded by later physicians. Its influence in the medical field was extensive, later spreading to China, Korea, the Arab world and Europe.

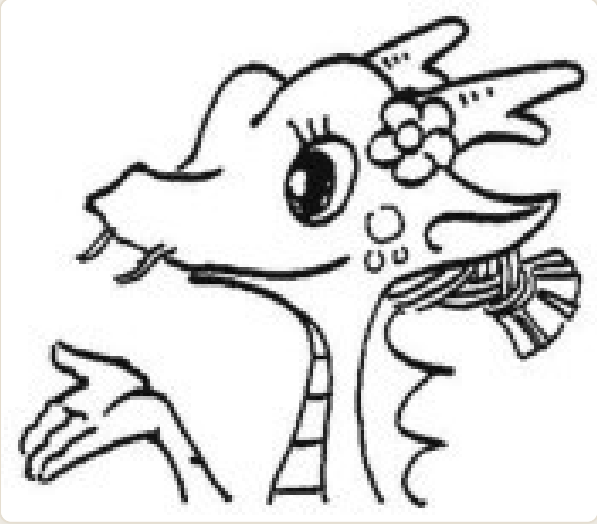
- * The study of the pulse.

FIG. 96



A four-panel comic strip. In the top-left panel a dragon wearing a flower tells its companion that it needn't describe her illness, and to simply hold out her hand. In the top-right panel it goes on that it only has to take her pulse to know what she is suffering from. In the bottom-left panel the other dragon is silent, its balloon holding only a row of dots. In the bottom-right panel the puzzled dragon waves its hand and exclaims that it cannot feel any pulse at all.

FIG. 97



The dragon mascot, wearing a flower and a bow, looking to the left with one hand raised, the tail of its speech balloon at its side.

Guo Yu and Diagnosis Through Pulse Taking

Guo Yu and Diagnosis Through Pulse Taking

"My beloved official Li, I heard you were gravely ill. Who cured your illness?"

"Your Majesty, it was Guo Yu. He is a skilled physician. He often treats the imperial concubines and court officials."

"Guo Yu is a divine physician indeed!"

"He merely felt my pulse and could tell me what I was suffering from."

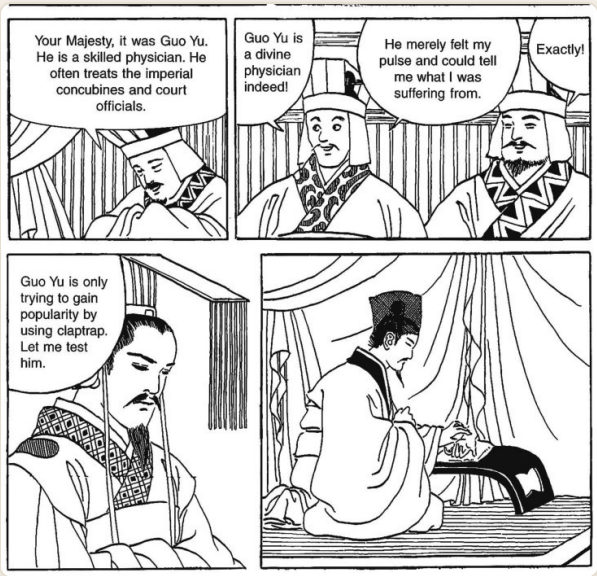
"Exactly!"

"Guo Yu is only trying to gain popularity by using claptrap. Let me test him."

FIG. 98

The opening row of the comic. The left panel carries the story title Guo Yu and Diagnosis Through Pulse Taking above a physician in a tall official's cap examining a patient behind a hanging curtain. The right panel shows the emperor seated on a dais beneath a dragon motif, a caption below reading "Han Dynasty, Emperor He's reign.", asking his recovered official who cured his illness.

FIG. 99



The middle and lower rows of the comic. An official answers the emperor that it was Guo Yu, a skilled physician who often treats the imperial concubines and court officials; a courtier calls Guo Yu a divine physician indeed; and the patient confirms that Guo Yu merely felt his pulse and could tell him what he was suffering from, to which the emperor agrees. In the lower-left panel another official, suspicious, says that Guo Yu is only seeking popularity with claptrap and asks to test him, while in the lower-right panel Guo Yu kneels before a curtained couch, feeling a pulse.

BOOK PAGE 45 · SCAN P054

Trang 45

"Please give me your right hand."

"... ..."

"Physician Guo, how is my beloved concubine?"

"Well..."

"Your Majesty, Her Ladyship's pulse is most unusual. Her left hand is of a yang nature while her right hand is of a yin nature."

"She possesses both the male and female pulse conditions. This is truly baffling."

"Hahaha!"

"Look!"

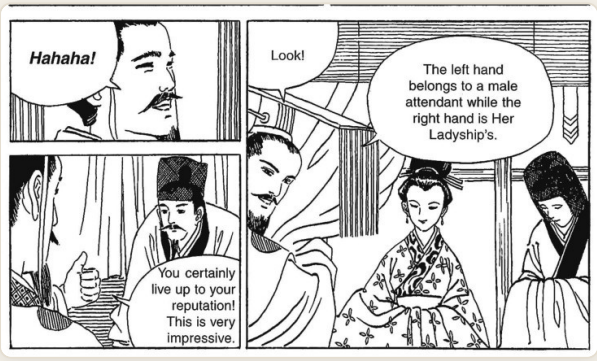
"The left hand belongs to a male attendant while the right hand is Her Ladyship's."

"You certainly live up to your reputation! This is very impressive."

FIG. 100

The upper panels of the comic. In the top row Guo Yu asks the patient to give him her right hand, a hand feels a pulse behind a curtain, and Guo Yu frowns over a balloon of dots. In the second row the emperor asks how his beloved concubine is; Guo Yu hesitates, then reports that Her Ladyship's pulse is most unusual — her left hand of a yang nature and her right hand of a yin nature — and, bowing low, concludes that she possesses both the male and female pulse conditions, which is truly baffling.

FIG. 101



The lower panels of the comic. The emperor bursts out laughing and calls "Look!", while Guo Yu declares that the left hand belongs to a male attendant and the right hand is Her Ladyship's; at the foot of the page the emperor tells Guo Yu that he certainly lives up to his reputation and that this is very impressive.

Diagnosis Through Palpation

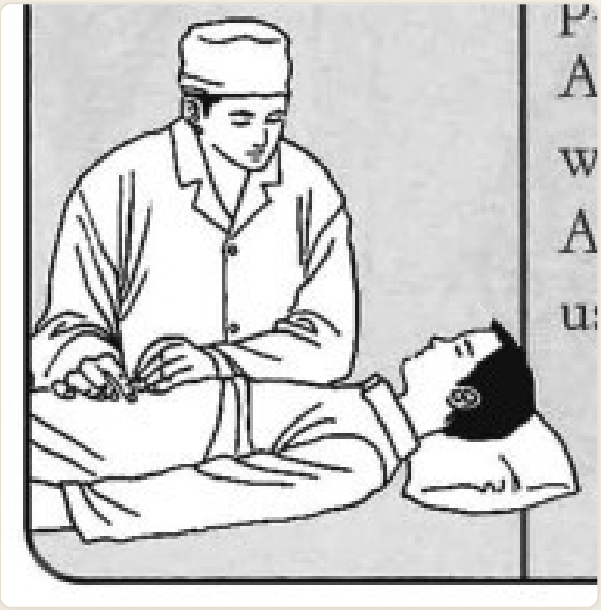
Diagnosis Through Palpation

Palpation involves pressing on the patient's body with one's hands. It is a part of diagnosis through pulse feeling and palpation.

Area pressed	Findings
Pressing on the skin	Warm skin indicates the presence of excess pathogenic heat.
	Cold skin indicates a deficiency of yang and qi.
	Dry skin indicates a deficiency of fluids.
	If the skin feels thorny, it is usually an indication of damage to the yin or internal blood stasis.
	If the skin initially feels warm to the touch before cooling down, the heat is external.
	A gradual warming of the skin indicates internal heat.
Pressing on swellings	When the swelling remains dented after being pressed, it indicates the presence of oedema.
	When the swelling pops back after being pressed, it indicates the presence of air.
Pressing on the limbs	Cold limbs indicate an excess of yin and cold.
	Warm limbs usually indicate an excess of yang and heat.
	A warm back of hand usually indicates external heat.
	A warm palm where other parts of the body remain relatively cold usually indicates damage to the yin.
	When a child's body feels warm and his fingertips are cold, look out for a possible fit.
Pressing on the abdomen	A painful and swollen abdomen suggests exogenous causes.

	A swollen but soft abdomen with no pain indicates a deficiency syndrome.
	A swollen abdomen which rises when pressed and makes hollow sounds indicates the presence of excess air.
	A swollen abdomen which shows wave-like movements when pressed on both sides indicates the presence of excess fluid.
	A hard swelling in the abdomen which doesn't move and hurts when pressed usually indicates blood stasis.
	A swelling that has no form, is painless and moves around usually indicates a stagnation of qi.

FIG. 102



A line drawing set into the lower left of the table: a physician in a white coat presses both hands on the abdomen of a patient lying on their back with their head on a pillow.

Diagnosis Through the Analysis of Excreta

Diagnosis Through the Analysis of Excreta

Stools and urine are waste products from the human body. They offer telling signs of a person's state of health. In general, stools are yellowish brown. But if they remain in the intestines for too long, they'll turn a darker colour and become drier. In diarrhoea, the stools are more yellowish as they have stayed in the intestines for only a short time.

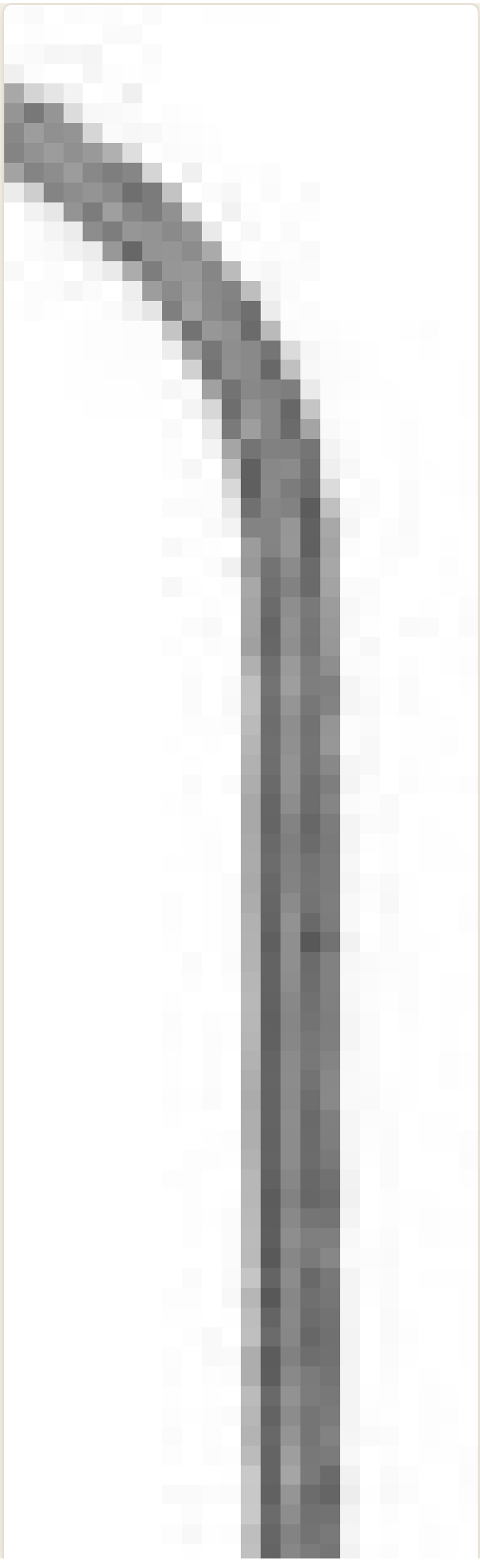
Examination of stools and urine are commonly carried out in hospital checkups. They provide a basis for diagnosis. Examination of stools and urine involve the physical appearance, consistency, colour, degree of digestion, etc.

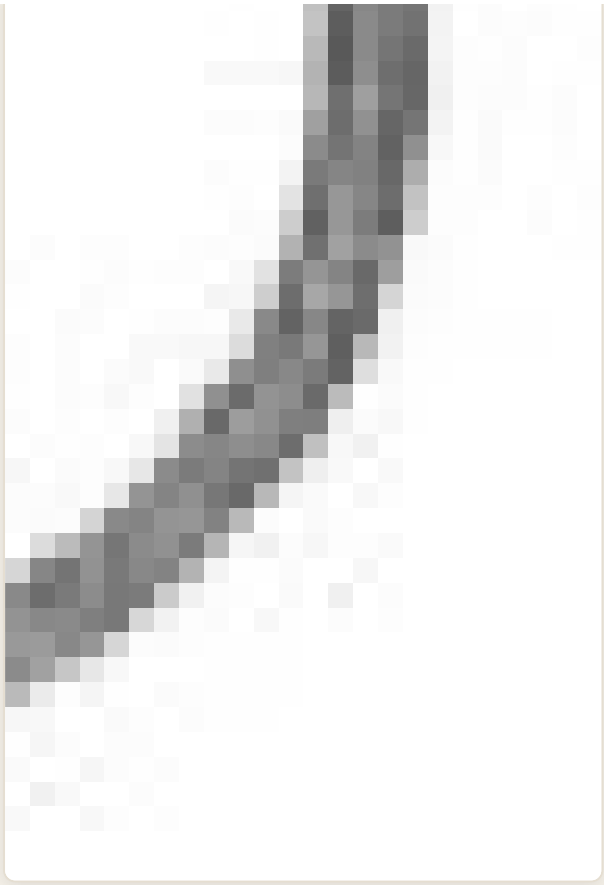
Examination of stool is not exactly a part of traditional Chinese medicine. But there have been records of tasting of stool in China to diagnose a patient. It's said that bitter stools indicate signs of recovery while sweet stools are bad news. Just how accurate and true is this? Well, no harm reading it up for fun.

The King of Yue Tastes Stool

During the Spring and Summer Period when the states of Yue and Wu were at war, the state of Yue lost and the king of Yue was held as a prisoner-of-war. The king of Yue took the humiliation in his stride. In order to gain the trust of the king of Wu, he tasted King Wu's stool when the latter fell ill and predicted a full recovery. True enough, the king of Wu got his health back and released the king of Yue. The king of Yue then returned to rebuild his country and eventually defeated the state of Wu.

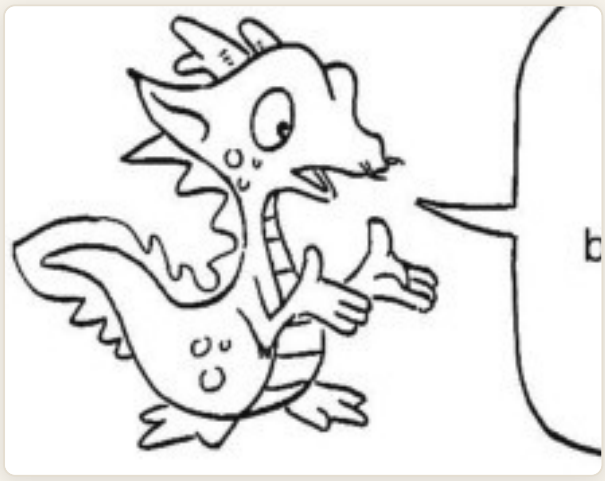
FIG. 103





A narrow cropped sliver showing only a fragment of the rounded decorative border that frames the story box.

FIG. 104



The dragon mascot, whose speech balloon holds the paragraph above, standing with one forelimb raised and mouth open in speech, the tail of the balloon trailing to its right.

FIG. 105

A line drawing in two parts: above, a standing attendant beside a chamber pot on a low stand and a figure stooping nearby in a curtained room; below, a heavily patterned coverlet under which a bearded man lies ill in bed.

BOOK PAGE 48 · SCAN P057

A Filial Son Tastes His Father's Stool

A Filial Son Tastes His Father's Stool

During the Southern Qi period, there was a boy called Yu Qianlou. When his father fell ill, he got him a physician,

"If the stool is bitter to the taste, your father's illness isn't serious."

"But if it tastes sweet, I'm afraid that's bad news."

"It tastes sweet! What shall I do?"

"I'm afraid his disease is incurable."

"I'm willing to shorten my life-span in exchange for my father's recovery."

Perhaps Yu Qianlou's filial piety touched Heaven. His father gradually regained his health. This story is recorded in the book *Twenty-Four Exemplars of Filial Piety*.

FIG. 106

The whole page is a single comic strip. The top-left panel carries the title A Filial Son Tastes His Father's Stool above Yu Qianlou standing in thought; the top-right panel has a caption box introducing Yu Qianlou of the Southern Qi period, who fetched a physician when his father fell ill, showing the boy and the physician at the sick man's bedside. In the middle-left panel the physician explains that a bitter-tasting stool means the illness is not serious, but a sweet taste is bad news; in the middle-right panel Yu Qianlou, having tasted it, finds it sweet and fears the disease is incurable. In the bottom-left panel he kneels in prayer before an incense burner, offering to shorten his own life in exchange for his father's recovery; and the bottom-right panel carries a caption explaining that his filial piety perhaps touched Heaven, that his father gradually recovered, and that the story is recorded in the book Twenty-Four Exemplars of Filial Piety, with Yu Qianlou attending his recovered father.

Methods of Treatment in Traditional Chinese Medicine

Methods of Treatment in Traditional Chinese Medicine

The methods of treatment in traditional Chinese medicine are many and diverse in nature. The commonly-seen ones are Chinese medicine, acupuncture and moxibustion, massage, diet therapy, *qigong* and mood therapy, though there are more unusual therapies, such as cupping, scraping and bloodletting. The methods of treatment used vary depending on the ailment and constitution of each patient.

BOOK PAGE 50 · SCAN P059

Method One — Chinese Medicines

Method One — Chinese Medicines

Discovery of Chinese medicinal herbs

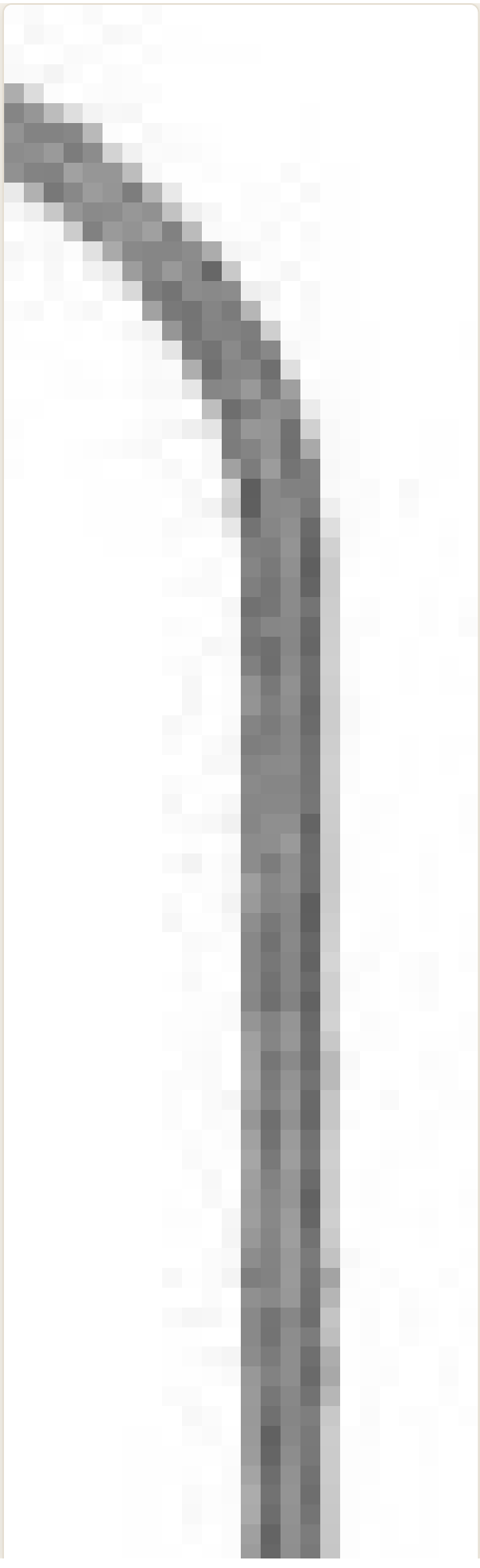
An ancient saying tells us: "The Divine Peasant tasted a hundred types of herbs to treat the diseases of the people." In their quest for survival, the forefathers of the Chinese people tasted countless wild fruit, seeds and plants. Over time, they learnt to distinguish the poisonous plants from the non-poisonous ones and discovered which ones had healing properties. In this way they accumulated knowledge of medicinal plants.

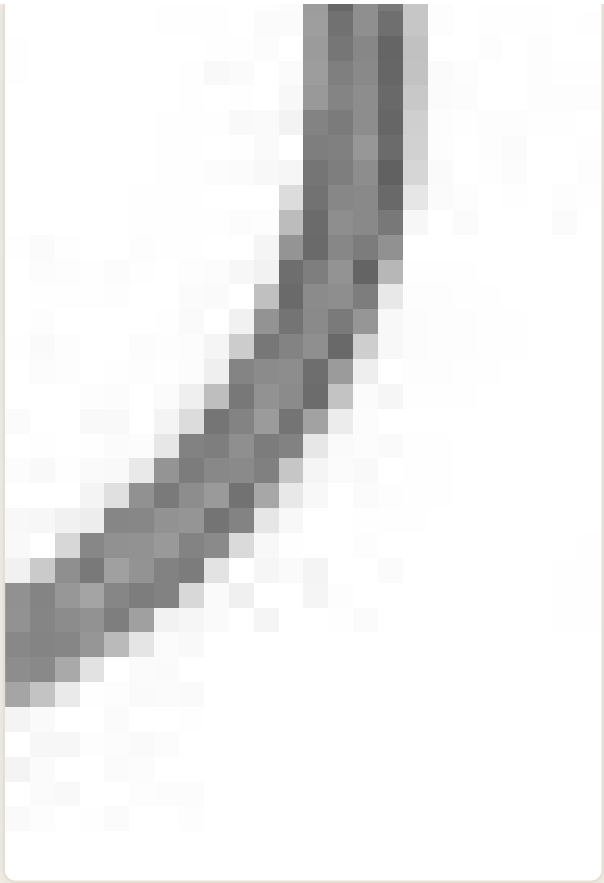
It was during hunting trips that they discovered some animals also possessed healing and medicinal properties. With the accumulation of knowledge and experience, the Chinese people developed an extensive body of knowledge which became known as traditional Chinese medicine.

The Divine Peasant (also known as Shennong or Yandi)

In the distant past, medicinal herbs, grains, weeds and flowers grew together. In order to find out which ones among them could be used as medicine or food, the legendary Divine Peasant tasted the plants himself, identifying many medicinal herbs and edible plants. However, he was fatally poisoned one day after tasting a deadly plant.

FIG. 107



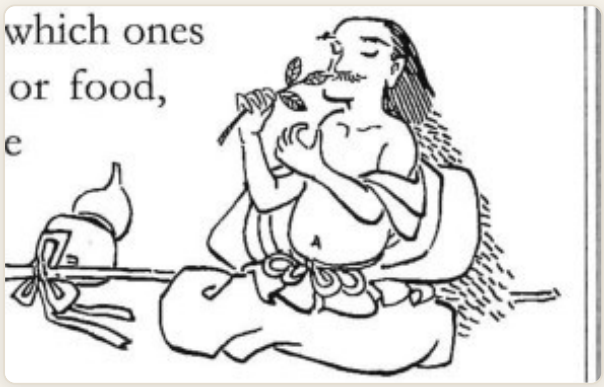


A narrow decorative arc: the rounded left corner of the heading banner, a border ornament rather than a picture.

FIG. 108

A line drawing of a forest scene: three figures of ancient China in a wood — one holding a spear, one stooping to gather plants, one carrying a bundle of herbs — with a deer, a small animal, mushrooms and undergrowth around them. Two small inset drawings at the lower right show a bird and a forked root.

FIG. 109



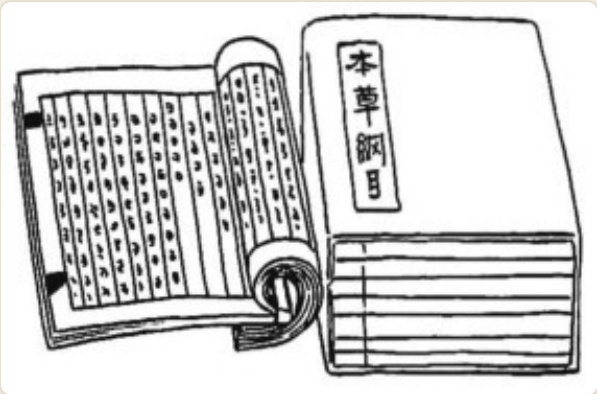
The Divine Peasant sitting cross-legged and tasting a leaf held to his mouth, with a gourd flask and a bundle of herbs laid beside him.

Types of Chinese medicines

Types of Chinese medicines

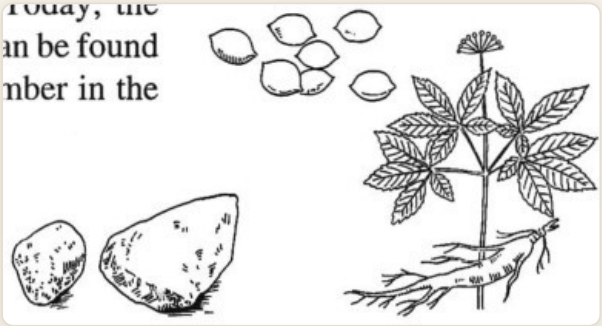
Apart from the medicinal herbs we are familiar with, Chinese medicine also includes minerals and animal parts. China, with its vast land area, varied terrain and range of climatic conditions, is home to a wide variety of plants, animals and minerals. The definitive classic on Chinese medicines, the *Compendium of Materia Medica*, records 1892 types of medicines. Today, the number of possible medicines that can be found from these rich resources easily number in the thousands.

FIG. 110



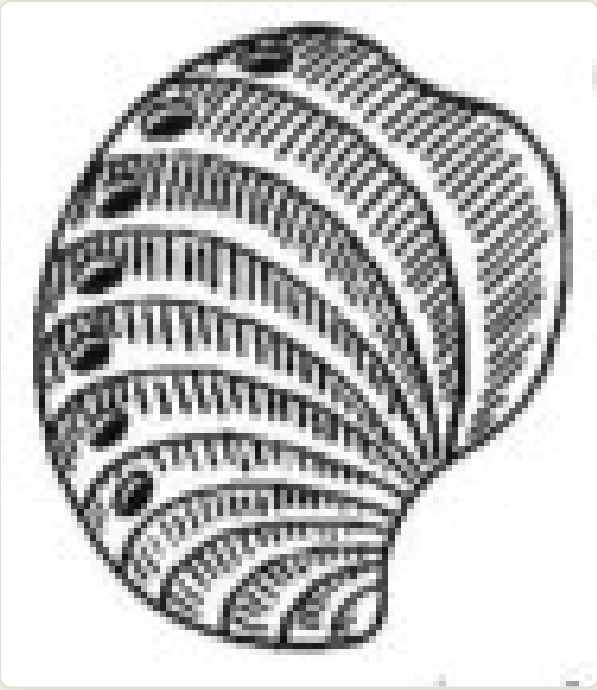
A drawing of the Compendium of Materia Medica: an open book of block-printed pages, with a stack of bound volumes resting beside it.

FIG. 111



A group of medicinal materials: a scattering of flat oval seeds, two rough mineral stones, and a plant with compound leaves, a small umbel of flowers and a slender root.

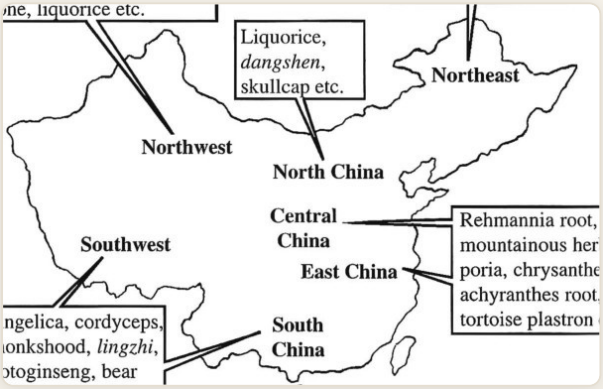
FIG. 112



A ribbed, fan-shaped shell — a medicine of animal origin.

Where medicinal herbs can be found

FIG. 113



A map of China marked with regional labels — Northeast, North China, Northwest, Central China, East China, Southwest and South China — each with a boxed list of the medicinal herbs and other medicines produced in that region.

FIG. 114

A small fragment of the map: a section of the outline with a pointer line running to one of the regional label boxes.

BOOK PAGE 52 · SCAN P061

Medicinal herbs

Medicinal herbs

The parts of medicinal herbs that are used include the root, bark, leaves, flowers, fruit and seed, cane and more.

Root

It is the part of the plant that absorbs nutrients and water from the soil and air.

Stem

It transports water and nutrients from the root. It also serves to support the plant.

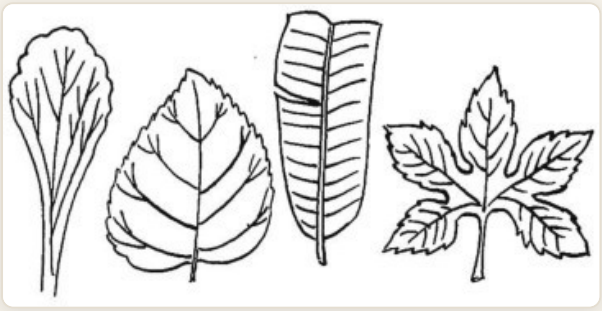
BOOK PAGE 53 · SCAN P062

Trang 53

Leaf

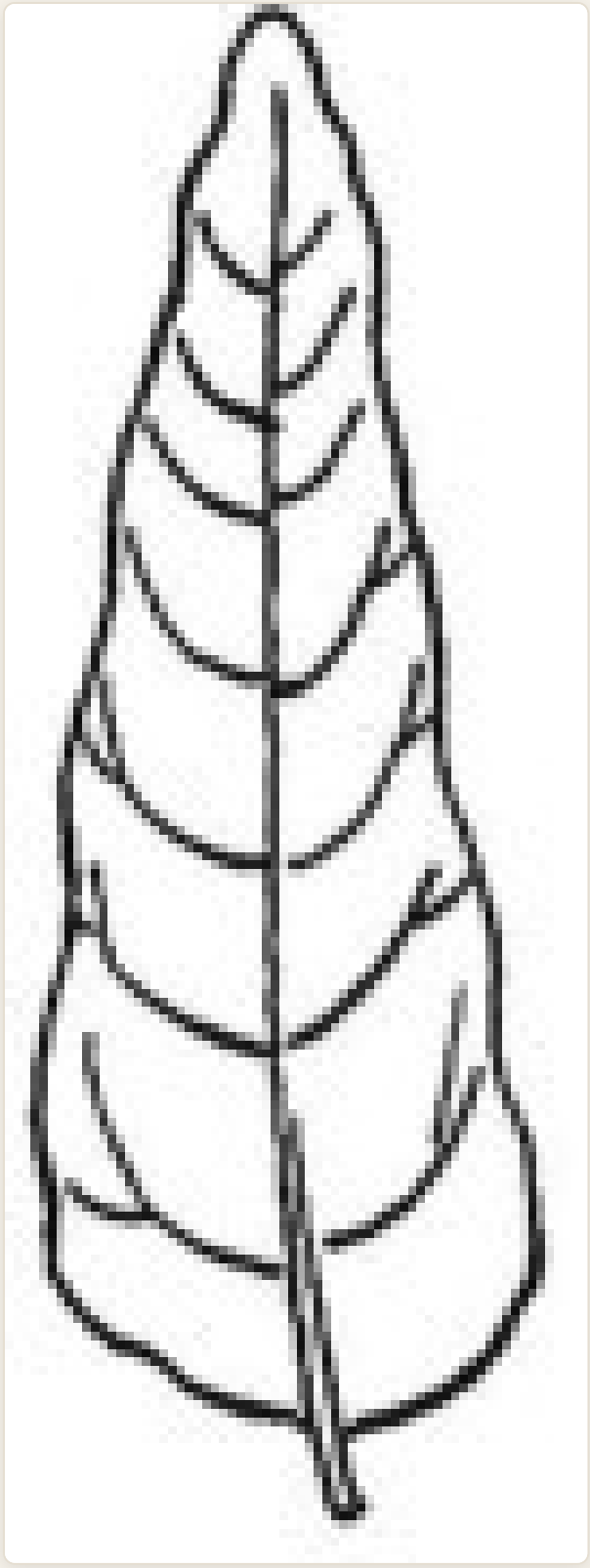
The part where the plant makes food.

FIG. 115



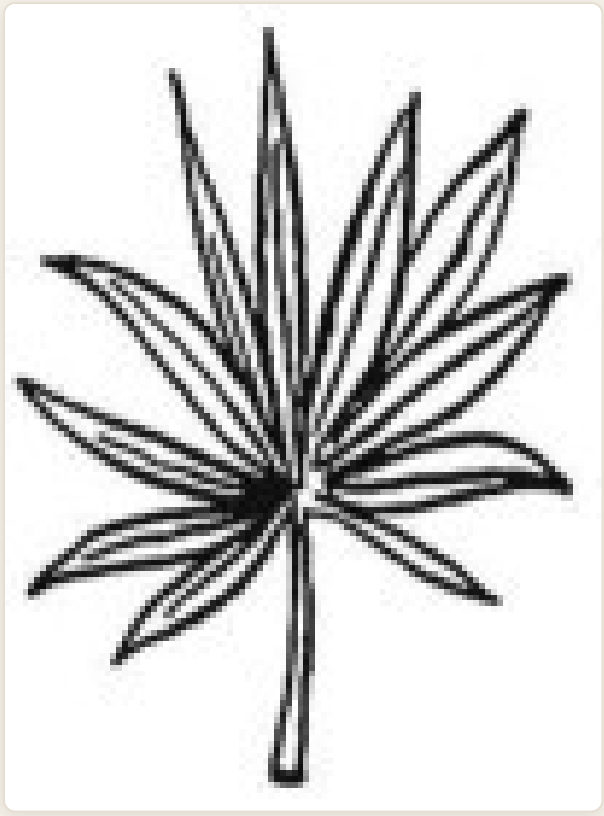
Four leaf shapes side by side: a spatula-shaped leaf with pinnate veins, an ovate leaf with serrated edges, a long strap-like leaf with parallel side veins, and a lobed maple-like leaf.

FIG. 116



A single large teardrop-shaped leaf with curved parallel veins and a long stalk.

FIG. 117



A fan-shaped leaf with many slender pointed lobes radiating from the base.

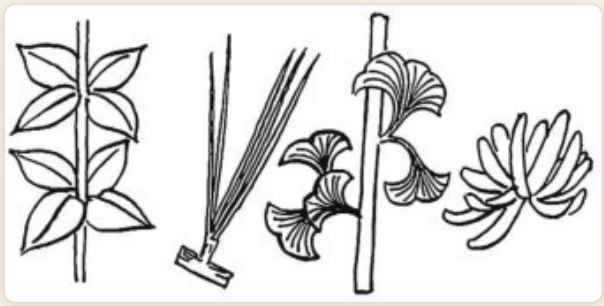
FIG. 118

A pinnately compound leaf: opposite pairs of oval leaflets along a stem, ending in a single terminal leaflet.

FIG. 119

Two leafy twigs bearing alternate oval leaves.

FIG. 120

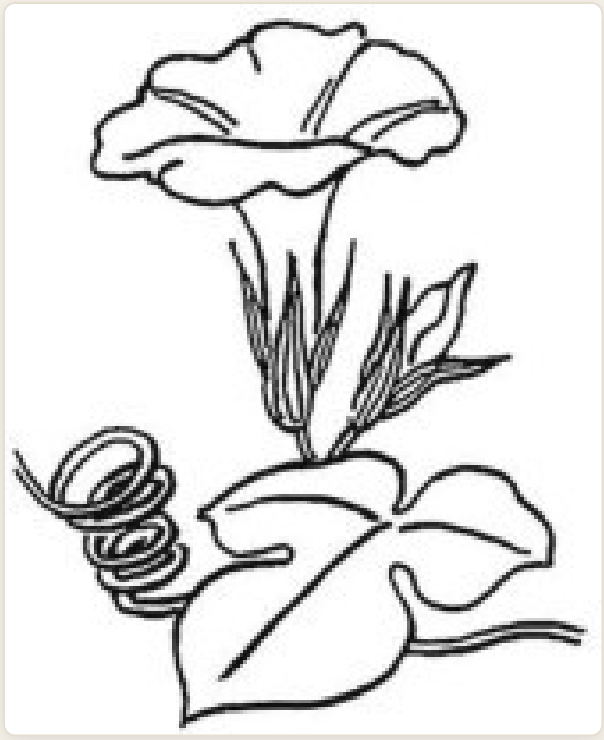


A cluster of leaf forms: a stem with opposite lance-shaped leaves, a bundle of long grass-like blades, a spray of fan-shaped ginkgo leaves, and a fan-shaped lobed leaf.

Flower

Mainly responsible for the reproduction of the plant.

FIG. 121

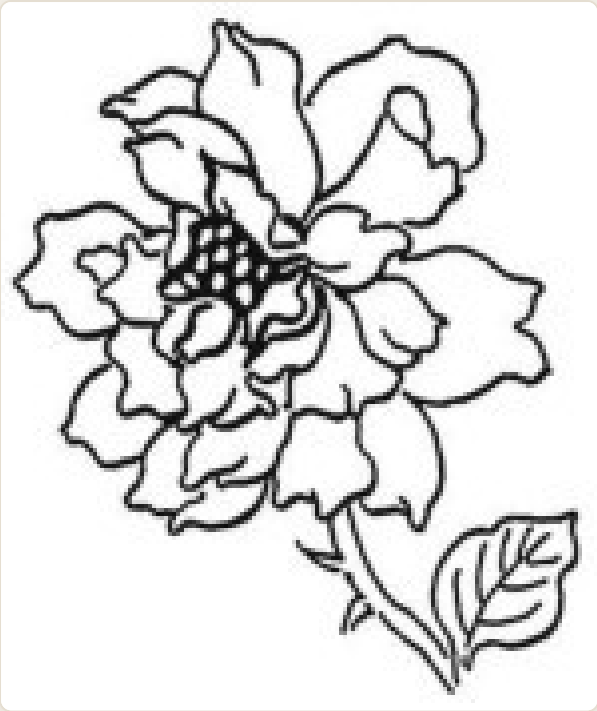


A morning-glory flower: a trumpet-shaped bloom with a coiled tendril and heart-shaped leaves.

FIG. 122

Two flowering branches: a bare twig bearing plum blossoms, and a hanging cluster of pea-like flowers.

FIG. 123

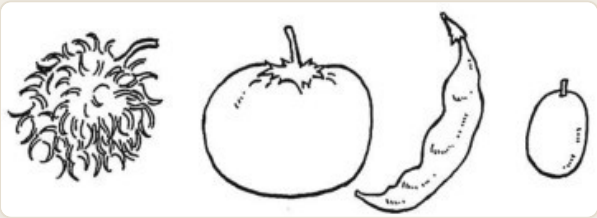


A large double flower with many ruffled, layered petals, together with a leaf and stem.

Fruit

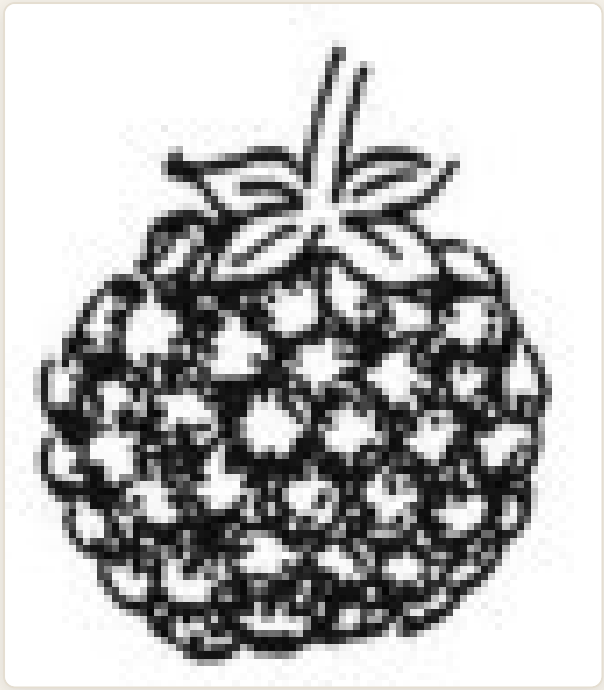
A fertilized part of the plant with reproductive function.

FIG. 124



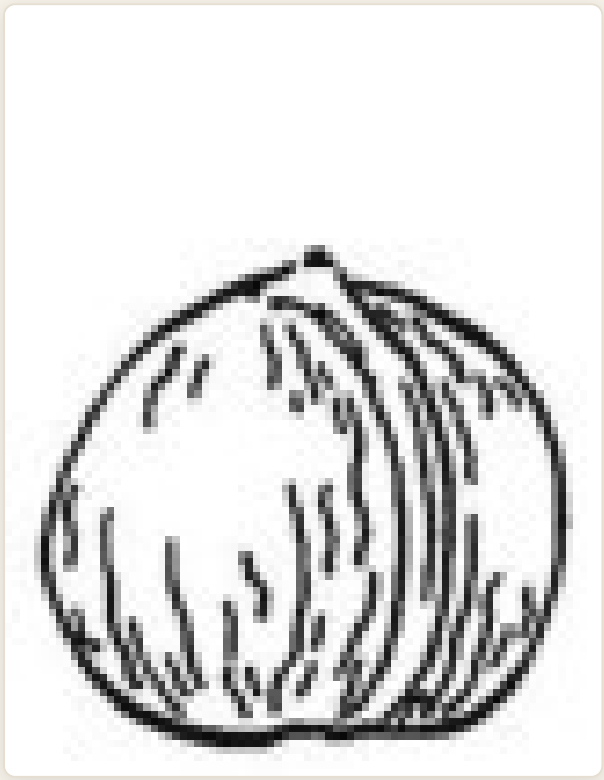
A group of fruits: a spiky burr, a round fruit with a stalk, a long curved pod, and a small oval fruit.

FIG. 125



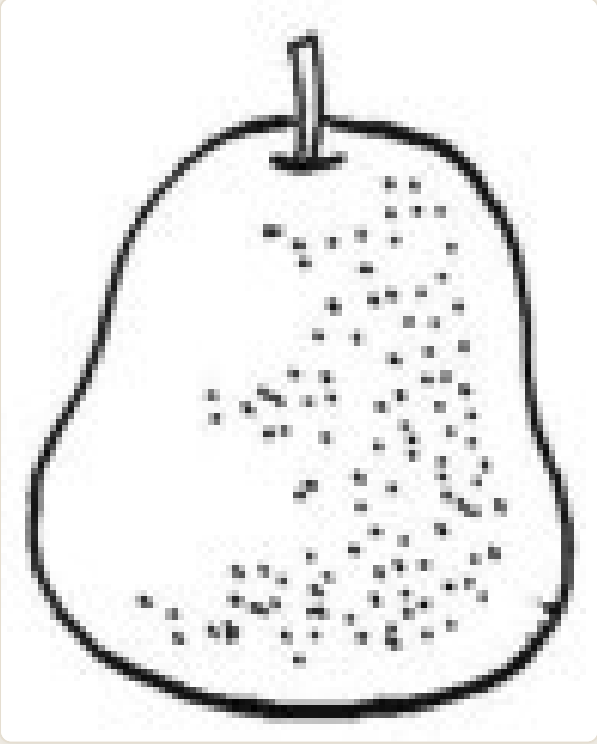
An aggregate berry built of many small drupelets, topped by a leafy calyx.

FIG. 126



A round melon with vertical stripes.

FIG. 127



A pear-shaped fruit with a stalk and speckled skin.

BOOK PAGE 54 · SCAN P063

Collection and preparation of medicinal herbs

Collection and preparation of medicinal herbs

Medicinal herbs have various uses and their effectiveness is dependent on the time of the year (seasonal changes). That is why the picking of medicinal herbs has to be done under the right climatic conditions and during the right stage of the plant's growth, among other factors, to ensure the optimal effectiveness of the herbs. For example, root plants are usually picked in autumn, winter and early spring when their leaves wither. It is during these times that the roots store the largest amount of nutrients.

Other than the timing of herb collection, medicinal herbs also undergo preparatory processes like cleaning, cutting, frying, steaming and quenching. These processes remove or reduce the toxicity and side effects of the herbs; increase their effectiveness, change the nature of the herbs and discourage the growth of mould and parasites for storage purposes.

BOOK PAGE 55 · SCAN P064

Some common medicinal herbs

Some common medicinal herbs

Angelica root

Sweet and hot to the taste, warm in nature. Tonic for the qi and blood, moistens the intestines to ease constipation. Good for deficiency of blood, weak constitution, constipation and external injuries.

Fleeceflower root

Bittersweet to the taste, warm in nature. Tonic for the kidney and liver, good for ovulation, detoxifies, eases constipation. Used to treat hair loss due to iron deficiency caused by menstruation, sallow complexion etc.

Ginseng root

Sweet and slightly bitter to the taste, neither warm nor cold in nature. Boosts vital energy, spleen and lungs, promotes production of fluids and calms the mind. Good for cold limbs, fatigue and lethargy, poor appetite, weak constitution etc.

Tangerine peel

Bitter and hot to the taste, warm in nature. Regulates qi, strengthens the spleen, removes internal heat and phlegm. Good for qi stagnation in the spleen and stomach, poor appetite, cough with phlegm etc.

Rehmannia root

Shengdi is bittersweet and cold in nature. Dispels heat, strengthens yin, promotes production of fluids, clots blood. *Shoudi* is sweet and mildly warm. Good for the kidneys and blood, regulates menstruation and replenishes yin.

Loquat leaf

Bitter to the taste, cooling in nature. Dispels heat in the lung and treats cough, stops vomiting. Good for coughs due to heat in the lung, heavy breathing, thirst due to heat.

Trang 56

Lotus seed

Sweet and bitter to the taste, neither cold nor heaty in nature. Tonic for the spleen, stops diarrhoea, benefits the kidneys, calms the mind. Good for deficiency of the kidneys, prolonged diarrhoea, insomnia due to worry, incontinence and loss of sperm.

Gingko nut

Bittersweet to the taste, neither cold nor heaty in nature, toxic. Good for asthma, prevents parasites, controls urination. Used to treat coughs with phlegm, whitish discharge, incontinence, frequent urination.

Chinese date

Sweet to the taste, warm in nature. Replenishes qi, promotes blood and calms the mind, moderate medicinal properties. Good for weak spleen and stomach, deficiency of blood, insomnia, lethargy etc.

Chrysanthemum flower

Bittersweet, cold in nature. Dispels wind and heat, benefits the eyes and detoxifies. Used to treat colds due to external febrile factors, headaches, dizzy spells, infections.

Magnolia bark

Bitter and hot, warm in nature. Eliminates dampness and clears phlegm, treats stagnation of the qi. Good for discomfort of the spleen and stomach due to dampness, indigestion and stagnant qi; nausea, constipation, cough with excess phlegm.

Eucommia bark

Sweet, warm in nature. Tonic for the kidneys and liver, strengthens the muscles and bones, calms pregnancy. Good for joint aches due to failure of the liver and kidney, weak legs, unstable pregnancy, high blood pressure etc.

BOOK PAGE 57 · SCAN P066

The Story of the Hawthorn Fruit

The Story of the Hawthorn Fruit

A sweet fruit, warm in nature. It aids digestion, dispels bruises, clears phlegm and clots blood.

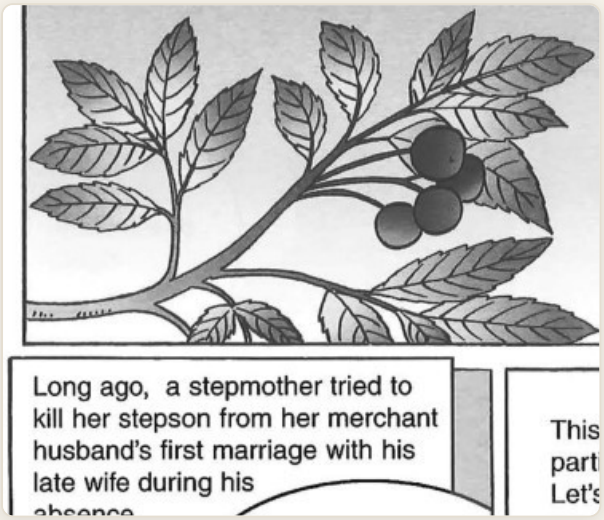
Long ago, a stepmother tried to kill her stepson from her merchant husband's first marriage with his late wife during his absence.

I must remove this thorn in the flesh to let my own child inherit the money.

This rice is only partially cooked. Let's see how you're going to digest it.

If I complain about the rice, Stepmother will get angry. Let me just finish eating it.

FIG. 128



A line drawing of a hawthorn branch: a bare stem running across the panel, with sprays of oval leaves whose edges are sharply toothed, and a cluster of four small round berries hanging at the upper right.

FIG. 129

A four-panel comic strip. Top left: a woman in a headscarf and long robe, a spotted bundle and a small child slung on her back, watches a boy walk off with a basket; beside her the caption tells how a stepmother plotted against her stepson while her merchant husband was away, and she mutters that she must remove this thorn in the flesh so that her own child inherits the money. Top right: the same woman ladles steaming rice into a bowl at a window with a wooden lattice, saying the rice is only partly cooked. Bottom left: the boy sits on the ground eating the rice with chopsticks, looking unhappy as he decides not to complain. Bottom right, wordless: he drinks straight from the bowl, eyes wide.

BOOK PAGE 58 · SCAN P067

Trang 58

Hmph!

As the days went by, the boy began to lose weight.

Ah, my stomach doesn't feel right.

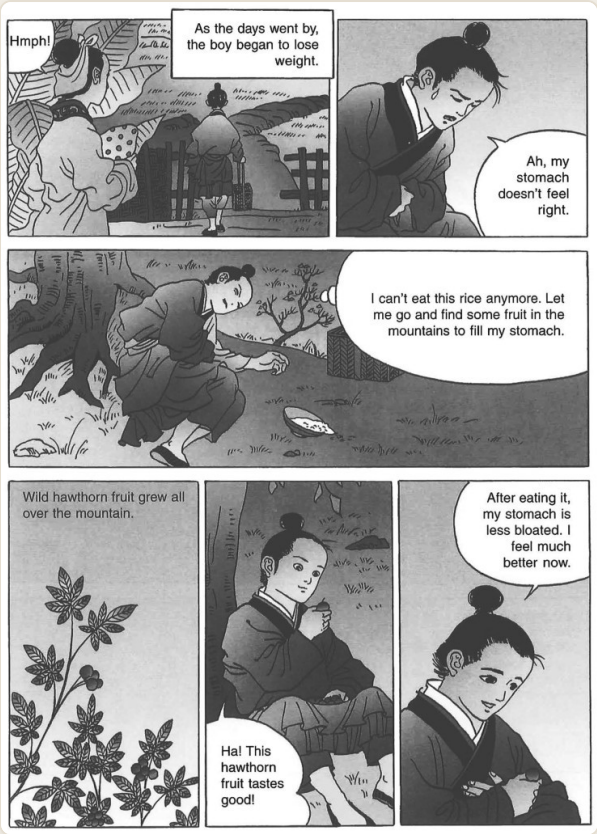
I can't eat this rice anymore. Let me go and find some fruit in the mountains to fill my stomach.

Wild hawthorn fruit grew all over the mountain.

Ha! This hawthorn fruit tastes good!

After eating it, my stomach is less bloated. I feel much better now.

FIG. 130



A full-page comic strip of six panels in three rows. Top row: at the left the stepmother turns away with a dismissive "Hmph!", the caption between the panels noting that as the days went by the boy began to lose weight, and at the right the boy doubles over clutching his stomach. Middle row: one wide panel in which the boy crouches at the foot of a tree beside an overturned empty bowl, then trudges off along a path towards the hills. Bottom row: at the left a hawthorn branch with toothed leaves and clusters of fruit grows across the mountainside; in the middle the boy sits under a tree eating the fruit; at the right he smiles and pats his stomach, much relieved.

BOOK PAGE 59 · SCAN P068

Trang 59

This is odd. This child has become more energetic instead.

Don't tell me he has the protection of the gods?

I'd better not ill-treat him anymore.

Father, you're back!

Was your stepmother good to you?

She fed me very hard rice which made my stomach unwell.

But I felt much better after eating hawthorn fruit from the mountain.

Looks like the hawthorn fruit aids digestion.

Let's make pills from them and sell them for money.

The hawthorn fruit became immensely popular. It was found to be very effective in alleviating indigestion.

FIG. 131

A comic page of eight panels in three rows. Top row: the stepmother, carrying her child in a spotted sling, watches the boy stride off down the path and wonders why he has grown more energetic instead of weaker; in the next panel she wonders whether he has the protection of the gods and resolves not to ill-treat him any more. Middle row: the merchant father returns and the boy runs into his arms crying "Father, you're back!"; the father asks whether his stepmother treated him well, and the boy explains that her half-cooked rice made his stomach unwell but that the hawthorn fruit he ate on the mountain made him feel much better. Bottom row: the father strokes the boy's cheek and concludes that the hawthorn fruit aids digestion, then declares that they should make pills from it and sell them; the last panel shows a street scene where a shop banner lettered 山楂丸 (hawthorn pills) hangs above a crowd gathered around a vendor.

BOOK PAGE 60 · SCAN P069

The Story of the Glossy Privet Fruit (Nuzhenzi)

The Story of the Glossy Privet Fruit (Nuzhenzi)

A bittersweet fruit, neither cooling nor heaty in nature. It acts as a tonic for the liver and kidney, strengthens the back and knees, brightens the eyes, promotes black hair, alleviates swelling and

relieves pain.

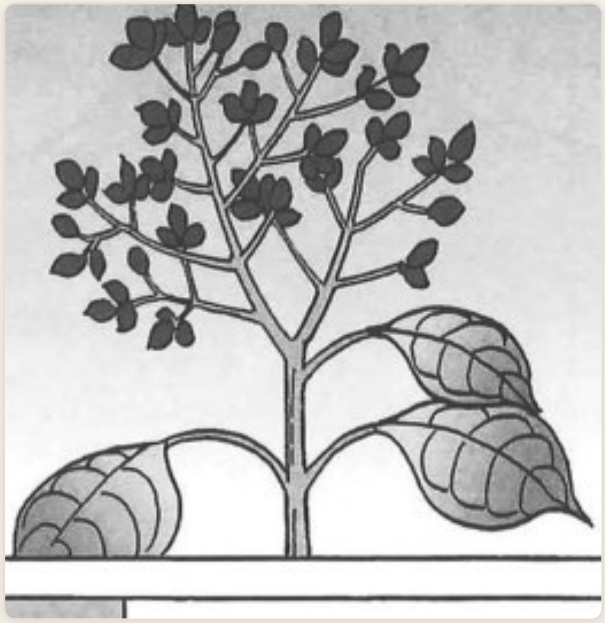
Long ago, a lady called Zhenzi married a farmer. The couple was very loving.

You must come back safe and sound. I'll be waiting for you.

The husband was conscripted to fight in the war one year.

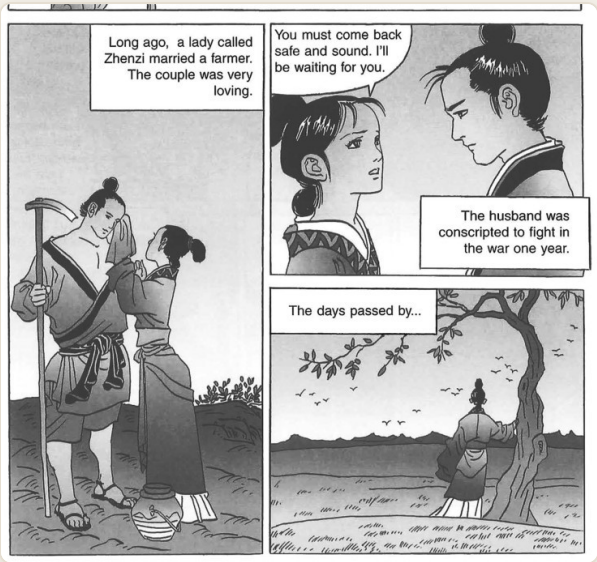
The days passed by...

FIG. 132



A line drawing of the glossy privet (Chinese ilex) plant: a slender branching stem crowded with small rounded leaves in opposite pairs, and at the base two large, broad, veined leaves that curve outwards to left and right.

FIG. 133



A comic strip of four panels. Left, a tall panel: a farmer in a short tunic stands with his hoe over his shoulder while his young wife wipes his brow with a cloth; the caption above says that long ago a lady named Zhenzi married a farmer and the couple was very loving. Top right: the wife, hair in a bun, looks up at her husband, who turns his head away, and she begs him to come back safe and sound because she will be waiting; a boxed caption adds that the husband was conscripted to fight in the war one year. Bottom right: the wife stands alone beside a tree in an open landscape with birds flying overhead, watching the horizon under the caption "The days passed by...".

BOOK PAGE 61 · SCAN P070

Trang 61

Zhenzi fell ill as she missed her husband too much.

Mother, I'm afraid I won't pull through.

When I die, plant the Chinese ilex in front of my tomb.

That tree will represent me. Even if I die, I shall wait for my husband's return.

A few years later...

Zhenzi, I've come back late. Sob... sob...

He's been crying for three days and three nights.

He's getting weaker by the day.

FIG. 134

A comic page of six panels in three rows. Top row: Zhenzi lies on her sickbed while her mother sits beside her; the caption says she fell ill from missing her husband too much, she murmurs that she fears she will not pull through, and then asks that a Chinese ilex be planted before her tomb, saying that the tree will stand for her and that even in death she will wait for her husband's return. Middle row: a wide panel of an open field with birds in the sky, where a lone man in a travelling cloak walks towards a tree, under a boxed caption reading "A few years later...". Bottom row: the husband, now grey-haired, kneels weeping at the tree by a stone tomb wall, crying that he has come back too late; two onlookers comment that he has been crying for three days and three nights and is getting weaker by the day; the last small panel shows the glossy privet branch heavy with clusters of fruit, rays bursting behind it.

BOOK PAGE 62 · SCAN P071

Trang 62

Oh! Look!

The Chinese ilex has borne fruit! There are so many deep purple fruits!

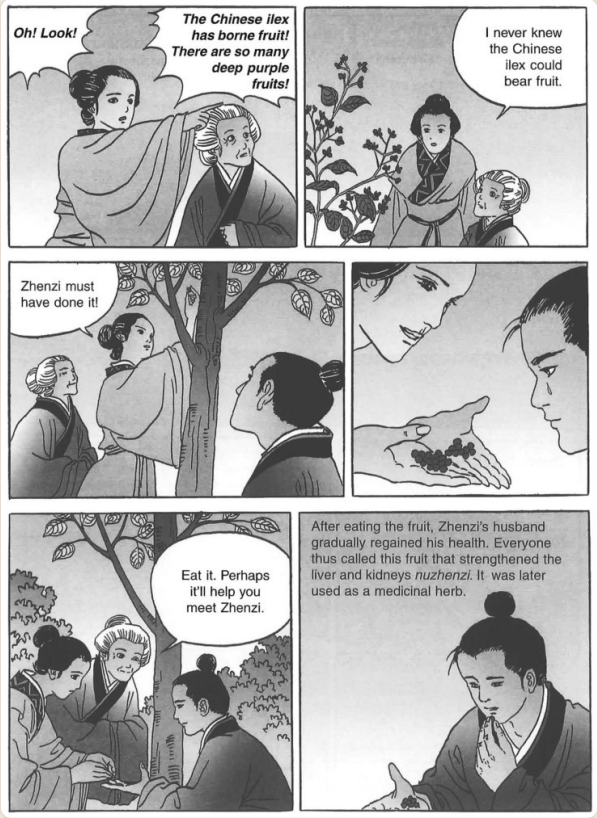
I never knew the Chinese ilex could bear fruit.

Zhenzi must have done it!

Eat it. Perhaps it'll help you meet Zhenzi.

After eating the fruit, Zhenzi's husband gradually regained his health. Everyone thus called this fruit that strengthened the liver and kidneys nuzhenzi. It was later used as a medicinal herb.

FIG. 135



A comic strip of six panels in three rows. Top row: an old woman in a patterned robe lifts a hand in wonder as she spies the tree, crying that the Chinese ilex has borne fruit and that the deep purple fruits are plentiful; in the next panel a young man beside the leafy shrub says he never knew the Chinese ilex could bear fruit. Middle row: the wife, the old woman and the young man gather round the tree trunk, and the wife declares that Zhenzi must have done it; then a close-up of two hands holding a handful of small dark fruits, offered to the grey-haired husband. Bottom row: the wife holds out the fruit to the kneeling husband and tells him to eat it, for perhaps it will help him meet Zhenzi; the last panel shows him eating the fruit with a thoughtful, hopeful expression.

The Story of Wolfberries

The Story of Wolfberries

Wolfberries: Sweet and neither cooling nor heaty in nature. A tonic for the liver and kidneys, promotes essence of life and brightens vision. Used to treat dizziness and ringing in the ears due to deficiency of yin in the kidneys and insufficient menstrual blood, worsening eyesight, aching back and knees etc.

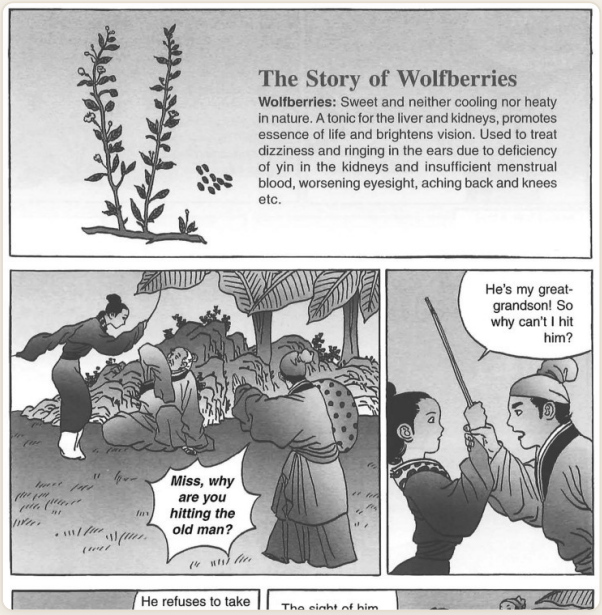
Miss, why are you hitting the old man?

He's my great-grandson! So why can't I hit him?

He refuses to take his medicine. He's young but he already has white hair and is losing his teeth. He's now too weak to walk.

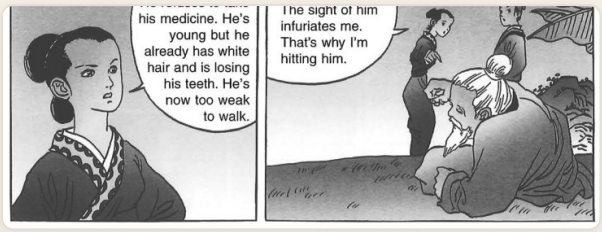
The sight of him infuriates me. That's why I'm hitting him.

FIG. 136



The title block of the page: a line drawing of a wolfberry plant with two slender upright stems bearing small oval leaves and tiny flowers, a scattering of small dried berries beside it, and the printed heading and description text to the right. Below this block the strip begins: in a wooded setting a woman in a long robe raises a stick over an old man crouching on the ground, while a man carrying a woven basket on his back asks her why she is beating the old man; in the next panel the woman grips the raised stick while a young man holds her arm back, and she protests that the old man is her great-grandson, so why should she not hit him.

FIG. 137



The lower panels of the same comic strip: at the left a close-up of the woman answering that her great-grandson refuses to take his medicine, that he is young yet already has white hair and is losing his teeth, and is now too weak to walk; at the right she stands over the old man, who kneels on the ground with his long white beard, while a young man watches, and she explains that the very sight of him infuriates her, which is why she beats him.

BOOK PAGE 64 · SCAN P073

Trang 64

Miss, how old are you?

I'm 372 years old. My great grandson is only 90.

It turned out that this lady often took a particular medicinal herb called Essence of Heaven during springtime. In summer, it was known as wolfberries. In autumn, it was called earth bone and in winter, immortal's staff. It was said that if one ate it all-year round, he or she would live as long as heaven.

Legend has it that the wolfberry could turn into a dog.

Hey! Two puppies!

How come they're gone?

Little puppies, come out.

Haha! I've dug out two wolfberries. They do look like two puppies.

Wow! I can fly now!

BOOK PAGE 65 · SCAN P074

Animal medicines

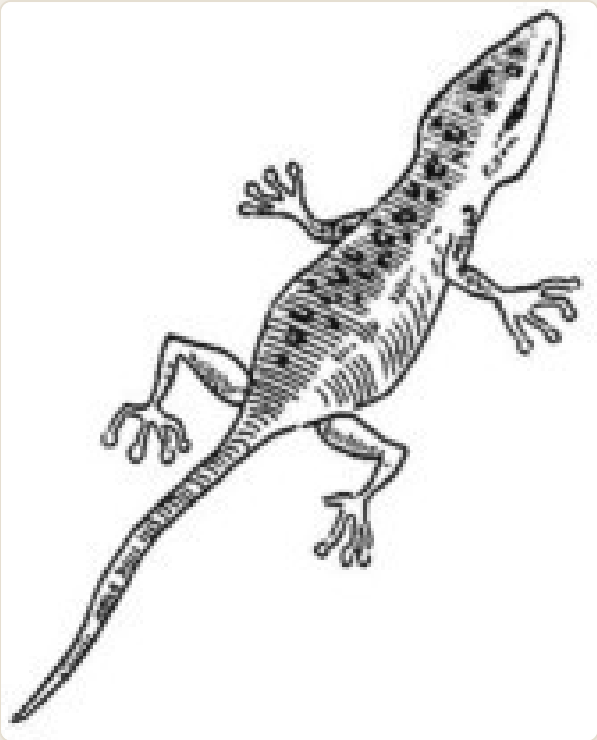
Animal medicines

Animal medicines also include creepy crawlies like house lizards, centipedes, earthworms and silkworms, and aquatic animals like seahorses and seals.

Some examples of animal medicines

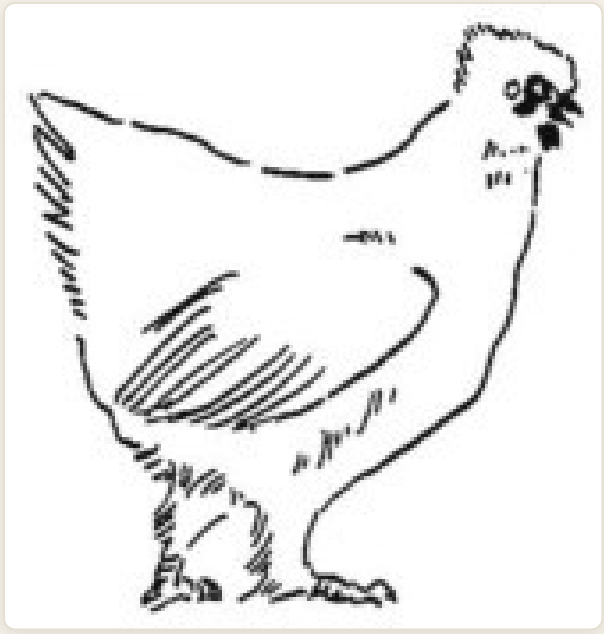
- - **House lizard:** Tastes salty, cold in nature, mildly poisonous. Expels wind, relieves pain caused by cold or dampness and soothes nerves. Used to treat paralysis due to stroke, numbness due to rheumatism, inflamed sores etc.
- - **Black-bone chicken:** Tastes sweet, neither warm nor cold in nature. Strengthens the kidneys, nourishes the qi and blood, dispels heat of deficiency type.
- - **Abalone shell:** Tastes salty, cold in nature. Detoxifies the liver and brightens the eyes, treats headaches and dizzy spells, blurred vision etc.
- - **Seahorse:** Tastes sweet, warm in nature. Strengthens the kidneys and improves virility, reduces swelling. Used to treat impotency, incontinence, deficiency of the kidneys, injuries due to a fall, difficulty in childbirth.
- - **Centipede:** Tastes pungent, warm in nature, poisonous. Expels wind and relieves febrile diseases, neutralises toxins, clears the channels and relieves pain. Used to treat infantile convulsions, twitching, stroke, tetanus, poisonous snake bites, inflamed boils.
- - **Antelope horn:** Tastes salty, cold in nature. Subdues hyperactivity of the liver to calm endogenous wind, clears the liver and brightens the eyes. Used to treat high fever, fainting spells due to febrile diseases, bipolar disorder, headaches and dizzy spells etc.

FIG. 138



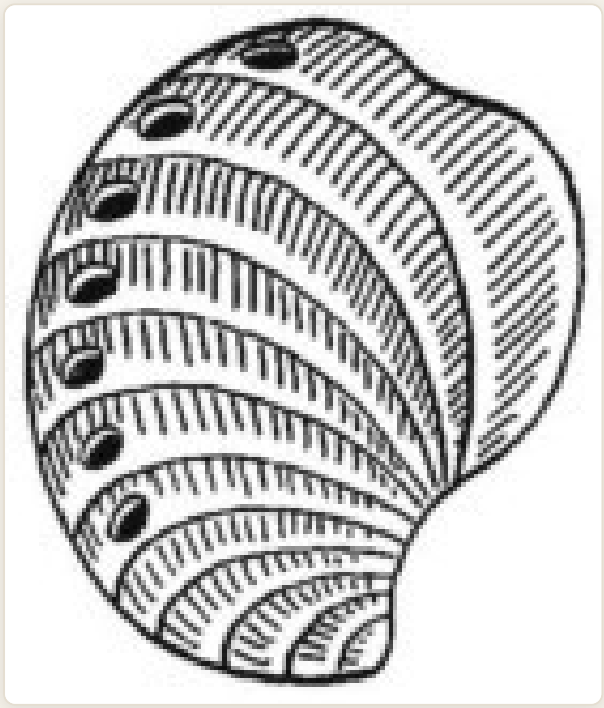
A line drawing of a house lizard seen from above, its head towards the upper right and its long tail curving down to the lower left; four splayed feet grip the surface and the back is covered with small dark speckles.

FIG. 139



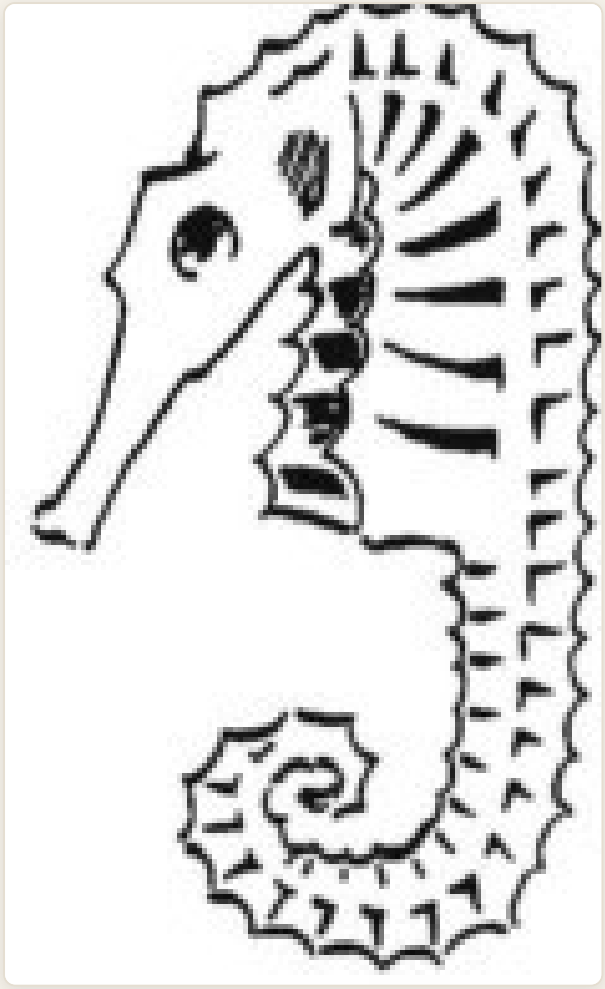
A line drawing of a black-bone chicken standing in profile facing right, with a small speckled comb, short wattles, a folded wing and a short tail.

FIG. 140



A line drawing of an ear-shaped abalone shell, with a row of small holes running along its left edge and fine radiating ridges across the surface.

FIG. 141

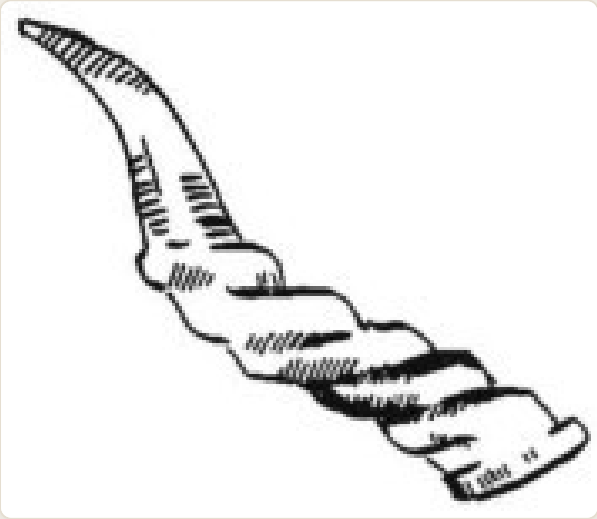


A line drawing of a seahorse in profile facing left, with a long snout, a ridged body and a tightly curled tail.

FIG. 142

A line drawing of a centipede running diagonally across the space, its body made of many bead-like segments, with a pair of antennae at the lower left and a pair of legs on each segment.

FIG. 143



A line drawing of a single antelope horn, long and tapering, curving up to a sharp point at the upper left, with ridged rings around its thicker base.

Cordyceps

- - **Leech:** Tastes salty and bitter. Neither cold nor warm in nature, poisonous. Removes blood stasis, clears congestion and clears the channels. Treats bruises, injuries due to falls.
- - **Clam shell:** Tastes bitter and salty, cold in nature. Clears heat and phlegm, relieves aches and pain. Treats cough with phlegm due to heat, pain in the chest, blood in the phlegm, abdominal pain and acid regurgitation.
- - **Silkworm:** Tastes salty and pungent. Warm in nature. Calms and dispels wind, relieves febrile diseases, clears phlegm. Treats twitching due to convulsions, headaches due to wind, sore throat, itching and rubella etc.

Animal medicines such as bear gall, pilose antler, leopard bones and rhinoceros horn have caught the attention of animal activists. In their quest to lay hands on these animal parts for medicinal use, there has been poaching and killing of these animals. Also, often the methods used to obtain these medicines can be very cruel. That is why many Chinese physicians avoid using such animal parts in their prescriptions by substituting them with other medicines with similar properties.

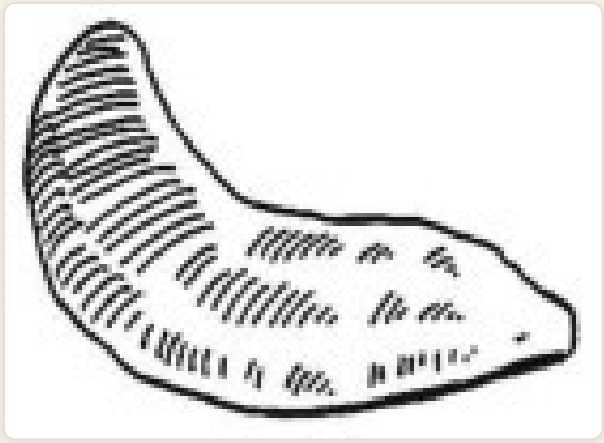
Cordyceps

Is cordyceps (a type of Chinese medicine) a worm or a plant?

It's actually a type of fungus which grows as a parasite on the caterpillar of the bat moth in winter and grows to fill the caterpillar's entire body cavity, leaving only the skin. In summer, a blade-like leaf grows out. The fungus takes five to six years to reach maturity. As it resembles a worm, it is known as *dong chong xia cao* (literally meaning winter worm, summer plant).

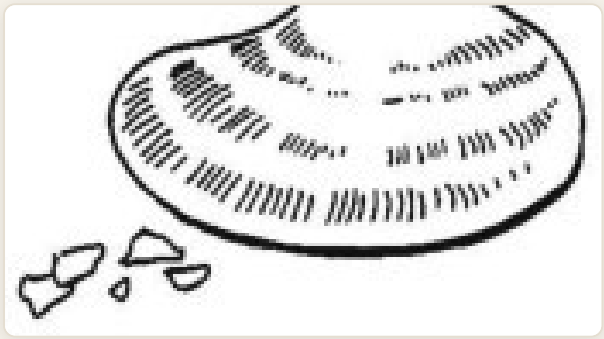
Cordyceps are mainly found in Sichuan, Qinghai, Guizhou and Yunnan. They are sweet-tasting and warm in nature. They nourish lungs and kidneys, stop bleeding, clear phlegm etc.

FIG. 144



A line drawing of a leech: a flattened, elongated body bent like a comma, its surface marked with close horizontal striations.

FIG. 145

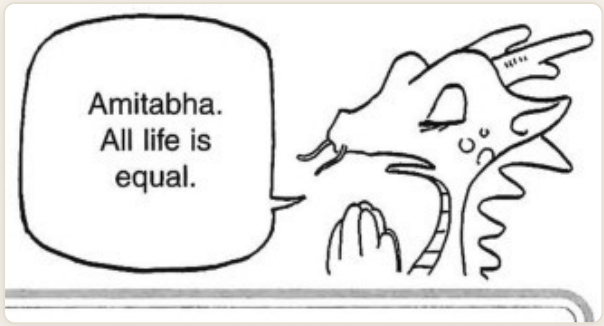


A line drawing of a clam shell seen from the side, a broad oval disc crossed by concentric growth ridges, with a few small broken shell fragments lying at its lower left.

FIG. 146

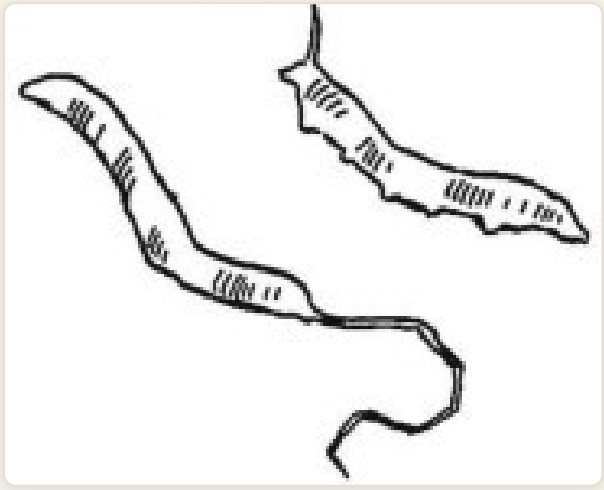
A line drawing of a silkworm in profile, a smooth segmented larva with a slightly raised head at the right end.

FIG. 147



A cartoon dragon with a gentle, downcast expression, its clawed hands held up together, beside a speech balloon that reads "Amitabha. All life is equal."

FIG. 148



A line drawing of two cordyceps specimens: a slender stalk emerging from a caterpillar's body, one specimen bent like a hook and the other curving away to the right, with fine shading along the stems.

BOOK PAGE 67 · SCAN P076

Minerals

Minerals

Minerals are materials culled from nature which possess chemical properties. During the ancient times, minerals were also used in pill-making. In fact, minerals make up quite a substantial section in Chinese medicine.

Some examples of minerals used in Chinese medicine

Gypsum: Tastes sweet and pungent. Cold in nature. Clears heat and expels fires, quenches thirst.

Realgar: Tastes pungent, warm in nature and poisonous. Neutralizes poison, kills worms, especially effective in nullifying poisonous snake and insect bites. In ancient times, wine made with realgar was drunk during the Dragon Boat Festival.

Mica: Tastes sweet. Neither warm nor cold in nature. Nourishes the kidneys and relieves asthmatic symptoms, arrests bleeding and treats infection. Used to treat consumption of the lung and deficiency of the kidneys, asthma and asthmatic cough, dizzy spells, shock, inflamed sores.

Fossil fragments: Fossils left behind by prehistoric animals. Tastes bittersweet and neither warm nor cold in nature. Calms nerves, arrests discharges. Used to treat an uneasy mind, insomnia due to anxiety, diarrhoea, seminal emission etc.

Properties and functions of Chinese medicine

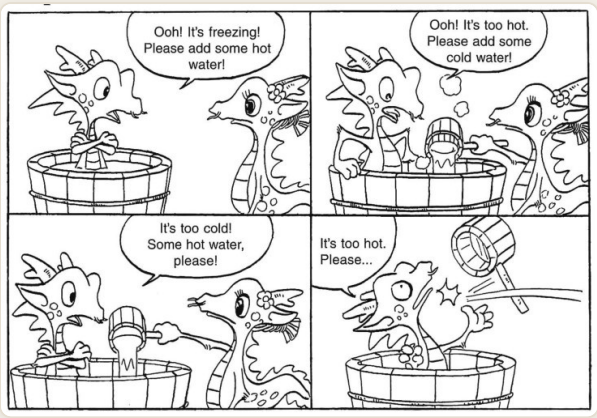
Properties and functions of Chinese medicine

The Four Properties:

- - **Cold, cooling** — Clears heat, dispels fire, detoxifies
- - **Warm, heaty** — Warms the interior, dispels cold, promotes yang

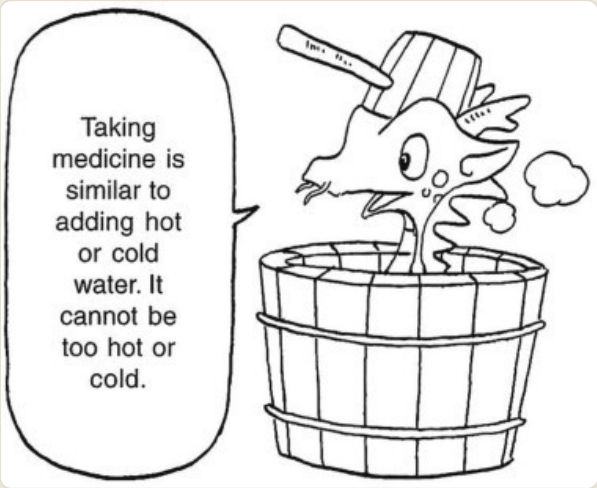
Treatment for diseases of the heat syndrome uses medicines with cold and cooling properties. Conversely, medicines with warm and heaty properties are used to treat ailments of the cold syndrome. The principle of yin-yang balance is used here. Medicines which are not very strong are known as moderate medicines. These medicines are used for treating ailments of both the heat and cold syndrome.

FIG. 149



A comic strip in four panels, two rows of two. In each panel a small dragon sits in a wooden tub of water while a second dragon stands by; in the first and third panels the bather shivers and asks for hot water, and in the second and fourth it is flushed and overheated and asks for cold water.

FIG. 150



A cartoon dragon sitting in a wooden tub, looking startled as water is tipped over its head from a wooden bucket held on a pole, with a tall speech balloon beside it explaining that taking medicine is like adding hot or cold water — it cannot be too hot or too cold.

Trang 69

The Five Flavours:

Sour	Sweet	Bitter	Pungent	Salty
Arrests discharges, acts as an astringent.	Strengthens the body, balances the yin and yang, relieves pain.	Expels heat, reduces dampness, strengthens the yin, depresses fire.	Disperses internal heat, boosts circulation of the qi and blood.	Moistens, purgative effect.

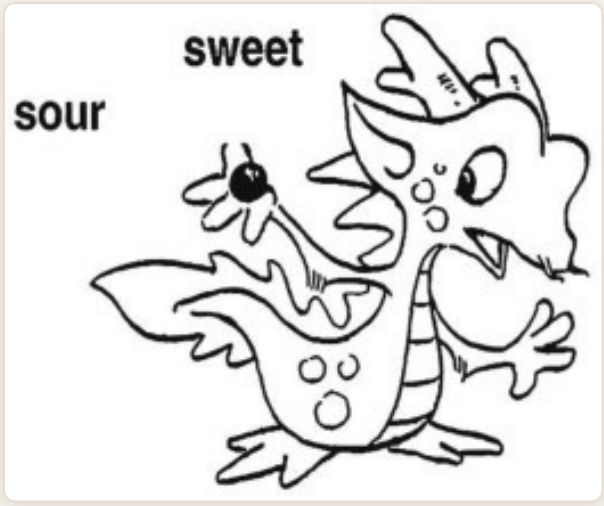
Orientation and Location:

This refers to the location and orientation of the medicine in a person's body. It may be classified into two groups:

- - **Ascending** — promotes yang, to emit exterior heat of the exterior syndrome, dispels cold, induces vomiting.
- - **Descending** — reduces internal heat, purgative, diuretic, arrests inflammation.

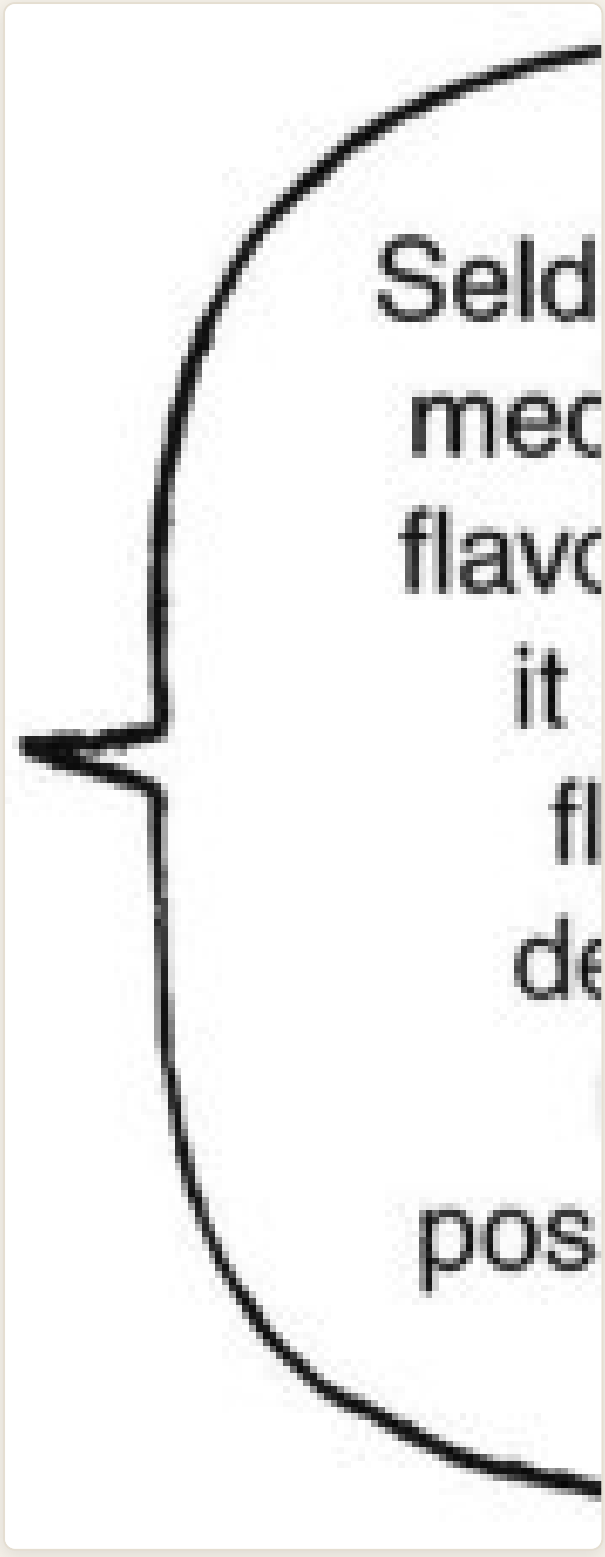
An illness may affect a person in the upper part, lower part, exterior or interior. It may be identified as ascending, descending, exterior or interior in nature. Hence, treatment of the illness has to be in accordance with the nature of the illness. For example, a patient who vomits and coughs is suffering from an ailment that affects his upper body and is exterior in nature. Therefore, the medicine prescribed will be descending in nature.

FIG. 151



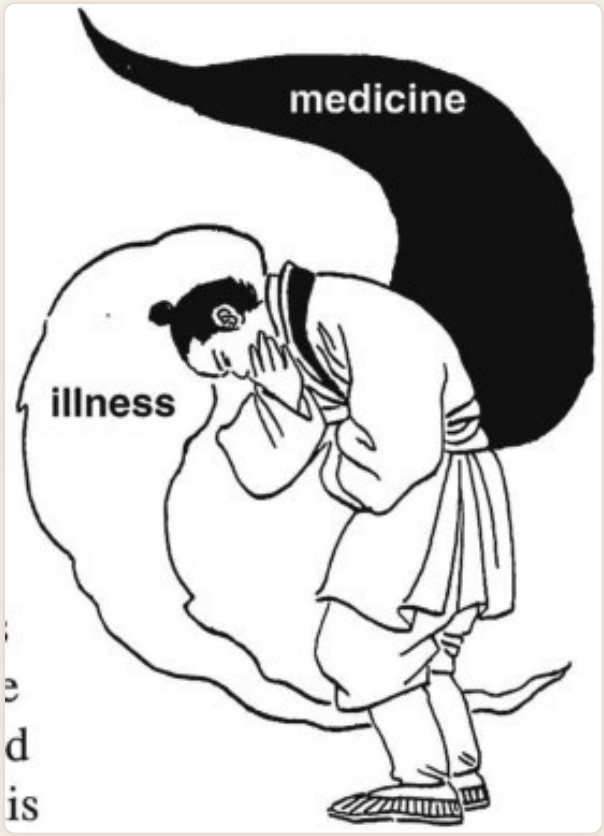
A cartoon dragon tasting something: it holds up a small dark round fruit on a stem, licks its lips and looks pleased, with the words "sweet" above it and "sour" to its left.

FIG. 152



A tall, narrow speech balloon, cropped close, carrying the explanation that a particular medicine seldom belongs to one flavour alone but usually possesses several flavours in varying degrees.

FIG. 153



A man in a traditional robe and scholar's cap, standing with his hands raised to his face and his head bowed, surrounded by a pale cloud-shaped outline labelled "illness", while a large solid black brush-stroke labelled "medicine" sweeps down over him from above.

BOOK PAGE 70 · SCAN P079

Trang 70

Classification of medicines according to the meridians:

Illnesses often occur in different meridians and organs. Different drugs have different effects on each organ and meridian. The same drug that has effect on a particular disease may not be effective on another disease.

For example, Chinese ephedra is effective on diseases of the lung meridian but not the liver meridian; cinnabar works on the heart meridian but not the spleen meridian.

Toxicity

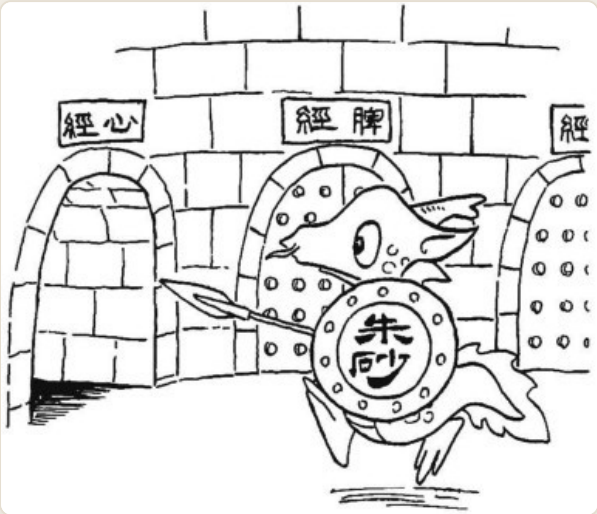
Medicines have two natures. On the one hand, they treat diseases and benefit the human body; on the other hand, they are toxic to a certain extent. If they are not used correctly, they will cause

harm to the human body.

In traditional Chinese medicine, the benefits of a medicine are enhanced while its toxicity and harm to the human body are reduced to the minimum. In medical journals for traditional Chinese medicine, every item will be labelled as toxic, non-toxic, highly toxic or mildly toxic.

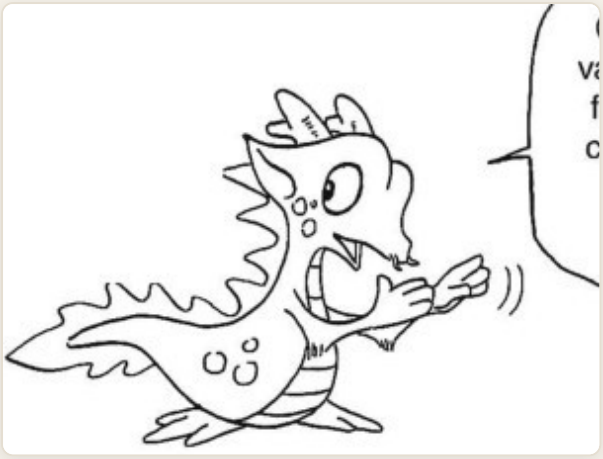
Highly toxic drugs are arsenic, croton etc; mildly toxic drugs are pharbitis seed, bitter almonds; non-toxic drugs are poria and liquorice.

FIG. 154



A cartoon creature with a spear in one hand and a round shield in the other, the shield bearing the characters for cinnabar, charging towards a stone wall pierced by three arched doorways; above the doorways hang plaques reading "heart meridian", "spleen meridian" and "meridian".

FIG. 155



A cartoon dragon gesturing with one claw raised and its mouth open, beside a speech balloon warning that Chinese drugs have various properties and functions and that it is best to check with a Chinese physician before taking them.

BOOK PAGE 71 · SCAN P080

Making up a prescription

Making up a prescription

The combination of ingredients is known as a prescription. It combines the different properties of the various ingredients to enhance the effectiveness of the prescription. Alternatively, it also serves to moderate certain the side-effects of certain components used in the prescription and promote the effectiveness of the prescription.

Taboos in preparing a prescription:

Some medicines cannot be mixed together as they may become toxic or decrease the effectiveness of the prescription. In traditional Chinese medicine, the taboos in preparing a prescription are known as the 18 Incompatible Medicaments and 19 Medicaments of Mutual Inhibition.

The 18 Incompatible Medicaments:

- - Aconite root (*wutou*) is incompatible with fritillary bulb, snakegourd fruit, pinellia tuber, *baijian*, bletilla tuber;
- - liquorice is incompatible with *gansui*, *dajian*, seaweed, genkwa flower;
- - *lihui* is incompatible with ginseng, *shashen*, *danshen*, *xuanshen*, *xixin*, peony root.

The 19 Medicaments of Mutual Inhibition:

- - Sulphur is inhibited by Chinese hackberry; silver is inhibited by arsenic;
- - *langdu* root inhibits yellow lead; croton is inhibited by pharbitis seed; clove is inhibited by aromatic turmeric;
- - nitre is inhibited by *jingsanling*; *chuanwu* and monkshood are inhibited by rhinoceros horn; ginseng is inhibited by *wulingzhi*; cinnamon is restrained by *shizhi*.

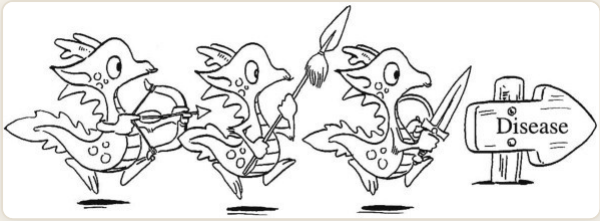
FIG. 156

A line drawing of a bundle of dried medicinal herbs lying on a sheet of paper: flat strips of bark, a handful of dried leaves and stems, round fruits and striped seeds piled together.

FIG. 157

A small cropped fragment showing the dark, wedge-shaped tip of the arrow-shaped signboard and the ground lines beneath it.

FIG. 158



Three cartoon dragons charging forward in a row, one drawing a bow, one carrying a banner on a long pole and one with a sword and shield, bearing down on an arrow-shaped signboard planted in the ground that reads "Disease".

BOOK PAGE 72 · SCAN P081

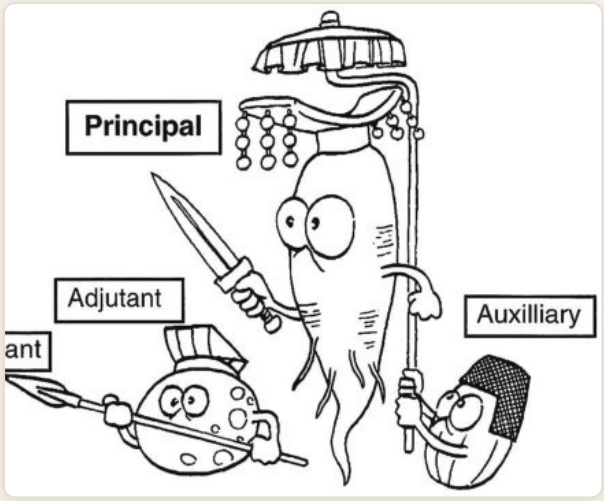
The principles behind a prescription

The principles behind a prescription

A prescription is made up with various principles in mind:

- - **Principal component:** It has the principal curative action.
- - **Adjutant component:** It strengthens the principal action.
- - **Auxiliary component:** It tempers the action of the principal ingredients, thereby reducing and preventing the occurrence of side effects.
- - **Conductant:** It directs action of the various components to the affected meridian or site.

FIG. 159



Four cartoon medicinal ingredients drawn as little warriors lined up for battle: in the centre a tall spring onion brandishing a dagger and holding a long staff, labelled "Principal"; to its left a round striped bulb holding a spear, labelled "Adjutant"; at the far left a small mushroom-like figure with a spear, labelled "Conductant"; and at the right a small bulb wearing a dark patterned cap and holding a staff, labelled "Auxiliary".

FIG. 160

A cartoon dragon holding an open folding fan in one claw and pointing with the other, with a speech balloon beside it warning that if the preparation of a prescription fails to follow the above principles, the recipe will be rendered ineffectual.

The Eight Principal Therapeutic Methods

The Eight Principal Therapeutic Methods

Perspiration

By inducing perspiration in a patient, the pathogenic factors are expelled from the body. This method is often used in the treatment of diseases caused by external pathogenic factors like colds and fevers.

Emesis

Vomiting is induced in a patient. This method is used in the treatment of overeating, indigestion, food poisoning or congestion of phlegm.

Diarrhoea

Laxatives are used to clear stagnation in the intestines and to relieve constipation or dysentery.

Soothing

Where inducement of perspiration and diarrhoea are not advisable, this method will be used in the treatment of diseases due to partial interior and exterior factors. Examples are a poor appetite, headaches and dizzy spells, thirst and bitterness in the mouth etc.

Trang 74

Warming therapy

It removes cold and restores yang in the body. It's primarily used to treat yin and cold syndromes. There are two types: restoring lost yang and cold-dispelling therapy.

Heat reduction

Drugs with cold and cooling properties are used to reduce heat. This method treats ailments of the heat syndrome, like fevers, fidgetiness, fainting spells etc.

Relieve

Treats food stagnation, clears phlegm, reduces swelling etc.

Tonics

Boosts the yin, yang, qi and blood; strengthens the constitution. There are four ways of doing it: nourish the qi, nourish the blood, nourish the yin and nourish the yang.

BOOK PAGE 75 · SCAN P084

Methods of delivery in traditional Chinese medicine

Methods of delivery in traditional Chinese medicine

Traditional Chinese medicine takes many forms. There are medicinal soups, pills, ointment and medicated wines.

Medicinal soup

This is the most common method for treating acute illnesses. The medicine is boiled as a soup, and the dregs drained away. It is absorbed into the body faster and results show faster.

Pills

The medicine is ground into a powder and water or honey is added so that it can be rolled into balls. This method will take a longer time to show efficacy and is used over a longer period of time. It is ideal for chronic illness and prolonged weakness.

Powder

The medicine is ground into powder. It is taken with water for faster absorption or used in external applications. It is also applied in the throat and eyes. Ideal for acute illnesses.

Ointment

The medicine is decocted until it thickens into a jelly, which may either be consumed orally or applied externally. It is ideal for chronic illnesses or to replenish the body. External application is often done by pasting oiled paper or a plaster over the ointment to treat boils, corns or rheumatism.

Medicated wine

The medicine is soaked in wine and the dregs are removed. It is quickly absorbed into the body and takes effect fast. Often used to treat rheumatic pains and injuries from falls or blows.

BOOK PAGE 76 · SCAN P085

How to decoct medicine

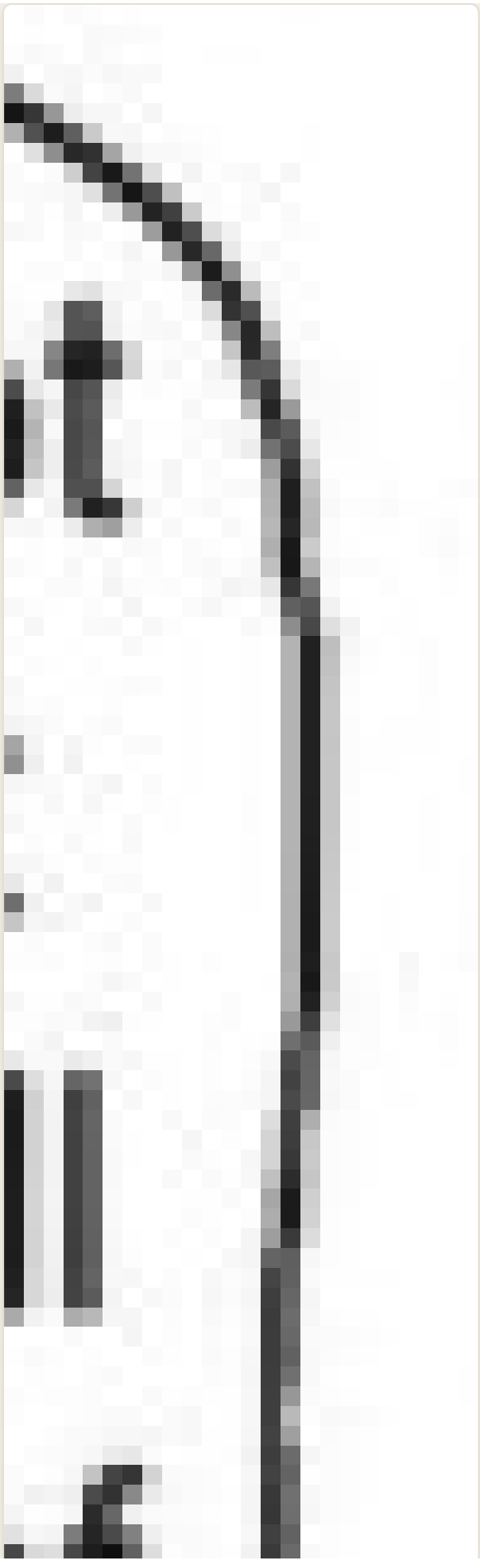
How to decoct medicine

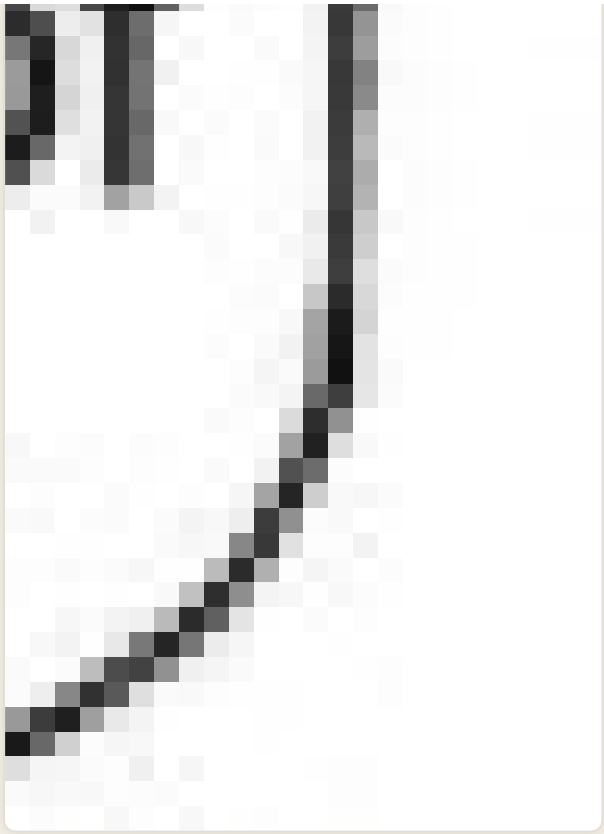
Decocting medicine is not as easy as it seems. If it is not done properly, it will affect the effectiveness of the recipe.

FIG. 161

A line drawing of a round-bellied ceramic decocting pot seen from the side: a lipped mouth at the top, a short spout projecting to the left, and a small ring-shaped handle on the right shoulder; the printed label "Pot" stands beside it.

FIG. 162





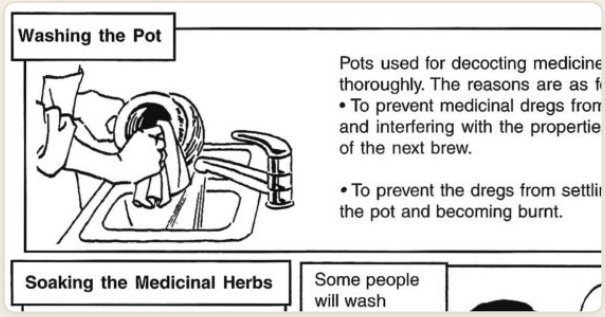
A narrow vertical fragment cut from the page: the rounded left-hand border of a speech balloon, with the trimmed ends of a few words still visible inside it.

FIG. 163

A cartoon dragon standing on one foot, pointing upward with one claw and balancing a shallow bowl of dark medicine in the other, the tail of a speech balloon just visible above its head.

The best crockery to use are those made of ceramics as they will not have any chemical reaction with the drugs. As they conduct heat slowly, the medicine will not get burnt and stick to the bottom of the pot. Stainless steel and glass pots will also do. But you must avoid using bronze, aluminium and iron pots. These metal pots will have chemical reactions with the drugs and affect their effectiveness. They may even cause side-effects!

FIG. 164

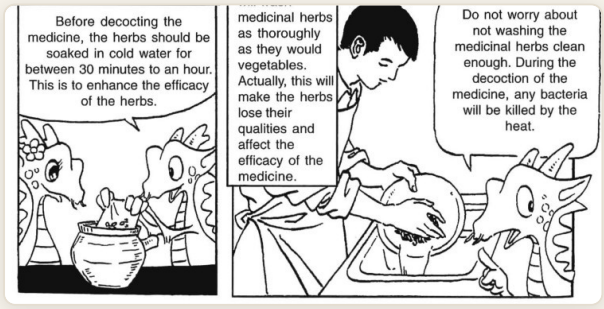


A line-drawn panel titled "Washing the Pot": a woman stands at a sink holding a pot under a running tap, scrubbing its inside with a cloth; a plate and a dish drainer sit on the draining board beside her.

Pots used for decocting medicine should be washed thoroughly. The reasons are as follows:

- - To prevent medicinal dregs from staying in the pot and interfering with the properties and effectiveness of the next brew.
- - To prevent the dregs from settling at the bottom of the pot and becoming burnt.

FIG. 165



A line-drawn panel titled "Soaking the Medicinal Herbs": on the left two cartoon dragons watch a lidded pot in which herbs are soaking; on the right a man stands at a basin, washing a handful of herbs under running water while a third dragon looks on.

Before decocting the medicine, the herbs should be soaked in cold water for between 30 minutes to an hour. This is to enhance the efficacy of the herbs.

Some people will wash medicinal herbs as thoroughly as they would vegetables. Actually, this will make the herbs lose their qualities and affect the efficacy of the medicine.

Do not worry about not washing the medicinal herbs clean enough. During the decoction of the medicine, any bacteria will be killed by the heat.

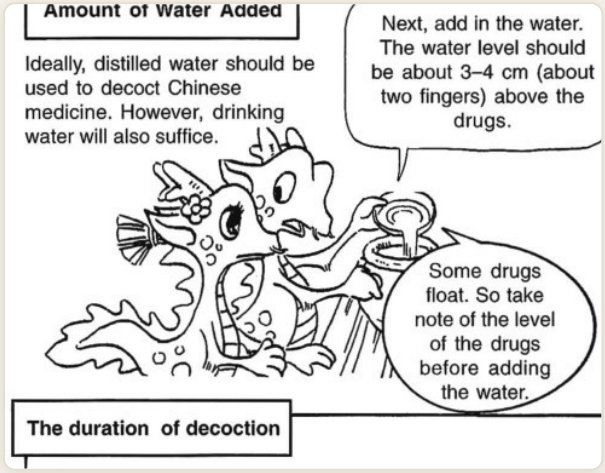
BOOK PAGE 77 · SCAN P086

Trang 77

Amount of Water Added

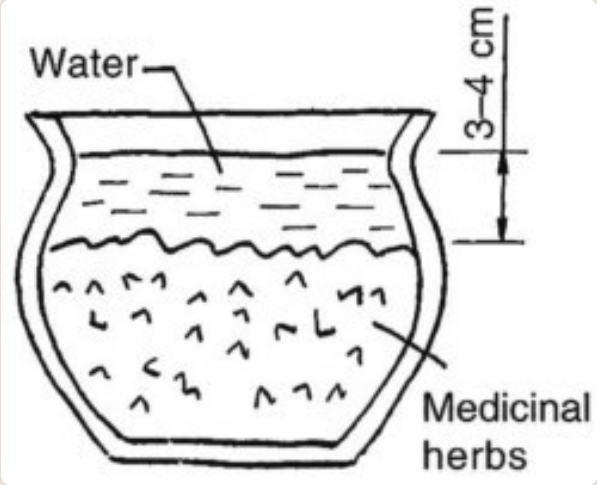
Ideally, distilled water should be used to decoct Chinese medicine. However, drinking water will also suffice.

FIG. 166



A comic panel headed "Amount of Water Added": two cartoon dragons sit beside a decocting pot, one of them pouring water into it from a small vessel; two speech balloons rise from them, one telling the reader to add water, the other warning that some drugs float.

FIG. 167



A cut-away diagram of a pot: a wavy line marks the surface of the water, labelled "Water"; the herb layer lies below it, labelled "Medicinal herbs"; and a bracket at the right shows that the water stands 3–4 cm above the drugs.

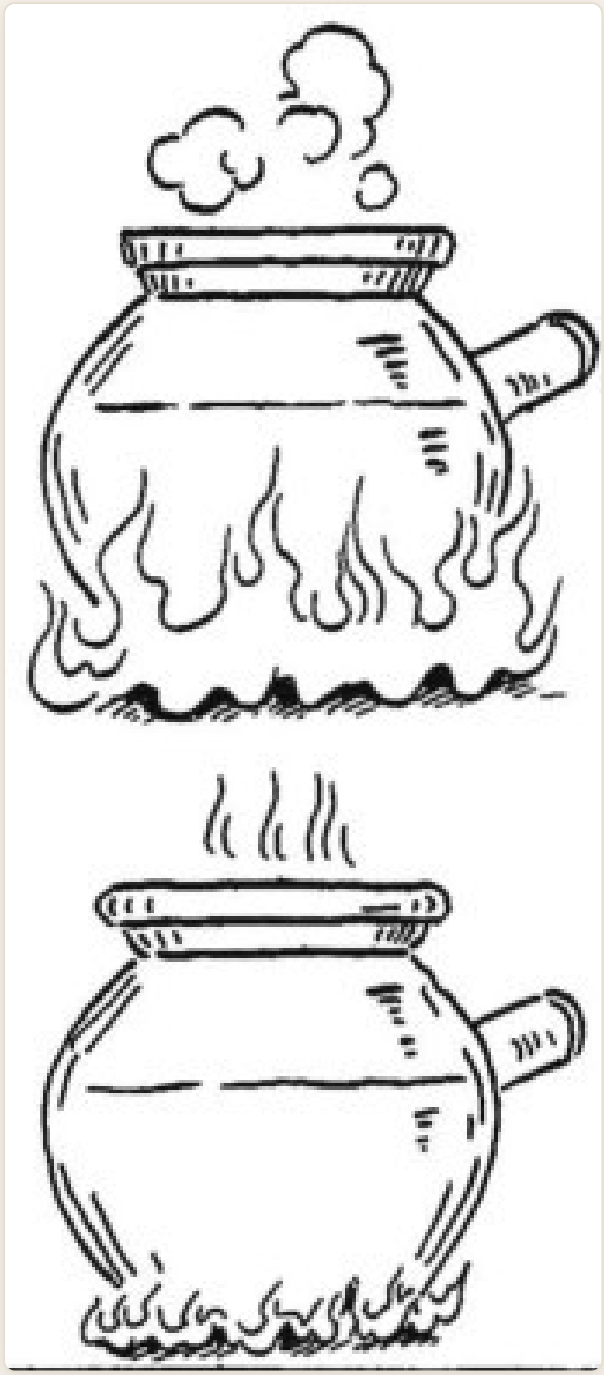
Next, add in the water. The water level should be about 3–4 cm (about two fingers) above the drugs. Some drugs float, so take note of the level of the drugs before adding the water.

The duration of decoction

Usually, decoction of medicine uses a strong fire to put the water to boil before lowering it to a slow fire. Tonics must be prepared over a slow fire.

Most Chinese medicines should be decocted at least twice. Only then can the active components be fully drawn out from the herbs.

FIG. 168

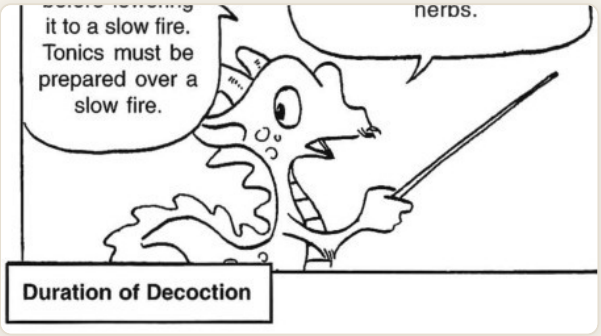


Two line drawings of a lidded decocting pot stacked one above the other: the upper pot sits in tall leaping flames and gives off clouds of steam, while the lower pot sits in a low flickering flame with only thin wisps of steam.

FIG. 169

A small cut fragment: the rounded top border of a speech balloon with the beginnings of a line of text beneath it.

FIG. 170



A cartoon dragon holding a long pointer and gesturing towards the pot drawings, with a speech balloon beside it and a small boxed label reading "Duration of Decoction" beneath.

FIG. 171

A cartoon dragon with an open mouth and both claws raised, as though talking.

The amount of time spent to decoct the medicine depends on the type of medicine used and its medicinal purpose.

	First decoction	Second decoction
Medicine for general ailments	Bring to boil and cook for 30 minutes	Bring to boil and cook for 20 minutes
Medicine to dispel exterior heat syndrome	Bring to boil and cook for 8–10 minutes	Bring to boil and cook for 5 minutes
Nourishing medicine	Bring to boil and cook for 60 minutes	Bring to boil and cook for 30 minutes

BOOK PAGE 78 · SCAN P087

Tips in Decocting Medicine

Tips in Decocting Medicine

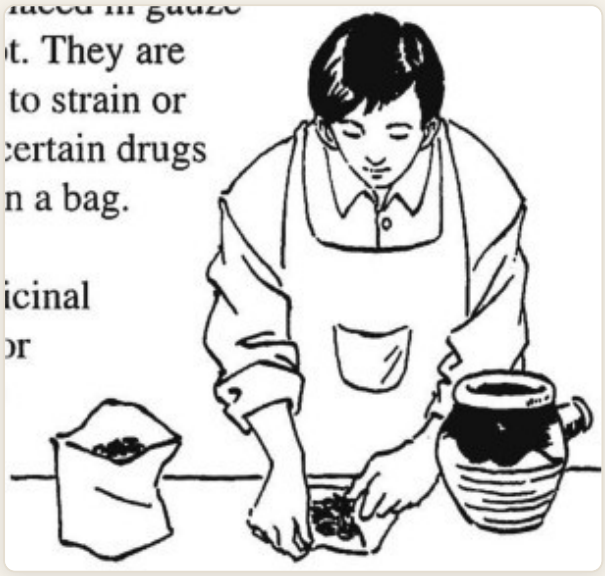
Advance decoction: Some herbs have to be decocted first before the rest are added. Advance decoction serves two functions:

- - To help certain drugs dissolve faster. Advance decoction usually involves minerals, shells and animal horns as they take a longer time to dissolve.
- - To reduce the toxicity. Some toxic drugs like *chuanwu*, *shengfuzi* and *shanglu* have to be decocted for at least two hours before their toxicity is dispelled.

To be added last: Some medicinal drugs like peppermint, *danggui* and *dahuang* easily lose their efficacy when they are boiled at high heat. So they are only added 5 to 10 minutes after the other medicinal drugs have been put in to heat.

Wrapped in bags: Some drugs have to be placed in gauze or tea bags before they are added to the pot. They are usually drugs which have fur, are not easy to strain or may cause discomfort to the throat. Also, certain drugs may stick to the pot if they are not placed in a bag.

FIG. 172



A line drawing of a woman in an apron standing at a table: she folds a handful of dark herbs into a paper or cloth packet with both hands; a finished packet of herbs rests at her left and a dark lidded ceramic pot sits at her right.

Separate decoction: Certain expensive medicinal drugs like the ginseng, American ginseng or antelope's horn are decocted separately to maintain their efficacy and prevent the other herbs from absorbing their medicinal properties.

Six ways to prevent the bottom of the pot from getting burnt:

1. Choose crockery that conducts heat evenly.

2. Clean the bottom of the pot thoroughly before decocting the medicine.

3. Place medicines that are sticky or fibrous in a bag before adding them to the pot.

4. Decoct the medicine over a low fire with the pot covered.

5. Make sure sufficient water is added.

6. Stir the mixture at regular intervals during decoction.

FIG. 173

A cartoon dragon with a startled expression, mouth open and claws raised, beside a speech balloon asking how to avoid the medicine thickening and burning at the bottom of the pot.

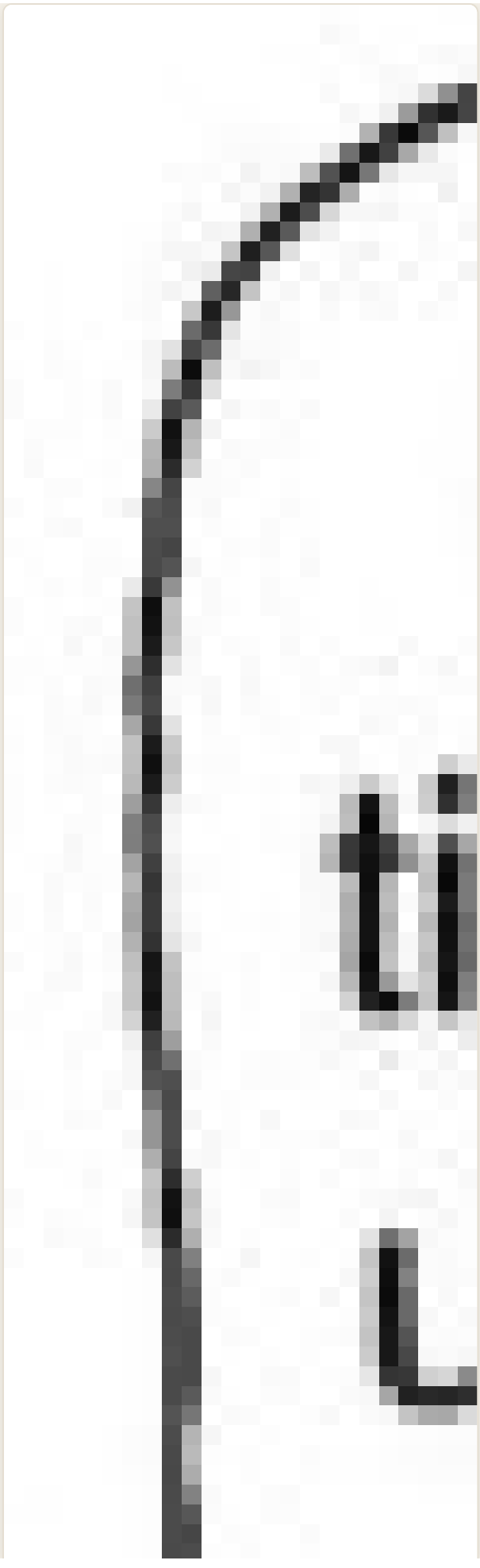
BOOK PAGE 79 · SCAN P088

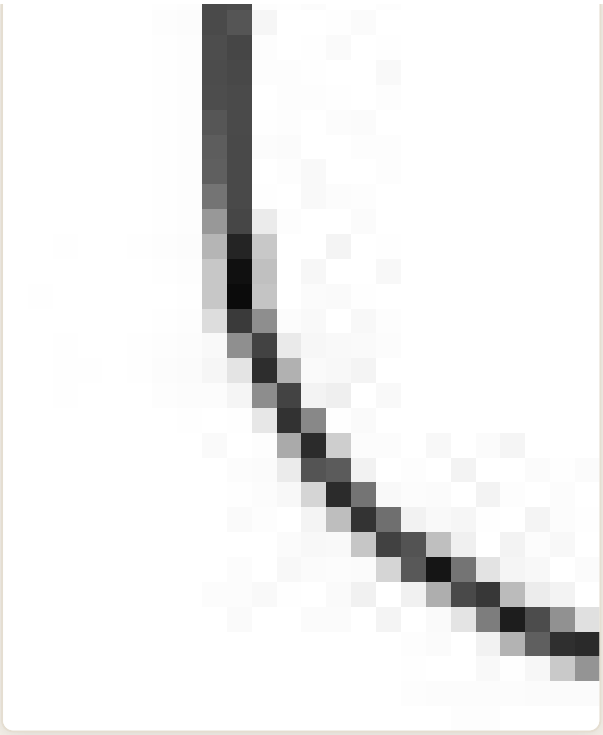
Trang 79

Oh no! I forgot to keep time. The water has dried up. What shall I do? Let's add more water!

You can't do that! The effectiveness of the medicine has been destroyed. This pot of medicine cannot be consumed. We have to decoct another pot of medicine.

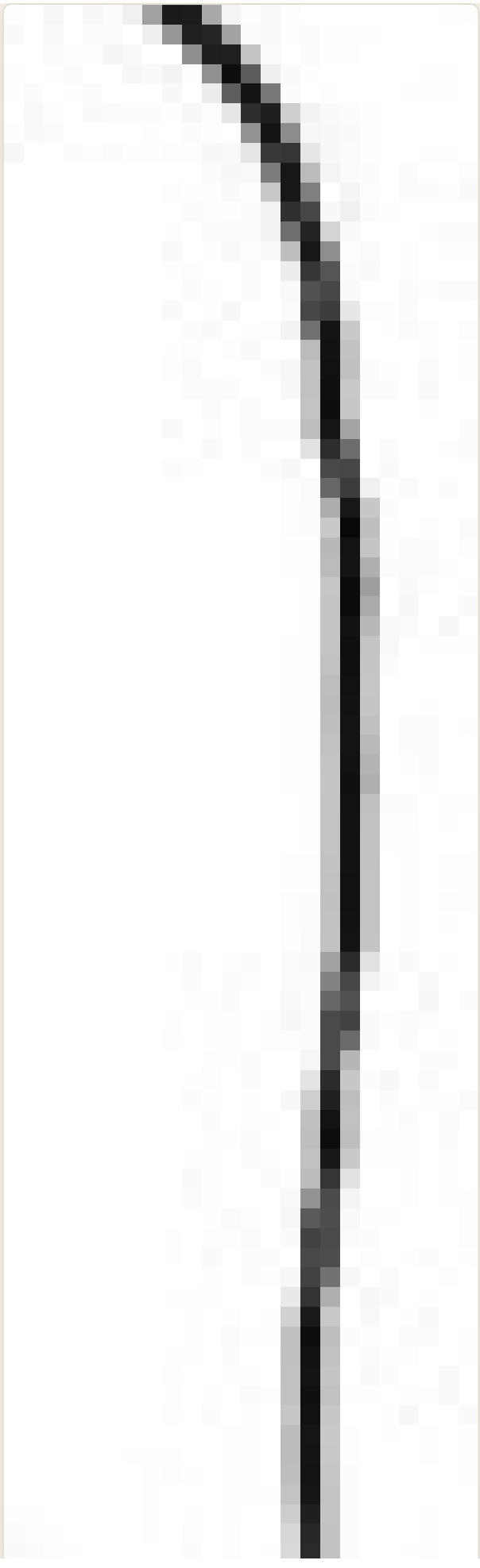
FIG. 174

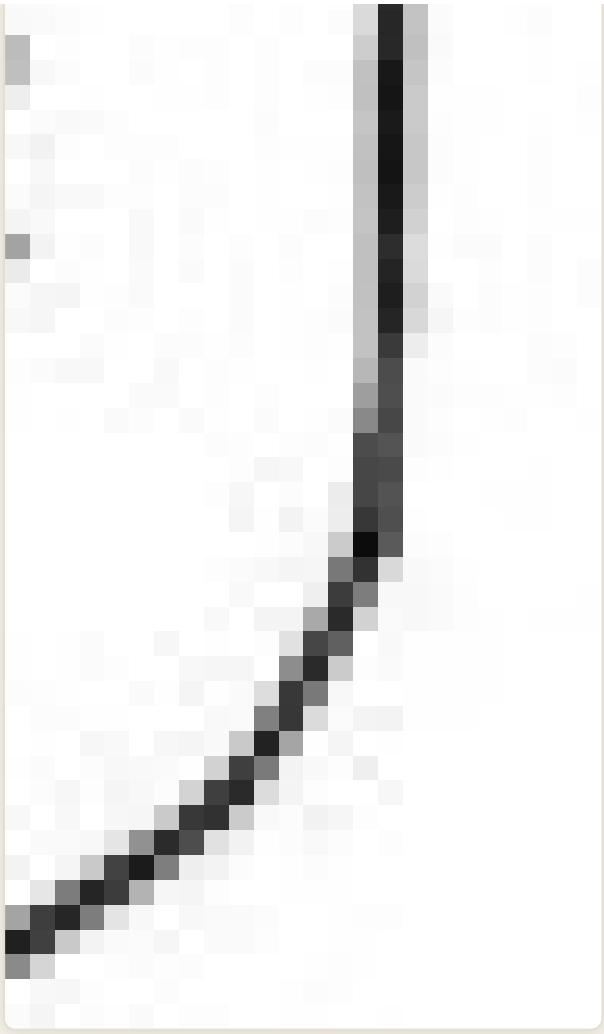




A narrow vertical fragment cut from the page: the rounded edge of a speech balloon.

FIG. 175



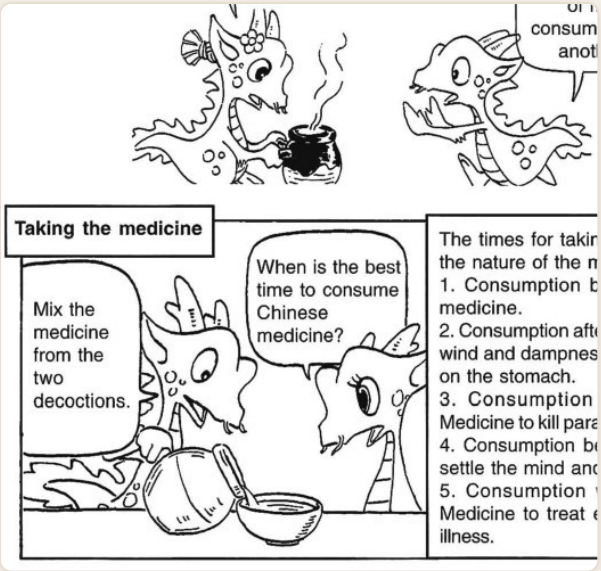


A narrow vertical fragment cut from the page: another curved piece of a speech balloon's border.

Taking the medicine

Mix the medicine from the two decoctions. When is the best time to consume Chinese medicine?

FIG. 176



A comic panel headed "Taking the medicine": two cartoon dragons sit beside a decocting pot and a bowl, one pouring the medicine from the pot into the bowl; speech balloons ask when the best time to take the medicine is, and a boxed list beside them sets out the five times for taking medicine.

The times for taking the medicine depend on the nature of the medicine:

1. **Consumption before a meal:** Nourishing medicine.

2. **Consumption after a meal:** Medicine to dispel wind and dampness or medicine that is strong on the stomach.

3. **Consumption on an empty stomach:** Medicine to kill parasites and treat constipation.

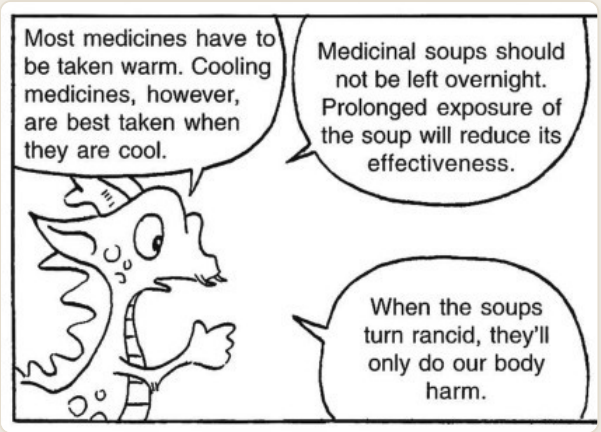
4. **Consumption before bedtime:** Medicine to settle the mind and the heart.

5. **Consumption without restricted timing:** Medicine to treat exterior syndrome or acute illness.

Dosage

- - **Staggered consumption:** Take one dosage once or twice a day. It is suitable for general illnesses. Chronic illnesses may require one dosage once every two days.
- - **One-time consumption:** Finish one dosage at one consumption. It is suitable for acute illnesses. Sufferers of serious illnesses may take two to three dosages a day.
- - **Frequent consumption:** The medicine is taken in small doses but more frequently. There is no fixed time to take it. It is usually the case for throat and oral cavity ailments.

FIG. 177



A comic panel with a cartoon dragon and three speech balloons: one says that most medicines are taken warm while cooling medicines are best taken cool; another warns that medicinal soups should not be left overnight, as prolonged exposure reduces their effectiveness; a third adds that rancid soups only harm the body.

FIG. 178

A cartoon dragon with a small flower on its head and a smiling face, beside a speech balloon remarking that there is a lot to remember about taking a bowl of medicinal soup.

Most medicines have to be taken warm. Cooling medicines, however, are best taken when they are cool.

Medicinal soups should not be left overnight. Prolonged exposure of the soup will reduce its effectiveness. When the soups turn rancid, they'll only do our body harm.

Wow! There's so much to remember about taking a bowl of medicinal soup!

BOOK PAGE 80 · SCAN P089

Things to note when taking Chinese medicine

Things to note when taking Chinese medicine

Foods to avoid

One should avoid taking cold and raw foods, oily foods and foods that are hard to digest when on Chinese medication. That will help reduce the burden on the digestive system and allow the medicine to be absorbed better.

At the same time, avoid garlic, onions and chilli.

Certain Chinese medicines should not be taken with Chinese tea. If you must have Chinese tea, drink it two to three hours after taking the medicine. However, there are certain Chinese medicines which have to be taken with Chinese tea. An example is the *chuanxiong* rhizome.

FIG. 179

A wide strip showing a cartoon dragon's head and shoulders peering in from the left, beside the rounded top edge of a bordered text box that runs across the rest of the strip.

The course of Chinese medicine

Chinese medicine takes a longer time to show efficacy. It is not immediate. Chinese medicine is unlike western medicine which has a course to follow. In general, the course of Chinese medicine depends on how serious the disease is, the patient's response to the medication and many other factors. The course may be as short as a few days to as long as several years.

Medicines to be avoided during pregnancy

Certain Chinese medicines are harmful to foetuses and may induce miscarriage. They should never be taken during pregnancy. Generally, these drugs may be classified as taboo drugs and drugs to be taken in moderation.

Taboo drugs: Toxic and potent drugs such as croton, pharbitis seed, *dajian*, mylabris, pokeberry root, *sanling*, leech, mercury, arsenic and *gansui* should never be ingested.

Medicines to be taken in moderation: Medicines that clear the meridians, bruises and stagnation of qi, and pungent medicines may be ingested in moderation, depending on the expectant mother's condition. They include peach kernel, safflower, *zhishi*, *dahuang*, dried ginger, cinnamon, *changshan* and Jack-in-the-pulpit tuber.

BOOK PAGE 81 · SCAN P090

The Legend of Picking Medicines

The Legend of Picking Medicines

We often see rows of little drawers behind the counter at a Chinese medical shop where the shop assistant will get the medicines from.

It is believed that this tradition of picking medicines was a legacy left behind by Sun Simiao, the King of Medicine who lived during the Tang Dynasty.

Sun Simiao often peddled his medical skill. Due to the many types of medicines he had to carry with him, he had an apron with many pockets sewn to store the drugs.

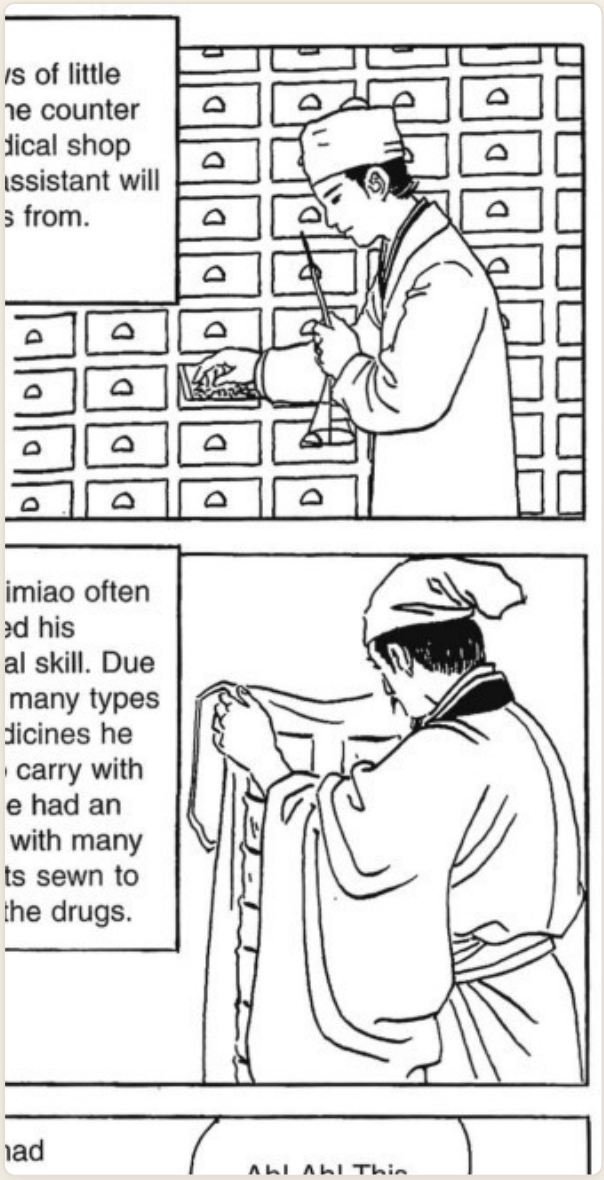
One day, Sun Simiao arrived at a small village.

"I've picked so many herbs today."

He saw a lady who had been bitten by a dog.

"Ah! Ah! This hurts terribly!"

FIG. 180



The right-hand column of the comic, two panels one above the other. In the upper panel a shop assistant in a soft cap stands before a wall of small square medicine drawers, each with a label and a round pull, reaching out to take the medicines. In the lower panel Sun Simiao, seen from behind in a cloth cap and a flowing robe, holds up a long apron sewn with many pockets.

FIG. 181

The left-hand column of the comic. The upper panel carries the story title The Legend of Picking Medicines above a portrait of Sun Simiao, a bearded man in a scholar's cap. In the lower panel he stands in profile with a hoe resting on his shoulder, a text box at his side.

FIG. 182

The bottom row of the comic, two panels side by side. In the left panel Sun Simiao, in profile and wearing a cap, holds up a sprig of herbs he has just picked, a speech bubble at his side. In the right panel he stands in the open beside a woman seated on the ground clutching her injured leg, a dog standing nearby, with a house and low hills behind; a speech bubble rises from the woman.

BOOK PAGE 82 · SCAN P091

Trang 82

"Let me apply some medicine on you."

The King of Medicine reached for his medicines without delay.

"How are you feeling?"

"The bleeding has stopped. It's also less painful now."

As the amount of each medicine used in a prescription was little, people began to call this way of taking the medicines 'picking medicine'.

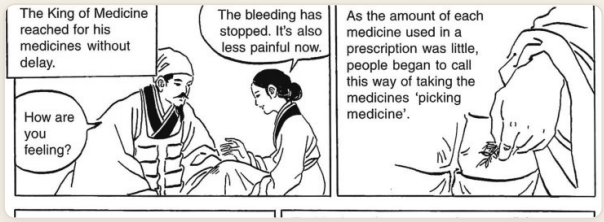
Later, in order not to confuse the wide variety of drugs, shopkeepers of medical shops followed the King of Medicine's method of storing the medicines in little compartments. These compartments are further divided into three or four smaller compartments to store different medicines.

To this day, whenever one buys medicines from a medical shop, it is also known as picking medicine.

FIG. 183

The top row of the comic, two panels side by side. In the left panel the King of Medicine kneels on the ground beside a seated woman and applies medicine to her leg, a standing lamp between them, a speech bubble at the lower right. In the right panel he is seen close up — a bearded old man in a soft cap — bending over the woman's leg as she sits opposite him.

FIG. 184

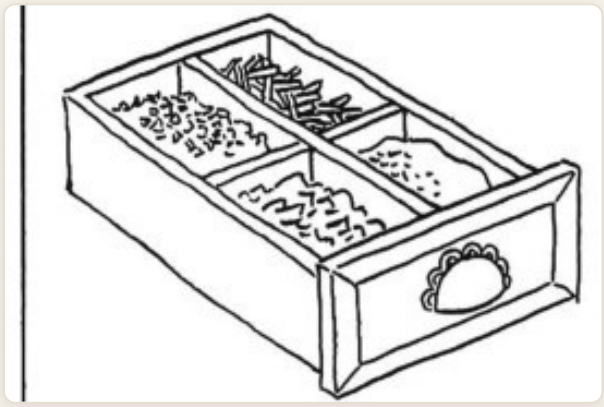


The middle row of the comic. In the left panel the King of Medicine tends the woman's leg while two speech bubbles hang above them and a small text box stands at the upper left. In the right panel a hand reaches into a cloth bag and pinches out a small handful of herbs, with a text box to its left.

FIG. 185

The lower-right panel: a customer in a jacket, seen from behind, stands at a counter buying medicine from a shop assistant, who holds a small jar-like packet in front of a wall of little medicine drawers.

FIG. 186



The lower-left inset: an open wooden drawer seen at an angle, its interior divided into three or four small compartments, each holding a different kind of herb, with a brass ring pull on the front face.

The Secret Prescription

The Secret Prescription

"Lad, how come I don't seem to understand what the physician has written?"

"His prescriptions are secret. So he had them written in a riddle form. Only we will understand what he's written."

"Where is the physician?"

"He's inside. Please go in."

"He does not seem to be a local."

"Your illness is not serious. Follow this prescription I've given you."

"Thanks! I'll fill this when I return to my hometown."

"Take care."

"Oh no!"

"I forgot to tell him that the prescription is different from the usual ones!"

FIG. 187

The whole page is one comic strip. The top-left panel carries the story title The Secret Prescription above the portrait of an old physician with a dark cap and a long white beard, holding a brush over a book. In the top-right panel two men stand before a wall of medicine drawers, one of them puzzling over the written prescription. The middle row shows the young man explaining that the prescriptions are written as riddles, a visitor asking at a doorway where the physician is and being told that he is inside, and a bystander remarking that the physician does not seem to be a local. The bottom row shows the physician telling a patient that his illness is not serious and handing him a prescription, the patient thanking him and promising to fill it back in his hometown, the patient walking away through a doorway, and finally the physician clapping a hand to his head in dismay as he realises he forgot to warn the patient that this prescription is different from the usual ones.

BOOK PAGE 84 · SCAN P093

Trang 84

"What herb is this?"

"I don't have it in my shop."

"I've been to several shops and they all tell me the same thing."

"Let me take a look at the prescription."

"Haha! I know this riddle! Let me write you another prescription."

"I see! These are the medicines you need. Lad, take a look."

"We have all these medicines."

"Writing the prescription as a riddle is quite an interesting idea!"

- * Nine deaths and one life - duhuo (pubescent angelica root), Stepping on flowers are the butterflies - xiangfu, twenty-one - sanqi (notoginseng), Thousand-year attack - tangerine peel, shepherd boy - qianniuzi (pharbitis seed)

FIG. 188

The whole page is one comic strip. The top row shows a shop assistant behind the counter, looking puzzled as he says that he does not have this herb in his shop, while in the next panel a customer and his companion stand before another shopkeeper, who asks to see the prescription. The middle row shows a hand holding up the written prescription, on which the herb names are set out in vertical Chinese characters with their weights in qian, and a man exclaiming that he knows the riddle and will write out another prescription. The bottom row shows the shop assistant laying out the medicines and telling the customer to take a look, a hand writing the new riddle prescription with the herb names and their weights, and the customer remarking that writing a prescription as a riddle is an interesting idea.

BOOK PAGE 85 · SCAN P094

Table of commonly used Chinese medicines

Table of commonly used Chinese medicines

For treatment of exterior syndrome (headaches, colds, etc):

Ephedra, saposhnikova root, fresh ginger, schizonepeta, *lanxiang* root, dahurian angelica root, peppermint, mulberry leaf, chrysanthemum, kudzuvine root, bugbane root.

Purgatives:

Rhubarb, honey, pharbitis seed, genkwa flower.

For expelling pathological heat:

Talc, abalone shell, aloe, selfheal spike.

For eliminating pathological heat from blood:

Bezoar, peony bark, gromwell root, *baimao* root, starwort root.

For eliminating heat-toxin:

honeysuckle flower, forsythia root, dandelion herb, oldenlandia.

For expelling heat:

Green bean, hyacinth seed, eupatorium.

For relieving rheumatic conditions:

Pubescent angelica root, acanthopanax bark, flowering-quince fruit, cocklebur fruit, *suanpanzi*.

For warming the interior:

Typhonium tuber, dried ginger, Chinese cinnamon, clove, fennel fruit.

For expelling dampness:

Poria, plaintain seed, wax-gourd peel, ricepaper-plant pith, loosestrife.

For expelling phlegm:

Jack-in-the-pulpit tuber, monkshood daughter root, milkwort root, fritillary bulb, seaweed, sea tangle.

Antitussives, expectorants and antiasthmatics:

Apricot kernel, balloonflower, gingko seed, loquat leaf, mulberry bark.

Table of commonly used Chinese medicines

Table of commonly used Chinese medicines

For regulating the qi:

tangerine peel, flatsedge tuber, finger citron, eaglewood, cardamon, costus root.

For boosting blood circulation:

Chuanxiong rhizome, red sage root, peach kernel, *wenyujin* rhizome, turmeric root, sappan wood.

To arrest bleeding:

Notoginseng, agrimony, argyi wormwood leaf, burnet root.

To nourish the qi:

Ginseng, liquorice, Chinese date, *baishu*.

To nourish the blood:

Angelica root, fleeceflower root, mulberry fruit, mulberry mistletoe.

To nourish the yin:

Asparagus root, lily bulb, glossy privet fruit, solomonseal rhizome, wolfberry.

To nourish the yang:

Gecko, curculigo rhizome, dodder seed.

Sedatives/tranquilizers:

cinnabar, spiny jujube seed, silktree flower.

FIG. 189

An inset line drawing of a Chinese medical shop. Behind a counter stands the shopkeeper in a scholar's cap, holding up a large round medicine vessel, with a wall of small medicine drawers behind him. A customer stands at the counter in front of him, and two large earthenware jars with cloth covers stand on the ground to the left, with more jars stacked at the far right.

BOOK PAGE 87 · SCAN P096

Method Two — Acupuncture and Moxibustion

Method Two — Acupuncture and Moxibustion

"My head hurts."

"Let me help you!"

"Ouch! Why are you poking me with a needle?!"

"This is known as acupuncture. It's amazing!"

"You're poking me with a sewing needle?!"

"How are you feeling?"

"Do you feel numbness or pain? Tell me!"

"It's very painful! Sob... sob..."

Isn't it amazing that a needle is able to relieve pain in the body?

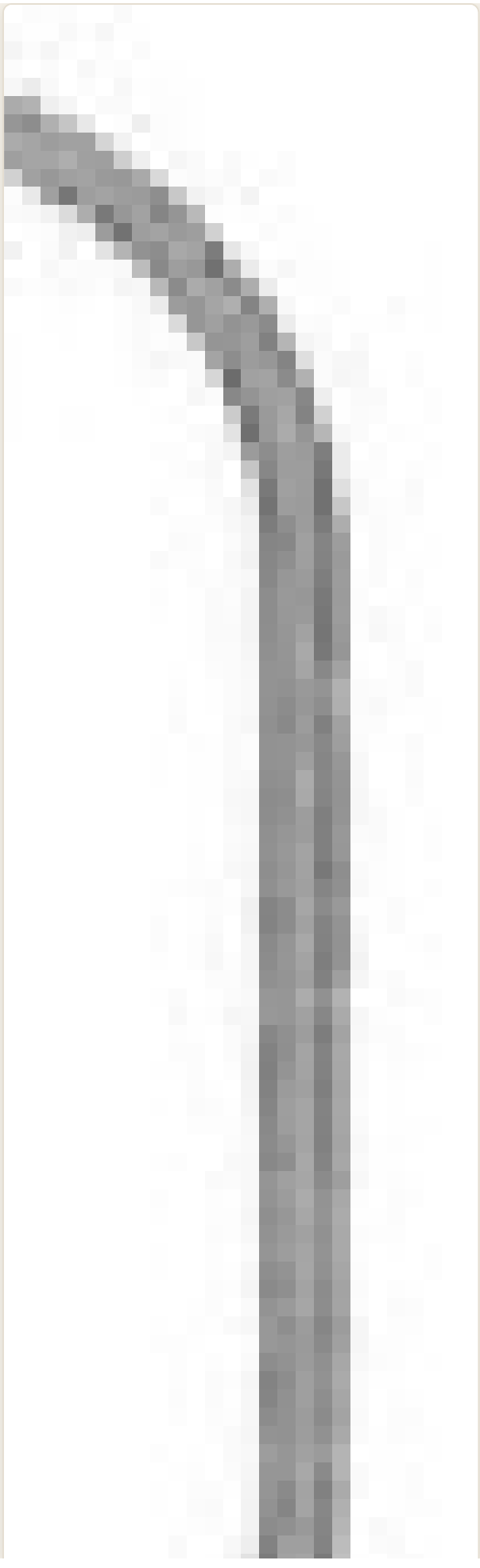
Acupuncture and moxibustion are remarkable features of techniques in traditional Chinese medicine. They are used in the treatment and prevention of many diseases. The effects are almost immediate and side-effects seldom arise.

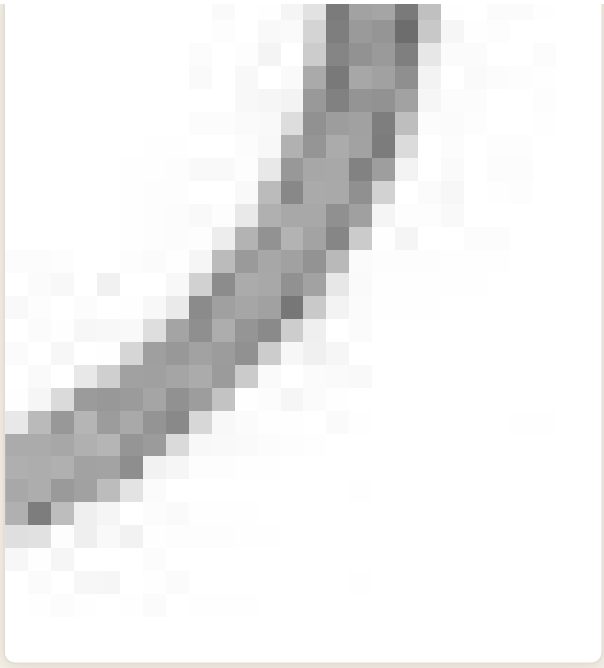
Acupuncture and moxibustion are two different types of treatment. Both methods stimulate the acupoints on the body surface to bring about a harmony of the qi, blood, yin and yang in the afflicted body part.

Acupuncture

Moxibustion

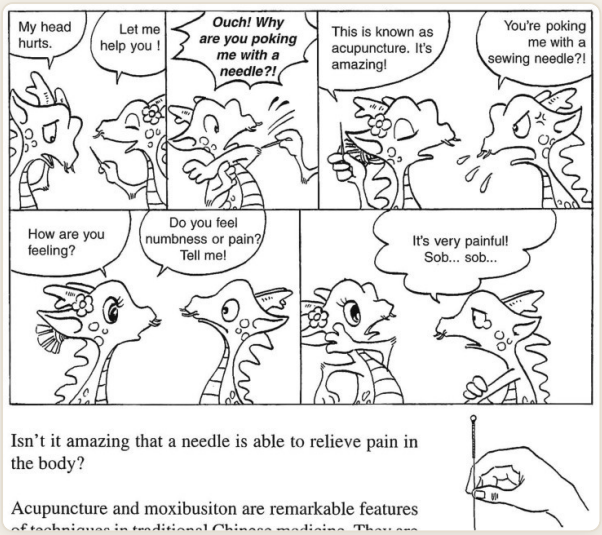
FIG. 190





A narrow cropped fragment showing the rounded left end of the banner that frames the chapter title.

FIG. 191



The comic strip at the top of the page, in two rows of panels. In the first row one dragon complains of a headache and the other, wearing a flower, offers to help; in the next panel the dragon with the needle pricks its companion, who yelps and asks why it is being poked; in the third panel the needle-bearer explains that this is acupuncture, and the other protests that it is being poked with a sewing needle. In the second row the dragon asks how its companion is feeling and whether it feels numbness or pain, while the other wails that it is very painful. Below the strip, at the lower right, a small line drawing shows a hand holding an acupuncture needle upright.

BOOK PAGE 88 · SCAN P097

The origins of acupuncture

The origins of acupuncture

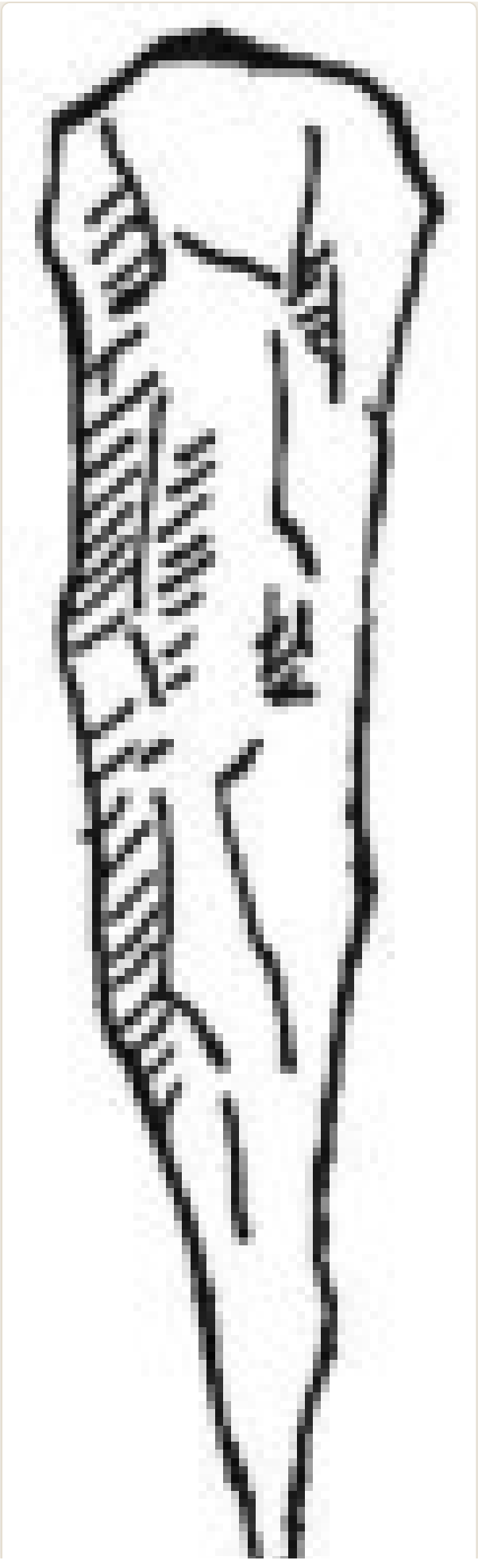
These two methods of treatment can be traced back to the use of stone needles during the New Stone Age. At that time, they used needles of various shapes and sizes made from bones.

In the post-Zhou Dynasty era, metal acupuncture needles made their first appearance. The use of needles to treat diseases was already very popular.

During the Qin and Han Dynasties, acupuncture had already spread to Japan and Southeast Asia. The Europeans began to learn of acupuncture during the 17th century. At present, more than 120 countries and regions have practitioners of acupuncture. It has been playing a significant part in the human health sciences.

Needles made of bone

FIG. 192



A single bone acupuncture needle drawn upright: a thick, flat, slightly curved sliver of bone tapering to a sharp point, its surface scored with fine scratched grooves.

FIG. 193

A wide line drawing of a treatment scene. At the centre an older man with a moustache sits leaning forward in patterned trousers while a bearded practitioner, his hair tied in a topknot, reaches out with a small needle to the back of the patient's neck; behind the patient a standing figure steadies his head and shoulders. On the left a small child peers out beside a seated youth in a soft cap, both watching. On the right a young attendant in a patterned garment holds up a tray bearing a small box, with a stand and round container behind him. A pair of black shoes, a wrapped bundle and a few tools lie scattered on the ground in front.

BOOK PAGE 89 · SCAN P098

How acupuncture is carried out

How acupuncture is carried out

Acupuncture involves the insertion of needles into the skin of a patient. Very fine needles made of metal or stainless steel are commonly used. They come in various lengths measuring from 15 milimetres to 100 milimetres. Their thicknesses also vary.

The acupuncturist will select the type of needles used based on the patient's state of health and physical condition. For example, in areas which are more fleshy and muscular, longer and thicker needles will be used. Shorter and finer needles are used for the chest and back areas.

After inserting the needle into the acupoint on the skin surface, he may move the needle in a variety of ways to exert varying degrees of stimulation on that acupoint. The patient will feel

sore, numb and bloated in the spot where the needle has been inserted. This condition is known as 'getting the qi'. If such a condition is absent, it is probably due to the wrong acupoint being chosen and hence failure to treat the afflicted part.

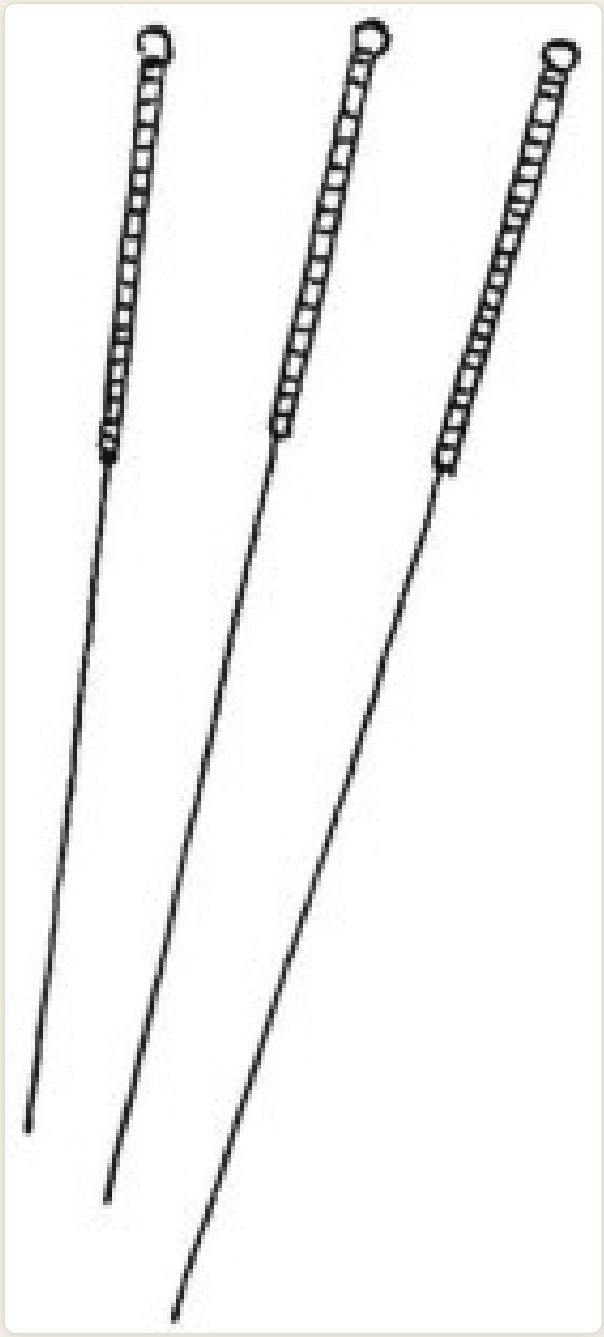
Lift and thrust method:

When the needle has been inserted, the needle is lifted and thrusted into the skin surface or muscles.

Rotating method:

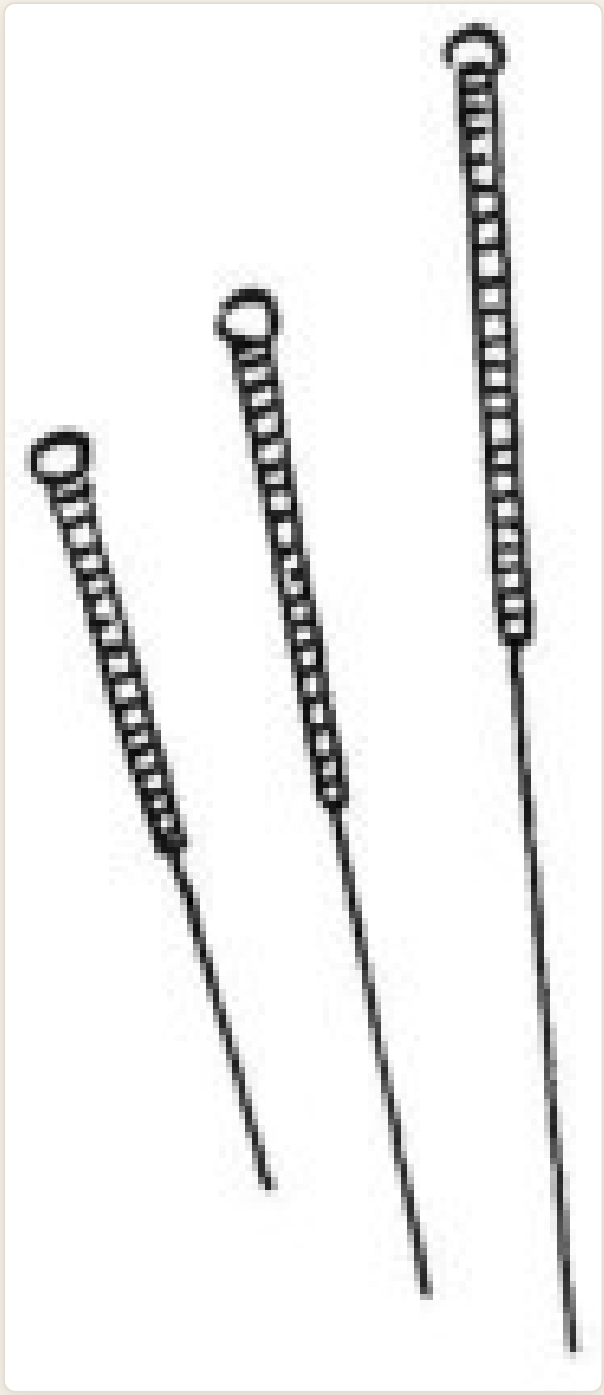
When the needle is secured in the skin surface, the thumb, the index finger and the middle finger will then hold on to the needle and rotate it back and forth.

FIG. 194



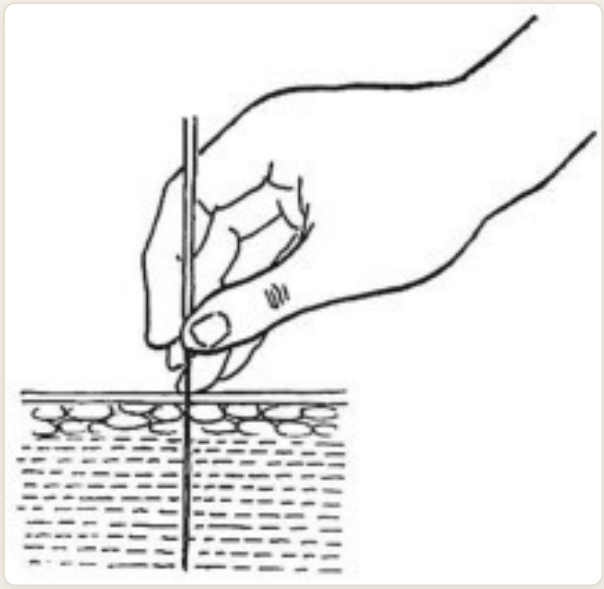
Three fine acupuncture needles with handles made of closely coiled wire, fanned out at a slant.

FIG. 195



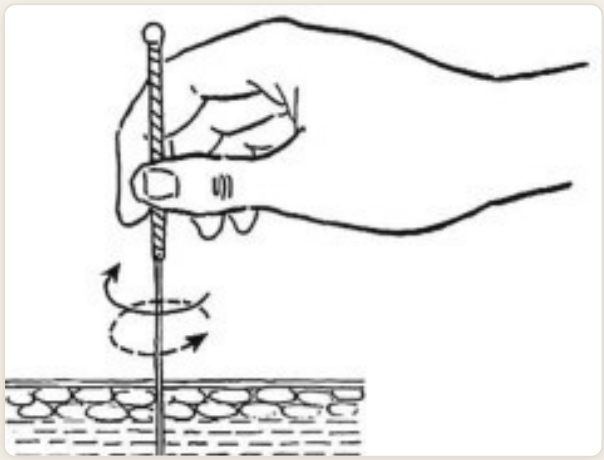
Three more acupuncture needles with coiled-wire handles, tilted in the opposite direction, forming the rest of the same cluster of needles.

FIG. 196



A hand holding a needle upright and pressing it straight down; the skin is drawn in cross-section, showing the layered tissue beneath the surface with the needle passing through it.

FIG. 197



A hand gripping the coiled handle of an inserted needle, with curved arrows drawn around the shaft to show the needle being twisted back and forth.

Trang 90

Flicking method:

The index finger or the middle finger is used to flick the needle to cause vibrations, hence hastening the flow of qi.

Rocking method:

Once the needle is inserted and secured, it is bent from side to side to allow the needle to make its impact greater.

Intermittent rotating method:

The needle is rotated vigorously before the thumb and the index finger are removed. The procedure is repeated.

BOOK PAGE 91 · SCAN P100

Ear-acupuncture therapy

Ear-acupuncture therapy

The ear has reactive points with various diseases. That is why carrying out ear-acupuncture on these points will effect treatment of diseases. Ear-acupuncture is used to treat a wide variety of diseases like various pains, phlegm, sensitivity, emotional upset, infectious diseases, chronic diseases etc. It may also be helpful in treating nicotine and other drug addictions as well as aiding weight loss etc.

Diagram of acupoints in Ear-acupuncture.

BOOK PAGE 92 · SCAN P101

Moxibustion

Moxibustion

Moxibustion involves the use of lit moxa wool, a moxa stick or moxa cone to burn the acupoint, thereby regulating the qi and blood through the heat. Moxa is pungent to the taste and warm in nature. It therefore warms the collaterals and meridians and helps expel cold and dampness.

During treatment, one end of the moxa stick is lit and placed on the acupoint or held at about one milimetre away from the acupoint.

Sliced fresh ginger or sliced garlic is also used to form a barrier between the moxa and skin surface.

After a moxibustion session, it is normal for the skin to be slightly red.

Moxibustion is used to treat yin, interior, deficiency and cold syndromes, such as chronic pathogenic cold and wind factors.

BOOK PAGE 93 · SCAN P102

Bian Que Restores Life with Acupuncture

Bian Que Restores Life with Acupuncture

The famous physician Bian Que of the Warring States Period travelled through the State of Guo one day.

"It's too late. He has just passed away."

"Your Majesty, I heard the Crown Prince is gravely ill. Let me see him."

"Ah! He still has a pulse."

"Sir, why are you inserting needles into the Crown Prince's corpse?"

FIG. 198

The whole page is one comic strip in three rows, set in the palace of the State of Guo. The top-left panel carries the title Bian Que Restores Life with Acupuncture above Bian Que in a scholar's cap, a long needle held up between his fingers. In the top-right panel a caption box tells how the famous physician Bian Que of the Warring States period travelled through the State of Guo one day, while an attendant reports to him that it is too late and the Crown Prince has just passed away, and Bian Que, bowing before the king seated behind a screen with his attendants, asks to be allowed to see the gravely ill prince. In the middle-left panel Bian Que kneels at the bedside feeling the wrist of the prince, who lies beneath a quilt, and exclaims that he still has a pulse; the middle-right panel is a close-up of the prince's face as a hand presses a needle into the skin of his forehead. The bottom-left panel shows Bian Que needling the prince, who lies with his head on a pillow while several needles already stand upright in his chest and shoulder; in the bottom-right panel a courtier, seen from behind in a winged official's cap, protests and asks why Bian Que is inserting needles into the Crown Prince's corpse.

BOOK PAGE 94 · SCAN P103

Trang 94

"The Crown Prince isn't dead."

"The flows of his qi and blood were reversed, causing the immobility of his body."

"That is why it looks like he is dead."

"You mean you have a way to bring him back to life?"

"Acupuncture will be able to save him."

"I have just treated the Crown Prince. He should regain consciousness soon."

Next, Bian Que had his apprentice prepare moxibustion medicines to place below the Crown Prince's armpits.

"The Crown Prince is able to get up and sit on the bed. He is out of danger now."

After 20 days of treatment, the Crown Prince made a complete recovery.

"You are truly a divine physician who can bring the dead back to life!"

FIG. 199

The continuation of the comic, in three rows. In the top-left panel Bian Que, seen from behind, insists that the Crown Prince is not dead; in the top-right panel he explains to the king that the prince's qi and blood had flowed in reverse, which made his body immobile so that he only looks dead, and the king asks whether he has a way to bring him back to life. In the middle-left panel Bian Que declares that acupuncture will be able to save him; the middle-right panel is a close-up of the Crown Prince lying on his pillow with his eyes open, as Bian Que says that he has just treated him and he should regain consciousness soon. A caption box at the left of the bottom row tells how Bian Que then had his apprentice prepare moxibustion medicines to be placed below the Crown Prince's armpits, and the panel beneath it shows the bare-chested prince propped up in bed with a smoking moxa preparation at each armpit and the apprentice attending him. In the bottom-middle panel he is able to get up and sit on the bed, out of danger; and in the bottom-right panel a caption records that after twenty days of treatment the Crown Prince made a complete recovery, while a courtier in a garden setting declares that Bian Que is truly a divine physician who can bring the dead back to life.

Wang Weiyi Creates the Bronze Man

Wang Weiyi Creates the Bronze Man

Wang Weiyi was an imperial physician during the Northern Song Dynasty. His job was to teach acupuncture.

"Acupuncture is taught in this court. Make sure you master it."

"You have to commit the acupoints to memory. Just one slip and it may cost a life."

"Sir, I have no problem remembering all the acupoints."

"But I am terrified of inserting needles into a living person."

"Come, let me demonstrate how it should be done."

"Tremble..."

FIG. 200

The whole page is one comic strip in three rows, set in the Northern Song court. The top-left panel carries the title Wang Weiyi Creates the Bronze Man above a bare-chested bronze anatomical model standing beside Wang Weiyi; the top-right panel is a portrait of Wang Weiyi in a black official's cap, with a caption box explaining that he was an imperial physician during the Northern Song Dynasty whose job was to teach acupuncture. In the middle row Wang Weiyi, standing before a wall of shelves, tells his students that acupuncture is taught in this court and that they must master it, and that they must commit the acupoints to memory because a single slip may cost a life; two students listen, one of them holding a chart of the human body marked with acupoints. In the bottom-left panel a frightened student, needles in hand, says that he has no problem remembering all the acupoints but is terrified of inserting needles into a living person; in the bottom-right panel Wang Weiyi holds a needle over a forearm and demonstrates how it should be done, the word Tremble... printed beside the needle.

BOOK PAGE 96 · SCAN P105

Trang 96

"Do you call this acupuncture?"

"Please forgive me, Sir. I don't wish to create unnecessary holes on you. But if you were made of wood, I would have gone ahead with it."

"A wooden man? You have given me a wonderful idea."

"Using an anatomical model of the human body in class is a good idea."

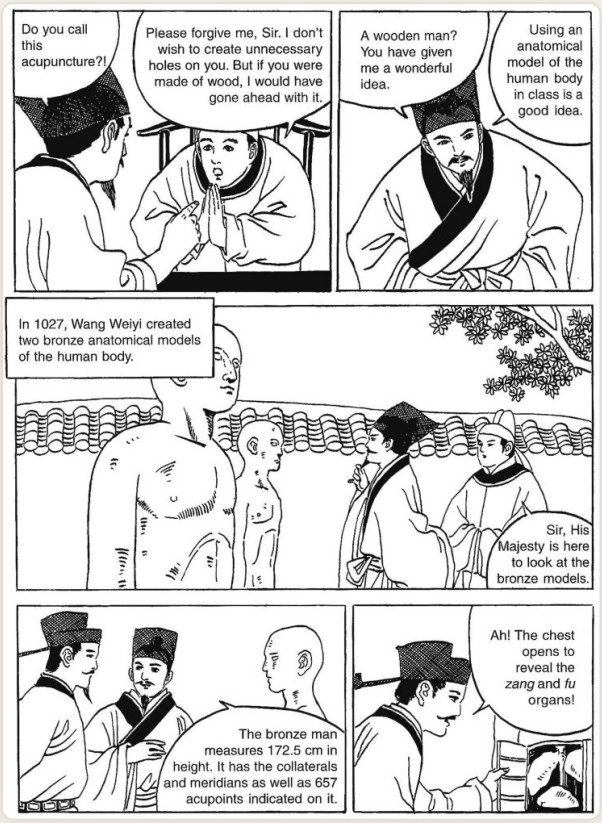
In 1027, Wang Weiyi created two bronze anatomical models of the human body.

"Sir, His Majesty is here to look at the bronze models."

"The bronze man measures 172.5 cm in height. It has the collaterals and meridians as well as 657 acupoints indicated on it."

"Ah! The chest opens to reveal the zang and fu organs!"

FIG. 201



The continuation of the comic, in three rows. In the top-left panel Wang Weiyi, seen from behind in his official's cap, scolds the student and asks whether he calls that acupuncture; the student answers with his palms pressed together in apology, saying that he did not wish to make unnecessary holes in his master, but that if Wang Weiyi were made of wood he would have gone ahead with it. In the top-right panel Wang Weiyi brightens, repeating "A wooden man?" and telling the student that he has given him a wonderful idea, while the student remarks that using an anatomical model of the human body in class is a good idea. In the middle row a caption box records that in 1027 Wang Weiyi created two bronze anatomical models of the human body; the panel shows the two bronze figures, a large one and a smaller one, standing in a courtyard with tiled roofs, while a student announces that His Majesty has come to look at the bronze models. In the bottom-left panel two officials and the student examine the head and shoulders of the bronze figure, with a speech balloon explaining that it measures 172.5 cm in height and that the collaterals and meridians and 657 acupoints are indicated on it. In the bottom-right panel Wang Weiyi lifts the hinged front of the bronze figure to reveal the organs inside, exclaiming that the chest opens to show the zang and fu organs.

Trang 97

"Your Majesty, we plan to apply a layer of wax on the model before we put the students to the test."

"How do we use this bronze man?"

"It will also be filled with water."

"The students will then select the acupoint based on the question thrown to them."

"Look, once the needle is inserted in the right position, water will flow out."

"If the needle misses the acupoint, it won't be able to penetrate into the bronze man."

"This is amazing! We'll place one model in the Daxiangguo Temple and one in the Imperial Medical College."

"This is great! My hands won't be trembling when I have to practise acupuncture."

FIG. 202

A full-page comic strip in three rows. Top row, left to right: an official in a winged cap tells the emperor that they plan to apply a layer of wax on the model before the students are put to the test; a scholar asks how the bronze man is used, and another explains that it will also be filled with water; then a panel shows a needle being inserted into the bronze man's shoulder while a text box explains that the students will select the acupoint based on the question thrown to them. Middle row: an official points at the bronze figure, saying that once the needle is inserted in the right position water will flow out; a young student notes that if the needle misses the acupoint it will not be able to penetrate into the bronze man; and an official with a moustache and beard declares it amazing, adding that one model will be placed in the Daxiangguo Temple and one in the Imperial Medical College. Bottom row: a delighted student says his hands will not be trembling when he has to practise acupuncture; the facade of a temple is shown with a plaque bearing the characters 相國寺 (Daxiangguo Temple); and a practitioner seated beside the standing bronze man works a needle into his back, the figure's meridians drawn as dotted lines.

Trang 98

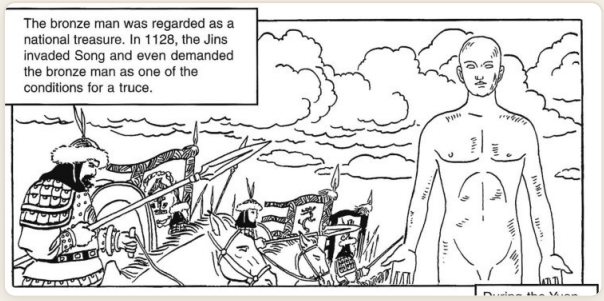
The bronze man was regarded as a national treasure. In 1128, the Jins invaded Song and even demanded the bronze man as one of the conditions for a truce.

During the Yuan and Ming dynasties, further improvements were made to the bronze man. It is a shame that the bronze man from the Song Dynasty was lost through the changes of dynasties.

But during the Ming and Qing dynasties, the bronze man saw a revival. Acupuncture was thus re-introduced to the people.

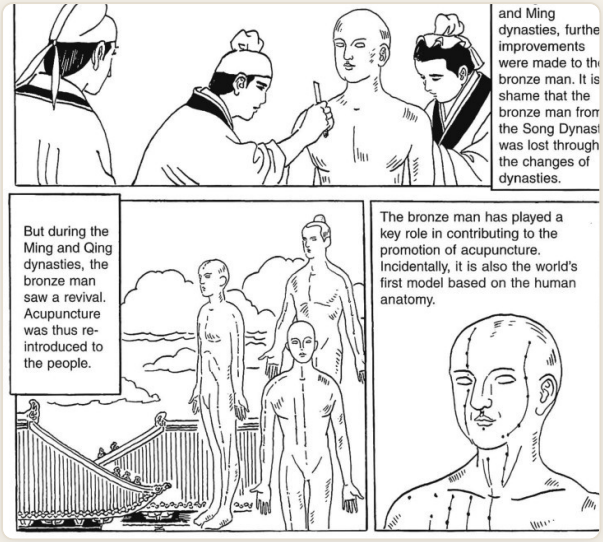
The bronze man has played a key role in contributing to the promotion of acupuncture. Incidentally, it is also the world's first model based on the human anatomy.

FIG. 203



The top row of the comic. A caption box at the upper left records that the bronze man was regarded as a national treasure and that in 1128 the Jins invaded Song, even demanding the bronze man as one of the conditions for a truce. Below it, armoured Jin horsemen with feathered helmets and long spears charge across an open field under rolling clouds, while at the right stands the naked bronze man, seen from the front, its surface dotted with small incised markings for the meridians and acupoints.

FIG. 204



The middle and bottom rows of the comic. In the middle row three figures in scholar's caps and robes gather around the bronze man: the one in the centre inserts a needle into the figure's shoulder, while the two at the sides look on; a caption box at the right notes that during the Yuan and Ming dynasties further improvements were made to the bronze man and that the Song-Dynasty bronze man was lost through the changes of dynasties. In the bottom-left panel three bronze figures stand before a river and an arched bridge with a temple roof behind them, with a caption box recording that during the Ming and Qing dynasties the bronze man saw a revival and acupuncture was re-introduced to the people. In the bottom-right panel a close-up of the bronze man's head and shoulders shows the acupoint markings dotted over the face, neck and chest, with a caption box explaining that the bronze man played a key role in promoting acupuncture and is also the world's first model based on the human anatomy.

BOOK PAGE 99 · SCAN P108

Method Three — Massotherapy

Method Three — Massotherapy

Massage pushes, presses, kneads or rubs the body to stimulate blood circulation, increase the skin's resistance level and regulate the nervous system.

"These days, the uses of massage have evolved to include promoting good health and strengthening the physique. It is no longer limited to the treatment of diseases. Regular massage will relieve fatigue and perk one up!"

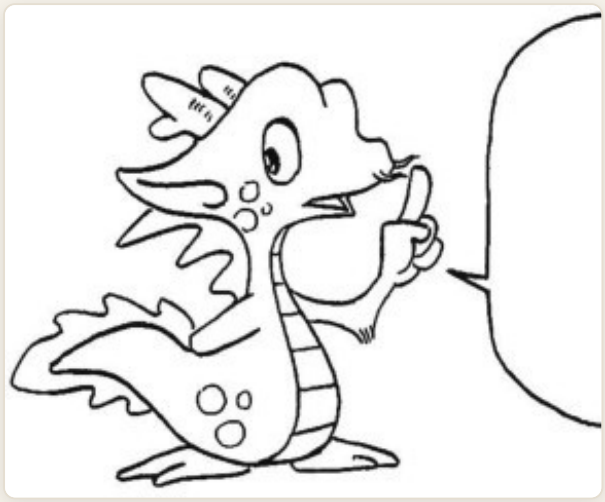
"Does massotherapy mean to 'push' and 'grasp'?"

"There are eight common types of massage. Pushing and grasping are just two types."

Pushing: Pushing and squeezing the muscles with the fingers, palms, or elbow forward and backward.

Grasping: Lifting and squeezing the skin or muscle with three or five fingers of one or both hands.

FIG. 205



The book's cartoon dragon mascot, standing upright with its head turned to the right and one clawed forelimb raised as if it were speaking; the scalloped edge of a speech balloon is visible at the right, and the dragon has small round spots on its body and a finned back.

FIG. 206

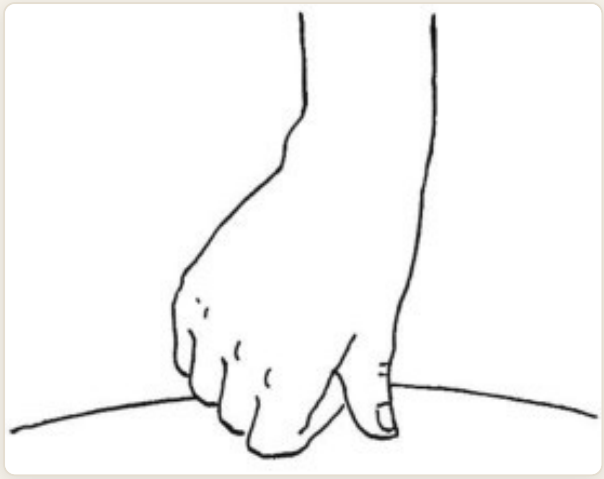
A boxed strip in two halves. In the upper half two cartoon dragons face each other across the panel, the left one with its claws raised and a speech balloon asking whether massotherapy means to "push" and "grasp", the right one answering in a balloon that there are eight common types of massage and that pushing and grasping are just two of them. In the lower half are two hand studies: on the left a hand rests flat on a limb and is being pushed forward and back, with a small arrow beside it showing the direction of travel; on the right a hand grips and lifts a fold of skin or muscle.

BOOK PAGE 100 · SCAN P109

Trang 100

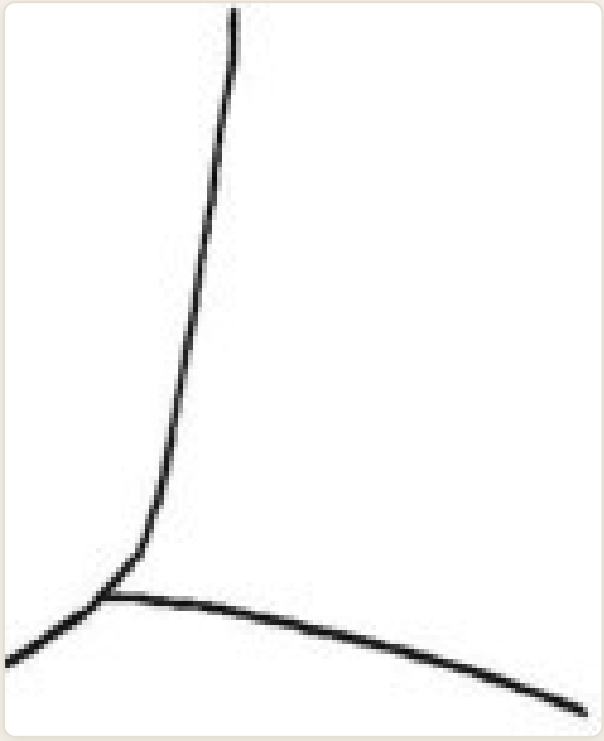
- - **Pressing:** Pressing the acupoint or affected part with the thumb, palm or knuckle.
- - **Tapping:** Tapping a point on the patient's body with the fingertips.
- - **Fingernail-pressing:** Pressing at a point on the body with a finger-nail to produce a strong stimulation.
- - **Massaging:** Rubbing the affected part with the fingertips or the palm in a circular motion.
- - **Foulage:** Kneading and pressing the muscles of the limbs with the palms.
- - **Patting:** Patting gently with the palm or side of the hand to cause relaxation.

FIG. 207



A hand seen from the side, the forearm coming down from above with the fingers curled and the fingertips pressed onto a surface, the drawing used for the tapping technique.

FIG. 208

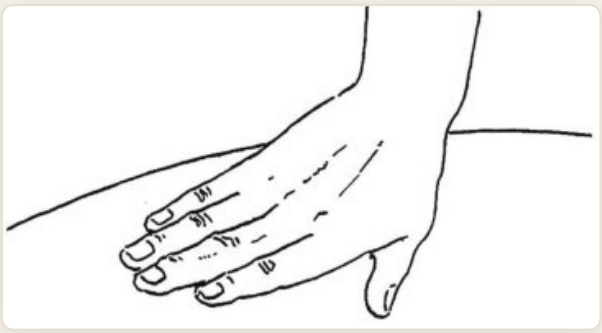


A detail crop from the same illustration panel: the curving line of the practitioner's arm as it comes down to the surface, with the surface line running out to the right and the rest of the frame left blank.

FIG. 209

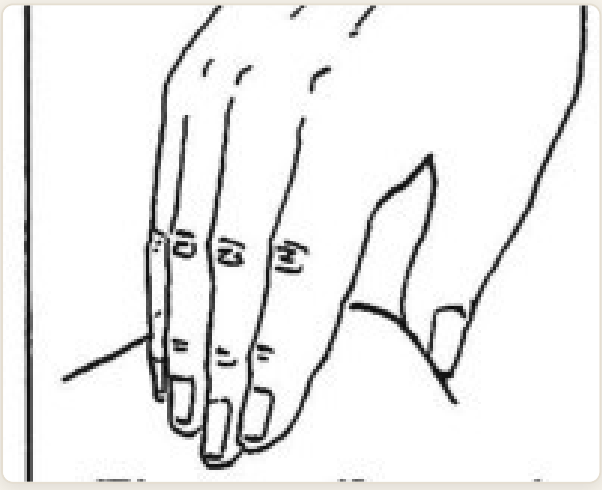
A hand laid flat, seen from the side, the fingers extended and pointing to the left and the palm pressed down on the surface, small dotted marks drawn on the back of the hand.

FIG. 210



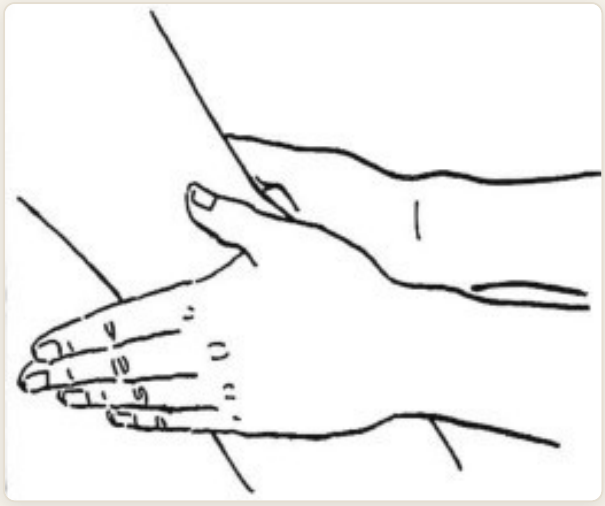
A hand seen from the back, the fingers extended and slightly spread with the wrist to the right, resting flat on a surface as if rubbing it.

FIG. 211



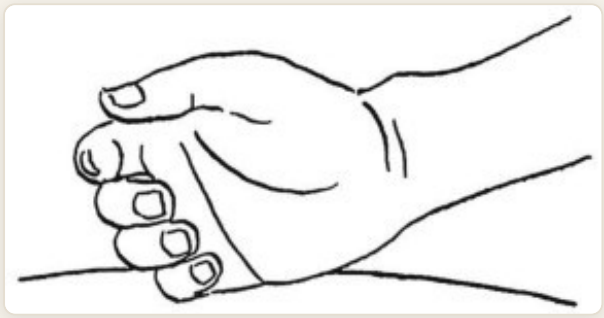
A hand held vertically, the fingers pointing downward and the nails clearly drawn, pressing at a single point on the surface.

FIG. 212



Two hands: one hand lies over the other on a limb and kneads and presses it, an arm crossing the upper left of the frame.

FIG. 213



A hand with the fingers curled and bent, the palm and the edge of the hand turned downward onto the surface, as in a light pat.

BOOK PAGE 101 · SCAN P110

Trang 101

"It is when the manipulation of the acupoints cause soreness that the acupoints have gained qi."

"If there is only pain with no soreness, it may be due to harsh massotherapy or wrong identification of acupoints."

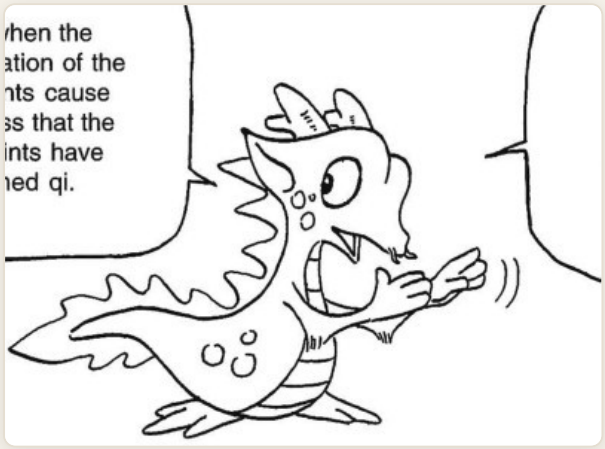
Massotherapy covers a broad spectrum of systems like the nervous system, muscular system, respiratory system, digestive system etc. It has been proven to be effective in treating ailments

of these systems.

Cardiac Massage

We often watch on television how doctors will press on a patient's chest to try to return a regular heartbeat to the patient, thereby reviving him or her. This is also a technique used in massotherapy. During the Eastern Han Period, the famous physician Zhang Zhongjing introduced this method in *Synopsis of The Prescriptions of Golden Chamber*.

FIG. 214



The cartoon dragon mascot, its mouth open and its clawed hands raised as if gesturing, with the scalloped outline of a speech balloon at the upper left; the edge of a second balloon shows at the right.

FIG. 215

A man in a short-sleeved shirt kneels over a patient lying flat on the ground and presses down on the patient's chest with both hands to perform cardiac massage; the patient's eyes are closed and one arm lies outstretched. To the right stands a large traditional stitched book with a title slip reading 金匱要略 (Jingui Yaolue, Synopsis of the Golden Chamber).

Foot reflexology

Foot reflexology

Foot reflexology has become very popular in recent years. Chinese physicians believe that there are six main channels and 66 acupoints on a person's foot and that these are correlated to many organs in one's body. Through the stimulation of these acupoints, it is possible to maintain good health and treat disease. Foot reflexology helps to boost blood circulation, increase metabolism, promote hormonal balance, expel harmful toxins from the body, relieve exhaustion, maintain and improve one's complexion etc.

Diagram of acupoints in foot reflexology

- - A. Head
- - B. Thyroid gland
- - C. Lung
- - D. Heart
- - E. Liver
- - F. Stomach
- - G. Spleen
- - H. Pancreas
- - I. Right kidney
- - J. Left kidney
- - K. Duodenum*
- - L. Large intestine
- - M. Small intestine
- - N. Right knee
- - P. Left knee
- - P. Urinary bladder
- - Q. Reproductive organs

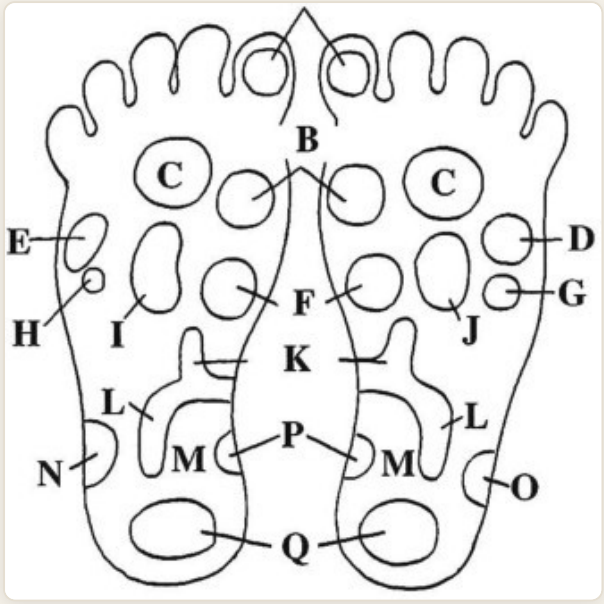
* The first part of the small intestine connecting to the stomach.

There are four basic methods in foot reflexology:

- - Foulage, rubbing and kneading
- - Stretching
- - Stretching
- - Twisting

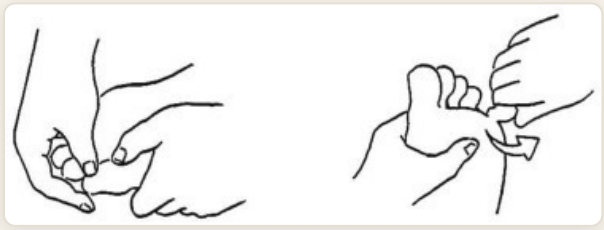
"Do remember to drink water after a foot reflexology session. Body wastes are accumulated in the kidneys during foot reflexology. Hence consumption of water will help expel these body wastes through the passing of urine."

FIG. 216



The diagram of the soles of two feet, side by side and slightly splayed, with small oval and round zones drawn on each sole and keyed by the letters A to Q: A at the tips of the big toes for the head, B at the base of the toes for the thyroid gland, C over the ball of each foot for the lungs, D on the outer edge for the heart, E and H on the outer edge for the liver and pancreas, and further zones lettered F, G, I, J, K, L, M, N, O, P and Q running down towards the heels for the stomach, spleen, right and left kidneys, duodenum, large and small intestines, knees, urinary bladder and reproductive organs.

FIG. 217



The upper pair of the four foot-reflexology hand positions. On the left, one hand steadies the foot while the fingers of the other press and knead the sole, for foulage, rubbing and kneading. On the right, a hand grips the foot and bends it, a small arrow marking the direction of the stretch.

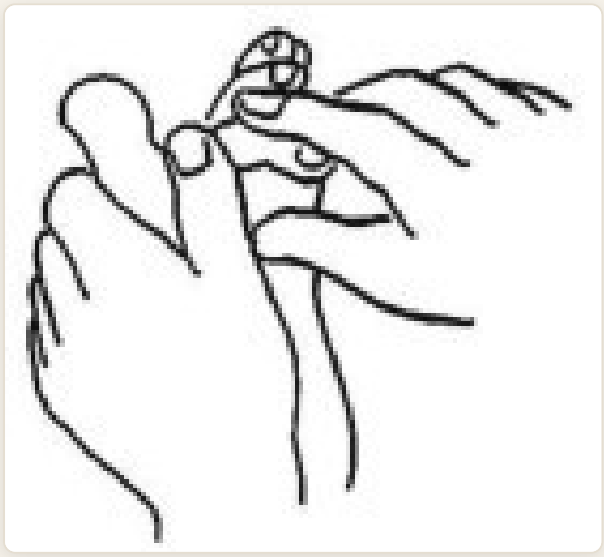
FIG. 218

The twisting position: both hands grip the foot and rotate it, with two curved arrows drawn above the hands showing the twisting movement in opposite directions.

FIG. 219

The cartoon dragon mascot, seated with its mouth open in a grin and its tail curling behind it, holding up a glass of water in one clawed hand; above it is the tail of a speech balloon carrying the words "passing of urine."

FIG. 220



The stretching position: one hand steadies the foot from below while the fingers of the other hand grip the toes and stretch them upwards.

Other Methods in Foot Reflexology

Other Methods in Foot Reflexology

Washing the feet:

Traditional Chinese medicine believes that the act of washing feet also has massotherapeutic effects. The washing of feet is best done before bedtime. It is a simple method. Fill a basin with warm water and soak your feet in it. Rub your feet at the same time. This will not only clean the feet but also boost blood circulation, treat diseases and strengthen the constitution. You may also add marbles in the basin and step on the marbles.

Wearing slippers with bumps:

Some slippers come with little bumps on them. Wearing these slippers also massages the feet.

Walking on pebbles barefooted:

Walking on a pebbled path barefooted is like having foot reflexology and has therapeutic effects.

"You may also step on pebbles at home!"

"Just place the pebbles in a cloth-bag and you may step on it any time you like!"

FIG. 221

A circular vignette showing a woman in a striped blouse seated on a low stool, her trouser legs rolled up, soaking and rubbing her feet in a basin of steaming warm water on the floor.

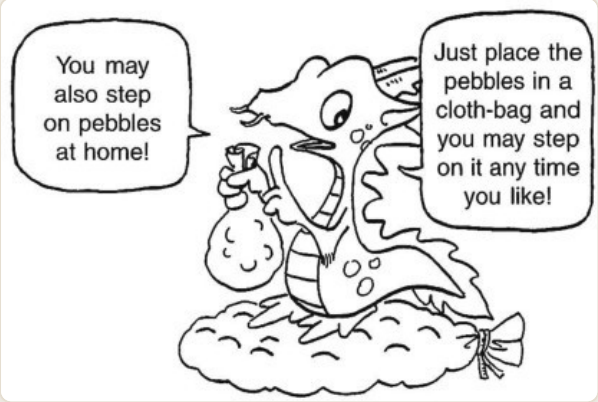
FIG. 222

A circular vignette showing a pair of open-toed slippers with a cross-over strap, the footbed covered with small raised bumps.

FIG. 223

A circular vignette showing a young man in a jacket and trousers walking in profile, barefooted, over a bed of rounded pebbles.

FIG. 224



The cartoon dragon mascot standing on a pebble mat, holding up a small cloth bag of pebbles in one clawed hand, with two speech balloons on either side of it.

BOOK PAGE 104 · SCAN P113

Method Four — Diet Therapy

Method Four — Diet Therapy

"Why are you looking listless? Are you feeling unwell?"

"Let me see if I can help you. I've just learnt about diet therapy. You needn't take medicine or go for an injection."

"I'll make you lotus root soup, carrot congee, persimmons, watermelon, mango..."

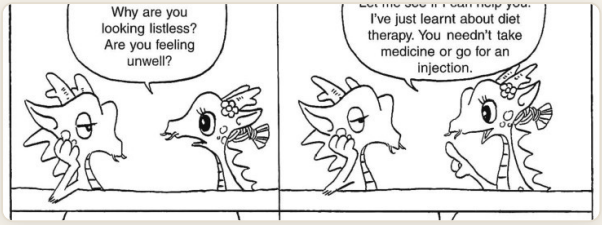
"I ate too much just now. I feel like sleeping now."

"Then you should take foods to aid digestion..."

Diet therapy uses the food we eat daily to treat or assist in the treatment of diseases.

Long ago in China, food and medicine were already considered to go hand in hand. Many plants were actually once food. As time passed, they became widely used as medicines.

FIG. 225



The upper row of the comic, two panels side by side. In the left panel the long-snouted dragon asks its companion, which has a small flower on its head and drooping eyes, why it is looking listless and whether it is feeling unwell. In the right panel the flowered dragon replies that it will see if it can help, since it has just learnt about diet therapy and the other needn't take medicine or go for an injection.

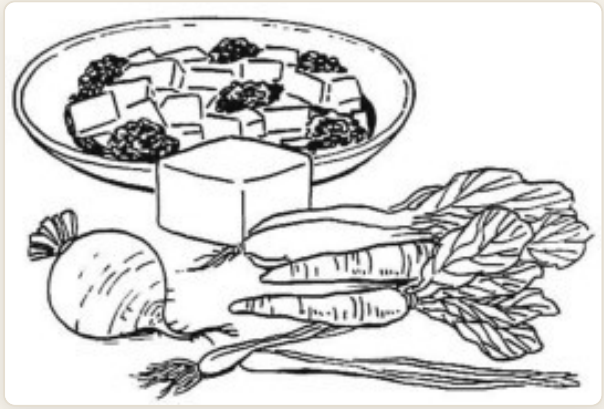
FIG. 226

The lower row of the comic, two panels side by side. In the left panel the flowered dragon offers to make lotus root soup, carrot congee, persimmons, watermelon and mango. In the right panel the snouted dragon says it ate too much just now and feels like sleeping, and the flowered dragon answers that it should take foods to aid digestion.

FIG. 227

A still life of foods and cooking vessels: a bamboo steamer holding buns with a pile of eggs beside it, a covered pot, a bowl of soup with a whole chicken, a casserole of stew with mushrooms and a bowl of rice, with a Chinese cabbage and other leafy vegetables laid beside them and steam rising from the dishes.

FIG. 228



A plate of bean curd (tofu) cubes topped with green vegetables, with a large white radish and two carrots and their leafy tops lying beside it.

Dieticians

The famous physician Sun Simiao once said:

> *"To keep ourselves in good health, we have to depend on food. It is only in times of serious illness that medicines are prescribed. A poor knowledge of the right diet will not keep us healthy. A good physician ought to know the cause of a disease and find out where the afflicted part is. Treat the disease with diet therapy first. Prescribe medicine only if this fails."*

Dieticians

In the Early Qin period, medical practitioners were already categorised into four groups: surgeons, physicians, dieticians and veterinarians. The dietician, in particular, would take care of the kings' and emperors' diets. He would plan the menu based on the season and the person's state of health to maintain the latter's good health and prevent disease.

FIG. 229

Portrait of the physician Sun Simiao: a bearded man wearing Tang-dynasty robes and a soft cloth headwrap, his collar crossed and edged in black.

FIG. 230

Four robed figures standing side by side, one for each branch of early medicine: an official in a tall crown with one hand raised; a physician holding a small mallet; a dietician carrying a tray of covered dishes; and a veterinarian cradling a small animal. A short caption is printed beneath each figure in the original artwork.

BOOK PAGE 106 · SCAN P115

The relationship between diet and diseases

The relationship between diet and diseases

Some fruits and vegetables that prevent diseases:

Vegetables	
Caixin (flowering cabbage)	Aids digestion, promotes the metabolism.
Lily bulb	Diuretic, arrests bleeding, brings down swelling.
Leaf mustard	Improves vision.
Broccoli	Moistens the intestines, removes excess heat.
Cabbage	Benefits the kidneys.
Spinach	Nourishes the blood, removes excess heat and toxins, clears the intestines and stomach.
Bittergourd	Removes excess heat, nourishes the qi.
Towel gourd	Replenishes the blood, removes toxins and phlegm and relieves pain.

Cucumber	Diuretic, quenches thirst.
Winter melon	Removes excess heat, diuretic.
Fresh ginger	Disperses cold, prevents nausea, clears phlegm and toxins.
Lotus root	Arrests vomiting of blood, reduces fatigue, clears excess heat.
Carrot	Prevents infection, relieves facial swelling and toxins.
Tomato	Alleviates pain, disperses blood, lowers swelling.
Mushroom	Aids digestion, lowers blood pressure.
Pea	Nourishes the qi, arrests bleeding, diuretic.
French bean	Nourishes the blood, improves vision, prevents flaccidity of lower limbs.
Onion	Induces perspiration, aids digestion, treats colds.
Red pepper	Dispels cold and dampness, rejuvenates.
Lentil	Good for weak spleen and stomach, treats diarrhoea.

Trang 107

Fruits	
Mango	Treats coughs, nausea and dizziness.
Watermelon	Diuretic, relieves heat, treats inflammation of the kidneys.
Grape	Nourishes the blood, diuretic, treats liver diseases.
Pomelo	Aids digestion, neutralises toxins from alcohol.
Pear	Treats coughs and clears phlegm, quenches thirst, moistens the heart and lungs.
Sugar cane	Treats infection, nourishes the spleen, quenches thirst, clears toxins.
Loquat	Treats coughs and moistens the lungs.

Persimmon	Improves appetite, clears infection, treats coughs and moistens the lungs.
Longan	Nourishes the blood, sedative, improves appetite and nourishes the spleen.
Lychee	Quenches thirst, clears the mind.
Starfruit	Quenches thirst, clears heat, treats sore throats.
Papaya	Improves vision, clears heat, clears heat in the intestines, aids digestion.
Apple	Nourishes the heart and qi, promotes body fluid, quenches thirst.
Lemon	Helps in weight loss, aids digestion, clears the qi.
Banana	Quenches thirst, moistens the lungs and intestines, clears the blood vessel.
Guava	Diuretic, treats constipation.
Mandarin orange	Clears stagnation of qi, treats coughs and removes dampness.
Luohan fruit	Clears heat, treats coughs.
Pineapple	Quenches thirst, prevents heatstroke, brings down swellings and removes dampness.
Peach	Treats infection, clears blood clots, prevents constipation.

FIG. 231

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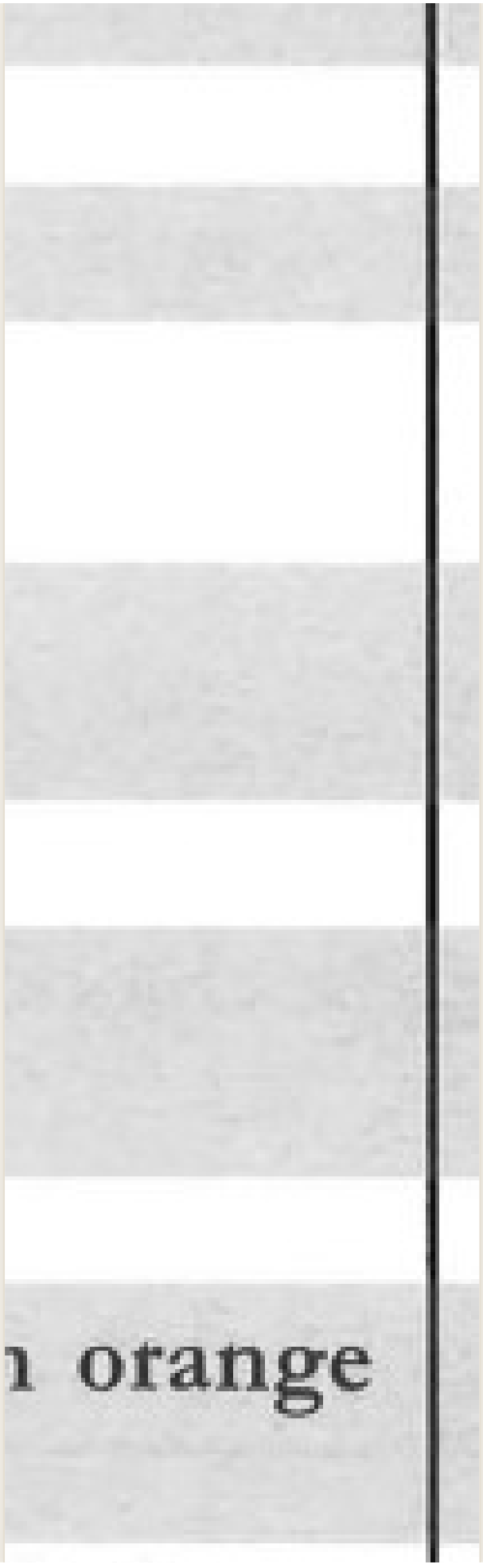

n orange

A tall, narrow cropped fragment of the left-hand column of the Fruits table, showing the alternating shaded and unshaded row bands and the cut-off ends of several fruit names, with "Mandarin orange" legible near the bottom.

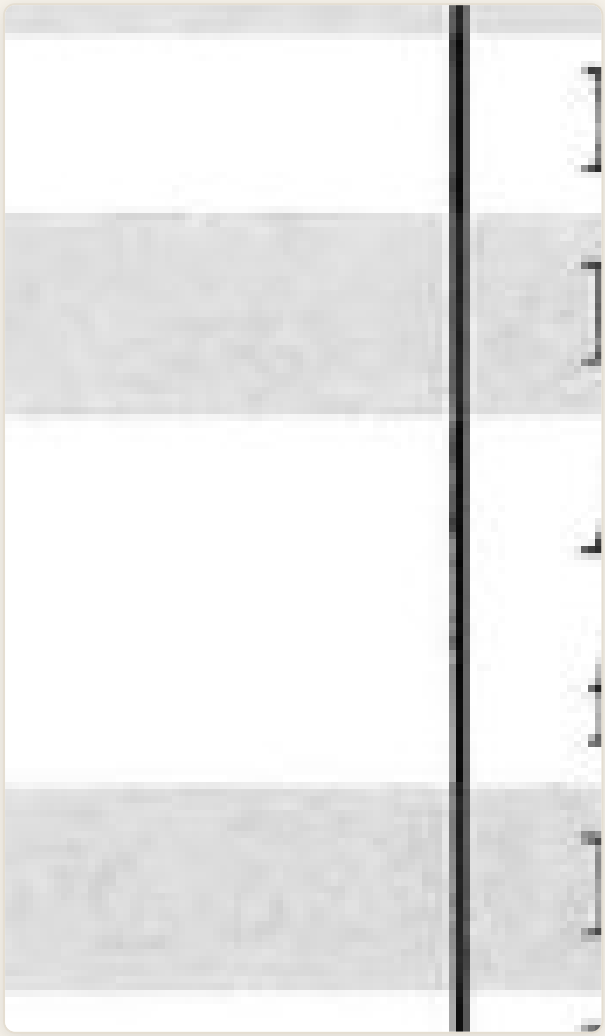
BOOK PAGE 108 · SCAN P117

Trang 108

Others	
Red bean	Diuretic, treats flaccidity of lower limbs and water retention.
Green bean	Diuretic, clears heat.
Sesame	Nourishes the liver and kidneys; promotes blood.
Peanut	Arrests bleeding, improves the complexion, treats flaccidity of lower limbs.
Chestnut	Nourishes the kidneys.
Melon seed	Improves radiance, nourishes the qi.
Walnut	Improves complexion, promotes black hair, replenishes energy.
Olive	Good for hangovers, prevents coughs.
Sweet potato	Strengthens the spleen, stomach and kidneys.
Potato	Lowers blood pressure, treats gastric ulcers, asthma.
Corn	Strengthens one's body, nourishes one's brain, promotes bowel regularity.
Yam	Strengthens the intestines, treats diarrhoea.
Sunflower	Promotes blood, moistens the intestines.
Rose	Benefits qi and promotes blood, clears bruises and relieves pain.
Lily petals	Clears heat, sedative, prevents coughs and clears phlegm.

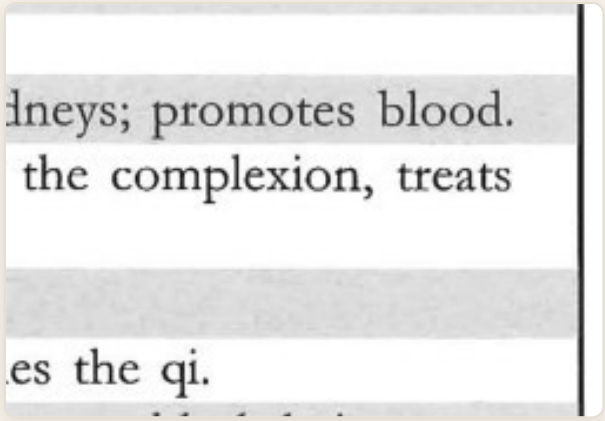
Chrysanthemum flower	Improves vision, clears heat, regulates blood pressure.
Beancurd	Clears the intestines and stomach, nourishes the qi.
Black moss	Nourishes the blood, promotes black hair.

FIG. 232



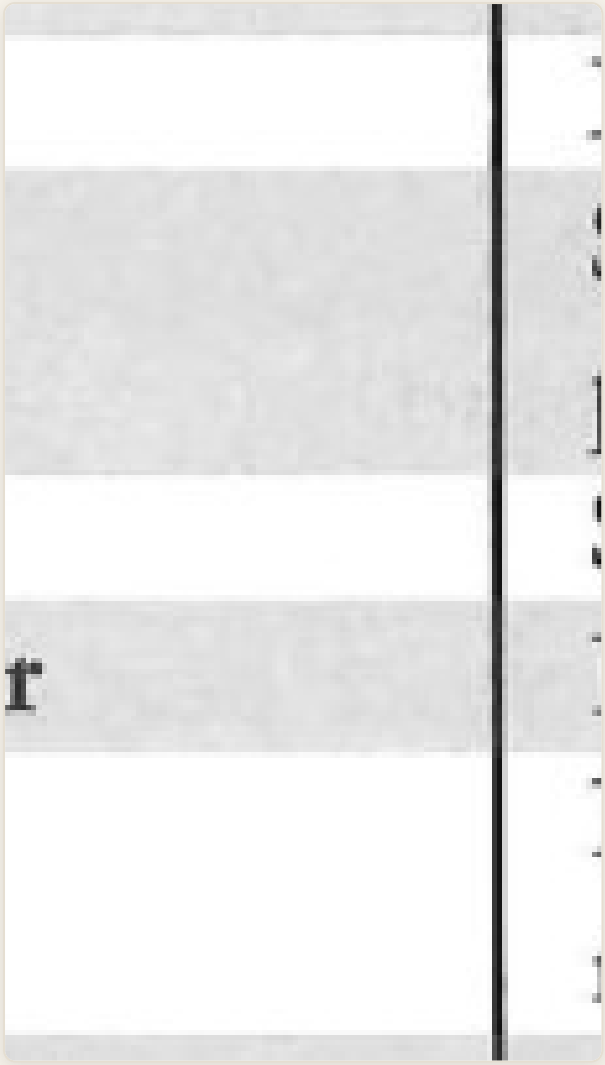
A small cropped fragment of the left-hand column of the Others table, showing the shaded and unshaded row bands and the table's vertical rule.

FIG. 233



A cropped fragment of the right-hand column of the Others table, carrying the cut-off ends of several property descriptions, among them "...dneys; promotes blood." and "...es the qi."

FIG. 234



A narrow cropped fragment of the right-hand column of the Others table, showing the alternating row bands, the table's vertical rule and a stray letter at the edge.

BOOK PAGE 109 · SCAN P118

The Five Flavours of food

The Five Flavours of food

"The five flavours of food are sour, salty, pungent, bitter and sweet. Each flavour benefits a different organ in our body."

"I see! So I just need to keep eating to benefit my body!"

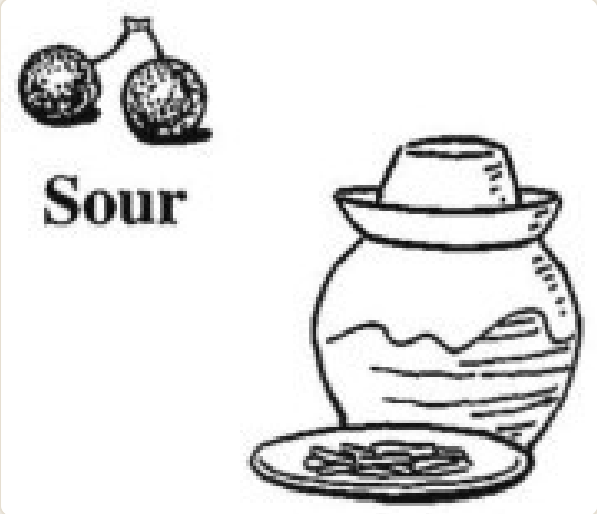
"That's not the right way. The five zang organs work to balance one another."

"If you overeat one type of food, it will cause harm to another organ."

"Eating sour food in moderation benefits the liver. But indulging in it will harm the spleen."

"If the spleen does not function properly, it will affect the kidneys. Bad kidneys will affect the heart and lungs. The lungs will in turn affect the liver. It will be a vicious circle."

FIG. 235



Two small speckled round fruits hanging from a stalk, with the printed word "Sour" beneath them, beside a wide-mouthed jar of salt with a small dish of salt crystals set in front of it.

FIG. 236

A cartoon dragon with a small flower on its head, standing beside a speech balloon with one hand raised in a questioning gesture.

FIG. 237

A line drawing of a bitter gourd, its ridged, warty skin curving to a point at the right, with the printed word "Bitter" above it.

FIG. 238

The middle row of the comic: two cartoon dragons facing each other, each with a speech balloon — the left dragon declaring that it only needs to keep eating to benefit its body, and the right dragon correcting it that the five zang organs work to balance one another; at the right edge a third balloon begins, warning that overeating one kind of food will harm another organ.

FIG. 239

The bottom-left panel of the comic: a cartoon dragon speaking, its balloon explaining that eating sour food in moderation benefits the liver, but that indulging in it harms the spleen.

FIG. 240

The bottom-right panel of the comic: a cartoon dragon with a bow tied at its tail, gesturing as it speaks, its balloon explaining that a spleen that does not work properly will affect the kidneys, that bad kidneys will affect the heart and lungs, and that the lungs will in turn affect the liver — a vicious circle.

BOOK PAGE 110 · SCAN P119

The relationship between the Five Flavours and Five *Zang* Organs:

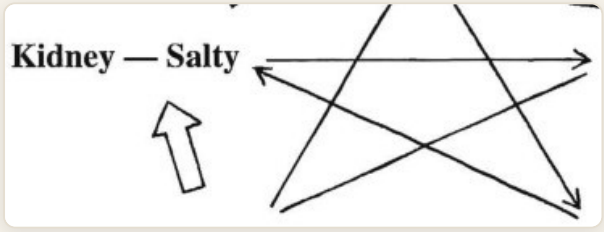
The relationship between the Five Flavours and Five *Zang* Organs:

- - Liver — Sour
- - Heart — Bitter
- - Lung — Pungent
- - Spleen — Sweet
- - Kidney — Salty

Too much of one flavour will do harm to the body:

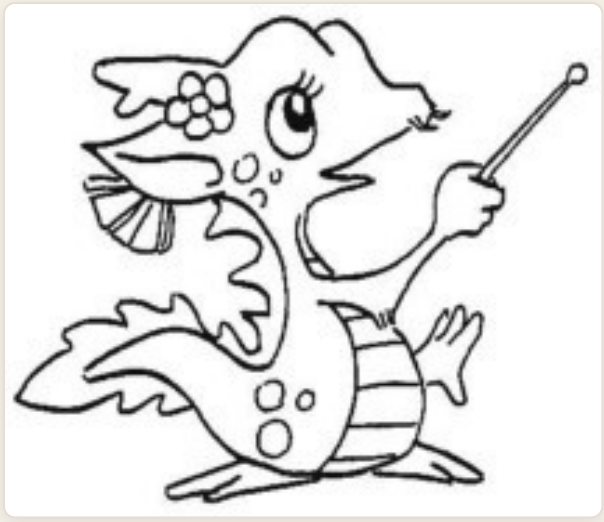
Flavour	Effect
Overly Sour	The skin will become thick and wrinkled. Those with ailments of the muscles and spleen should avoid sour food.
Overly Salty	Causes thirst, thickening of the blood. Those with ailments of the blood and heart should avoid salty food.
Overly Pungent	Causes knotted muscles and brittle nails. Those with ailments of the respiratory system and liver should avoid pungent food.
Overly Bitter	Causes withered skin and hair loss. Those with ailments of the bones and lungs should avoid bitter food.
Overly Sweet	Causes orthopaedic pains and loss of hair. Those with ailments of the flesh and kidneys should avoid sweet food.

FIG. 241



A fragment of the diagram: a five-pointed star drawn with long arrow-tipped lines that cross one another, with the printed label "Kidney — Salty" and a short upward arrow at its left.

FIG. 242



A cartoon dragon holding a long pointer stick raised in one claw, its mouth open as it explains the diagram, a flower tucked on its head and a bow tied at its tail.

BOOK PAGE 111 · SCAN P120

The Four Properties of food

The Four Properties of food

Food can be warm, heaty, cold or cooling.

Warm and heaty foods: mutton, fresh ginger, garlic, carrot, longan, pepper, wine etc.

Uses: Builds the spleen, improves appetite, nourishes the kidneys, nourishes the body.

Cold and cooling foods: duck, crab, beancurd, spinach, bittergourd, pear, green bean etc.

Uses: Clears heatiness, brings down fire, detoxifies.

Foods that are neither warm nor cold: rice, soya bean, pork, carp, mushroom, apple, pumpkin etc.

Uses: Suitable for invalids and convalescents in general.

BOOK PAGE 112 · SCAN P121

Four types of tonic

Four types of tonic

Tonics are usually foods prepared with medicinal properties. They are taken as part of the daily diet, having curative properties for someone who is ill and benefiting a healthy person. Before we take any tonic, we should understand our state of health in order to select one that will improve our health.

Nourishing the qi:

Examples: ginseng, Chinese dates, liquorice etc.

Suitable for people who are easily tired, short of breath, have poor appetite, perspire easily, down with a cold.

Nourishing the blood:

Examples: angelica, *shoudi*, fleeceflower root, wolfberry etc.

Suitable for people who have a pale complexion, get giddy spells and blurred vision easily, and suffer from insomnia.

Nourishing the yin:

Examples: lily bulb, *shashen*, *zhimu*, white fungus etc.

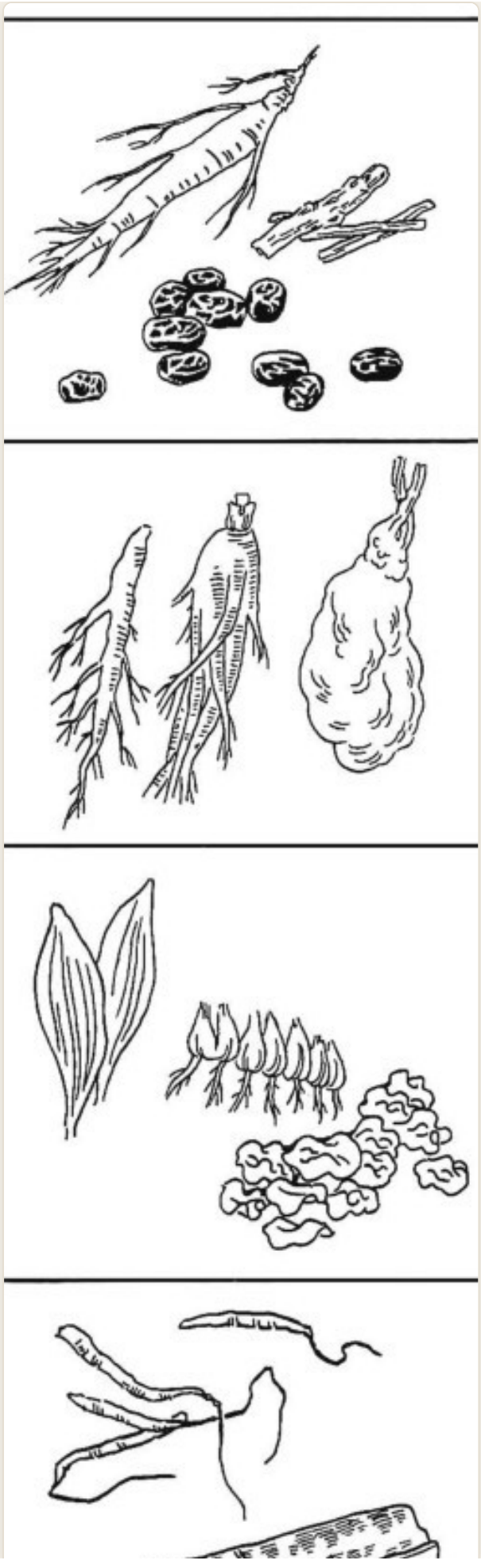
Suitable for people with a weak constitution, insomnia due to stress, constipation, dizzy spells with ringing in the ears, dry mouth.

Nourishing the yang:

Examples: cordyceps, monkshood daughter root, Chinese cinnamon bark etc.

Suitable for people who are afraid of the cold, have cold limbs, weak and aching back and limbs, frequent urination.

FIG. 243



A tall strip cut from the left-hand column of the tonic table, holding the four illustrations of tonic ingredients stacked one above the other: ginseng roots with a bundle of dried sticks and a heap of dark round slices; two branching roots with fine rootlets beside a large bulbous root; a layered lily bulb with a cluster of slender pointed roots and a clump of frilly white fungus; and a long thin rhizome with a caterpillar-shaped cordyceps beside a rolled stick of rough cinnamon bark.

BOOK PAGE 113 · SCAN P122

Food taboos

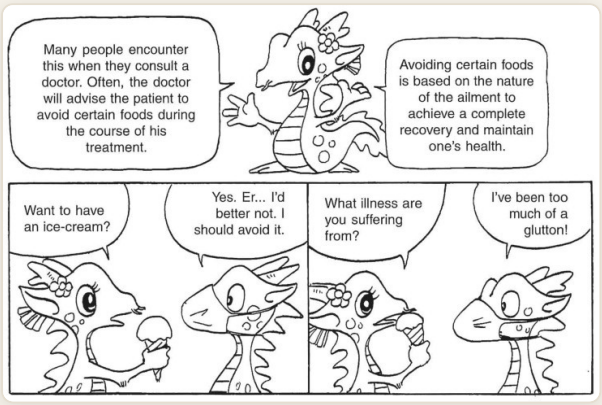
Food taboos

Foods to avoid during an illness

Ailment	Foods to avoid
High fever	Oily and spicy foods.
Insomnia	Strong tea, coffee.
Water retention	Salt.
Cold	Deep-fried foods, sweet foods, wine, chilli, white fungus.
Cough	Deep-fried or fatty foods, wine, pepper, prawn.
Diarrhoea	Fish, prawn, fried and deep-fried foods, fatty meat, fresh ginger, pepper.
Stroke	Salted meat and vegetables, fatty meat, coffee, strong tea.
Constipation	Wine, coffee, chilli, white fungus.
Asthma	Fatty meat, fish, prawn, crab, wine, soya bean, pumpkin, leaf mustard, carbonated drinks.
Diabetes	Sugar, sugar cane, fruit, sweet potato, starch, water chestnut, lotus, yam.
Kidney stones	Shellfish, asparagus, spinach, beancurd, lentil, persimmon.

High blood pressure	Organ meats, crab roe, egg yolk, chilli, wine, strong tea, coffee.
Jaundice	Fatty meat, deep-fried foods, chilli, wine, fish, prawn, crab.
Heart palpitations	Fatty meat, strong tea, coffee.

FIG. 244



The little flower-crowned dragon stands between two speech boxes: the left one says that many people meet this advice when they consult a doctor, who often tells the patient to avoid certain foods during treatment; the right one says that avoiding certain foods follows the nature of the ailment, so as to bring about a complete recovery and keep one in good health. Underneath is a four-panel strip: the dragon offers a cone of ice-cream; the second dragon, though tempted, waves it away and says it had better not; the first dragon asks what illness it is suffering from; and the second dragon admits it has simply been too much of a glutton.

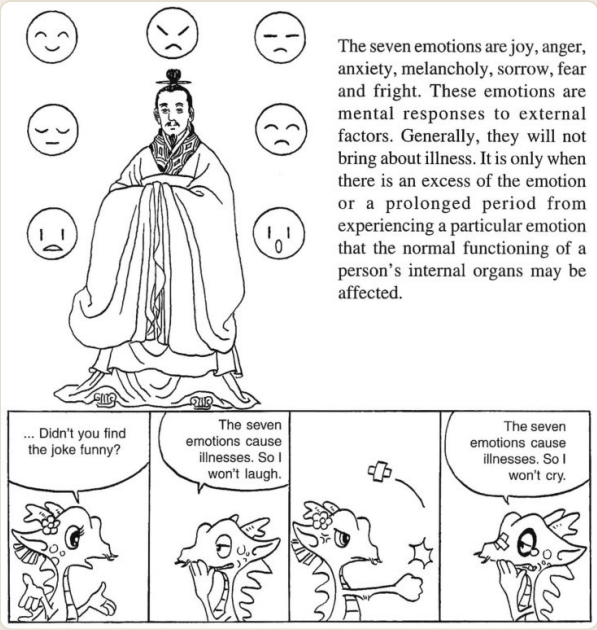
BOOK PAGE 114 · SCAN P123

Method Five — Psychotherapy

Method Five — Psychotherapy

There is a common saying: Ailments of the heart require medicine for the heart. This is in reference to psychological illnesses. Chinese physicians refer to ailments caused by psychological factors as ailments of the seven emotions.

FIG. 245

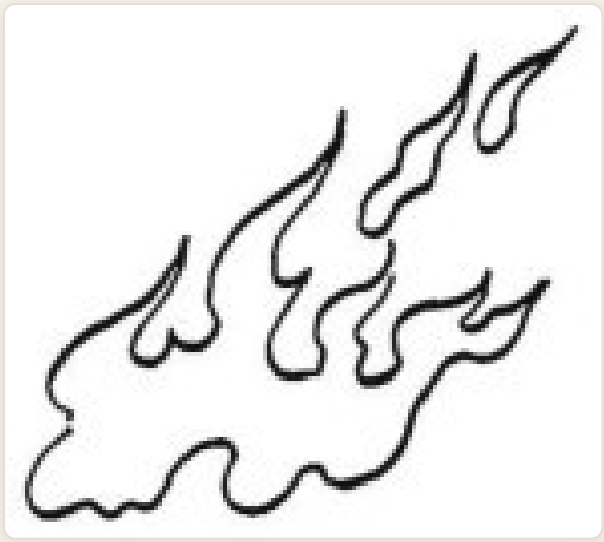


A Chinese physician in flowing robes and a scholar's cap stands with his arms folded. Around him float seven round faces, each showing a different expression: a smile, a scowl, a calm face, a downcast face, a frowning face, a weeping face and a startled face. To his right, a block of text explains that the seven emotions are joy, anger, anxiety, melancholy, sorrow, fear and fright; that they are mental responses to external factors; that normally they do not bring illness; and that only when an emotion becomes excessive, or is experienced for a long time, may the normal functioning of a person's internal organs be affected. Below, a four-panel strip shows the little dragon: puzzled that its friend did not find the joke funny; the friend answering that since the seven emotions cause illnesses it will not laugh; the dragon taking a swing at it with a club; and the friend, in tears, saying that it will not cry either.

The Seven Emotions and their relationship with the Five *Zang* organs and Five Elements

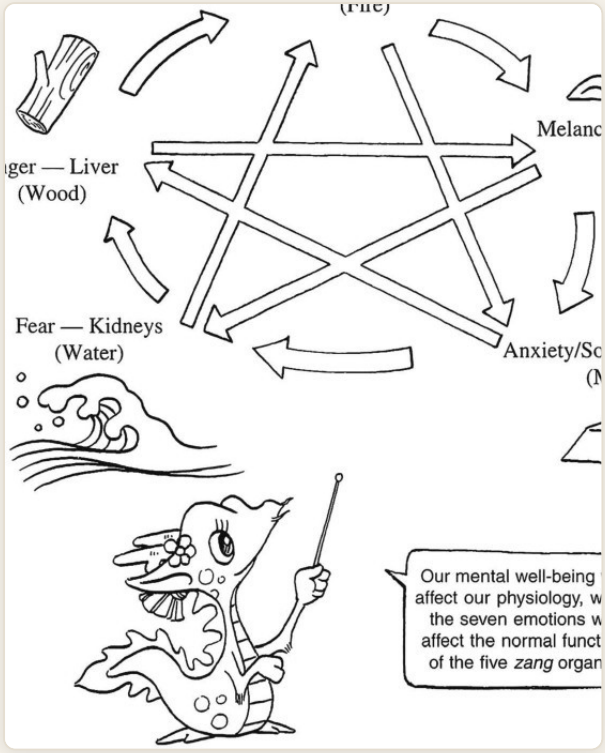
The Seven Emotions and their relationship with the Five *Zang* organs and Five Elements

FIG. 246



A stylised drawing of leaping tongues of flame, the emblem of the Fire element.

FIG. 247

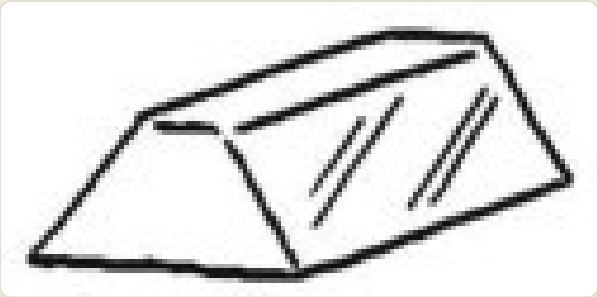


A five-pointed star drawn over a five-element chart. The points are labelled, clockwise from the top: Joy/Fright — Heart (Fire); Melancholy — Spleen (Earth); Anxiety/Sorrow — Lungs (Metal); Fear — Kidneys (Water); Anger — Liver (Wood). Broad curved arrows run from one point to the next around the outside of the star, and straight lines criss-cross the inside. Beside the chart are drawings of a split log for Wood and of a breaking wave for Water. At the lower left the little dragon points with a stick at a speech box which says that our mental well-being affects our physiology, while the seven emotions affect the normal function of the five zang organs.

FIG. 248

A small drawing of two rounded hills, the emblem of the Earth element.

FIG. 249



A small drawing of a wedge-shaped metal ingot, the emblem of the Metal element.

BOOK PAGE 116 · SCAN P125

Trang 116

Joy is detrimental to the Heart

There is a saying: "Sorrow grows out of excessive joy." Though joy is an expression of happiness, too much of it will expend our vitality and qi, doing damage to the heart.

FIG. 251

A portrait of a man in ancient dress with his hair gathered into a topknot, laughing heartily with his mouth wide open and his eyes squeezed shut.

Fright is detrimental to the Heart

Fright is when a sudden occurrence causes feelings of nervousness and fear. The heartbeat will go faster, adding burden to the heart.

FIG. 252

A portrait of a startled young boy, his head shaven except for a small tuft of hair, clutching his chest with both hands; beads of sweat fly from his head and his eyes are wide with alarm.

Anger is detrimental to the Liver

Anger is the feeling of agitation, which causes the qi to flow in reverse and travel in the upward direction. This may do harm to the qi in the liver.

FIG. 250

A portrait of a burly, bald-headed man with a fierce scowl and clenched fists, tongues of flame leaping from the top of his head.

Melancholy is detrimental to the Spleen

Indulgence in melancholy or sentimentality will lead to depression and cause loss of appetite, doing harm to the qi in the spleen.

FIG. 255

A portrait of a woman with an elaborate coiled hairstyle and a flower ornament, resting her chin on her hand with a downcast, wistful expression.

Sorrow is detrimental to the Heart and Lungs

Sorrow is an expression of sadness and a troubled mind. Indulgence in sorrow will hurt the heart and the lungs.

FIG. 254

A portrait of a woman with her hair in a bun, pressing a cloth to her face as she weeps quietly.

Fear is detrimental to the Kidneys

Fear is terror or dread. It is the extreme expression of nervousness and will harm the kidneys.

FIG. 253

A portrait of a man wrapped in a head-cloth, huddled up with his hands held to his mouth and his teeth chattering; wavy lines of cold rise around him.

BOOK PAGE 117 · SCAN P126

Overcoming or countering one emotion with another

Overcoming or countering one emotion with another

As ailments of the heart require heart medicine, medicines will not do the job of treating the ailment. It is only by adjusting the emotions that the best treatment is achieved.

The seven emotions promote and restrain one another. One type of emotion will lead to another emotion:

Over-indulgence in melancholy and anxiety → Sorrowful and pessimistic disposition → Timidity, fear

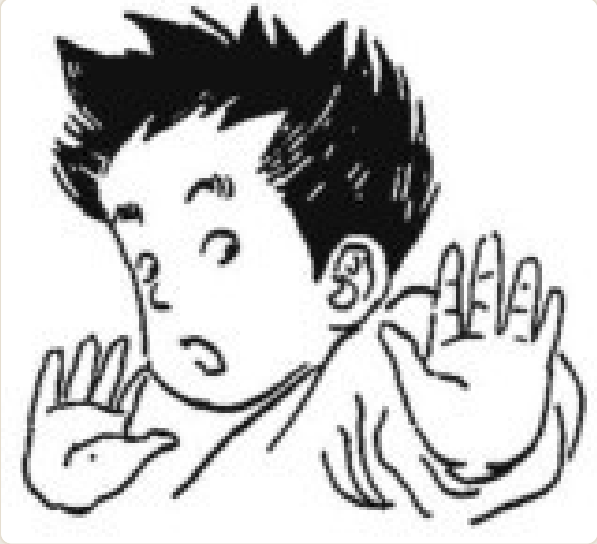
FIG. 256

The first portrait of a three-part chain: a man resting his chin on his hand with a brooding, frowning look and a squiggle of irritation rising above his head.

FIG. 258

The second portrait of the chain: a sorrowful youth with drooping eyes and a down-turned mouth, a small arrow entering from the left.

FIG. 257



The third portrait of the chain: a startled young man with spiky hair raising both palms in front of him, his mouth open in alarm.

The method of overcoming one emotion with another involves curbing one emotion with another:

Sorrow overcomes anger: Sadness will cause feelings of anger to dissipate. It may be used to treat ailments arising from anger.

Anger overcomes melancholy: A melancholy person may be provoked to ease the tension within him.

Melancholy overcomes fear: Melancholy promotes rationality, thus irrational fear may be overcome through reasoning.

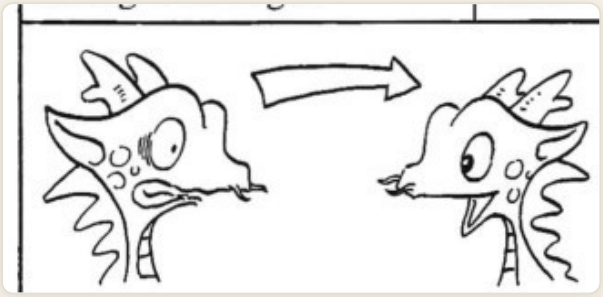
Fear overcomes joy: Frightening a patient who has been consumed by excessive joy will calm him down.

Joy overcomes sorrow: Take care of the patient and meet his needs so that he may feel joy. This will curb any sorrow he may be feeling.

FIG. 259

The upper row of the diagram: three panels side by side, each showing a pair of little dragons with a hollow arrow pointing from left to right between them, illustrating one emotion curbing another.

FIG. 260



A panel from the lower row of the diagram: two little dragons with a hollow arrow between them, the left one glaring with its mouth open while the right one smiles.

BOOK PAGE 118 · SCAN P127

The Famous Physician Who Was Cooked

The Famous Physician Who Was Cooked

There was a famous physician called Wen Zhi during the Spring and Summer Period. One day, he was summoned to treat King of Qi who was suffering from headaches.

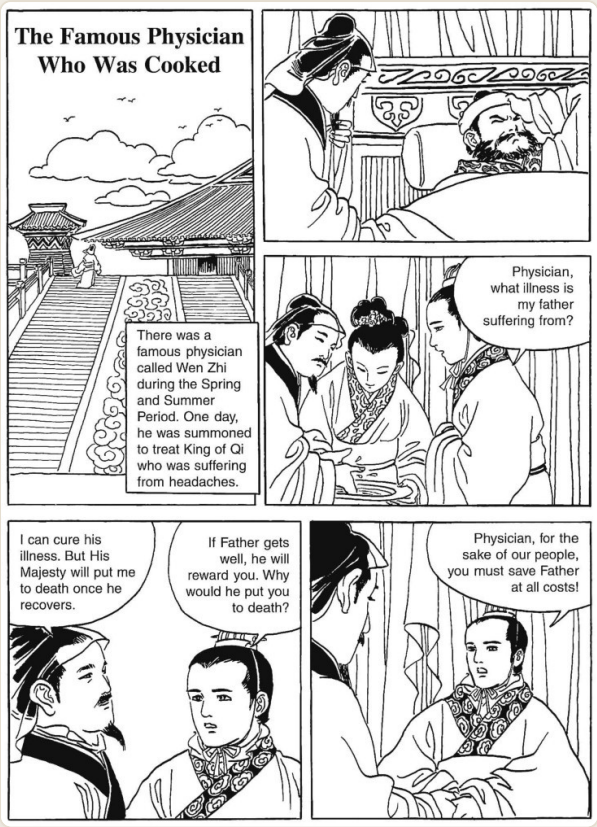
"Physician, what illness is my father suffering from?"

"I can cure his illness. But His Majesty will put me to death once he recovers."

"If Father gets well, he will reward you. Why would he put you to death?"

"Physician, for the sake of our people, you must save Father at all costs!"

FIG. 261



The full-page comic. Top-left panel: the title and a view of the palace courtyard, with its roofed gate and long flight of steps, and a text box at the lower right giving the narration. Top-right panel: Wen Zhi, in a scholar's cap, bends over the King of Qi, who lies in bed with a cloth over his brow. Middle-right panel: Wen Zhi and two attendants wait on the king while the young prince asks his question. Bottom-left panel: Wen Zhi and the prince talk face to face. Bottom-right panel: the prince pleads with Wen Zhi to save his father.

BOOK PAGE 119 · SCAN P128

Trang 119

"But promise me one thing. No matter what I do, you are not to interfere."

"All right."

After Wen Zhi went home, he stopped going to the palace to treat the king.

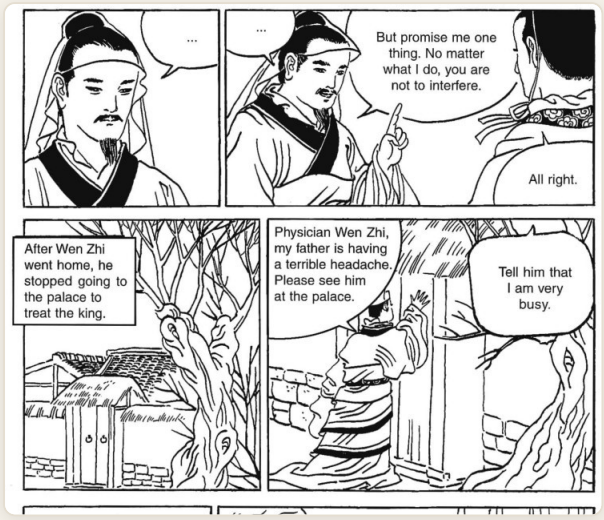
"Physician Wen Zhi, my father is having a terrible headache. Please see him at the palace."

"Tell him that I am very busy."

"That lowly physician actually has the audacity to snub me!"

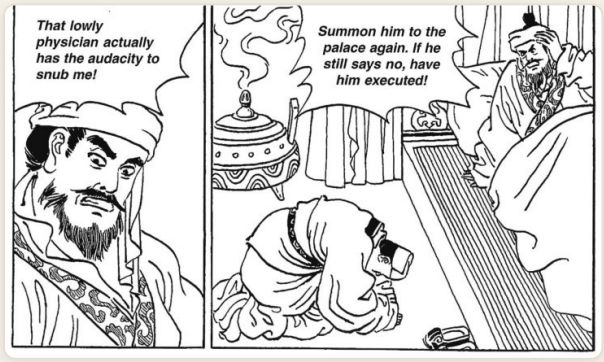
"Summon him to the palace again. If he still says no, have him executed!"

FIG. 262



The upper part of the comic. Left panel: a close-up of Wen Zhi with lowered eyes, his speech bubble holding only an ellipsis. Right panel: Wen Zhi raises a finger as he sets his one condition, while the prince, seen from behind, answers "All right." Lower-left panel: Wen Zhi's house standing behind a gnarled tree, with the narration box beside it. Lower-right panel: a messenger stands at the gate reporting the king's headache, and Wen Zhi's reply comes from behind the door.

FIG. 263



The lower row of the comic. Left panel: a close-up of a bearded, angry man who feels he has been snubbed. Right panel: the King of Qi seated on his throne orders the physician to be summoned, while a messenger kneels and bows low before him.

Trang 120

Wen Zhi finally showed up at the palace. But he stepped on the King of Qi's bed with his shoes on.

"You're still alive? By the looks of you, your days are numbered!"

"You! You!"

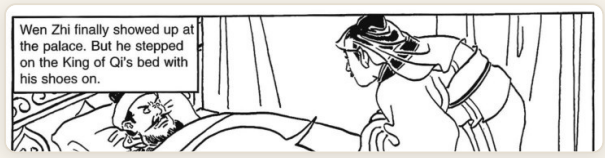
"What's the point of consulting a physician? You're wasting my time!"

"Audacious fellow! Men, I want this horrible physician cooked in a pot!"

"Father, you've made a full recovery!"

In his extreme anger, the headaches King of Qi suffered had subsided.

FIG. 264



The top strip of the comic: the narration box on the left, and to its right Wen Zhi standing beside the King of Qi's bed, the king lying propped on his pillow beneath a curtained canopy.

FIG. 265

The rest of the comic. Top panel: Wen Zhi taunts the king on his sickbed, the speech bubble carrying his insult. Middle-left panel: the King, furious, points and shouts "You! You!". Middle-right panel: Wen Zhi turns away with a dismissive gesture. Bottom-left panel: the King, seated, orders that the physician be cooked in a pot. Bottom-right panel: the prince tells the king that he has made a full recovery, with a narration box beneath.

BOOK PAGE 121 · SCAN P130

Trang 121

"Do spare the physician's life."

"Anyone who pleads for mercy on his behalf will be cooked as well!"

"Physician Wen Zhi..."

"Do not be sad. I knew this day would come. Now that His Majesty has recovered fully, I can die with no regrets."

"A few days later..."

"Physician Wen Zhi agitated you on purpose to treat your headache."

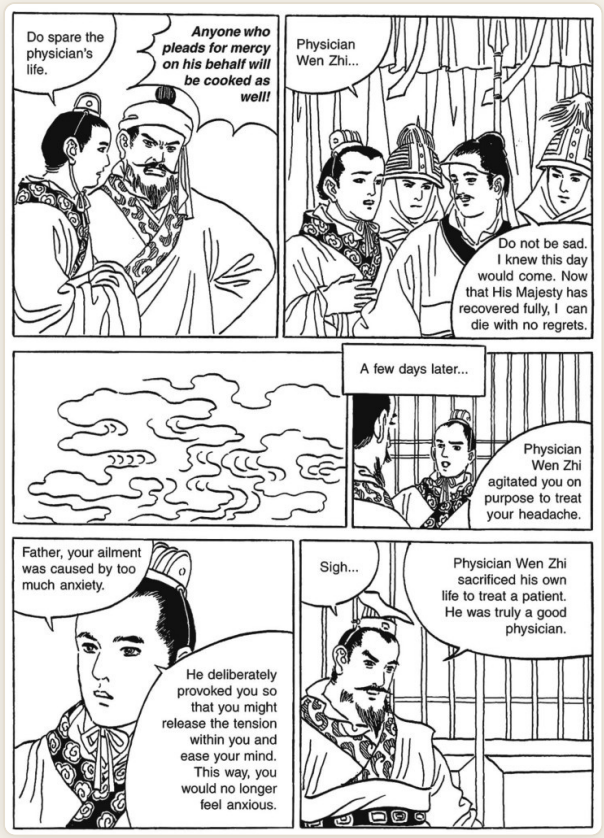
"Father, your ailment was caused by too much anxiety."

"He deliberately provoked you so that you might release the tension within you and ease your mind. This way, you would no longer feel anxious."

"Sigh..."

"Physician Wen Zhi sacrificed his own life to treat a patient. He was truly a good physician."

FIG. 266



The whole page is a single comic strip in three rows, continuing the story of the physician Wen Zhi. In the top-left panel a young man in a patterned robe clasps his hands and begs the king, who wears a beaded cap and a long beard, to spare the physician's life; the king angrily refuses, saying that anyone who pleads for mercy on his behalf will be cooked as well. In the top-right panel soldiers in armour stand guard around Wen Zhi, who smiles calmly as he is told he is to die and answers that he knew this day would come and can now die with no regrets since His Majesty has recovered. The middle-left panel is a wordless landscape of rolling clouds. In the middle-right panel a caption reads "A few days later...", and behind a barred window a figure explains to the prince that Wen Zhi deliberately agitated him in order to cure his headache. In the bottom-left panel the prince, seated with a downcast look, is told that his father's illness was caused by too much anxiety and that Wen Zhi provoked him on purpose so that he might release the tension inside him and ease his mind. In the bottom-right panel the king stands behind bars with a heavy sigh, and a speech bubble says that Wen Zhi sacrificed his own life to treat a patient and was truly a good physician.

Types of dispositions in traditional Chinese medicine

Types of dispositions in traditional Chinese medicine

Personalities can also be categorised based on the yin-yang and five elements to create the five *tai* personalities and the five elemental personalities respectively.

The Five *Tai* Personalities

Taiyang Person

- - Characteristics: Easy-going, talks without thinking first, aims too high in life.
- - Appearance: Walks with head high and chest out, stomach in and straight back.

Shaoyang Person

- - Characteristics: Good socializing skill, strong abilities, self-conceited.
- - Appearance: Head lifted high while standing, walks with a swagger, has a habit of placing both hands on the back with palms facing outwards.

Yinyang-heping Person

- - Characteristics: Pure in heart and has few desires, contented, composed, adaptable.
- - Appearance: Calm countenance, poised with an easy manner.

Shaoyin Person

- - Characteristics: Greedy, gossipy, lacks compassion for others.
- - Appearance: Aloof mien, secretive, walks quietly, fidgets while standing.

Taiyin Person

- - Characteristics: Shrewd and deep, doesn't show emotions easily, acts slowly, persists in his old ways.
- - Appearance: Brooding mien, seldom smiles, seems always to be in deep thought.

FIG. 267

A line-drawn portrait, head and shoulders, of the Taiyang type: a man whose hair is gathered into a topknot on the crown, with thick dark eyebrows, a firm direct gaze and a dark collar on his robe, his head turned slightly to the side.

FIG. 268

A line-drawn portrait, head and shoulders, of the Shaoyang type: a man with a piece of cloth tied over his topknot and hanging down at the back, chin lifted, eyes looking up and away, wearing a robe with a bold patterned collar.

FIG. 269

Three line-drawn portraits stacked one above the other. The top one is the Yinyang-heping type: a bearded man in a soft cloth cap with ear flaps and a patterned robe, his expression calm and composed. The middle one is the Shaoyin type: a man with a topknot and a sidelong, aloof glance, the corner of his mouth turned down. The bottom one is the Taiyin type: a man in a dark checkered cap with a moustache and beard, his brows drawn down in a brooding frown.

The Five Elemental Personalities

The Five Elemental Personalities

Fire Element

- - Characteristics: A quick worker, able to take stress, capable, generous and thinks little of money.
- - Appearance: Ruddy complexion, thin face, small head, small hands and feet.

Metal Element

- - Characteristics: Both quiet and active, shrewd worker, honest.
- - Appearance: Pale complexion, square face, small head, small shoulders, small abdomen.

Earth Element

- - Characteristics: Trustworthy, keeps his emotions in check, helpful.
- - Appearance: Yellowish complexion, round face, big head, thick shoulder and back, large abdomen, small hands and feet.

Wood Element

- - Characteristics: Talented and intelligent, introspective, melancholic, acts with motives.
- - Appearance: Pale complexion, long face and small head, broad shoulders and back, small hands and feet.

Water Element

- - Characteristics: Active, indecisive.

- - Appearance: Dark complexion, big head, small shoulders, large abdomen.

FIG. 270

Two line-drawn portraits stacked one above the other. The upper one is the Fire Element type: a man with a topknot, thick dark eyebrows and a slight smile, a long thin face and a

dark collar. The lower one is the Metal Element type: a young man with a tuft of hair bound up on top of his head, a squarish face and a rounded, patterned collar.

FIG. 271

A line-drawn portrait of the Earth Element type: a plump, round-faced man with a broad smile, a small topknot fixed with a hairpin on the crown of his head, and shoulders covered by a striped garment.

FIG. 272

A line-drawn portrait of the Wood Element type: a man in a dark cloth cap, with a long thin face, a moustache and a small beard, his brows slightly drawn and his gaze turned to the side.

FIG. 273

A line-drawn portrait of the Water Element type: a man with a large head and a topknot tied with a small strip of cloth standing up above it, thick eyebrows, wide open eyes and a dark-bordered robe.

BOOK PAGE 124 · SCAN P133

Diagnosis of illnesses through dream analysis

Diagnosis of illnesses through dream analysis

Our dreams are often tied to our emotional state, real-life experiences and encounters and our physical, among others. That is why dreams are able to reflect a person's state of health.

In *The Yellow Emperor's Medicine Classic — Miraculous Pivot*, dreams are classified in detail to diagnose illnesses.

Dream	State of Health
Fearful dream	Deficiency of qi in the heart and gallbladder, prolonged illness, excessive anxiety.

Angry dream	Stagnation of qi in the liver and gallbladder, as in hardening of the liver or the presence of gallstones.
Happy dream	Smooth flow of qi and blood, speedy recovery even if one should fall ill.
Sad dream	Deficiency of qi in the heart and lungs, deficiency of yin in the liver as with chronic liver disease and tuberculosis.
Melancholic dream	Imbalance in the liver and spleen, possibly due to poor food digestion and gastric ulcers.
Striving dream	Reverse flow of qi in the liver and gallbladder, rising of the yang in the liver as occurs with hypertension and poor food digestion.
Floating in dream	Excess in the upper part of body but deficiency in the lower part, like deficiency of the kidneys, excess phlegm, coronary heart disease.
Falling in dream	Deficiency in the upper part but excess in the lower part of the body. Often seen in water retention of the kidneys, deficiency of the yang in the heart.
Looking for food	Weak spleen and strong stomach, deficiency of yin in the stomach with pathogenic heat, gastric ulcers, intestinal parasites.
Looking for toilet	Often caused by stranguria (painful urination), inflammation of the intestines, poor digestion, diarrhoea.
Looking for drink	Mostly caused by excess yang and depletion of bodily fluids like due to high fever and dehydration.
Feeling cold in dream	Insufficient yang and heat, excess of yin and cold. Examples are deficiency of yang in the spleen and kidneys, interior cold syndrome.
Sleepwalking	Usually caused by stagnation of qi in the liver, distractions.

Traditional music therapy

Traditional music therapy

With the growing acceptance of alternative treatments, music therapy has gained much attention. In fact, ancient physicians did considerable research on music therapy.

There are five notes in ancient Chinese music: *gong*, *shang*, *jiao*, *zhi*, *yu*. Chinese physicians matched each of these notes to a zang organ:

Gong (Do) — Spleen — Mediating nature

The note 'do' gives one a sense of calm and seriousness. It is used to treat someone who has been given a fright and is thus fidgety.

Shang (Re) — Lungs — Clearing nature

This clear and quiet note is used to treat someone suffering from anxiety and irritability.

Jiao (Mi) — Liver — Soothing nature

It creates a sense of softness, comfort and relaxation. It is used to dispel anger.

Zhi (Sol) — Heart — Invigorating nature

This note gives a sense of excitement and passion. It is used to treat someone with depression.

Yu (La) — Kidneys — Cooling and moistening nature

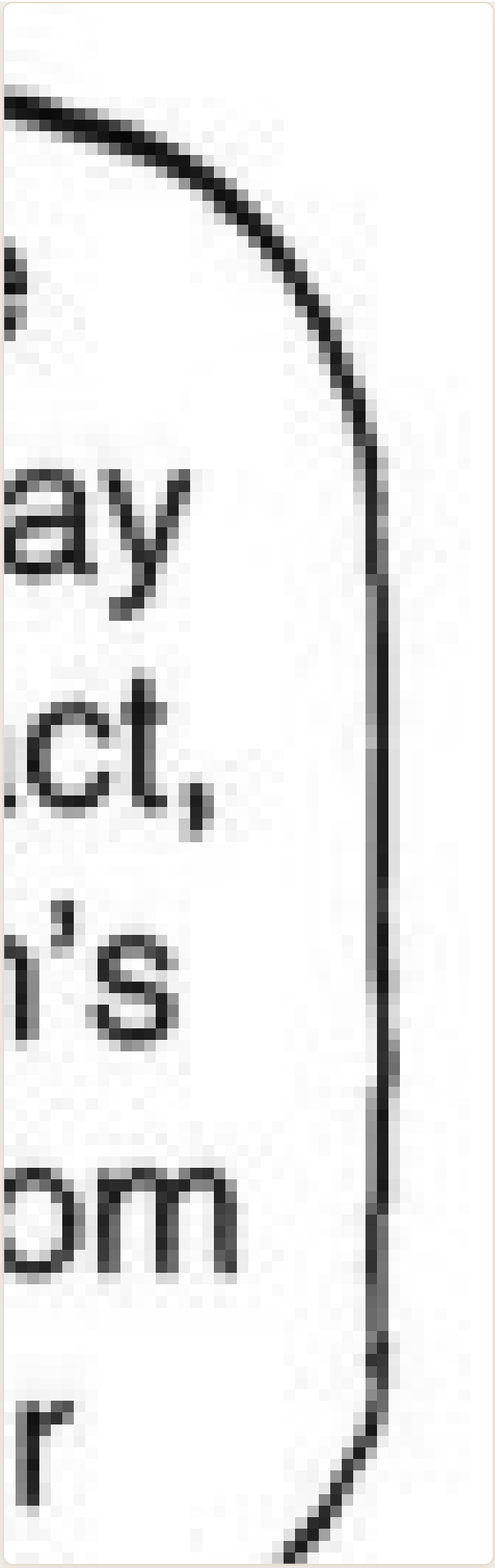
It is a melancholic note and acts as a sedative. It may be used to treat insomnia due to excessive joy or sorrow, heart palpitations etc.

"The ancient Chinese believed that music may cultivate a person. In fact, we may read a person's mood and character from the music he plays or listens to."

FIG. 274

A line drawing of a Chinese scholar with a cloth band tied over his topknot and a dark-edged robe; five-line musical staves with notes curl through the air on both sides of him, one stave running to his left and another floating to his right.

FIG. 275


ay
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A narrow vertical crop showing the left edge of the little dragon's speech bubble, with only a few fragments of the printed words visible along the outline.

FIG. 276

The little dragon sits at a long stringed instrument like a zither, its hands resting on the strings, and turns its head to the right to speak; a large speech bubble beside it carries its comment that the ancient Chinese believed music could cultivate a person and that one can read a person's mood and character from the music he plays or listens to.

BOOK PAGE 126 · SCAN P135

Method Six — Qigong

Method Six — Qigong

Traditional Chinese medicine holds that the human body consists of vital essences, vital energy and mentality. Qi or vital energy is the force that maintains normal physiological functioning. All activities of the *zang* and *fu* organs of the human body require qi.

There is congenital qi and acquired qi. Congenital qi begins in the mother's womb. It is the basic source of life. It is also called the Primordial Energy or Genuine Energy. Acquired qi is derived from air, food and other sources. Congenital qi depends on nourishment from acquired qi to carry out its functions.

FIG. 277

A solid black silhouette of a person standing with the legs apart and both arms stretched out wide, surrounded by sweeping curved lines that suggest energy swirling around the body. Three printed labels are laid over the figure: "Vital Essences" above the head, "Vital Energy" across the chest, and "Mentality" across the lower body.

BOOK PAGE 127 · SCAN P136

Trang 127

When there is insufficient qi, the person will be listless, suffer general poor health and be susceptible to infectious diseases. By boosting the qi in the body, the functions of the *zang* and *fu* organs will be strengthened and the person will also become more energetic. But if the flow of qi is blocked or stagnates in the *zang* and *fu* organs, it will result in ailments of the body. That is why a smooth flow of qi is important for ensuring good health.

Deficiency of qi	Disruption in qi system
Stuttering speech	Easily agitated (depression of qi leading towards fiery disposition)
Feeling weak all over	Irritable and fidgety (depression of qi)
Pessimistic	Cough and shortness of breath (reversed flow of qi)
Gets tired easily	Bloated abdomen (stagnant qi)

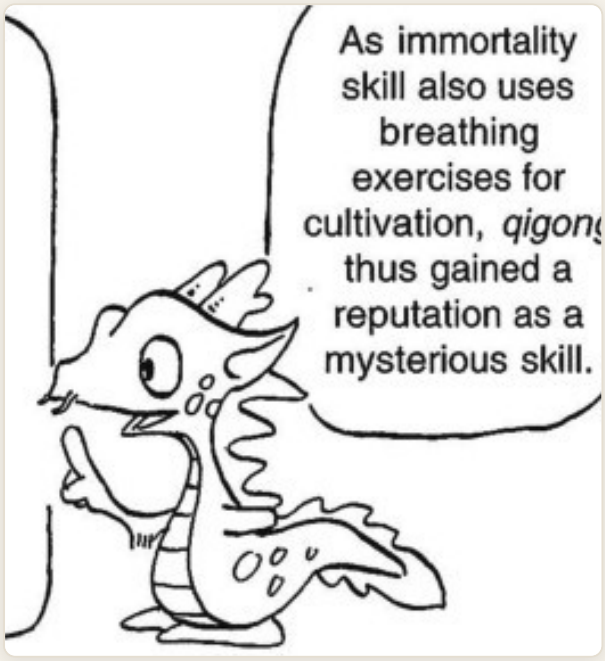
Thin and weak breathing	Breathing difficulty (stagnant qi)
Panting and shortness of breath	Nausea (reversed flow of qi)

The practice of *qigong* will increase or boost vitality, thereby clearing the collaterals and meridians, replenishing qi in the blood, as well as harmonising yin and yang. It will treat diseases and boost the health of a healthy person.

"Qigong is not some mystic skill. It strengthens one's body and extends one's lifespan through the regulation of qi in the body. It's all very scientific."

At present, the US, Germany, Japan and other countries have set up research bodies on *qigong*. Many non-Chinese have also taken up *taijiquan* (tai chi) and meditation.

FIG. 278



The little dragon on the right of the strip stands upright on its hind legs and turns its head back over its shoulder to speak, one small forepaw raised; the speech bubble beside it explains that because immortality practices also use breathing exercises for cultivation, qigong came to be regarded as a mysterious skill.

FIG. 279

The little dragon on the left, with a small flower on its head, stands with one paw lifted as it asks its question; the speech bubble above it wonders whether qigong is really so amazing, whether simply taking in air and moving one's limbs can cure diseases and improve one's health.

BOOK PAGE 128 · SCAN P137

Trang 128

Qigong may be broadly grouped into two categories

Internal exercise

Also known as static *qigong*, it emphasizes the training of the mental state. Methods include meditation, breathing exercises, relaxation etc.

External exercise

Also known as dynamic *qigong*. It promotes circulation of qi and blood through exercising one's muscles. Methods include gentle exercises like *taijiquan*, massage, conduction of qi etc.

Whether it is dynamic *qigong* or static *qigong*, the emphasis lies in the regulation of the body, breathing and heart.

BOOK PAGE 129 · SCAN P138

Trang 129

The effects of practising *qigong*

- - A small abdomen and limbs that are warm to the touch.
- - Slight perspiration.
- - Increased salivation.
- - The movement of the stomach and intestines becomes faster, resulting in a higher frequency of breaking wind.
- - Increased appetite.
- - Good sleep.
- - A clear mind.
- - The body feels light.

If *qigong* is practised correctly, there will be changes to one's physiological state. These changes are known as the effects of *qigong*.

When I practise internal exercise, it feels like worms are crawling on my skin.

Is that normal?

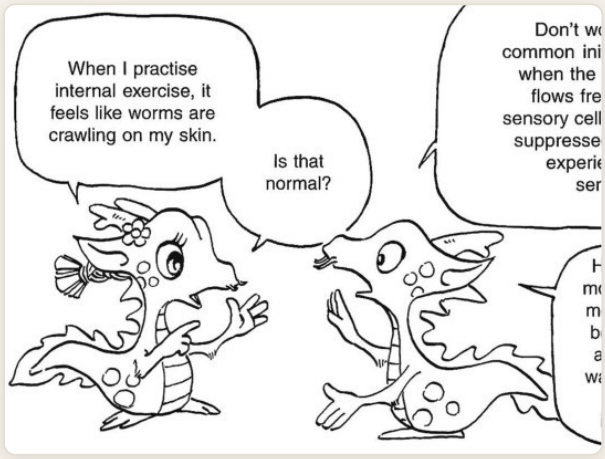
Don't worry. That is a common initial phenomenon when the *qi* in your body flows freely. When the sensory cells in the brain are suppressed, your skin will experience certain sensations.

Hence, your skin is more sensitive to any movement within the body. Do not be too alarmed. You don't want to be distracted while practising internal exercise.

FIG. 280

Drawing of a dragon in a dynamic pose, illustrating free flow of qi through the body.

FIG. 281



Two dragons talking: one says it feels like worms are crawling on its skin when it practises internal exercise, and asks whether that is normal; the other explains it is a common initial phenomenon of freely flowing qi.

Trang 130

The Origins of Qigong

The premise of *qigong* lies in the movement of the limbs. It is believed that *qigong* had its beginnings in Stone Age dances.

At that time, the cold and damp conditions often caused stagnation of blood and brought discomfort to the muscles and bones.

Ah! It is freezing cold! My hands and legs are getting stiff!

Yes! My joints are aching.

Let's see if moving my limbs will ease the discomfort.

Ah! It works! My body feels warmer now!

My arms and legs no longer feel numb!

The people gained inspiration from the movements of limbs and the ancient dance was born. Some of the movements were not lost to time and were further adapted to become *qigong* that promotes well-being and has therapeutic properties.

FIG. 282

Full-page comic: "The Origins of Qigong" — Stone Age people, suffering from cold and stiff joints, move their limbs in dance-like motions, discover it eases their discomfort, and that ancient dance becomes the origin of qigong.

BOOK PAGE 131 · SCAN P140

Cupping

Special Treatments

Other than the different methods of treatment introduced in the earlier pages, there are also special and highly unique therapeutic methods practised among the Chinese people.

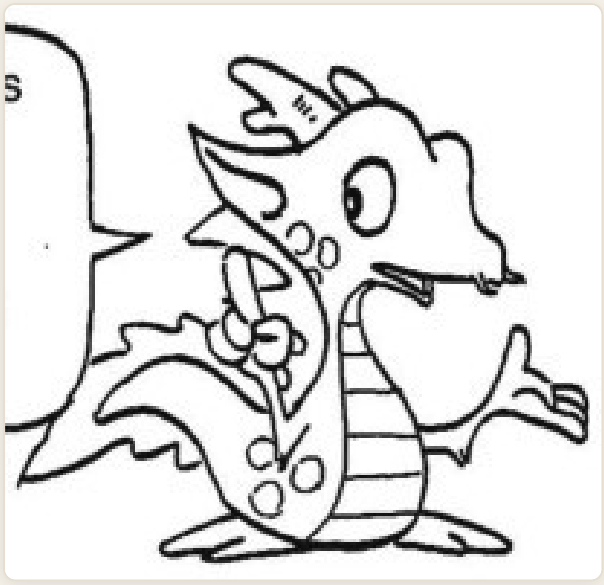
Examples are cupping, scraping and bloodletting.

Cupping

A small flame is placed inside a cup for a short while to heat it and expel any air within the cup. Using the principle of a vacuum, the cup is then sucked onto the skin surface to create local congestion in order to treat the ailment. This method is used in the treatment of rheumatism,

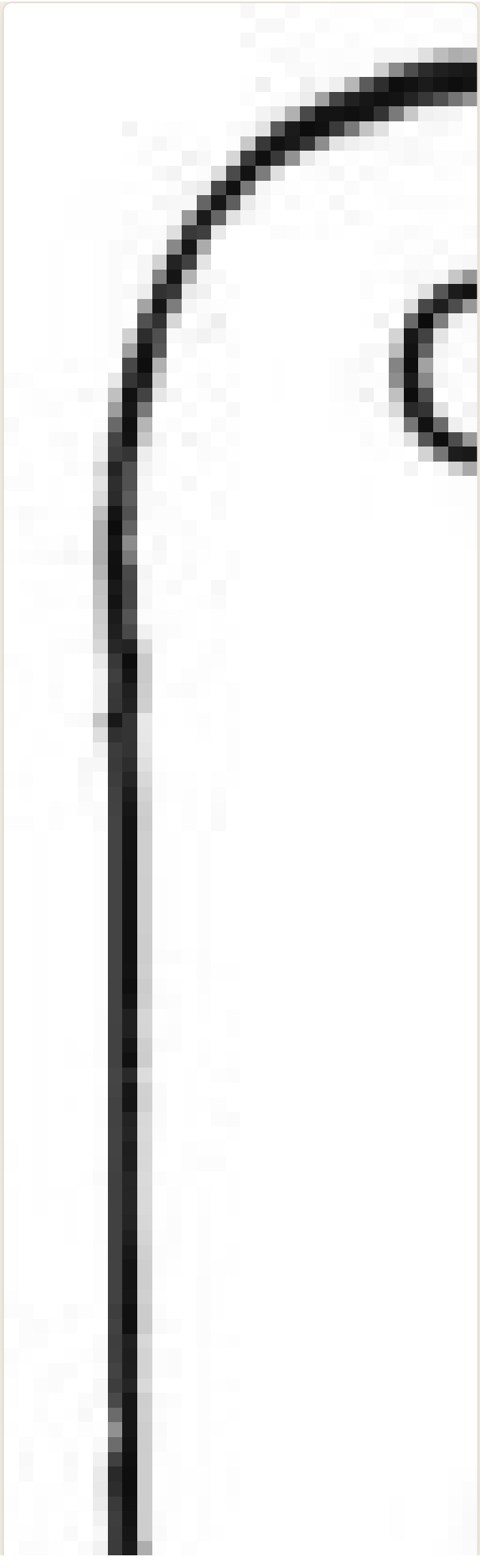
expulsion of toxins and excess heat, to promote circulation of *qi* and blood, reduce swelling and relieve pain.

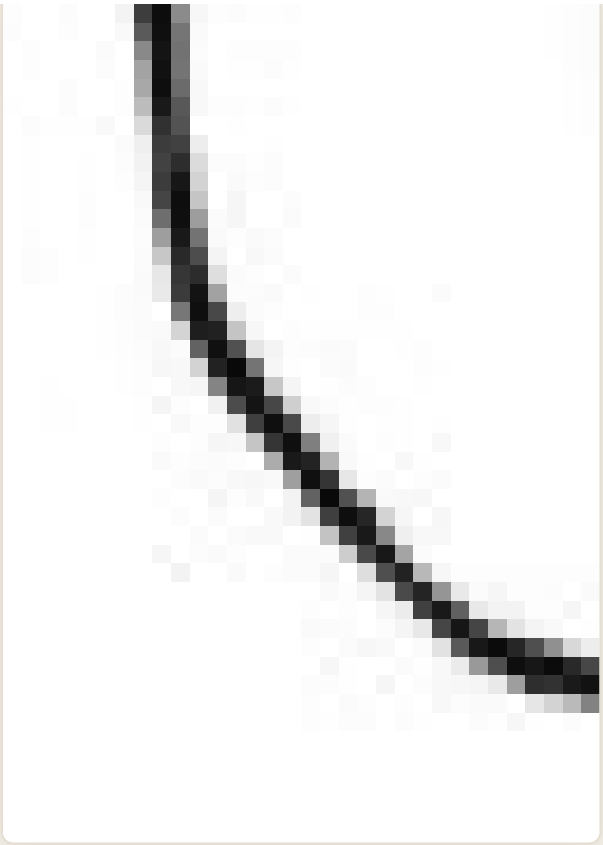
FIG. 283



A gourd (calabash), the traditional emblem of Chinese medicine, alongside the heading "Special Treatments".

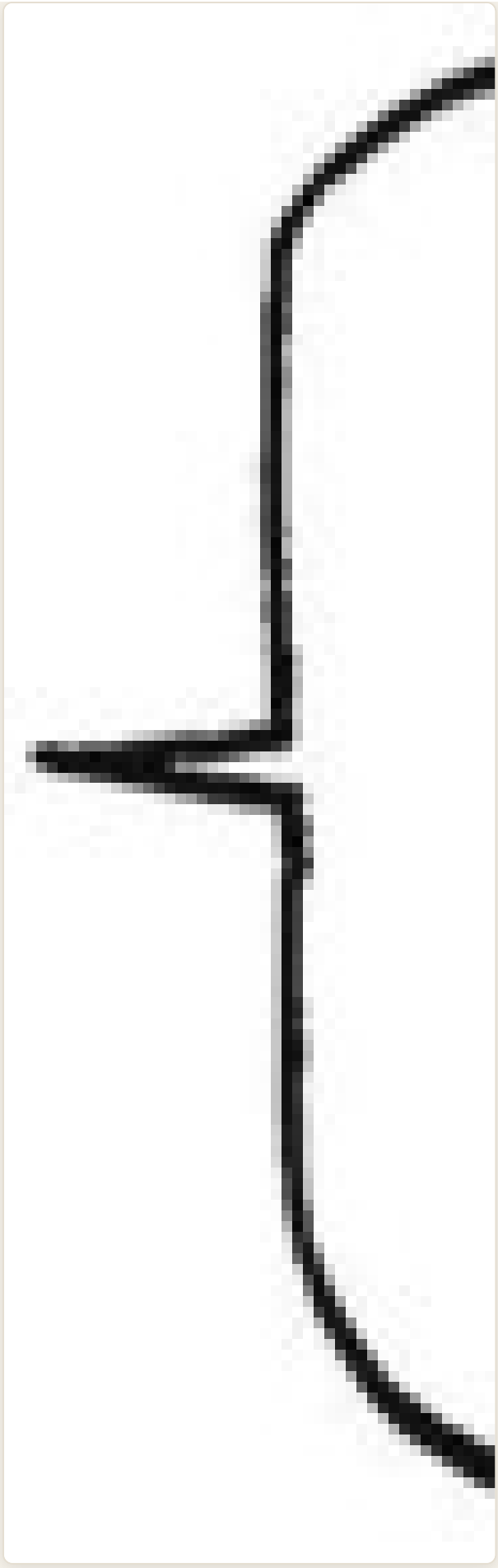
FIG. 284





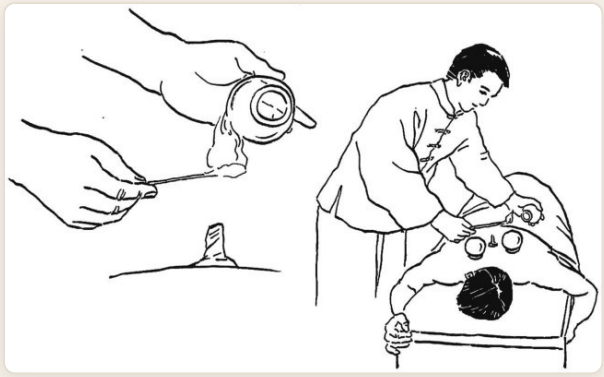
Hand holding a lit flame near the mouth of a cup to heat it and expel the air inside.

FIG. 285



Hand placing a cup onto the skin to create suction.

FIG. 286



A practitioner placing several cupping cups on a patient's back while the patient lies on a treatment table.

BOOK PAGE 132 · SCAN P141

Trang 132

The cups made of glass used in cupping come in three sizes — large, medium and small. Their volumes range from 30 to 60 cubic centimetres. The glass around the cup rim is thicker to minimise the escape of air.

In the absence of glass cups, ceramic or other materials are also used. Some alternatives are teacups, wine glasses, small bowls or bamboo tubes.

There are different methods used in cupping therapy:

Single-cup method: Suitable for the treatment of a smaller area.

Medicated-cup method: Pain suppressants or medicine is applied on the troubled spot before the cup is placed there. Sometimes, fresh ginger or garlic is also ground and applied before the cup is placed. The cups are usually placed there for between 10 and 20 minutes.

The vacuumed cups will give the skin a sensation of being pulled. It also creates a warm and soothing sensation. It is normal for the reddish purple or purplish marks left behind by the cups to last for one or a few days.

Cupping therapy is not recommended for highly nervous persons, people with sensitive or loose skin, and people who are very skinny.

Scraping

Scraping

A copper coin or a small spoon dipped in oil or water is used to scrape the patient's chest, back, neck and other areas. Each area is scraped 20 times until purplish-red marks appear. It is used to treat dizzy spells, stuffy chest, bloated and painful abdomen, aching body etc.

In the past, the tools used in the scraping therapy were rather primitive. Copper coins, spoons and tile pieces were used, and very often, they caused bleeding and infections. Hence, it gave the impression of being primitive and unscientific. Nowadays, buffalo horns are used in scraping therapy. Buffalo horns are able to remove excess heat and expel toxins. They do not conduct heat and electricity. And the horns may be filed into various shapes and sizes to reach different parts of the body. In addition, the smooth texture of the horn is comfortable and will not hurt the skin.

Before scraping, one should not have had a heavy meal or be starving. Scraping should only be done one hour after food and under the supervision of a trained physician. Patients who are suffering from blood diseases or bleed easily should avoid scraping therapy. A baby or young child undergoing scraping therapy should ideally have a sheet of cotton placed on the area to be scraped to avoid damaging the tender skin. Patients with skin problems should not go for scraping therapy.

Bloodletting

Bloodletting

Needles or knives are used to pierce the acupoint or pulse to release a small amount of blood. It is ideal for patients suffering from heatstroke, high fever, poisonous bites or poisoning through ingestion etc.

Umbilical cord therapy

Medicines, moxa sticks, heat, cupping and other therapies are used on the navel to treat various complaints, especially asthma, diarrhoea in young children, indigestion in young children, night terrors, irregular menstruation etc.

Nasal-insertion therapy

Medicines ground into powder are applied on a piece of cotton gauze which is then rolled into a stick. The cotton stick is then inserted into the nostril. It is used to treat nosebleeds, blocked nasal passages, toothaches, headaches, asthma etc.

BOOK PAGE 135 · SCAN P144

Medicinal pillows

Medicinal pillows

Medicinal pillows are a type of treatment used in traditional Chinese medicine. Aromatic medicinal herbs that boost blood circulation and clear the channels are stir-baked before they are used as pillow filling. Sleeping on these medicinal pillows will help prevent diseases, fight ageing and prolong life.

The various types of medicinal pillows

Cloth pillows: Pillows made of cotton or gauze stuffed with herbs.

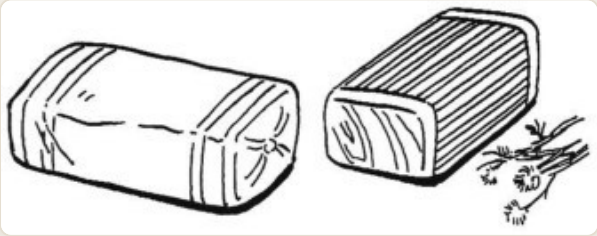
Wooden pillows: The hollow part of the wooden pillow is stuffed with aromatic herbs. The wooden pillow is then wrapped in a piece of cotton cloth.

Stone pillows: Stones and ceramics with medicinal properties are shaped into pillows.

Electromagnetic pillows: Electromagnetic gadgets are fixed to a traditional medicinal pillow to boost its effectiveness.

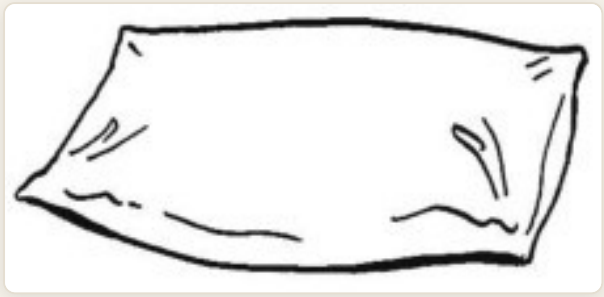
Whoa! So the hard wooden pillows our grandmothers used to sleep on had medicinal properties!

FIG. 287



A plain cloth pillow made of cotton or gauze.

FIG. 288

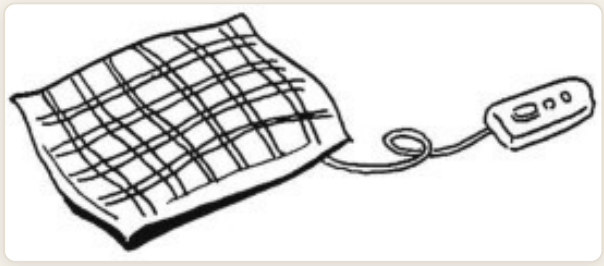


A wooden pillow with aromatic herbs stuffed into its hollow interior.

FIG. 289

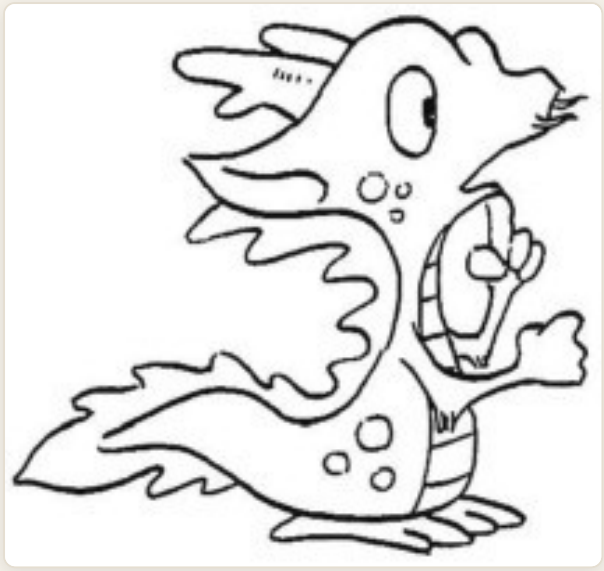
A person resting on a stone pillow carved with decorative patterns.

FIG. 290



A pillow fitted with an electromagnetic device connected by a cord to a control box.

FIG. 291



A dragon exclaiming that the hard wooden pillows its grandmother used to sleep on had medicinal properties.

FIG. 292

Small illustration of a medicinal pillow beside the text.

Dance therapy

Dance therapy

Dance relaxes our muscles and boosts blood circulation. Not only does it strengthen the body, it can also be used to treat motor ailments like muscle cramps, stiff joints, etc. Ancient records reveal that dance was used to treat physical ailments.

Mud therapy

Natural mud is applied. Usually, mineral-rich mud from wells, soil from farmland and yellow earth are used. Different types of mud possess different curative properties. For example, mud found in hot springs is warm, serving to boost blood circulation and free the meridians. Yellow earth, which is neither cooling nor heaty, benefits the spleen and stomach.

I am undergoing "sand therapy". Natural sand from the river or the desert is used to cover my body. This therapy treats rheumatism due to pathogenic cold, rheumatic pains, muscular atrophy etc.

Exposing our body to sunlight also helps to speed up the recovery process. This is known as "sunlight therapy". It is ideal for people who are deficient in the *qi* of the yang.

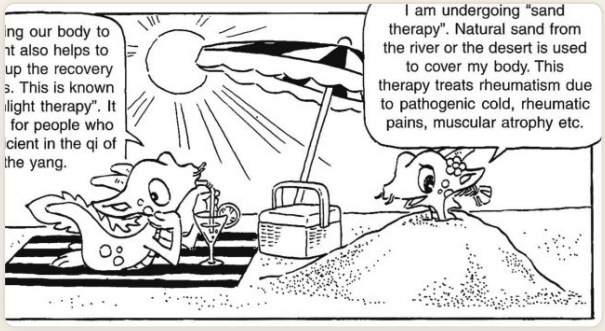
FIG. 293

A dancer in motion, illustrating dance therapy.

FIG. 294

A person applying natural mud to the body while bathing.

FIG. 295



Comic scene on a beach: one dragon is being covered with sand for "sand therapy", while the other explains "sunlight therapy" and the benefits of exposing the body to sunlight.

BOOK PAGE 137 · SCAN P146

Trang 137

Diseases are cured but not the person

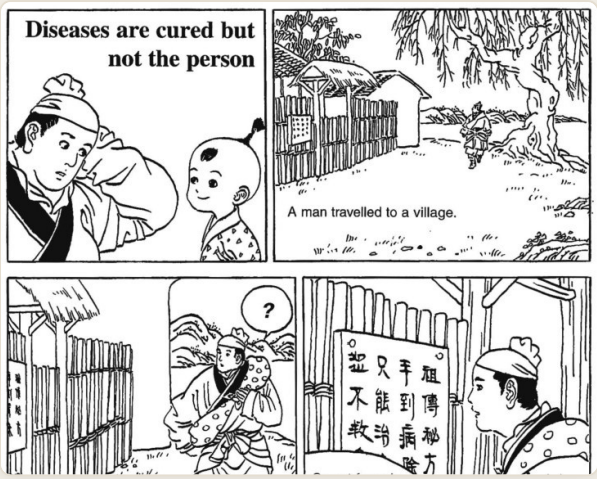
A man travelled to a village.

(Signboard over the gate: "The secret formula handed down from our ancestors treats diseases but cannot save a human life.")

Secret formula handed down from the ancestors that treats diseases but cannot save a human life.

It treats diseases but cannot save a life. What's going on?

FIG. 296



A traveller with his bundle stands beside a curious boy, under the heading "Diseases are cured but not the person".

FIG. 297

The traveller, marked by a question mark above his head, reads the ancestors' signboard promising a secret formula that treats diseases but cannot save a human life.

BOOK PAGE 138 · SCAN P147

Trang 138

Little boy, is the owner of that house a physician?

Yes, he is.

His ancestors were all physicians. He's highly-skilled. He is a well-known physician here.

But why does the signboard in front of his house say that he cannot save human lives?

The signboard is written correctly. That family of physicians do not treat humans.

But why can't they save human lives?

Can't you guess? Heehee! Let me tell you. He is a ...

Just what did the child tell the traveller? Make a guess, everyone!

I see! Haha!

Answer: He is a vet!

FIG. 298

The traveller questions the boy about the physician's house and its strange signboard, and the boy explains the family's odd practice.

Famous Physicians

Famous Physicians

Many top Chinese physicians have left their mark in the annals of Chinese history. These physicians not only possessed consummate medical skills, they also played an integral part in the development of Chinese medicine. More than just being gifted healers, they also possessed the highest moral integrity.

Medical Ethics

Medical Ethics

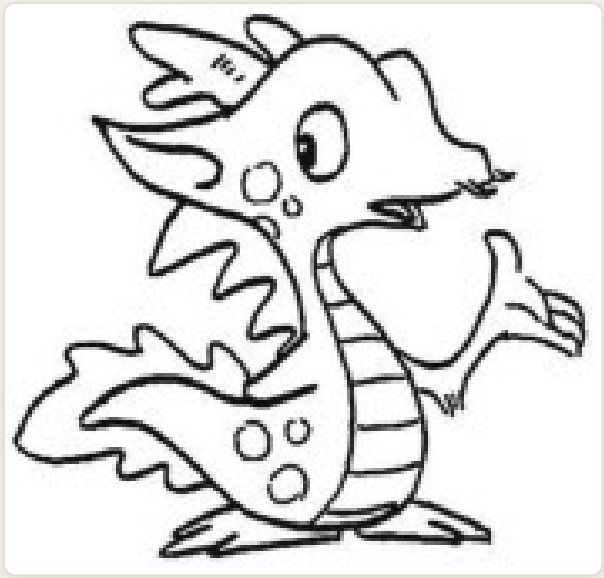
Medical ethics has been practised and advocated in China for a few thousand years. It advocates benevolence and compassion. Doctors do not just require excellent medical skills, they also have to be of an upright and moral character. There has been no lack of such benevolent doctors in Chinese history. To this day, these men are still highly regarded in the medical field.

Dong Feng, a physician during the Han Dynasty, treated his patients without expecting any remuneration. Once the patient recovered, all the patient had to do was plant an apricot tree on the mountain Dong Feng lived on. After many decades, a forest of apricot trees could be seen. Dong Feng became known as the Benevolent Physician of the Apricot Woods.

People began to use 'life among the apricot woods' and 'well-known among the apricot woods' in praise of compassionate doctors.

They deserve our admiration!

FIG. 299



Cartoon dragon character illustrating the story with a lively, expressive gesture.

FIG. 300

Standing figure of the benevolent physician Dong Feng in flowing robes.

FIG. 301

Two cartoon dragons discussing how phrases like 'life among the apricot woods' came to praise compassionate doctors.

Bian Que

Bian Que

A famous physician during the Warring States Period, Bian Que introduced the Four Diagnoses of Illnesses — observation, auscultation and olfaction, interrogation and pulse taking.

Bian Que's birthname was Qin Yueren. He was the first physician to be recorded in Chinese history. Sima Qian of Western Han vividly narrated Bian Que's practice in *Records of the Historian — The Biography of Bian Que*.

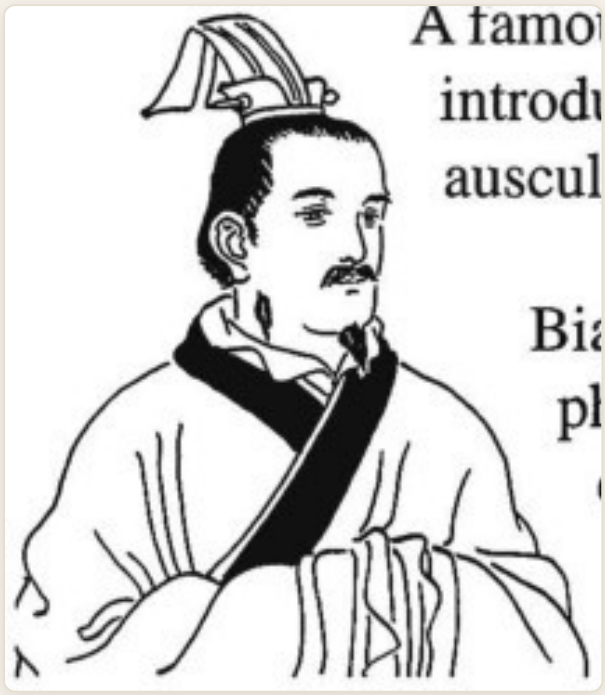
In his youth, Bian Que worked in an inn. He later became an apprentice of Chang Sangjun to be trained in medicine. Legend has it that Chang Sangjun fed Bian Que some medicine which allowed him to see through walls so that he could look into his patients' *zang* and *fu* organs during consultation.

Bian Que was an all-rounder in the medical field, well-versed in internal medicine, surgery, gynaecology, paediatrics and others. As he travelled, he was able to adapt his skills to suit the culture and needs of the people in a particular place. In Handan, where the women were esteemed, he became a gynaecologist, while in Luoyang, where the elderly were held in high regard, he became an otolaryngologist (ear-nose-throat specialist). In Xianyang, he took up paediatric practice as the people there loved children.

Bian Que wrote the *Internal Classics of Bian Que* and *External Classics of Bian Que*, which have since been lost. The only surviving book is the *Classic on Medical Problems* written by Qin Yueren. This book expounds on the technique of pulse taking.

Bian Que's consummate medical skill was renowned. He travelled to many places to treat diseases among the people. Like the magpie or bird of joy, he brought good fortune to the people. Therefore he became known as Bian Que among the people though his birthname was Qin Yueren. However, his fame incurred the jealousy of imperial physician Li Xi of the State of Qin, who had him assassinated.

FIG. 302



Portrait of Bian Que wearing a scholar's headdress and dark-collared robe.

BOOK PAGE 142 · SCAN P151

Bian Que uses the Four Diagnoses on Marquis Qi Huan

Bian Que's discourse on diseases:

"When a disease is on the skin, use heat;

if the disease is in the blood and pulse, treat it with acupuncture and moxibustion;

if the disease occurs in the intestines and stomach, treat it with medicinal decoctions;

but once the disease is in the bone marrow, not even a top physician will be able to do anything."

Bian Que uses the Four Diagnoses on Marquis Qi Huan

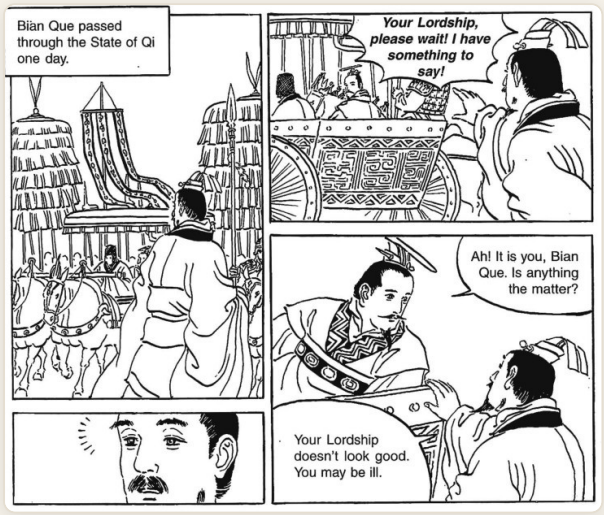
Bian Que passed through the State of Qi one day.

Your Lordship, please wait! I have something to say!

Ah! It is you, Bian Que. Is anything the matter?

Your Lordship doesn't look good. You may be ill.

FIG. 303



Bian Que halts the Marquis of Qi's carriage to warn him, then tells him plainly that his complexion looks unwell.

BOOK PAGE 143 · SCAN P152

Trang 143

Your illness is still mild and in the exterior. But if you do not seek treatment soon, it will only worsen.

I feel fine! I am not ill.

All these physicians want is to make gains from treating a disease that does not even exist.

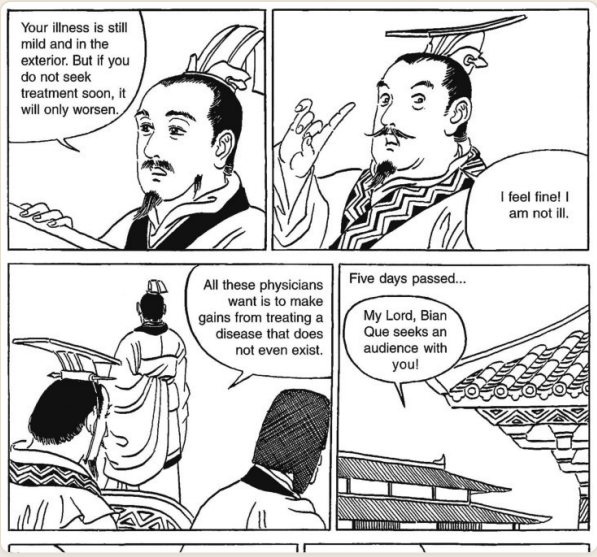
Five days passed...

My Lord, Bian Que seeks an audience with you!

Your Lordship, your illness has penetrated your blood. If left untreated, I am afraid your condition will deteriorate.

I am in perfect health. I don't need you. You may leave.

FIG. 304



Bian Que warns the Marquis that the illness is still mild and in the exterior, but the Marquis insists he is fine. Five days later, his attendants announce that Bian Que seeks an audience.

FIG. 305

Bian Que tells the Marquis that the illness has now penetrated his blood, but the Marquis dismisses him, saying he is in perfect health and does not need him.

BOOK PAGE 144 · SCAN P153

Trang 144

Another five days passed before Bian Que sought an audience with Marquis Qi Huan.

Your illness has penetrated your *zang* and *fu* organs. It will be too late if you do not seek treatment.

You have come to bother me again! Go! Go!

Sigh!

When Bian Que saw the Marquis for the fourth time...

He said nothing and left.

FIG. 306

Bian Que tells the Marquis that the illness has reached his zang and fu organs, is driven away angrily, and on his fourth visit says nothing and departs.

BOOK PAGE 145 · SCAN P154

Trang 145

"Physician, don't go yet. His Lordship wants to speak to you."

"You came several times hoping to treat me. Why did you walk off without saying a word this time?"

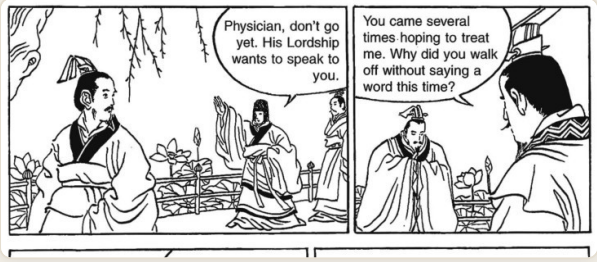
"Previously, there was still a cure for Your Lordship's disease. But now that it has penetrated the bone marrow, there is nothing I can do about it."

"..."

True enough, the Marquis fell ill shortly after.

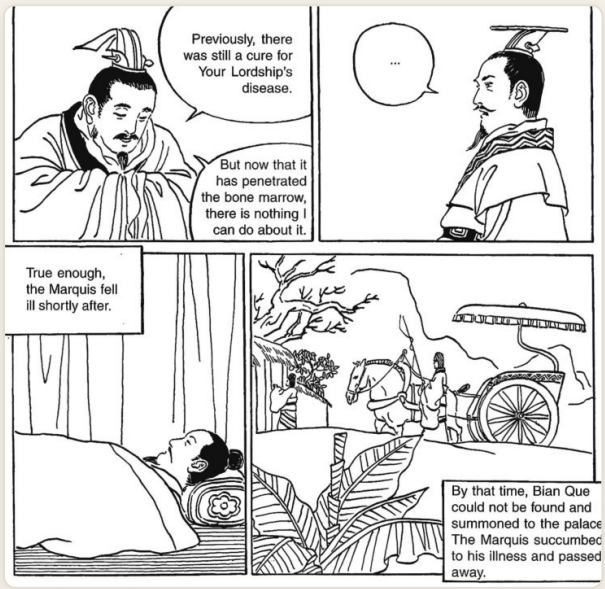
By that time, Bian Que could not be found and summoned to the palace. The Marquis succumbed to his illness and passed away.

FIG. 307



Two comic panels: attendants ask the physician Bian Que to stay because the Marquis wishes to speak with him; the Marquis complains that Bian Que, after coming several times to treat him, walked off this time without a word.

FIG. 308



Four comic panels: Bian Que explains that the Marquis's disease was once curable but has now penetrated the bone marrow; the Marquis is speechless; the Marquis then falls gravely ill, and because Bian Que cannot be found, the Marquis succumbs and dies.

Trang 146

Hua Tuo

Hua Tuo (145AD-208AD), a physician from the Eastern Han Dynasty, was another all-rounder in terms of medical expertise. He was well-versed in gynaecology, internal illnesses, paediatrics and intestinal parasitic worms, among other fields. But his greatest achievement was in surgery. He was acclaimed as the Father of Surgery and the Holy Hand of Surgery.

He pioneered general anaesthesia for surgery on the abdomen, 1600 years ahead of the first successful surgery carried out under general anaesthesia recorded in western medicine in 1848.

At that time, Hua Tuo was already engaged in the removal of tumours and surgery on the stomach and intestines. When acupuncture and drugs failed to do the job, he would proceed with surgery. His patients would down an anaesthetic with wine. Once they lost consciousness, he would cut open their abdomen and remove any tumour that might be present. If the disease occurred in the intestines, he would snip at the intestines and clean them up before stitching them up again and applying medicated balm on them. The surgical wound would take four to five days to heal, and the patient would make a full recovery in about a month's time.

Hua Tuo was also an expert on intestinal parasitic worms. He discovered that eating raw food was the main culprit behind intestinal parasitic worms, and fed his patients purgatives to make them throw up the parasitic worms and thus recover.

Hua Tuo realized the importance of physical exercise. He believed that appropriate exercise could prevent diseases and prolong one's life. He created China's earliest form of health-preserving exercise — the Frolics of Five Animals (see p.154).

FIG. 309

Ink portrait of Hua Tuo, the Eastern Han physician, wearing a scholar's headdress and a full beard.

BOOK PAGE 147 · SCAN P156

Hua Tuo Treats Severe Headaches

He treated Cao Cao's severe headache and neutralised the poison in Guan Yu by scraping his bone. Unfortunately, Hua Tuo was later killed by Cao Cao. He compiled his medical experience into a book known as the *Book of the Black Bag*, but it was lost after his death.

> ***Hua Tuo:***

> *"Running water is never stale and a door-hinge never gets eaten by worms."*

>

> *As running water is in constant movement, it never grows stale and smelly; a door-hinge turns every day, so it does not get eaten by worms. The human body needs adequate and suitable exercise. Exercise promotes food digestion, the flow of qi and blood and prevents diseases.*

Hua Tuo Treats Severe Headaches

"My head hurts! Who can help me?"

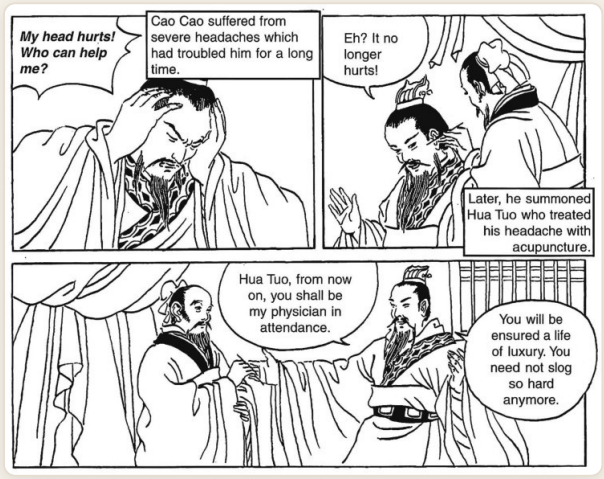
Cao Cao suffered from severe headaches which had troubled him for a long time.

"Eh? It no longer hurts!"

Later, he summoned Hua Tuo who treated his headache with acupuncture.

"Hua Tuo, from now on, you shall be my physician in attendance. You will be ensured a life of luxury. You need not slog so hard anymore."

FIG. 310



Comic strip: Cao Cao, tormented by severe headaches, summons Hua Tuo, who cures the pain with acupuncture; Cao Cao then offers to keep Hua Tuo as his personal physician with a life of ease.

BOOK PAGE 148 · SCAN P157

Trang 148

"I practise medicine to serve the people. I do not wish to wait on just one person."

"Let me find an excuse to turn down his offer."

"I have spent a long time travelling. I'd like to go back to my hometown and collect my book at the same time."

"All right. Make it back here fast."

It had been a few years since Hua Tuo returned to his hometown. Cao Cao wrote him several letters urging him to return. But Hua Tuo would always come up with an excuse to decline his offer.

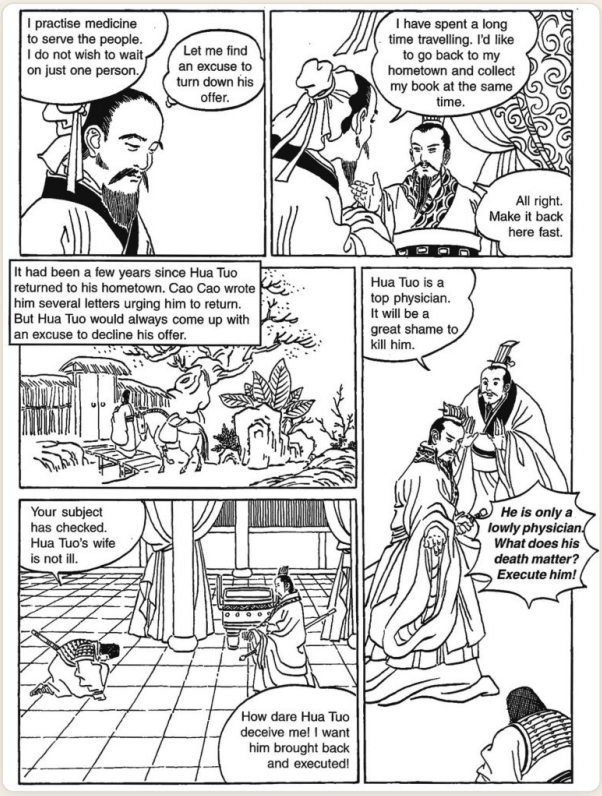
Hua Tuo is a top physician. It will be a great shame to kill him.

He is only a lowly physician. What does his death matter? Execute him!

"Your subject has checked. Hua Tuo's wife is not ill."

"How dare Hua Tuo deceive me! I want him brought back and executed!"

FIG. 311



Comic page: Hua Tuo refuses to serve only one man and asks leave to return home to collect his book; years pass and he keeps declining Cao Cao's summons with excuses; when Cao Cao learns Hua Tuo's wife was never ill, he orders him seized and executed, despite an adviser's warning.

Trang 149

"If my knowledge could be passed on, I'd die with no regrets."

"Prison warden!"

"This book will save lives. I'll leave it with you for safekeeping."

"I cannot take the book! If I get found out, I will be beheaded!"

And so, Hua Tuo burnt his book.

"Sigh!"

"My head hurts terribly! Bring Hua Tuo here!"

Prime Minister, Hua Tuo has been executed.

"Ahh! I should not have had Hua Tuo killed!"

BOOK PAGE 150 · SCAN P159

Frolics of Five Animals

Frolics of Five Animals

Hua Tuo created China's earliest form of health-preserving exercise — Frolics of Five Animals. It was based on the movements of the tiger, deer, bear, ape and bird. The series of movements promote a clear mind, boost the function of the heart and lung, strengthen the back and kidneys, lubricate the joints and improve one's constitution.

In recent years, it has been widely used in the therapy of stroke patients, rheumatic patients, arthritic patients, patients suffering from spinal injury and others.

Tiger: Roaring and plunging foward like a tiger.

Deer: Dashing happily like a deer.

Bear: Walking slowly like a bear.

Monkey: Jumping around like a monkey.

Bird: Spreading out one's hands to fly like a bird.

It is said that Hua Tuo's disciple who practised the Frolics of Five Animals lived to over 100 years of age!

FIG. 312

Drawing of a man in ancient robes stooping forward with fists clenched, imitating the tiger: roaring and plunging forward.

FIG. 313

Drawing of a man in ancient robes lifting one leg with hands clasped, imitating the deer: dashing happily.

FIG. 314

Drawing of a man in ancient robes leaning back with arms swung behind, imitating the bear: walking slowly.

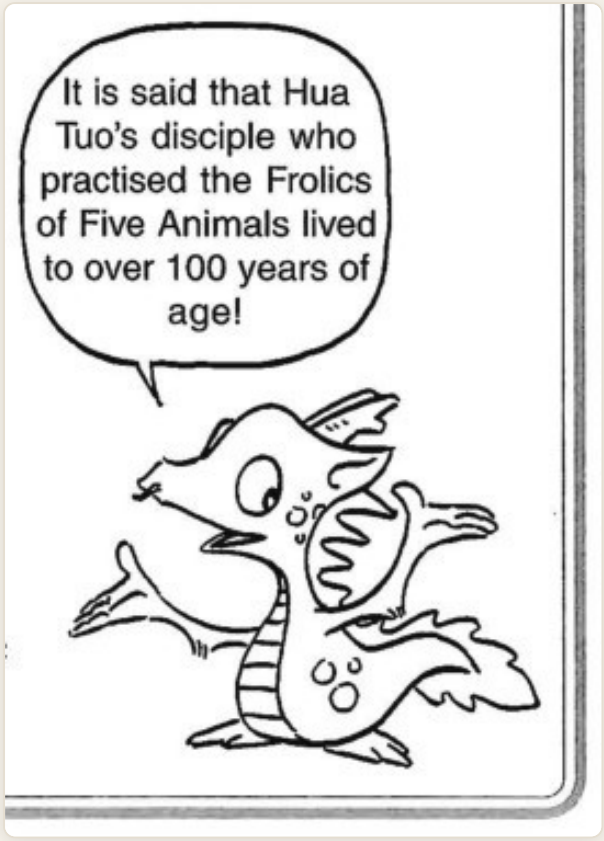
FIG. 315

Drawing of a man in ancient robes with one arm raised, imitating the monkey: jumping around.

FIG. 316

Drawing of a man in ancient robes with both hands raised above his head, imitating the bird: spreading out one's hands to fly.

FIG. 317



Cartoon dragon beside a speech bubble saying that Hua Tuo's disciple who practised the Frolics of Five Animals lived to over 100 years of age.

BOOK PAGE 151 · SCAN P160

Trang 151

Zhang Zhongjing

Zhang Zhongjing (AD150-219) lived during the Eastern Han Dynasty. He resolved to become a physician after witnessing the ravages brought about by epidemics.

He was a high-ranking court official at some point. Even while he was posted to Changsha, he never neglected treating the people. At that time, court officials could not enter the residential area of the commoners at any time they wished to. And so Zhang Zhongjing would open the doors of the yamen on every first and 15th day of the lunar month so that he could provide consultation for the commoners. Patients from all over the land would travel to seek treatment from him.

Legend has it that dumplings, a traditional Chinese food, were invented by Zhang Zhongjing. Seeing how the poor suffered in the bitter cold and their ears became frostbitten, Zhang

Zhongjing decided to wrap mutton, chilli and some warming medicinal herbs in dough skin. Folding them into the shape of an ear, he boiled them in water before giving them to the poor. Eating them warmed the body, promoted blood flow and thawed the cold ears. This medicine was called the 'Warming Ear Soup', and later dumplings.

Zhang Zhongjing later compiled experience culled from his practice and wrote 16 volumes of the *Treatise on Febrile and Miscellaneous Diseases*. It was China's earliest book to combine medical theories and medical experience, and provided analyses of the causes, symptoms, development and methods of handling acute febrile diseases in accordance with the theory of the Six Meridians.

More than 300 prescriptions and their effectiveness were recorded in the book. People called the prescriptions 'classic prescriptions'. His book also earned Zhang Zhongjing the title of 'Ancestor of Prescriptions' and the 'Ancestor of Medicine'. Practitioners of Chinese medicine still use his original prescriptions to treat diseases today.

* *Treatise on Febrile and Miscellaneous Diseases* has been lost through the ages. Wang Shuhe, a famous physician during the Jin Dynasty, rearranged the materials into two books — *Treatise on Febrile Diseases* and *Synopsis of Prescriptions of the Golden Chamber*.

FIG. 318

Ink portrait of Zhang Zhongjing, the Eastern Han physician and author of the Treatise on Febrile and Miscellaneous Diseases, wearing a scholar's cap and robe.

BOOK PAGE 152 · SCAN P161

Zhang Zhongjing's Practice

Synopsis from Prescriptions of the Golden Chamber — Decoction of Liquorice, Wheat and Jujube

Ingredients: 10 g of liquorice, 30 g of wheat, 10 jujube

Preparation: Cook them in 500 ml of water. Take it in three doses, one dose a day.

Functions: Used as a sedative for neurosis, strengthens the spleen.

The original decoction was to treat hysteria in women resulting from melancholy. It is now used to treat neurosis, schizophrenia, hysteria and menopause.

Zhang Zhongjing's Practice

It was near the end of the Eastern Han period. There was chaos everywhere and epidemics were prevalent. The plagues killed members from every household.

"Sob, sob. Old Master, you were taken away from us so suddenly..."

FIG. 319

Comic panels: a battlefield strewn with broken weapons and chariot wheels amid the chaos and epidemics at the end of the Eastern Han; and mourners weeping at a pavilion over the sudden loss of their Old Master.

BOOK PAGE 153 · SCAN P162

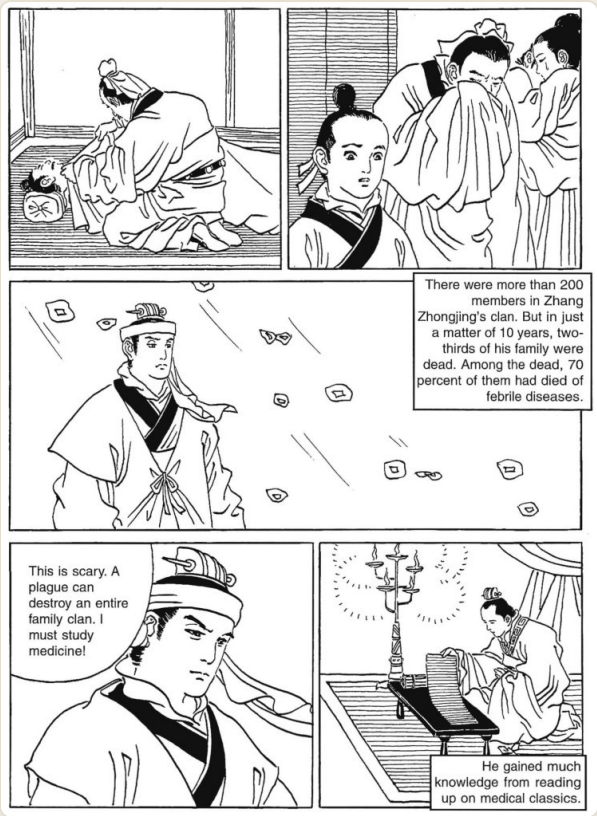
Trang 153

There were more than 200 members in Zhang Zhongjing's clan. But in just a matter of 10 years, two-thirds of his family were dead. Among the dead, 70 percent of them had died of febrile diseases.

This is scary. A plague can destroy an entire family clan. I must study medicine!

He gained much knowledge from reading up on medical classics.

FIG. 320



A five-panel comic strip. It opens with a physician kneeling beside a sick man lying on a mat while the family weeps, and the young Zhang Zhongjing looking on. He is next shown walking on alone, lost in thought, as the caption tells how a plague wiped out two-thirds of his clan within ten years. Resolving that he must study medicine, he sits reading medical classics by the light of a tall many-branched candelabrum.

BOOK PAGE 154 · SCAN P163

Trang 154

He also collected famous ancient prescriptions and local prescriptions.

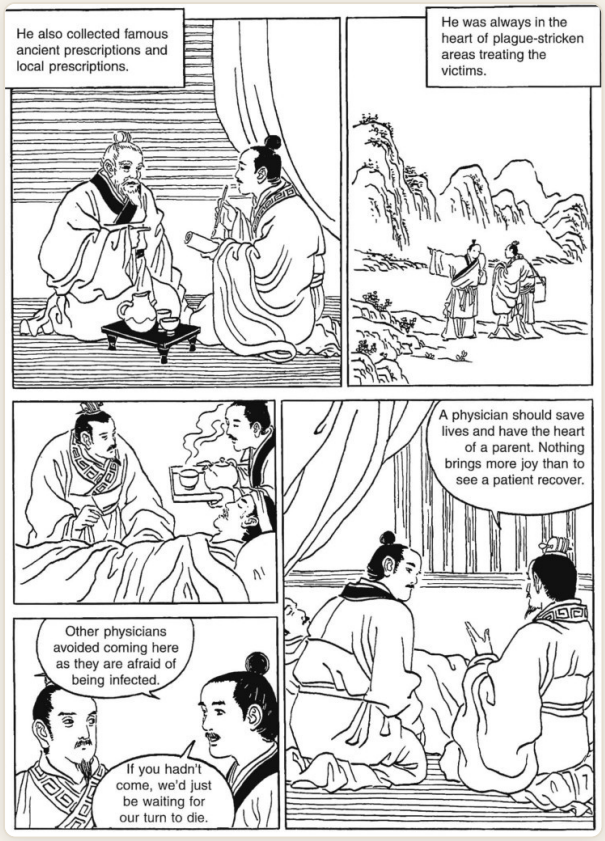
He was always in the heart of plague-stricken areas treating the victims.

A physician should save lives and have the heart of a parent. Nothing brings more joy than to see a patient recover.

Other physicians avoided coming here as they are afraid of being infected.

If you hadn't come, we'd just be waiting for our turn to die.

FIG. 321



A five-panel comic strip. In the first panel an old physician discusses prescriptions with a younger man taking notes; the next shows two figures travelling through mountainous plague country. A further panel pictures a patient being nursed in bed while an assistant carries in a tray of medicine. Zhang Zhongjing tells a companion that a physician should save lives and have the heart of a parent, and rejoices when a patient recovers; two grateful villagers remark that other doctors stayed away for fear of infection.

BOOK PAGE 155 · SCAN P164

Trang 155

His body became scorching hot after he fell ill.

Physician, what is this plague called? Will it be easy to treat?

A disease like this that strikes during a particular season is a febrile disease.

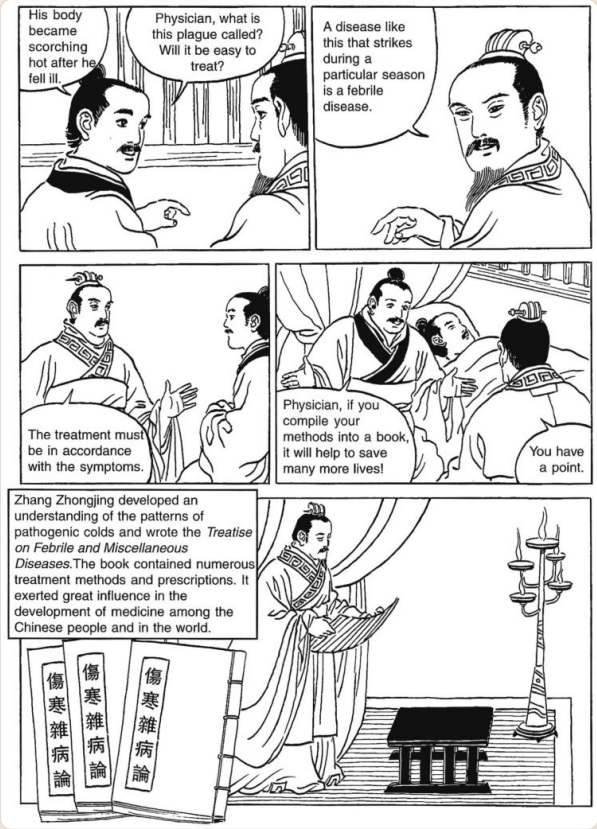
The treatment must be in accordance with the symptoms.

Physician, if you compile your methods into a book, it will help to save many more lives!

You have a point.

Zhang Zhongjing developed an understanding of the patterns of pathogenic colds and wrote the *Treatise on Febrile and Miscellaneous Diseases*. The book contained numerous treatment methods and prescriptions. It exerted great influence in the development of medicine among the Chinese people and in the world.

FIG. 322



A five-panel comic strip. A relative describes how a patient's body turned scorching hot after he fell ill, and asks the physician what the plague is called and whether it is easy to treat; Zhang Zhongjing answers that an illness striking in a particular season is a febrile disease, and that treatment must be in accordance with the symptoms. When a patient urges him to compile his methods into a book so that many more lives may be saved, he agrees. The final panel shows him holding a scroll beside three bound volumes of his work, the Treatise on Febrile and Miscellaneous Diseases.

Sun Simiao

Sun Simiao

Sun Simiao was a famous physician during the Sui Tang Dynasty (581–682). He was a sickly child, yet he lived to 101 years old. Sun Simiao practised medicine for more than 80 years and was hailed as the King of Medicine.

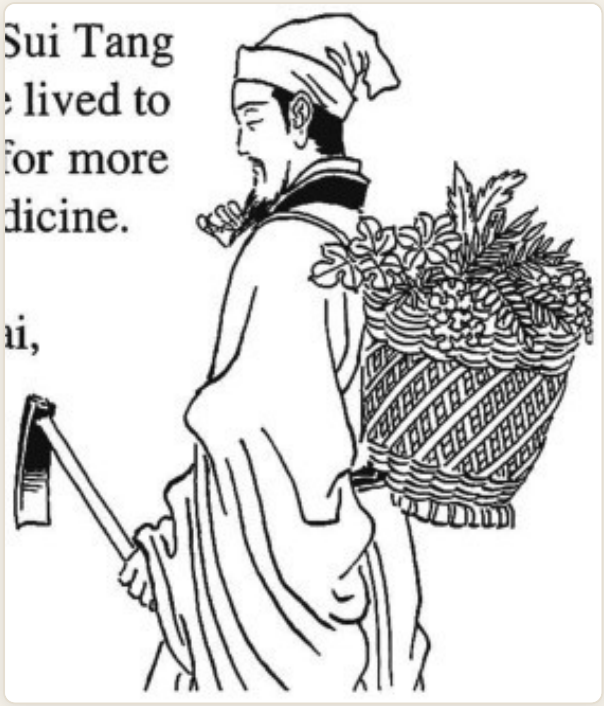
He often picked medicinal herbs on Mount Wutai, which later became known as King of Medicine Mountain. There is even a King of Medicine Temple on the mountain where offerings are made to his statue.

Prescriptions Worth A Thousand Gold for Emergencies (30 volumes) and *Supplement to the Prescriptions Worth A Thousand Gold* (30 volumes) count among his famous works. The former title covered topics like obstetrics and gynaecology and paediatrics with knowledge culled from his experience, ways to expel poison, emergency diet therapy, cultivation of one's disposition, pulse taking, acupuncture and moxibustion and others. It was hailed as China's earliest medical encyclopaedia. He also introduced the compound prescription in this book, combining two or three classical prescriptions into one to boost its effectiveness, and simplifying some classical prescriptions to treat specific diseases.

Sun Simiao was a forerunner in the study of obstetrics and gynaecology. In the *Prescriptions Worth A Thousand Gold for Emergencies*, he emphasized gynaecology and paediatrics. He also discovered an effective way of treating flaccidity of the lower limbs, 1000 years before European doctors began studies on treating this disease in 1642. He also pioneered the treatment of localised goitre by using thyroid glands from goats. The use of animal liver to treat night blindness was also one of his many medical breakthroughs.

Sun Simiao placed paramount importance on the cultivation of medical ethics. He believed that excellent medical skills should be accompanied by sincerity of heart. His motto was: "Take decisive action tempered with careful thought, be flexible in according treatment, but never be subjective in one's judgement."

FIG. 323



A drawing of the elderly Sun Simiao in flowing robes and a soft cloth cap, striding forward with a woven basket of freshly gathered medicinal herbs slung on his back and a hoe gripped in his hand.

BOOK PAGE 157 · SCAN P166

Sun Simiao — The Physician

Sun Simiao — The Physician

Sun Simiao:

"A life is worth a thousand taels of gold,

A life-saving prescription is worth more than a thousand taels of gold."

"Nothing is more precious than a person's life. It is worth more than a thousand gold. The merit a life-saving prescription earns is worth more than a thousand gold."

When he was a child, Sun Simiao suffered the ravages of illnesses and appreciated the importance of a physician. His famous works, *Prescriptions Worth A Thousand Gold for Emergencies* and *Supplement to the Prescriptions Worth A Thousand Gold* underline the value of life.

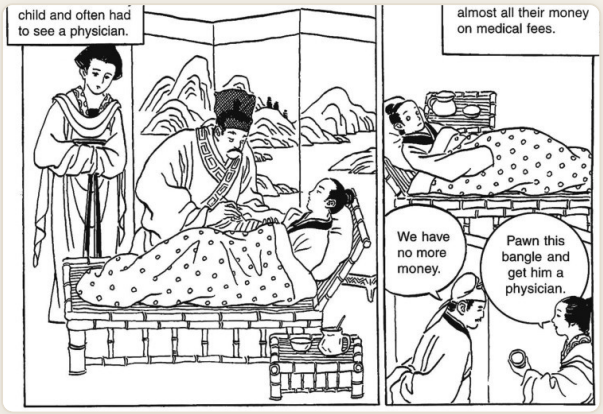
The young Sun Simiao was a sickly child and often had to see a physician.

His parents used up almost all their money on medical fees.

We have no more money.

Pawn this bangle and get him a physician.

FIG. 324



Two comic panels. In the first, a physician feels the pulse of the young Sun Simiao, who lies under a quilted coverlet while his mother stands beside the bed. In the second, the child lies in bed as his parents talk, the mother holding out a bangle to be pawned so that they can pay for a physician.

BOOK PAGE 158 · SCAN P167

Trang 158

I'm not the only one who suffers when I fall ill. The people around me also suffer.

I want to become a doctor when I grow up. I will remove the agony of being ill from myself and others.

Sun Simiao was intelligent and industrious. When he was seven, he could already read more than 1000 characters. When he turned 20, he was already versed in the various schools of thought.

He studied famous works by ancient scholars and learnt from medical experts.

FIG. 325

A four-panel comic strip. Lying sick in bed, the young Sun Simiao reflects that his illness makes those around him suffer too, and resolves to become a doctor who will remove the agony of illness from himself and others. The lower panels follow him as he grows: reading intently among the shelves of his study, then sitting outdoors with an elderly scholar, learning from him.

BOOK PAGE 159 · SCAN P168

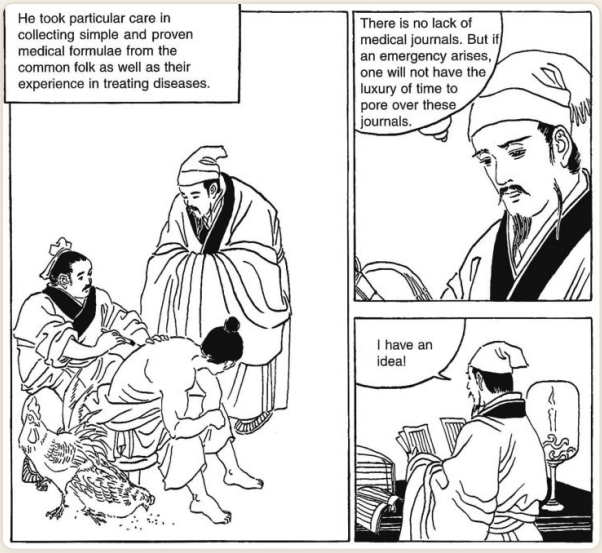
Trang 159

He took particular care in collecting simple and proven medical formulae from the common folk as well as their experience in treating diseases.

There is no lack of medical journals. But if an emergency arises, one will not have the luxury of time to pore over these journals.

I have an idea!

FIG. 326

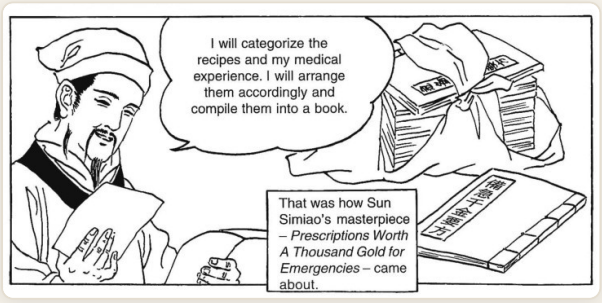


Three comic panels. In the first, Sun Simiao leans over to watch a village healer treat a patient, a cockerel scratching at his feet, as he gathers simple remedies from ordinary folk. In the second, he studies a sheaf of medical journals by a window. In the third, struck by an idea, he turns to a desk piled with books beside a lamp.

I will categorize the recipes and my medical experience. I will arrange them accordingly and compile them into a book.

That was how Sun Simiao's masterpiece — *Prescriptions Worth A Thousand Gold for Emergencies* — came about.

FIG. 327



A single wide panel. Sun Simiao sits writing on a sheet of paper, thinking aloud that he will sort out the recipes and his own medical experience and arrange them into a book; beside him lie bundles of paper and a bound volume of the finished work.

Trang 160

Sun Simiao emphasised the cultivation of medical ethics.

A true physician should be competent in his medical skill and sincere in his interaction with others.

Sun Simiao did not discriminate against the poor. He regarded patients, rich or poor, equally.

Doctor, I have no money to pay you. I'll work for you when I recover by way of payment.

Don't worry about paying me.

Take this silver to go and buy yourself some tonics.

Doctor, let's continue our journey at daybreak.

No, saving a life is akin to putting out a fire! It cannot wait!

No matter how treacherous the journey, whether it was day or night, freezing cold or scorchingly hot, Sun Simiao would not allow any condition to stop him from calling on a sick patient.

In his twilight years, he even wrote the *Supplement to Prescriptions Worth A Thousand Gold*.

FIG. 328

A six-panel comic strip. Sun Simiao holds a sprig of herbs as he says that a true physician must be competent in his skill and sincere in his dealings with others; he tells a poor patient not to worry about paying him; he presses silver on a recovered man to buy himself tonics; and riding on through the night he refuses to delay, saying that saving a life is like putting out a fire. The final panels show him travelling on through the mountains in all weathers and, in old age, writing the Supplement to Prescriptions Worth A Thousand Gold.

BOOK PAGE 161 · SCAN P170

Zhu Danxi

Zhu Danxi

Zhu Danxi was a famous physician who lived during the Yuan Dynasty (1281 – 1358). He was an excellent doctor and very often, one prescription from him would cure the patient. Hence the people called him 'Zhu One-Prescription' and 'Half-Immortal Zhu'.

Zhu Danxi only began to read up on medicine at 30 years of age as his mother suffered from a chronic pain in the spleen. Five years later, he cured his mother of her ailment.

When he was 36, he studied neo-Confucianism under Xu Wenyi. In just a few years, he was known as an erudite Confucian scholar.

When Xu Wenyi fell gravely ill, he advised Zhu Danxi to switch to the study of medicine. Remembering how his own child, wife, younger brother, uncles and other family members had died at the hands of inept physicians, Zhu Danxi gave up his ambition to become a court official and switched to the study of medicine instead.

At that time, the *Prescriptions of the Drug Mixing Store* from the Song Dynasty given out by the authorities was all the rage. Inept physicians would just lift the medical formulae from the book blindly and prescribe them to patients. Zhu Danxi recognized the limitations of the book. So he studied *The Yellow Emperor's Medicine Classic*, *Difficult Classic* and others. He also travelled to other regions and called on renowned physicians. The renowned physician Luo Zhiti took him under his wing, and a few years later, Zhu Danxi had become a top physician with vast knowledge and consummate medical skills.

Zhu Danxi conceived the unique theory of nourishing the yin. It advocates nourishing the yin to lower the fire in one's body. He also opposed the indiscriminate use of pungent and warming medicines and stressed the importance of watching one's diet. His theories had widespread influence. Japanese medical experts specially visited China during the Ming Dynasty to learn from Danxi. Today, Japan still has societies founded on Danxi's teachings.

FIG. 329

Line-drawing portrait of Zhu Danxi: head and shoulders of an elderly physician with a long beard, wearing a soft folded scholar's cap and a robe with a patterned collar.

Zhu Danxi's Theory of Nourishing the Yin to Prepare for Old Age

Zhu Danxi's Theory of Nourishing the Yin to Prepare for Old Age

Zhu Danxi believed that old age illness were due to insufficient yin and excess yang; hence he believed nourishing yin would expel fire and prevent sickness in old age.

"A person who has reached 60, 70 years of age will have depleted much of his vital essence and blood. Even if he is not suffering from poor diet or ill health, he is already suffering from the heat syndrome."

"Wufu pills should not be abused. Avoid wines and oily meat; grilled, smoked and fried food; spicy, sweet and oily food."

"The elderly have a deficiency of the spleen and insufficient yin. Heat in the stomach will cause hunger pangs; a weak spleen means poor food digestion and too much food will put stress on the stomach. Deficiency of yin will cause stagnation of the qi and result in diseases."

Zhu Danxi Studies Medicine

FIG. 330

Two-panel comic strip. On the left, a boy trudges along a country path carrying a great bundle of firewood on his back while his mother walks ahead of him, also bowed under a load of firewood; a caption box in the corner tells that Danxi lost his father young and lived in poverty with his mother. On the right, the same boy stands outside a schoolhouse, peering through the open lattice window at the children seated at their desks, with a speech bubble saying that only children from rich homes can afford to go to school.

Trang 163

How I envy them. I shall stand outside the window and listen in on the class...

Heaven, earth, man...

Eventually, he came to know more words than the pupils inside.

There was a family in the town that had many books. As he couldn't afford to buy books, Zhu Danxi often borrowed books from the family.

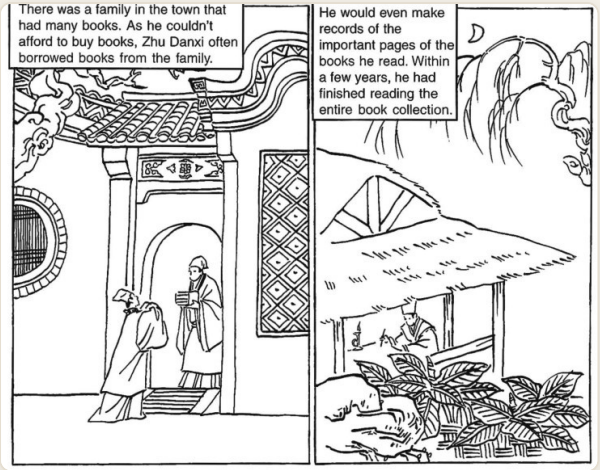
He would even make records of the important pages of the books he read. Within a few years, he had finished reading the entire book collection.

FIG. 331

Two-panel comic strip. In the left panel the young Zhu Danxi grips a bamboo fence and looks wistfully through it; a speech bubble shows him envying the pupils and deciding to stand outside the window to listen to the lesson. In the right panel he squats on the bare ground, writing characters with a stick in the sand, and a cloud-shaped bubble above him holds the words "Heaven, earth, man"; a caption box notes that he eventually came to know more words than the pupils inside.

>

FIG. 332



Two-panel comic strip. The left panel shows Zhu Danxi bowing respectfully at the gateway of a large tiled-roof house before a scholar who stands on the steps holding a stack of books; the caption says a family in the town owned many books and, unable to buy his own, he often borrowed from them. The right panel shows him inside a thatched hut, seated at a table copying out the important passages of the books he read; the caption says that within a few years he had finished the whole collection.

BOOK PAGE 164 · SCAN P173

Trang 164

When he was 30, Zhu Danxi's mother fell ill.

Mother is sick. But the physicians are unable to help her.

Let me read up on medical journals and see if I can find a cure.

It took him five years of persistent study before he cured his mother's troubled spleen.

FIG. 333

Comic strip opening the episode. The first panel shows Zhu Danxi's mother lying under a flowered quilt while a physician in a tall cap takes her pulse at the bedside, with the caption that his mother fell ill when he was thirty. The second panel shows Zhu Danxi holding a bowl of steaming medicine and brooding, with two speech bubbles: that his mother is sick and the physicians cannot help her, and that he will read up on medical journals to find a cure. The third panel shows him seated at his desk late at night, studying medical books by the light of an oil lamp, while a caption notes that five years of persistent study passed before he cured his mother's troubled spleen.

>

FIG. 334

Closing panel of the episode: Zhu Danxi, now grown and bearded, looks out over clouds and flying birds, and a speech bubble above him reads that learning medicine can save lives, so he shall study medicine.

Trang 165

He went to learn from the renowned physician Luo Zhiti.

My master does not impart his medical skills to anyone. Leave. Don't disturb my master again.

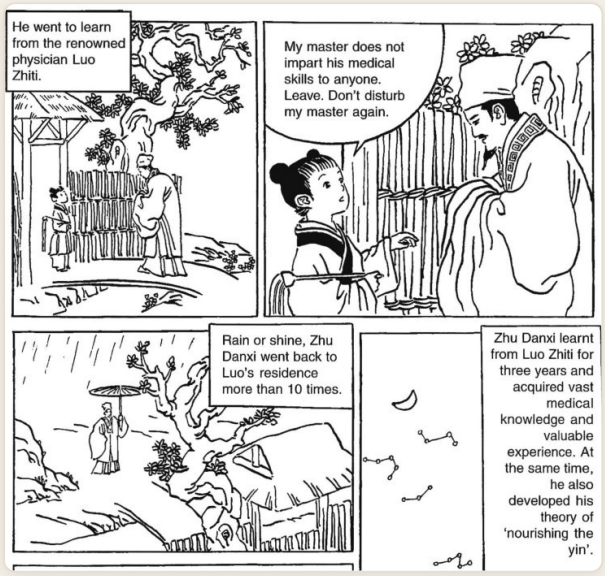
Rain or shine, Zhu Danxi went back to Luo's residence more than 10 times.

Zhu Danxi learnt from Luo Zhiti for three years and acquired vast medical knowledge and valuable experience. At the same time, he also developed his theory of 'nourishing the yin'.

His perseverance finally moved Luo Zhiti who made an exception and took him under his wing. At that time, Zhu Danxi was already 44 years old.

Yang is often in excess; yin is often too little.

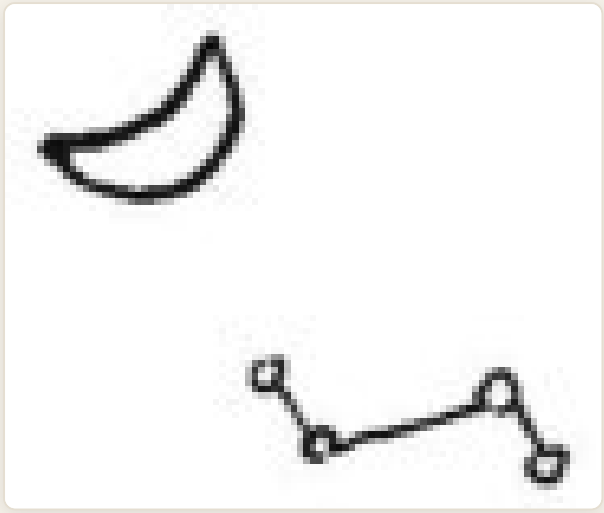
FIG. 335



Four-panel comic strip. The first panel shows the young Zhu Danxi standing at the gate of a fenced country house where a white-bearded master is receiving him, captioned that he went to learn from the renowned physician Luo Zhiti. The second panel shows an attendant blocking him at the gate with an outstretched hand, saying that the master does not impart his medical skills to anyone and that he should leave and not disturb the master again. The third panel shows Zhu Danxi walking back through the rain under an oil-paper umbrella, captioned that rain or shine he returned to Luo's residence more than ten times. The fourth panel is a night scene in which a moon and scattered stars hang over a lone figure on a dark plain, with a text box saying that he learnt from Luo Zhiti for three years, gained vast medical knowledge and experience, and in that time developed his theory of 'nourishing the yin'.

>

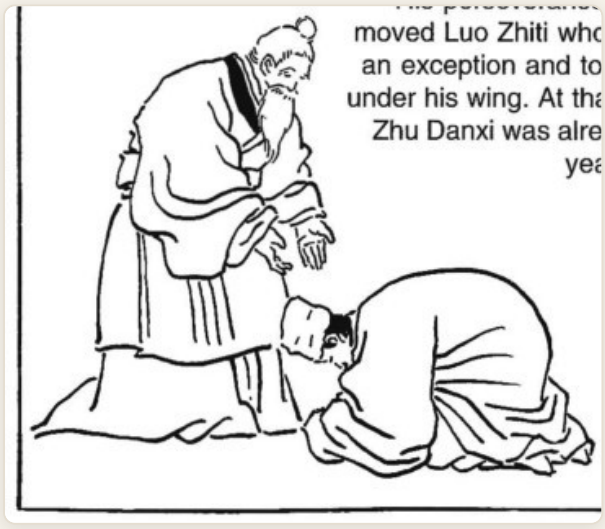
FIG. 336



Small decorative drawing within the night panel: a crescent moon and a few bright stars joined by straight lines into a constellation.

>

FIG. 337



Line drawing of Zhu Danxi, already a middle-aged man, kneeling on the ground in a deep bow while the white-bearded Luo Zhiti bends slightly forward and reaches out a hand to accept him; the caption tells that his perseverance finally moved Luo Zhiti, who made an exception and took him as a disciple when Zhu Danxi was already 44 years old.

>

FIG. 338

Small panel showing a lone figure in a long robe and tall cap standing on a bare stretch of ground, looking up, with a speech bubble beside him reading that yang is often in excess while yin is often too little.

Li Shizhen

Li Shizhen

Li Shizhen (1518 – 1593), a renowned physician from the Ming Dynasty, spent 27 years compiling the *Compendium of Materia Medica* — the world-renowned medical masterpiece. The compendium comes in 52 volumes. It contains 1892 Chinese medicines and more than 1000 illustrations. It is a compilation of China's 2000 years of medicinal knowledge.

In the process of writing the compendium, Li Shizhen often made personal observations and travelled to the deep mountains and vast grasslands to study and collect samples of medicines. He also learnt from more experienced persons in the area of medicine. Through his research, he debunked misconceptions about certain drugs and their uses.

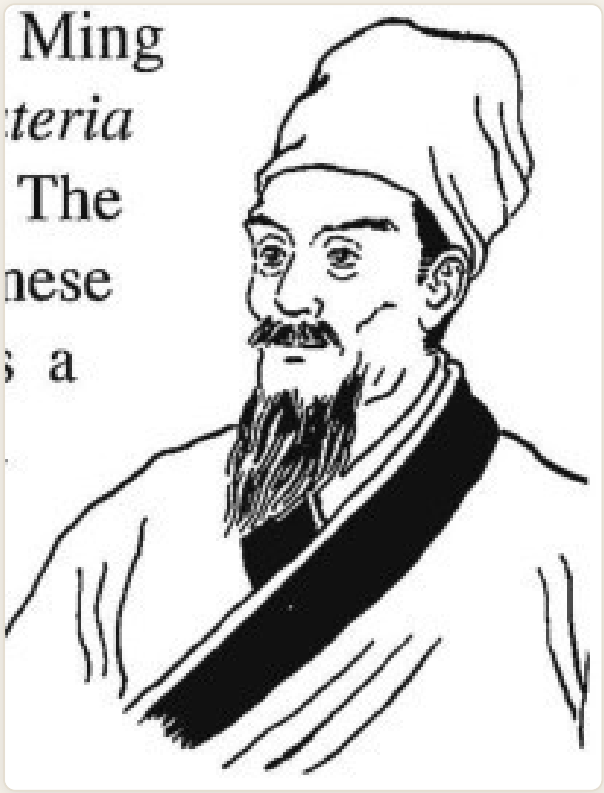
For example, *langmei* was widely believed to be an immortal fruit that would bestow eternal youth. Li Shizhen personally picked the fruit and tried it for himself. He discovered that it was just a mutated fruit of the elm tree with no special properties.

Pangolins were used as a medicinal drug. Earlier books had claimed the pangolin could live both on land and in water. It would feign death on land during the day and spread open its scales to lure ants into it, then go back into the water and spread open its scales to release the ants. When the ants floated to the water surface, it would swallow them as food. To verify this claim, Li

Shizhen approached hunters who lived in the mountains. He found out that pangolins actually attacked ants' nests and ate them by sticking their tongue out.

With his scientific and meticulous approach, Li Shizhen completed the *Compendium of Materia Medica* and made right many errors made by the forefathers of medicine. He also made significant contributions in the categorisation of plants and other related sciences (biology, chemistry, geology, mineralogy). The *Compendium of Materia Medica* has been translated into many languages and helped advance traditional Chinese medicine in the medical field.

FIG. 339



Line-drawing portrait of Li Shizhen: head and shoulders of a bearded physician in a Ming Dynasty scholar's cap, wearing a robe with a wide dark sash crossing his chest.

BOOK PAGE 167 · SCAN P176

Medicinal diets in the *Compendium of Materia Medica*

Medicinal diets in the *Compendium of Materia Medica*

Li Shizhen stressed medicinal diets to preserve health. Many medicinal food recipes were recorded in the *Compendium of Materia Medica*. Among the recipes was medicinal congee.

Walnut Congee

Ingredients: Walnut 60g, Millet 100g

Method: Crush the walnuts with the shells. Add some water and cook the millet into congee. Add the crushed walnut and cook until a film of oil forms on the surface of the congee. The congee should be taken warm twice a day.

Functions: It nourishes the kidneys and acts as an astringent for the lungs. It also moistens and replenishes the spleen and stomach.

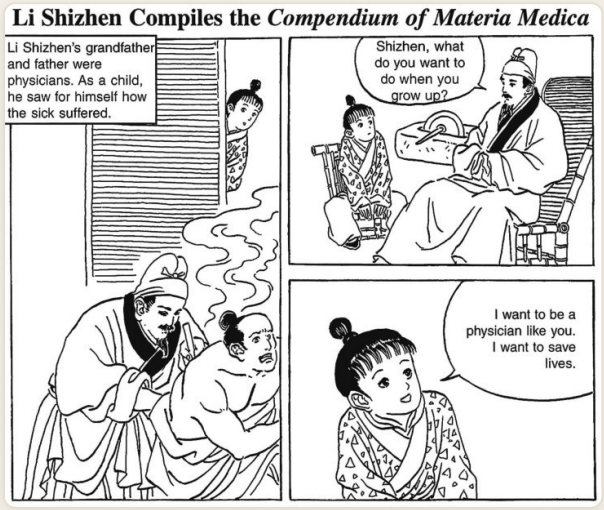
Li Shizhen Compiles the *Compendium of Materia Medica*

Li Shizhen's grandfather and father were physicians. As a child, he saw for himself how the sick suffered.

Shizhen, what do you want to do when you grow up?

I want to be a physician like you. I want to save lives.

FIG. 340



Three-panel comic strip. In the large left panel the boy Li Shizhen peeps through a barred lattice window while his father, a physician in a tall cap, treats a patient seated before him — the caption says his grandfather and father were physicians and that as a child he saw for himself how the sick suffered. In the upper right panel his father sits at a table with a small boy and asks him what he wants to do when he grows up. In the lower right panel the boy, hair tied in a topknot, answers with a bright face that he wants to be a physician like his father and save lives.

Trang 168

Shizhen, medical practice is not easy. I want you to study and be a court official one day.

Li Shizhen did not dare defy his father's wishes. He sat for the scholar's examination when he was 14.

But he still failed to make the grade after three attempts.

Father, I don't think I am made for the office. Let me study medicine.

All right. Perhaps this is fate.

And so Li Shizhen learnt medicine from his father.

At the same time, he also studied neo-Confucianism and history. After 10 years of hard work, Li Shizhen became a well-known physician in his town.

FIG. 341

Full-page comic strip in four scenes. In the first, Li Shizhen's father lays a hand on the boy's shoulder and tells him that medical practice is not easy, that he wants him to study and become a court official one day. In the second, the boy sits in a long hall packed with candidates bent over their examination papers, his father standing behind him; the caption says he did not dare defy his father's wishes and sat for the scholar's examination at fourteen. In the third, an elderly, white-bearded Li Shizhen sits with his father in a courtyard and tells him he is not made for office and asks to study medicine instead, to which his father answers that perhaps this is fate. In the fourth, he bends over his books at a desk lit by a candle, having learnt medicine from his father and, at the same time, studied neo-Confucianism and history; after ten years of hard work he became a well-known physician in his town.

BOOK PAGE 169 · SCAN P178

Trang 169

During the reign of Jiajing in the Ming Dynasty, Li Shizhen was summoned to the prince's residence. Shortly after, he was recommended to be an imperial physician.

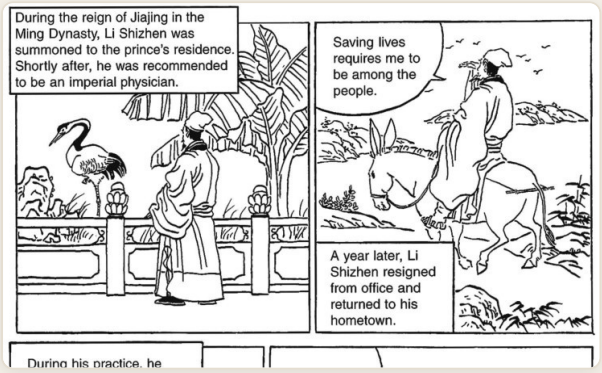
"Saving lives requires me to be among the people." A year later, Li Shizhen resigned from office and returned to his hometown.

During his practice, he discovered many errors in earlier medical journals.

"Ah! These errors may prove fatal. Besides, many of these ancient records on medicine are no longer relevant today."

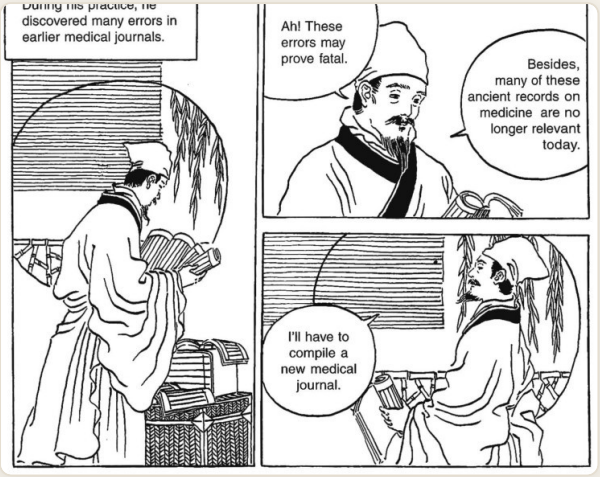
"I'll have to compile a new medical journal."

FIG. 342



Comic strip panel: Li Shizhen stands in the prince's courtyard beside a carved stone balustrade, a red-crowned crane perched on the rail and broad plantain leaves behind him; in the adjoining panel he rides a donkey along a country road with a bird flying overhead, having set off to be among the people.

FIG. 343



Comic strip panels: Li Shizhen sits at a table by a latticed window, poring over a bundle of old medical journals with a stack of books and a covered wicker basket beside him; in the adjoining panels he looks up in dismay at the errors he has found and resolves to compile a new medical journal.

Trang 170

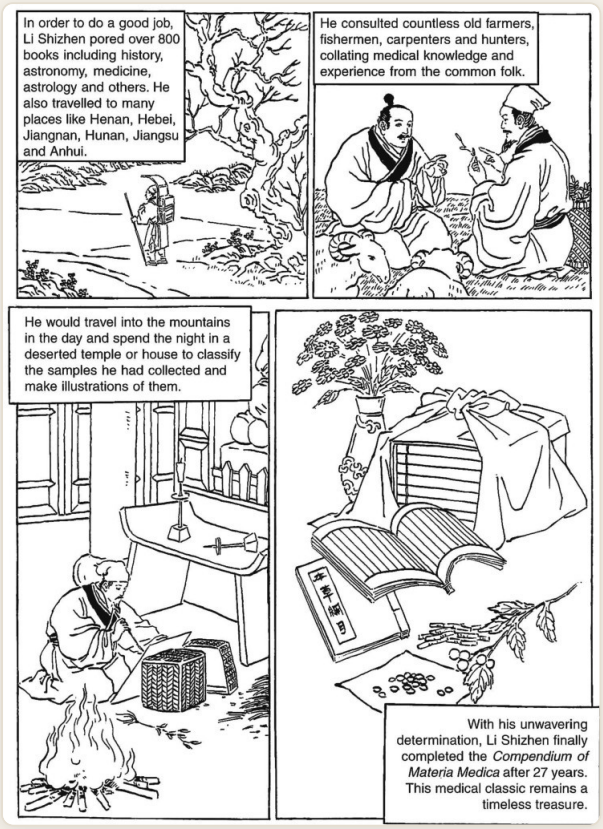
In order to do a good job, Li Shizhen pored over 800 books including history, astronomy, medicine, astrology and others. He also travelled to many places like Henan, Hebei, Jiangnan, Hunan, Jiangsu and Anhui.

He consulted countless old farmers, fishermen, carpenters and hunters, collating medical knowledge and experience from the common folk.

He would travel into the mountains in the day and spend the night in a deserted temple or house to classify the samples he had collected and make illustrations of them.

With his unwavering determination, Li Shizhen finally completed the *Compendium of Materia Medica* after 27 years. This medical classic remains a timeless treasure.

FIG. 344



Four comic panels showing Li Shizhen studying 800 books, consulting old farmers, fishermen, carpenters and hunters, sorting plant samples by night in a deserted temple, and finally completing the Compendium of Materia Medica.

BOOK PAGE 171 · SCAN P180

Ancient Female Physicians

Ancient Female Physicians

China had many female physicians too!

But very little was written about them. That is why few people know about them.

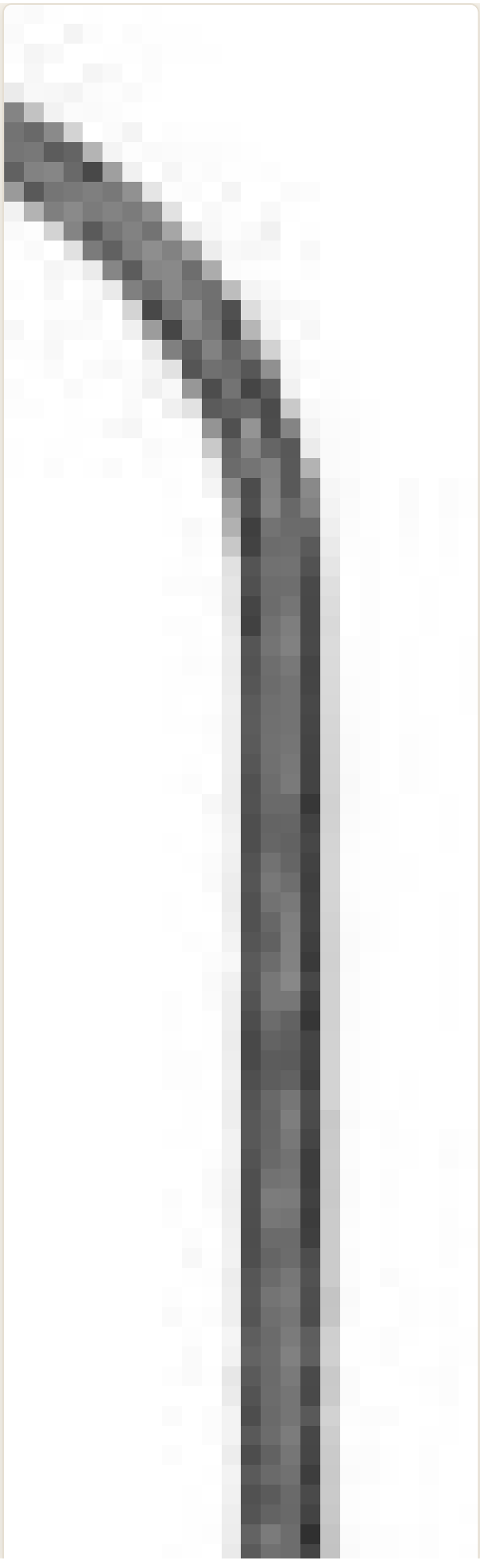
Chun Yuyan

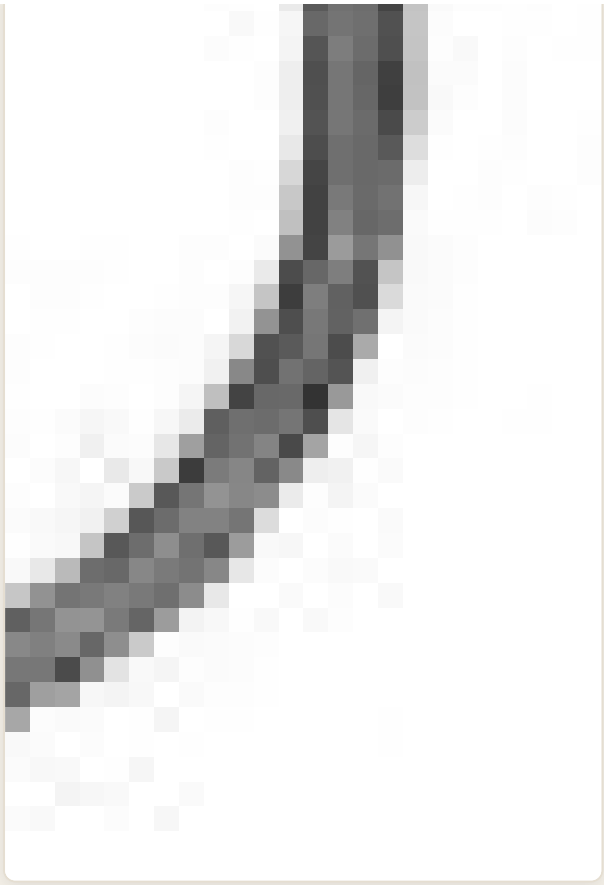
This female physician of the Han Dynasty was an expert in obstetrics and gynaecology. It is said she helped the Empress of her time during childbirth.

Bao Gu

A female physician during the Jin Dynasty. She was the wife of the famous academic Ge Hong. She learnt about medicine from her father and husband. She travelled widely to practise medicine and was especially good at moxibustion. The people later built a temple in her honour as a token of their gratitude towards her.

FIG. 345





Ornamental gourd motif beside the chapter title.

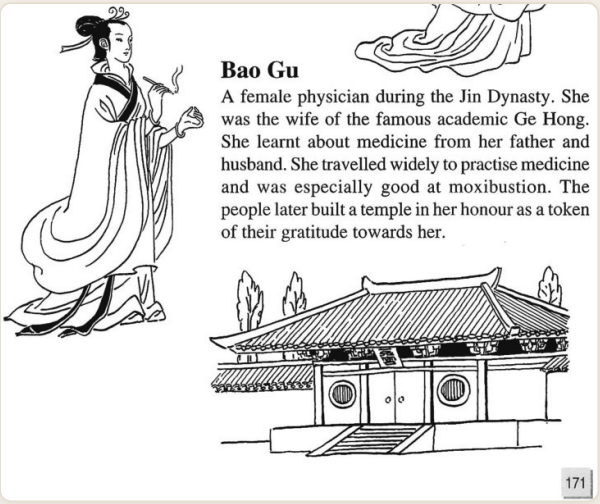
FIG. 346

A small decorative drawing of a dragon-like mythical creature accompanying the opening speech bubbles.

FIG. 347

An illustration of a female physician holding a newborn baby, alongside the speech bubble about female physicians being little recorded.

FIG. 348



A standing female physician holding a herb, with a temple building beneath the text about Bao Gu.

BOOK PAGE 172 · SCAN P181

Zeng Yi

Zeng Yi

The Qing Dynasty female physician wrote the *Gu Huan Shi Volume* in three parts — *Book on Females*, *Book on Medicine* and *Book on Poetry and Prose*. The *Book on Medicine* discoursed on pulse, colour of tongue, acute infectious febrile diseases, pathogenic wind, pathogenic cold, obstetrics and gynaecology, paediatrics and surgery.

Zeng Yi was struck by epidemics four times. So she had a personal knowledge of pathogenic cold and symptoms of acute infectious febrile diseases as well as their respective treatments. She often made up her own prescriptions and was adept at it. Zeng Yi was also very particular about teaching the people about personal hygiene. She recommended rest to preserve mental strength, breathing fresh air to preserve the lungs and frequent exercise to promote blood circulation. Zeng Yi may be considered the greatest female physician in ancient China.

Chinese medicine is not a male-dominated field. Female doctors have also made contributions.

BOOK PAGE 173 · SCAN P182

Modernisation of Chinese Medicine

Modernisation of Chinese Medicine

The unique theories, diagnostic methods and treatment in traditional Chinese medicine contrast greatly with western medicine. In order to stay relevant in the modern-day context, besides preserving the best of its traditions, traditional Chinese medicine has gradually embarked on the road towards modernisation.

Diagnosis goes hi-tech

Diagnosis goes hi-tech

Besides employing the four traditional methods of diagnosis, modern traditional Chinese medicine has also started to adopt technological devices to aid in the diagnostic process. There are diagnostic devices for analysing the acupoints and research is being conducted on an automated system for pulse diagnosis.

The Electrodermal Screening Device (EDSD) is one of the electronic gadgets that was designed to read the systems of collaterals and meridians and acupoints in traditional Chinese medicine. The doctor measures the electrical resistance on an acupoint with a pen-like tool while the patient holds a hand electrode to complete the circuit with the EDSD. This way, he will be able to find out the condition of the patient's internal organs, hormonal releases and others.

Experts in China and Hong Kong have also created a programme to collate and store countless pictures of patients' tongues in the computer. The computerised images will be further classified based on the colour and coating on the tongue. Reference material is then entered in the computer. The result is a programme that diagnoses diseases based on the condition of the tongue.

Computerized medical history

The use of computers is widespread in today's world. Chinese physicians have also begun to enter a patient's medical history and medication records into the computer. This greatly aids in recalling the patient's records and shortens the waiting time for a patient to see the doctor as well as the prescription of medication.

Chinese medicine in concentrate form

Chinese medicine in concentrate form

Chinese medicine often takes a long time to prepare. These days, Chinese medicine can be processed into a powder form with a strength from five to 15 times as concentrated. This not only ensures that the taste and efficacy of the medicine remains unaffected, it is also more economically viable.

Some medical halls also stock bottles of Chinese medicine concentrate. The pharmacist will dispense the concentrate based on the prescription given to him by the physician through the computer. The required quantity will then be packed in smaller bags and sealed before being dispensed to the patient.

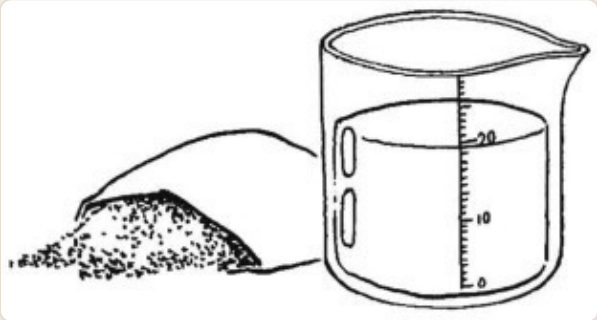
Chinese medicine in concentrate form and the prepared Chinese medicine we see in medical shops are different. The prepared Chinese medicine that we see are actually just compressed Chinese medicine in powder form.

The concentrate form of Chinese medicine involves a complex and stringent process where the essence of the active components has been extracted and treated.

Modern methods of decoction

To make things easier for the patients, some hospitals have installed special equipment to prepare Chinese medicine. High-pressure cookers will decoct the medicine before it is vacuum-sealed. Patients only have to reheat the medicine on reaching home before taking it. It is a fast and convenient system and has done away with the time-consuming decoction of medicine.

FIG. 349



A pile of powdered medicine beside a measuring beaker.

FIG. 350

A small cup of concentrated medicine being held up by the dragon-like mascot character.

FIG. 351

A pharmacist in a white coat preparing medicine in a storeroom lined with bottles of herbs.

East meets West

East meets West

Many integrated hospitals now offer both Chinese and western treatments to patients. They marry the two methods for greater efficacy in treating diseases. Some people have even called the modernisation of Chinese medicine and the marriage of Chinese and western medicine the Third Medical Science. This greater exchange of knowledge and learning between Chinese and western medicine will only benefit the human race.

Chinese medicine goes global

Recent years have seen a trend towards returning to nature. Developed countries like European nations and the US have begun to take notice of natural herbs and Chinese medicine. Where in the past Chinese medicine had been considered unscientific and behind the times, it is now gaining new respect in the modern medical field. Research has proven many traditional remedies to be effective.

At present, more than 120 countries have set up organisations for various schools of alternative medicine, including traditional Chinese medicine. Increasingly, people are willing to accept the methods of treatment and health care practised in traditional Chinese medicine. More western countries have developed an interest in researching this ancient science, and many foreign students have gone to China to study it as well.

The Trademark of Chinese Medicine - The Yin-Yang Fish

The Trademark of Chinese Medicine - The Yin-Yang Fish

What shop is this? A string of medicinal plasters hangs on either side of its doorpost.

This is a medical shop. Do you see the fish below the medicinal plasters?

The dark fish on the left represents yin while the right white fish represents yang. Put together, they become the yin-yang fish.

Also known as the *Taiji* (Grand Ultimate) Diagram, it's the emblem of traditional Chinese medicine.

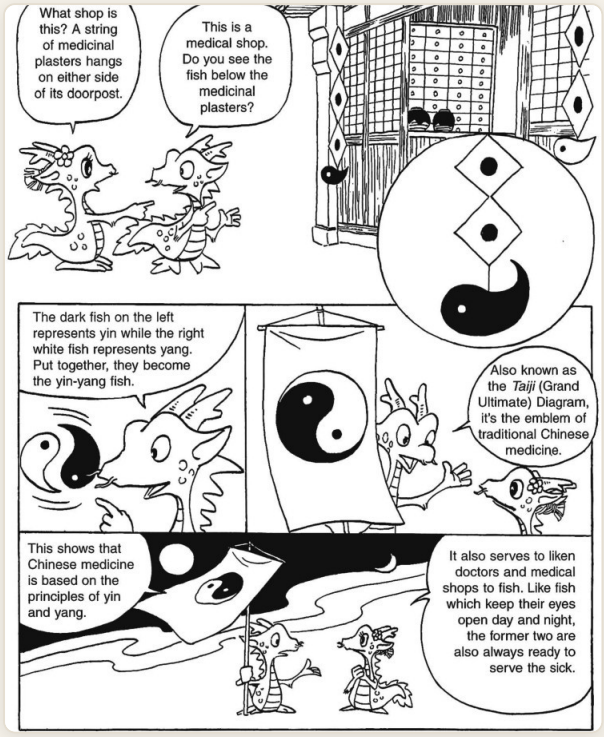
This shows that Chinese medicine is based on the principles of yin and yang.

It also serves to liken doctors and medical shops to fish. Like fish which keep their eyes open day and night, the former two are also always ready to serve the sick.

FIG. 352

A narrow decorative banner strip at the top of the page.

FIG. 353



A full-page comic strip: two dragon mascots stand before a medical shop hung with medicinal plasters, then a rounded panel magnifies the twin fish motif on the shopfront, followed by panels showing the yin-yang fish in a black-and-white roundel, on a hanging banner, and finally the two mascots sailing on a fish-shaped boat while the text likens doctors to ever-watchful fish.

Syndrome versus Symptom

Syndrome versus Symptom

We talked about the Eight Principal Syndromes in the earlier part of the book. The focus of traditional Chinese medicine is on the 'syndrome' as a whole rather than as 'symptoms'.

'Syndrome' versus 'symptom'

A symptom refers to the external manifestation of a disease, such as headaches and fevers. A syndrome takes into account the conditions caused by the disease, its nature, the affected areas and the relationship between disease-causing factors and the energies in play in the patient. A syndrome thus takes a wider and more comprehensive look at a disease.

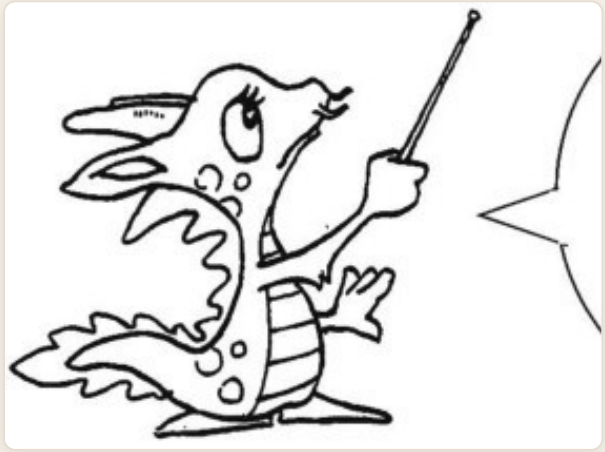
Chinese medicine follows a four-part methodology in diagnosis: observation, auscultation and olfaction, interrogation and pulse taking. The four steps of diagnosis are first used in consultation and the results derived are put together to arrive at a diagnosis based on an analysis of the symptoms and signs. Next, the treatment prescribed will be based on the diagnosis.

Hence, traditional Chinese medicine works on the 'syndrome' and not the 'symptom'. That is why patients suffering from similar symptoms which do not share the same syndrome will be given different treatments. Conversely, differing symptoms that share the same syndrome will be given the same treatment.

FIG. 354

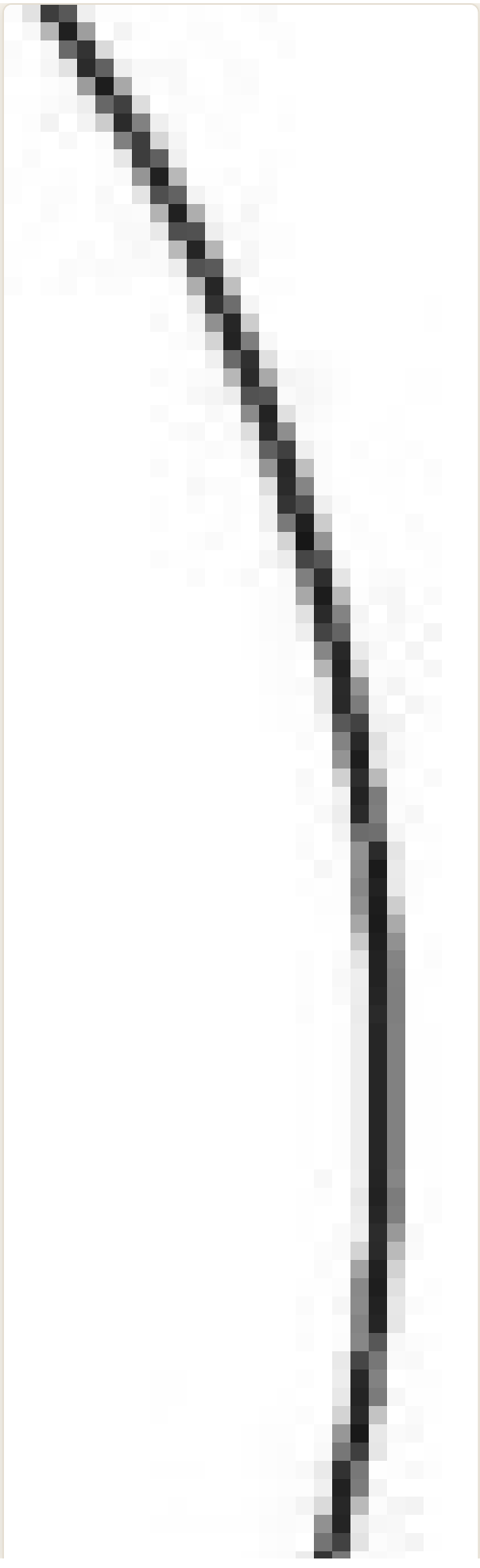
Fragment of the outline of the curved speech bubble.

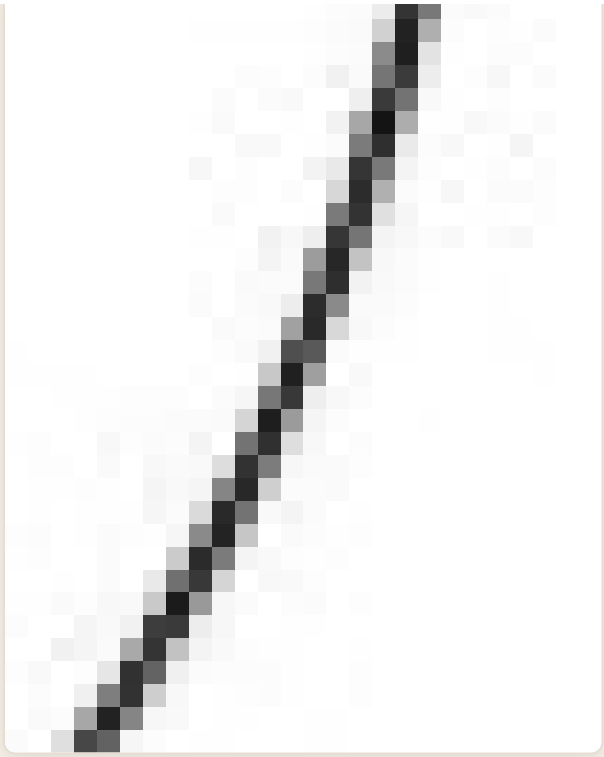
FIG. 355



Cartoon of the book's dragon-guide character, wearing a striped sash and pointing with a stick.

FIG. 356





Straight side edge of the speech bubble.

FIG. 357

Lower curved edge of the speech bubble.

Appendix

Appendix

The SARS outbreak

In February 2003, reports began trickling in about an outbreak of a mysterious atypical pneumonia in China, which had already infected 300 people and claimed five lives. Soon, it was spreading through Asia, and in March, the World Health Organisation (WHO) issued a global alert on what was becoming known as Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (SARS).

The WHO began a global surveillance on cases of atypical pneumonia as cases continued to appear in other countries in Europe, Asia and the Americas. By the time the epidemic finally ended in July, the virus had claimed 916 lives out of a total number of 8422 infected persons*.

Traditional Chinese medicine and the fight against SARS

Though SARS is a new disease, traditional Chinese medicine has acquired much experience in fighting epidemics and diseases of a similar type through the ages, as evidenced by Zhang Zhongjing's *Treatise on Febrile and Miscellaneous Diseases*, written well over 17 centuries ago.

In China, where the disease infected the greatest numbers, traditional Chinese medicine was combined with Western treatments to good effect. It was found to be most effective when started in the early stages of the disease, and in helping patients regain their strength during the recovery stage.

Here, in addition to acting directly to treat the disease, traditional Chinese medicine also helped to relieve pain, nausea and other side-effects of the Western treatments, especially as some of the Western medications used to suppress the virus also affected the body's own immune functions and caused the patient to become more susceptible to secondary infections from other pathogens.

*From the WHO summary: www.who.int/csr/sars/en/. Last updated 7 August 2003.

Defending against the threat of SARS

Defending against the threat of SARS

Though the SARS virus is in abeyance for now, some experts are concerned that the virus may return in the winter months, when the climate turns cooler again. Traditional Chinese medicine offers many preventive measures that can be taken to minimise your chances of succumbing to the disease.

In traditional Chinese medicine, SARS is classified as belonging to the heat syndrome with interior dampness, which act together to injure the qi in the lungs and bodily fluids quickly. Thus, treatment is centred on relieving internal heat, removing dampness, building qi and promoting the flow of fluids to detoxify the body.

Recipes to prevent SARS

Here are some tonic recipes to boost your immunity while reducing heat and dampness, taken from various websites on Chinese medicine.

Recipe 1

Honeysuckle 30g, woad root 10g, holly fern rhizome 10g, almond 10g, balloonflower root 10g, lilyturf root 15g, tangerine peel 6g, fresh liquorice 6g, chrysanthemum 6g.

Boil in 300ml of water for 15 minutes to condense it into 100ml. Take twice a day, morning and evening.

Recipe 2

Milkvetch root 10-12g, *baishu* 9g, ledebouriella root 6g, Japanese honeysuckle 9g, forsythia fruit 9g, reed rhizome 15-20g, mint 6g, platycodon root 6g, stir-baked liquorice 5g.

One dose a day, taken warm. Continue twice a day for five consecutive days.

Recipe 3

Cangshu 12g, *baishu* 15g, milkvetch root 15g, ledebouriella root 10g, giant hyssop 12g, glehnia root 15g, Japanese honeysuckle 20g, holly fern rhizome 12g.

Boil in water. Consume twice a day for seven to 10 consecutive days.

Recipe 4

Fresh reed rhizome 20g, Japanese honeysuckle 15g, forsythia fruit 15g, cicada slough 10g, white-stiff silkworm 10g, mint 6g, fresh liquorice 5g.

Boil in water and drink as a tea. Continue for seven to 10 consecutive days.

Recipe 5

Rhizome of cyrtomium 10g, Japanese honeysuckle 10g, forsythia fruit 10g, woad leaf 10g, *suye* 10g, kudzu vine root 10g, giant hyssop 10g, *cangshu* 10g, eupatorium 10g, pseudostarwort root 15g.

Boil in water and take twice a day for seven to 10 consecutive days.

Recipe 6

Honeysuckle 15g, forsythia fruit 15g, schizonepeta 15g, woad root 15g, houttuynia 30g, ledebouriella root 12g, mint 12g, skullcap root 12g, wild chrysanthemum 15g, liquorice 6g.

Soak for 30 minutes and bring to boil over a slow fire (add mint 10 minutes later) for 15 minutes. Take in three doses over three days.

Acupressure and moxibustion

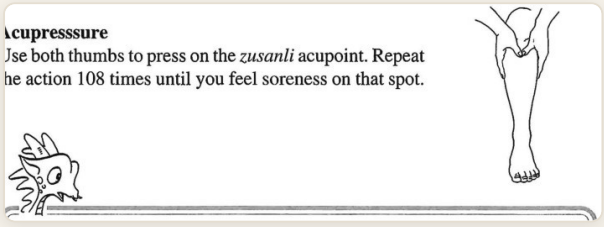
Acupressure and moxibustion

The *zusanli* acupoint, which can be found in both legs, strengthens the spleen and removes dampness.

Moxibustion

- - Light the moxa and place the moxa stick on the *zusanli* acupoints on both legs for five to 10 minutes.
- - Do it one or two times a day for five consecutive days.

FIG. 361



Acupressure: use both thumbs to press on the zusanli acupoint. Repeat the action 108 times until you feel soreness on that spot.

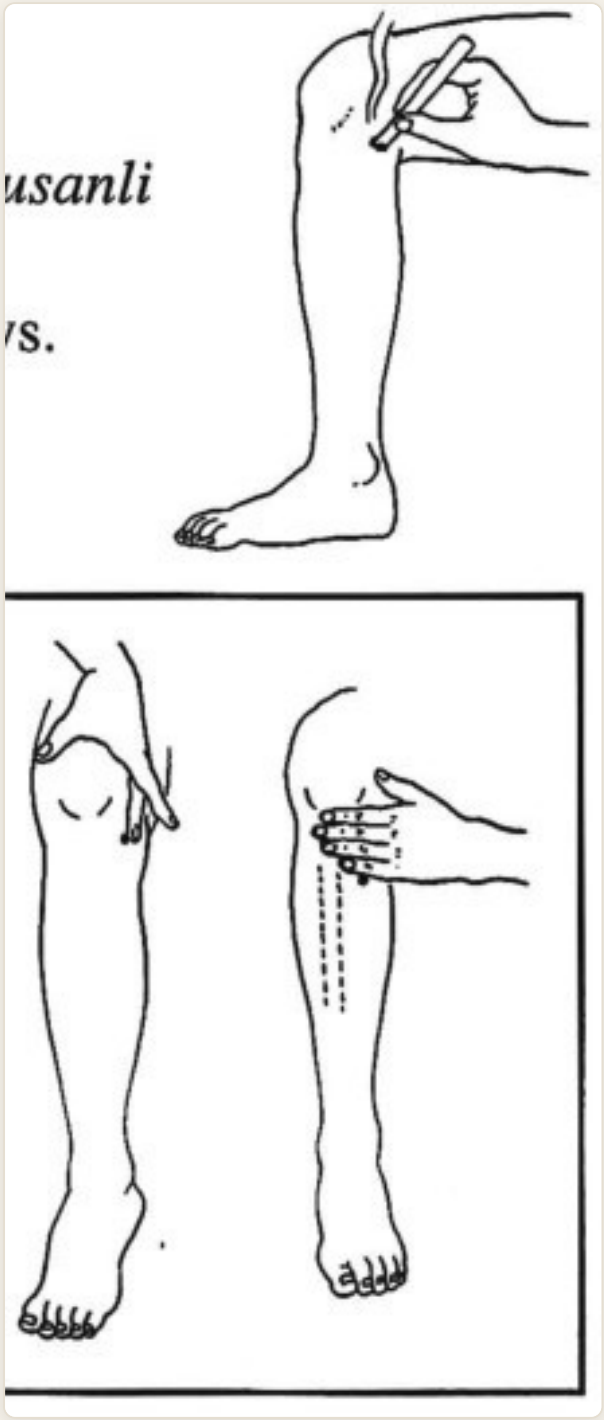
How to find it:

The *zusanli* acupoint is on the outer leg, three inches below the knee-cap. It is about one finger-breadth away from the front of the shin-bone.

Caution

Before taking any medicine, it is best to consult a physician first to make sure it suits your constitution. Remember, do not consume more than what is necessary! Also, moxibustion should only be carried out by professionals.

FIG. 358

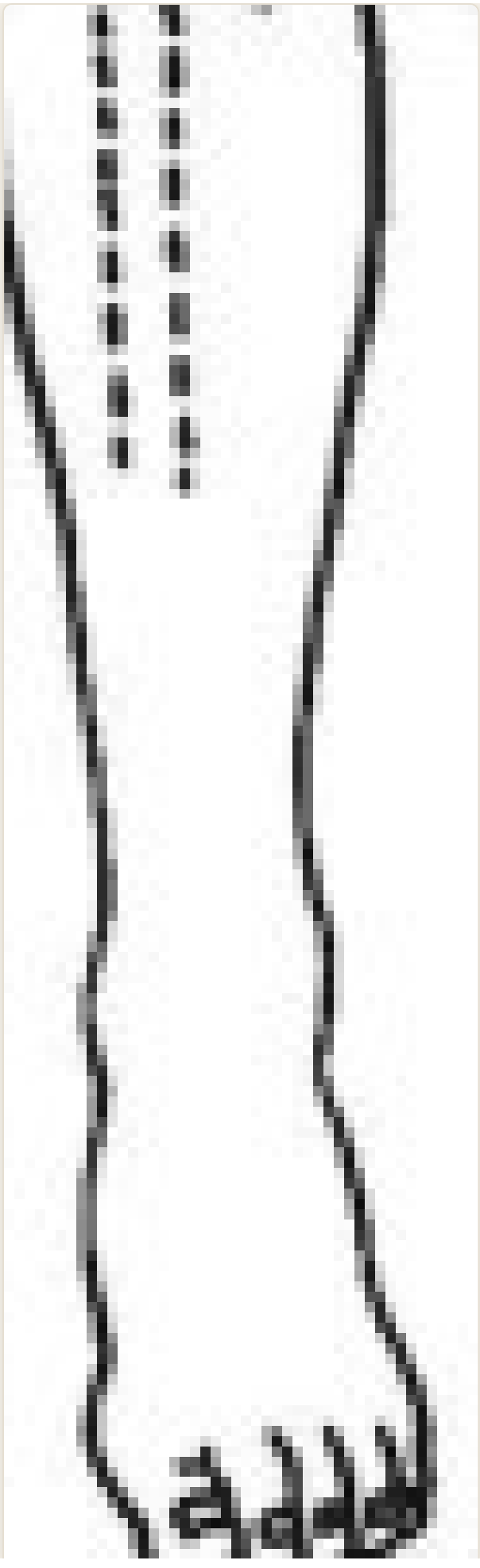


Illustrations of the leg showing how the zusanli acupoint is located and the moxibustion stick applied to it.

FIG. 359

Detail drawing marking the zusanli acupoint (足三里) on the outer lower leg.

FIG. 360



Line drawing of a lower leg and foot showing the pathway down to the acupoint.

CHINESE MEDICINE RESOURCES DIRECTORY

CHINESE MEDICINE RESOURCES DIRECTORY

MEDICAL ASSOCIATIONS

Singapore Chinese Physicians' Association

640 Toa Payoh Lorong 4

Singapore 319522

Tel: 65-6251 3428, 65-6251 3304

Fax: 65-6254 0037

website: en.singaporetcm.com

Singapore Association for Promoting Chinese Medicine

10 Lorong 9 Geylang

Singapore 388758

Tel: 65-6842 5470

Fax: 65-6741 3301

The Singapore Chinese Medical Union

21 Tyrwhitt Road

#05-04, Foo Chow Building

Singapore 207530

Tel: 65-6296 2645

Fax: 65-6536 5520

Singapore Acupuncture Association

60 Paya Lebar Road

#05-08, Paya Lebar Square

Singapore 409051

Tel: 65-6452 2988

website: www.acupuncture.org.sg

Society of Traditional Chinese Medicine (Singapore)

BIK 333 Kreta Ayer Road #01–12/13

Singapore 080333

Tel: 65-6323 0898/6225 2246

website: www.society-tcms.org

The Medicine Manufacturer Association of Singapore

132 Neil Road

Singapore 088861

Tel: 65-6224 5379

website: medmfg.org.sg

Singapore Chinese Druggists Association

119 Tyrwhitt Road

Singapore 207547

Tel: 65-6298 4740

Fax: 65-6299 3528

website: scda.org.sg

Singapore Chinese Drug Importers & Exporters Guild

151 Chin Swee Road

#15-02, Manhattan House

Singapore 169876

Tel: 65-6735 2983

Singapore Chinese Physicians' Training College Alumnus Association

Toa Payoh Central

P.O. Box 134

Singapore 913105

Tel: 65-6569 3905

Fax: 65-6256 3608

Singapore Chinese Medicines and Health Products Merchant Association

346A King George's Avenue

Singapore 208577

Tel: 65-6293 8019

Fax: 65-6293 5803

website: www.tcm.org.sg

MEDICAL INSTITUTES AND PRACTITIONERS

Singapore Thong Chai Medical Institution

50 Chin Swee Road

Thong Chai Building #01-01

Singapore 169874

Tel: 65-6733 6905

Fax: 65-6733 3552

website: www.stcmi.org.sg

Singapore Chung Hwa Medical Institution

No. 640 Toa Payoh Lorong 4

Singapore 319522

Tel: 65-6251 3304

Fax: 6254 0037

website: www.chunghwamedicalinstitution.com

Traditional Chinese Medicine Practitioners Board

website: www.healthprofessionals.gov.sg/content/hprof/tcmpb/en.html

CHINESE MEDICINE COURSES

CHINESE MEDICINE COURSES

Singapore College of Traditional Chinese Medicine

640 Toa Payoh Lor 4

Singapore 319522

Tel: 65-6250 3088

Fax: 6356 9901

website: www.singaporetcm.edu.sg

Professional courses in Chinese medicine.

TCM College (Singapore) Pte Ltd

371 Beach Road #02-37 Keypoint

Singapore 199597

Tel: 65-6227 9969

Fax: 65-6299 3294

Training school for Chinese Medicinal Materials Dispensers.

This listing is intended to be a resource for anyone with an interest in traditional Chinese medicine. If you wish to have your organisation or company included, please submit the name, address and contact information for your organization in English and Chinese. Listing is free. Thank you!

Fax: 6392 6455

Email: asiapacbooks@pacific.net.sg

WEB RESOURCES

Greater China Herbs

www.greaterchinaherbs.com

In English, Chinese, Japanese and Korean. It offers diet therapy, medicinal diets, tips on healthcare etc.

Traditional Chinese Medicine Basics

http://www.tcmbasics.com/

Learning resource for traditional Chinese medicine, with introductions to many fundamental theories.

Comprehensive Services of Traditional Chinese Medicine

http://www.tcmtreatment.com/

Online sale of books and herbs, with explanations and treatment advice for common ailments and an introduction to commonly used herbs.

Qi: The Journal of Traditional Eastern Health and Fitness

http://qi-journal.com/

Information on traditional Chinese medicine, including acupuncture, qigong, herbs, taijiquan. Also contains sections on Chinese culture and philosophy.

Translation complete

The book is complete — 192 scan pages (p001–p192).

All 361 figures have been cropped from the source scan and placed at their positions.

Contents: the concept and theory behind Chinese medicine, the methods of diagnosis, the six methods of treatment (medicinals, acupuncture, massotherapy, diet therapy, psychotherapy, qigong), the famous physicians, and the modernisation of Chinese medicine.

Built with ❤ for the Vietnamese Tai Chi community by Henry Phạm